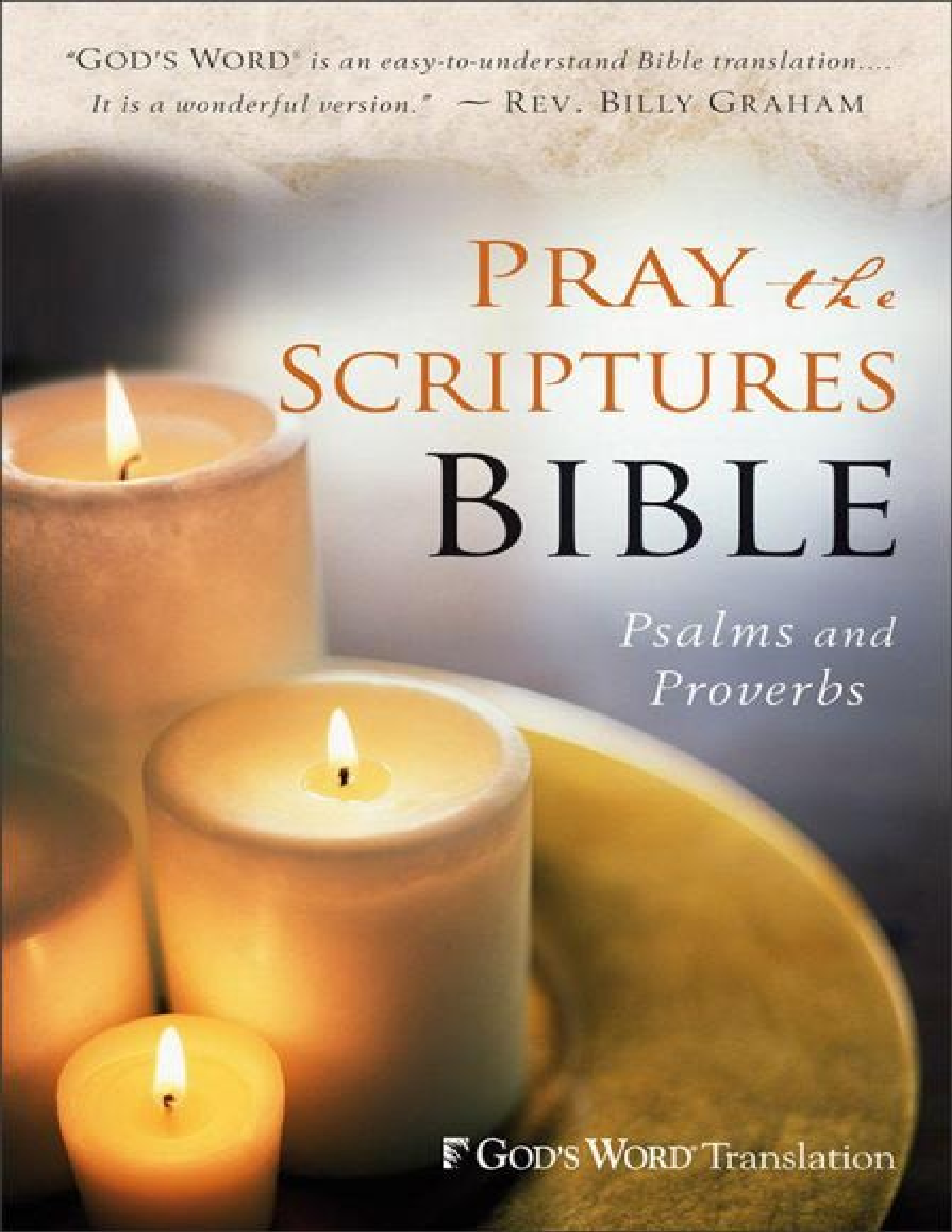


*"GOD'S WORD® is an easy-to-understand Bible translation....
It is a wonderful version."* ~ REV. BILLY GRAHAM

The background of the cover features a close-up photograph of three lit candles. Two are tall and cylindrical, while the third is shorter and wider. They are all lit, with bright yellow flames. The candles are resting in a shallow, circular brass tray. The lighting is warm and soft, creating a peaceful and contemplative atmosphere.

PRAY *the* SCRIPTURES BIBLE

*Psalms and
Proverbs*

 GOD'S WORD® Translation



PRAY *the*
SCRIPTURES
BIBLE

*Psalms and
Proverbs*



BETHANY HOUSE PUBLISHERS

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Preface

***GOD'S WORD*® Translation**

GOD'S WORD® Translation (GW), produced by God's Word to the Nations Mission Society, fills a need that has remained unmet by English Bibles: to translate the Bible from the Hebrew, Aramaic, and Greek texts to their closest natural English equivalent.

GW consciously combines scholarly fidelity with natural English. Because it was translated by a committee of biblical scholars, GW is an accurate, trustworthy translation. Because of the involvement of English reviewers at every stage of the translation process, GW reads like contemporary literature.

Closest Natural Equivalence

Like many Bibles published before it, *GOD'S WORD* has been translated directly from the Hebrew, Aramaic, and Greek texts. Unlike many Bibles before it, however, GW used a translation theory that reflects the advancement of translation theory and practice.

Closest natural equivalent (CNE) translation provides readers with a meaning in the target language that is equivalent to that of the source language. It seeks to express that meaning naturally, in a way that a native English speaker would speak or write. Finally, it expresses the meaning with a style that preserves many of the characteristics of the source text.

However, CNE does not attempt to make all books or passages function on the same level. The more difficult books of the Bible are translated to the same level of difficulty as the original languages. In addition, abstract concepts in Greek and Hebrew are translated into abstract concepts in English, and concrete concepts remain concrete in translation.

This translation theory is designed to avoid the awkwardness and inaccuracy associated with formal-equivalent translations, and to avoid the loss of meaning and oversimplification associated with functional-equivalent translations.

Translation Process

The first consideration for the translators of GW was to find equivalent English ways of expressing the meaning of the original text, ensuring that the translation is faithful to the meaning of the source text. The next consideration was readability; the meaning is expressed in natural

English by using common English punctuation, capitalization, grammar, and vocabulary. The third consideration was to choose the natural equivalent that most closely reflects the style of the Hebrew, Aramaic, or Greek text. At the core of this effort was a full-time translation team composed of biblical scholars who served as translators, English experts who actively reviewed English style with scholars at every stage of the translation process, and professional production personnel who oversaw the work. The basic process is outlined below.

Translation

In the first step of this process, a biblical scholar used the principles of closest natural equivalence to produce an initial translation of one of the books of the Bible. During this time, the translator was able to consult with the rest of the translation team as needed.

English Review

With the initial draft of a book completed, an expert in English style reviewed the translator's text and suggested changes. The English reviewer was concerned primarily with a natural English rendering. Additionally, the English reviewer electronically searched the entire translation to ensure that any proposed revisions would not destroy the translation's consistency.

The translator and the English reviewer then worked together to produce a second draft that improved both the naturalness and accuracy of the translation. Upon completion of the second draft, the translator and English reviewer served as resources for the rest of the editorial process.

Peer Review

After the English review process, the second draft was circulated to the other full-time translators and English reviewers for comments. This peer review stage allowed the other members of the translation team to compare the draft with their own work, offer suggestions for further improvement, and maintain consistency from one book of the Bible to another.

Technical Review

The translator and English reviewer incorporated all appropriate suggestions offered in the peer review stage to produce a third draft. This draft was then submitted to a number of scholarly technical reviewers, who submitted written suggestions for improvements in the translation.

Review by Book Editorial Committee

The next step in the process produced a fourth draft of the text. Taking into account the comments of the technical reviewers, a book editorial committee met to read and discuss the text for each book of the Bible.

The final step for the book editorial committee was reading the text aloud. Since the Bible is read not only silently but also aloud in worship and instructional settings, having a Bible translation that can be immediately grasped by the listener or reader and understood without the benefit of rereading was an important consideration.

Review by Consultative Committee

After the members of the book editorial committee finished their work, they passed the fourth draft to the members of the consultative committee. This group of more than fifty Christian leaders from various denominations submitted comments and suggestions.

Review by Old Testament, New Testament, and Bible Editorial Committees

The final editorial changes were made when all the books of the Bible had been completed or were near completion. Old and New Testament committees and, finally, a Bible editorial committee approved the accuracy and readability of the text.

Features of **GOD'S WORD®**

Layout

The features that distinguish *GOD'S WORD* from other Bible translations are designed to aid readers. The most obvious of these is the open, single-column format.

In prose, GW looks like other works of literature. It contains frequent paragraphing. Whenever a different speaker's words are quoted, a new paragraph begins. Lists, genealogies, and long prayers are formatted to help readers recognize the thought pattern of the text. The prose style of GW favors concise, clear sentences. While avoiding very long, complicated sentences, which characterize many English Bible translations, GW strives to vary the word arrangement in a natural way. Doing this enhances readability and brings the Scriptures to life.

The books that are primarily poetry in GW are instantly recognized by their format. The single-column format enables readers to recognize parallel thoughts in parallel lines of poetry. In a single-column, across-the-page layout, a variety of indentations are possible. The translators have used indentation to indicate the relationship of one line to others in the same context. This enables a person reading the Bible in English to appreciate the Bible's poetry in much the same way as a person reading the Bible in the original languages of Hebrew, Aramaic, or Greek.

Punctuation, Capitalization

In English, meaning is conveyed not only by words but also by punctuation. However, no punctuation existed in ancient Hebrew and Greek writing, and words were used where English would use punctuation marks. *GOD'S WORD* strives to use standard English punctuation wherever possible. At times this means that a punctuation mark or paragraph break represents the meaning that could only be expressed in words in Hebrew or Greek.

Italics are also used as they would be in other printed English texts: for foreign words or to indicate that a word is used as a word. (GW never uses italics to indicate emphasis.) Wherever possible, GW has supplied information in headings or half-brackets to identify the speaker in quoted material. To minimize the confusion produced by quotations within quotations, quotation marks are used sparingly. For instance, they are not used after formulaic statements such as “This is what the LORD says: . . .”

Contractions can fit comfortably into many English sentences. Certainly, “Don’t you care that we’re going to die” is more natural than, “Do you not care that we are going to die?” GW achieves a warmer style by using contractions where appropriate. But uncontracted words are used in contexts that require special emphasis.

GW capitalizes the first letter in proper nouns and sentences and all the letters in the word LORD when it represents *Yahweh*, the name of God in the Old

Testament. Some religious literature chooses to capitalize pronouns that refer to the deity. As in the original languages, GW does not capitalize any pronouns (unless they begin sentences). In some cases scholars are uncertain whether pronouns in the original texts refer to God or someone else. In these cases the presence of capitalized pronouns would be misleading. Additionally, in some cases Hebrew or Greek pronouns are not ambiguous but an English pronoun would be. In those cases, GW uses the appropriate proper noun in its place.

Gender References

The Scriptures contain many passages that apply to all people. Therefore, *GOD's WORD* strives to use gender-inclusive language in these passages so that all readers will apply these passages to themselves. For example, traditionally, Psalm 1:1 has been translated, "Blessed is the man who does not follow the advice of the wicked. . . ." As a result, many readers will understand this verse to mean that only adult males, not women or children, can receive a blessing. In GW the first psalm begins "Blessed is the person who does not follow the advice of the wicked. . . ."

If a passage focuses upon an individual, however, GW does not use plural nouns and pronouns to avoid the gender-specific pronouns *he*, *him*, and *his*. In these cases the translators considered the text's focus upon an individual more important than an artificial use of plural pronouns. For example, Psalm 1:2 has been translated "Rather, he delights in the teachings of the LORD. . . ." In addition, gender-accurate language is preserved in passages that apply specifically to men or specifically to women.

Word Choice

The translation team chose words that were natural in context and that were as easily understood as possible without losing accuracy and faithfulness to the Hebrew and Greek texts of the Bible.

One of the challenges faced by the translators of GW was finding words that accurately communicate the meaning of important theological concepts in the Bible. Many of these concepts have traditionally been translated by words that no longer communicate to most English speakers. Examples of these theological terms include *covenant*, *grace*, *justify*, *repent*, and *righteousness*. While these words continue to be used by theologians and even by many Christians, the meanings that readers assign to them in everyday use do not equate to the meanings of the Hebrew or Greek words they are intended to translate. *GOD'S WORD* avoids using these terms and substitutes words that carry the same meaning in clear, natural English. In some cases traditional theological words are contained in footnotes the first time they occur in a chapter.

Living, Active, and Life-changing

While all these features make *GOD'S WORD* Translation an accurate and readable Bible, the ultimate goal of the

God's Word to the Nations Mission Society is to bring the readers of GW into a new or closer relationship with Jesus. The translation team and support staff of the Mission Society pray that your reading of GW makes the living, active, and life-changing words of our great God and Savior clear and meaningful.

For more details on the translation process and the unique features that enable GW to accurately and clearly communicate God's saving, life-changing message, visit www.godsword.org. For more information on available editions of GW, visit www.godswordtranslation.org.

Notes on the Text of God's Word

Brackets

Proper names or foreign words whose meaning is significant for understanding a particular Bible passage are translated in brackets ([]) following the name or phrase. When reading aloud, a bracketed word may be treated as “that is.”

Half-brackets (⸮ ⸭) enclose words that the translation team supplied because the context contains meaning that is not explicitly stated in the original language.

Footnotes

Five types of footnotes are used in *GOD's WORD*:

1. Explanatory footnotes clarify historical, cultural, and geographical details from the ancient world to make the text more understandable to modern readers. These footnotes also identify word play in Hebrew or Greek that would otherwise be lost to the English reader.
2. Alternate translation footnotes offer other plausible translations. They are introduced by the word *or*.
3. Footnotes that state “English equivalent difficult” mark passages where a Hebrew or Greek expression cannot be adequately translated into modern English without resorting to a long, inappropriate paraphrase.
4. Footnotes that state “Hebrew meaning uncertain” or “Greek meaning uncertain” mark passages where scholars are not sure exactly what a Hebrew or Greek expression means.
5. Textual footnotes are included wherever *God's Word* translates the meaning of some text other than the Masoretic Text printed in *Biblia Hebraica Stuttgartensia* or its footnotes (Old Testament) or the Greek text printed in the twenty-seventh edition of *Novum Testamentum Graece* (New Testament).

Terms Used in Footnotes

Aramaic	one of the languages of the Old Testament, related to Hebrew
Dead Sea Scrolls	one or more of the Qumran manuscripts
Egyptian	one or more of the ancient translations of the Bible into the ancient Egyptian or Ethiopic languages
Greek	in the Old Testament: one or more of the ancient Greek translations of the Old Testament; in the New Testament: the Greek language, the language of the New Testament
Hebrew	the primary language of the Old Testament

Latin	one or more of the ancient Latin translations of the Bible
Masoretic Text	the traditional Hebrew text of the Old Testament
manuscript	an ancient, handwritten copy of a text
Samaritan Pentateuch	Samaritan Hebrew version of the first five books of the Bible
Syriac	the ancient Syriac translation of the Bible
Targum	one of the ancient Aramaic translations of the Old Testament

INTRODUCTION TO *PRAY THE SCRIPTURES BIBLE*

Most people pray. Many of us struggle. We wonder what to say to God and how to say it. We worry if we will get what we ask or if we can speak honest questions.

Pray the Scriptures Bible shows that all of God's Word teaches us how to pray. I envisioned this experiential Bible as a fresh, accurate, straightforward translation together with a stream of prayers flowing from both heart and mind, speaking back to the God who speaks to us in the Bible.

The prayers intentionally stay close to the Bible text. Prompted by Scripture, they capture an everyday conversation with God. Praying the whole Bible forces us to form prayers from both teachings and stories . . . to make sense of challenging and awkward passages . . . to find personal relevance in verses dense with history and sparse on obvious application.

Pray the Scriptures Bible is a personal response to Scripture, but I searched for themes and words that fit easily in anyone's mouth. I hope these prayers encourage your own one-on-one conversation with God—that these simple words help you process your own life circumstances and give voice to your own spiritual

longings, wonderings, and worship.

Don't keep these prayers to yourself. Pray them *for* others—family, friends, neighbors, co-workers, people you struggle to love, and the world at large. Pray them *with* others—in pairs, groups, and gatherings.

Thanks to Bethany House Publishers, from David Horton and Natasha Sperling to the entire staff, for partnering to use the *God's Word*® Translation to make this idea real. They join me in praying that this unique Bible will inspire your quest to know and experience God.

KEVIN JOHNSON

May 2011

Introduction to Psalms

As the songbook of God's Old Testament people, the psalms breathe prayer from start to finish. These songs, poems, and prayers were composed by a variety of people over a thousand-year span. Many flowed from King David, "the singer of Israel's psalms" (2 Samuel 23:1). Others come from Asaph and Ethan, national worship leaders appointed by David. Several of the earliest psalms trace back to Moses, Solomon added others, and a priestly family named the "Son of Korah" contributed songs over a period of centuries.

Although Israel incorporated these psalms into formal group worship, many relay intensely personal cries of individuals. Praise, confusion, remorse, anger, and joy come raw and unfiltered. And throughout history this songbook of Israel has become the prayer book of all God's people. Believers find here not only comforting words and beautiful prose but also a grid for processing life's most extreme difficulties. The psalms leave no doubt God can handle your speaking out loud your most wrenching emotions. They also make obvious that God won't abandon you to despair. He aims to lead you to new calm, purpose, and trust.

A surprising number of these songs talk about God and his acts in third person. Praying this book invites you to turn these declarations *about* God into prayers *to* God. Whatever the subject of these psalms, however much their bluntness challenges you, no matter how near or far their world seems from yours, you can make these inspired words part of your everyday conversation with God.

PSALMS

BOOK ONE

(Psalms 1–41)

Psalm 1

- ¹ Blessed is the person who does not
follow the advice of wicked people,
take the path of sinners,
or join the company of mockers.
- ² Rather, he delights in the teachings of the LORD
and reflects on his teachings day and night.

1:1–2 I would rather search your Word day and night than indulge evil opinions or sinful paths or mocking crowds. Lift me to your place of blessing.

- ³ He is like a tree planted beside streams—
a tree that produces fruit in season
and whose leaves do not wither.
He succeeds in everything he does.[\[1\]](#)

1:3 Plant me beside life-giving streams where I can drink you deeply. Let me be and do everything you plan for me. Give me success as I live your way.

- ⁴ Wicked people are not like that.
Instead, they are like husks that the wind blows away.
- ⁵ That is why wicked people will not be able to stand in the judgment
and sinners will not be able to stand where righteous people gather.

1:4–5 Don't let me dry up and blow away in the wind of your judgment. I choose to stand side by side with those who love you.

⁶ The LORD knows the way of righteous people,
but the way of wicked people will end.

Psalm 2

¹ Why do the nations gather together?
Why do their people devise useless plots?
² Kings take their stands.
Rulers make plans together
against the LORD and against his Messiah^[2] by saying,
³ “Let’s break apart their chains
and shake off their ropes.”

2:1–3 The whole world revolts against you with useless plots. The powerful and powerless alike try to shake off your reign. But I bow to you as my Lord.

⁴ The one enthroned in heaven laughs.
The LORD makes fun of them.
⁵ Then he speaks to them in his anger.
In his burning anger he terrifies them by saying,

2:4–5 You laugh at human rebels and burn with anger against them. You terrify them with the announcement of your rule.

⁶ “I have installed my own king on Zion, my holy mountain.”

⁷ I will announce the LORD’s decree.
He said to me:
“You are my Son.
Today I have become your Father.
⁸ Ask me, and I will give you the nations as your inheritance
and the ends of the earth as your own possession.

2:6–8 You’ve enthroned your Son as the one and only King over the whole earth. Every nation belongs to him.

⁹ You will break them with an iron scepter.
You will smash them to pieces like pottery.”

¹⁰ Now, you kings, act wisely.
Be warned, you rulers of the earth!

2:9–10 You break those who war against you, shattering them like brittle clay. I grow wise when I think hard about this fact!

¹¹ Serve the LORD with fear, and rejoice with trembling.
¹² Kiss the Son, or he will become angry
and you will die on your way
because his anger will burst into flames.
Blessed is everyone who takes refuge in him.

2:11–12 I serve you with trembling joy. I give you a loyal kiss. I smile as I submit to you. And I enjoy your blessing as I take refuge in you.

Psalm 3

A psalm by David when he fled from his son Absalom.

¹ O LORD, look how my enemies have increased!
Many are attacking me.
² Many are saying about me,
“Even with God on his side,
he won’t be victorious.” *Selah*

3:1–2 My enemies swarm around me. They say your help isn’t enough.

³ But you, O LORD, are a shield that surrounds me.
You are my glory.
You hold my head high.

⁴ I call aloud to the LORD,
and he answers me from his holy mountain. *Selah*

3:3–4 But you protect me on every side. You hold my head high. You are my powerful answer from heaven.

⁵ I lie down and sleep.
I wake up again because the LORD continues to support me.

3:5 Because you support me I can fall asleep each night and wake every morning.

⁶ I am not afraid of the tens of thousands
who have taken positions against me on all sides.

⁷ Arise, O LORD!
Save me, O my God!
You have slapped all my enemies in the face.
You have smashed the teeth of wicked people.
⁸ Victory belongs to the LORD!
May your blessing rest on your people. *Selah*

3:6–8 The thousands who entrap me don't scare me, because I know you'll come to my rescue.
Strike the jaws set hard against me. Seize your victory!

Psalm 4

For the choir director; with stringed instruments; a psalm by David.

¹ Answer me when I call, O God of my righteousness.
You have freed me from my troubles.
Have pity on me, and hear my prayer!

² You important people,
how long are you going to insult my honor?
How long are you going to love what is empty
and seek what is a lie? *Selah*

4:1–2 Answer me, O God who makes me righteous. As you’ve freed me in the past, hear my prayer now! Important people hurl insults at me as they chase empty and untrue things. Protect me!

³ Know that the LORD singles out godly people for himself.
The LORD hears me when I call to him.

⁴ Tremble and do not sin.
Think about this on your bed and remain quiet. *Selah*

4:3–4 You’ve singled me out and made me your own. I’ll keep doing good while I wait quietly for your answer.

⁵ Offer the sacrifices of righteousness
by trusting the LORD.

⁶ Many are saying, “Who can show us anything good?”
Let the light of your presence shine on us, O LORD.

⁷ You put more joy in my heart
than when their grain and new wine increase.

4:5–7 You shine on everyone who trusts you. You give me more joy than every kind of abundant possession.

⁸ I fall asleep in peace the moment I lie down
because you alone, O LORD, enable me to live securely.

Psalm 5

For the choir director; for flutes; a psalm by David.

¹ Open your ears to my words, O LORD.
Consider my innermost thoughts.

² Pay attention to my cry for help, my king and my God,
because I pray only to you.

³ In the morning, O LORD, hear my voice.
In the morning I lay my needs in front of you,
and I wait.

5:1–3 Help me! Hear my words and my unspoken thoughts. I count on you alone. Each morning I tell you my needs, and all day long I watch for your answers.

⁴ You are not a God who takes pleasure in wickedness.
Evil will never be your guest.

⁵ Those who brag cannot stand in your sight.
You hate all troublemakers.

⁶ You destroy those who tell lies.
The LORD is disgusted with bloodthirsty and deceitful people.

5:4–6 You can't stand evil. You chase it from your presence. Braggers and troublemakers and liars can't come close to you.

⁷ But I will enter your house because of your great mercy.
Out of reverence for you, I will bow toward your holy temple.

⁸ O LORD, lead me in your righteousness because of those who spy on me.
Make your way in front of me smooth.

5:7–8 Only your mercy allows me to come near you. Only your righteousness leads my path and smooths my way.

⁹ Nothing in their mouths is truthful.
Destruction comes from their hearts.
Their throats are open graves.
They flatter with their tongues.

¹⁰ Condemn them, O God.
Let their own schemes be their downfall.
Throw them out for their many crimes
because they have rebelled against you.

5:9–10 Liars breathe death in my direction. Don't let these rebels stand. Trap them in their own schemes. Toss them from your presence.

¹¹ But let all who take refuge in you rejoice.

Let them sing with joy forever.
Protect them, and let those who love your name triumph in you.
¹² You bless righteous people, O LORD.
Like a large shield, you surround them with your favor.

5:11–12 But let me stay close to you and sing. Support those who do your will. Surround them with your favor.

Psalm 6

For the choir director; with stringed instruments, on the sheminith,[\[3\]](#) *a psalm by David.*

- ¹ O LORD, do not punish me in your anger
or discipline me in your rage.
² Have pity on me, O LORD, because I am weak.
Heal me, O LORD, because my bones shake
with terror.

6:1–2 You have every reason to rage at me. But treat me with mercy, because I'm weak. Heal me, because I shake with terror.

- ³ My soul has been deeply shaken with terror.
But you, O LORD, how long . . . ?
⁴ Come back, O LORD.
Rescue me.
Save me because of your mercy!
⁵ In death, no one remembers you.
In the grave, who praises you?

6:3–5 I wonder where you've gone and when you'll be back to save me. It won't do you any good to watch me die, because no one will be left to worship you.

- ⁶ I am worn out from my groaning.

My eyes flood my bed every night.
I soak my couch with tears.
⁷ My eyes blur from grief.
They fail because of my enemies.

6:6–7 I can't stop groaning and crying. My eyes overflow with tears and I can't see straight.

⁸ Get away from me, all you troublemakers,
because the LORD has heard the sound of my crying.
⁹ The LORD has heard my plea for mercy.
The LORD accepts my prayer.
¹⁰ All my enemies will be put to shame and deeply
shaken with terror.
In a moment they will retreat and be put to shame.

6:8–10 I know you've heard my cries. And now my tormenters will run scared because you're coming to help me. You'll push them away and put them to shame.

Psalm 7

A shiggaion^[4] by David; he sang it to the LORD about the „slandorous„ words of Cush, a descendant of Benjamin.

¹ O LORD my God, I have taken refuge in you.
Save me, and rescue me from all who are
pursuing me.
² Like a lion they will tear me to pieces
and drag me off with no one to rescue me.

7:1–2 People hungry for my flesh hunt me. They mean to tear me apart. But you are my safe place.

³ O LORD my God,
if I have done this—
if my hands are stained with injustice,

⁴ if I have paid back my friend with evil
or rescued someone who has no reason to attack me—[5]
⁵ then let the enemy chase me and catch me.
Let him trample my life into the ground.
Let him lay my honor in the dust. *Selah*

7:3–5 If I've done wrong, then let my pursuers catch me and kill me. If I've acted unjustly or wronged my friends, then let them drag me to my death.

⁶ Arise in anger, O LORD.
Stand up against the fury of my attackers.
Wake up, my God.[6]
You have already pronounced judgment.
⁷ Let an assembly of people gather around you.
Take your seat high above them.

7:6–7 Wake up! You've already decided I'm right. Let the whole world hear your verdict. Let them watch you rise against my attackers.

⁸ The LORD judges the people of the world.
Judge me, O LORD,
according to my righteousness,
according to my integrity.

⁹ Let the evil within wicked people come to an end,
but make the righteous person secure,
O righteous God who examines thoughts and emotions.

7:8–9 You judge everybody on earth. So confirm my integrity. Examine my pure mind and heart. Consider my motives. Then shield me from sinners. Lock me in a safe place.

¹⁰ My shield is God above,
who saves those whose motives are decent.

¹¹ God is a fair judge,
a God who is angered by injustice every day.

¹² If a person does not change, God sharpens his sword.
By bending his bow, he makes it ready └to shoot┐.

¹³ He prepares his deadly weapons
and turns them into flaming arrows.

7:11–13 You never tolerate injustice. It angers you every time you see it. A person's failure to change for the better invites your flaming arrows.

¹⁴ See how that person conceives evil,
is pregnant with harm,
and gives birth to lies.

¹⁵ He digs a pit and shovels it out.
Then he falls into the hole that he made └for others┐.

¹⁶ His mischief lands back on his own head.
His violence comes down on top of him.

¹⁷ I will give thanks to the LORD for his righteousness.
I will make music to praise the name of the LORD Most High.

7:14–17 You cause trouble to boomerang back at people who conceive, carry, and bear evil. They suffer the pain they plan for others. I'm grateful for your righteous verdict.

Psalm 8

For the choir director; on the gittith;[\[7\]](#) a psalm by David.

¹ O LORD, our Lord, how majestic is your name
throughout the earth!

Your glory is sung above the heavens.[\[8\]](#)

² From the mouths of little children and infants,
you have built a fortress against your opponents
to silence the enemy and the avenger.

8:1–2 Your name is regal everywhere on earth. Your glory inspires worship throughout the universe. All it takes is praise on the lips of babes to hush your enemies.

³ When I look at your heavens,
the creation of your fingers,
the moon and the stars that you have set in place—
⁴ what is a mortal that you remember him
or the Son of Man that you take care of him?

8:3–4 I'm stunned and shrunken when I compare myself to the vastness of your creation. Why do you bother with me?

⁵ You have made him a little lower than yourself.
You have crowned him with glory and honor.
⁶ You have made him rule what your hands created.
You have put everything under his control:
⁷ all the sheep and cattle, the wild animals,
⁸ the birds, the fish,
whatever swims in the currents of the seas.

⁹ O LORD, our Lord, how majestic is your name throughout
the earth!

8:5–9 You seat me just below your throne and invest me with honor. You share your reign and put creation under my control. Your name is matchless in majesty and authority!

Psalm 9

For the choir director; according to muth labben;[\[9\]](#) *a psalm by David.*[\[10\]](#)

¹ I will give „you„ thanks, O LORD, with all my heart.
I will tell about all the miracles you have done.
² I will find joy and be glad about you.
I will make music to praise your name, O Most High.

9:1–2 My heart bursts with gratitude for your miracles. You give me joy. Praise wells up inside me, O Most High.

³ When my enemies retreat, they will stumble and die in your presence.

⁴ You have defended my just cause:
You sat down on your throne as a fair judge.

⁵ You condemned nations.
You destroyed wicked people.
You wiped out their names forever and ever.

⁶ The enemy is finished—in ruins forever.
You have uprooted their cities.
Even the memory of them has faded.

9:3–6 My enemies collapse when they meet you. They hear you defend me even though you condemn whole nations and peoples. You wipe them out so completely that no one remembers that they ever existed.

⁷ Yet, the LORD is enthroned forever.
He has set up his throne for judgment.

⁸ He alone judges the world with righteousness.
He judges לִּיטִּי people fairly.

⁹ The LORD is a stronghold for the oppressed,
a stronghold in times of trouble.

¹⁰ Those who know your name trust you, O LORD,
because you have never deserted those who seek your help.

9:7–10 Even as evildoers perish, you reign forever. You alone judge fairly and protect the oppressed. You never abandon anyone who counts on you for help.

¹¹ Make music to praise the LORD, who is enthroned in Zion.
Announce to the nations what he has done.

¹² The one who avenges murder has remembered oppressed people.
He has never forgotten their cries.

¹³ Have pity on me, O LORD.
Look at what I suffer because of those who hate me.
You take me away from the gates of death
¹⁴ so that I may recite your praises one by one

in the gates of Zion
and find joy in your salvation.

9:11–14 I see you on your throne and sing to you. I tell the world that you avenge murder and help the oppressed. Though others hate me, you pity me. You carry me back from the brink of death. I'll praise you for every detail of how you have saved me.

- ¹⁵ The nations have sunk into the pit they have made.
Their feet are caught in the net they have hidden _└to trap others┐.
- ¹⁶ The LORD is known by the judgment he has carried out.
The wicked person is trapped
by the work of his own hands. *Higgaion Selah*

9:15–16 Individuals and nations that plot evil get caught in their own traps. This is a sign of your judgment.

- ¹⁷ Wicked people, all the nations who forget God,
will return to the grave.
- ¹⁸ Needy people will not always be forgotten.
Nor will the hope of oppressed people be lost forever.
- ¹⁹ Arise, O LORD.
Do not let mortals gain any power.
Let the nations be judged in your presence.
- ²⁰ Strike them with terror, O LORD.
Let the nations know that they are _└only┐ mortal. *Selah*

9:17–20 Everyone who forgets you will die, but you never forget the needy or exploited. Don't let mere human beings seize control of our world. Prove that you are boss. Warn them that they will disappear in your judgment.

Psalm 10

- ¹ Why are you so distant, LORD?
Why do you hide yourself in times of trouble?

10:1 Why can't I see you when I need you most? Why are you so distant and hard to find?

² The wicked person arrogantly pursues oppressed people.
He will be caught in the schemes that he planned.

³ The wicked person boasts about his selfish desires.
He blesses robbers, but he curses the LORD.

⁴ He turns up his nose and says, "God doesn't care."
His every thought concludes, "There is no God."

⁵ He always seems to succeed.
Your judgments are beyond his understanding.
He spits at all his opponents.

⁶ He says to himself, "Nothing can shake me.
I'll never face any trouble."

10:2-6 Some people think they can get away with any kind of evil. They assume you don't care. They even conclude you don't exist. Why? Because these people always succeed. They can't picture themselves facing your judgment. They can't imagine failure.

⁷ His mouth is full of cursing, deception, and oppression.
Trouble and wrongdoing are on the tip of his tongue.

⁸ He waits in ambush in the villages.
From his hiding places he kills innocent people.
His eyes are on the lookout for victims.

⁹ He lies in his hiding place like a lion in his den.
He hides there to catch oppressed people.
He catches oppressed people when he draws them into his net.

¹⁰ His victims are crushed.
They collapse,
and they fall under the weight of his power.

¹¹ He says to himself,
"God has forgotten.
He has hidden his face.
He will never see it!"

10:7-11 Do I need to remind you how the wicked act? They do evil with their words. They ambush and kill the innocent. They lure and crush the unsuspecting. And they think you don't know or

care!

¹² Arise, O LORD!

Lift your hand, O God.

Do not forget oppressed people!

¹³ Why does the wicked person despise God?

Why does he say to himself, “God doesn’t care”?

¹⁴ You have seen ¹⁴it¹⁴; yes, you have taken note of trouble and grief
and placed them under your control.

The victim entrusts himself to you.

You alone have been the helper of orphans.

10:12–14 Stand up! Do something to save the oppressed! Don’t give the wicked one more reason to think you don’t care—especially while victims and orphans trust in your help.

¹⁵ Break the arm of the wicked and evil person.

Punish his wickedness until you find no more.

¹⁶ The LORD is king forever and ever.

The nations have vanished from his land.

10:15–16 Crush those who crush others. Punish every last bit of wickedness. Make evil nations disappear.

¹⁷ You have heard the desire of oppressed people, O LORD.

You encourage them.

You pay close attention to them

¹⁸ in order to provide justice for orphans and oppressed people
so that no mere mortal will terrify them again.

10:16–18 Rule over earth forever. Pay attention to the browbeaten and abandoned. Lift them out of discouragement. Give them justice so they can live free from fear.

Psalm 11

For the choir director; by David.

¹ I have taken refuge in the LORD.

How can you say to me:

“Flee to your mountain like a bird?

² Wicked people bend their bows.

They set their arrows against the strings

to shoot in the dark at people whose motives are decent.

³ When the foundations [of life] are undermined,
what can a righteous person do?”

11:1–3 People mock me for depending on you to protect me. Evildoers shoot at me and everyone decent. What are we supposed to do?

⁴ The LORD is in his holy temple.

The LORD’s throne is in heaven.

His eyes see.

They examine Adam’s descendants.

⁵ The LORD tests righteous people,

but he hates wicked people and the ones who love violence.

⁶ He rains down fire and burning sulfur upon wicked people.
He makes them drink from a cup filled with scorching wind.

11:4–6 From your throne in heaven you see everyone and everything. You study all of us. Even good people don’t escape your tests, but evil people face your stinking sulfur and scorching wind.

⁷ The LORD is righteous.

He loves a righteous way of life.

Decent people will see his face.

11:7 You are good. You love when people follow your good way. You let them see you.

Psalm 12

For the choir director; on the sheminith; a psalm by David.

¹ Help, O LORD.

No godly person is left.

Faithful people have vanished from among Adam's descendants!

² All people speak foolishly.

They speak with flattering lips. They say one thing but mean another.

12:1–2 I need your help. I look around and see no one who loves you. Everyone left is a lying, flattering fool.

³ May the LORD cut off every flattering lip
and every bragging tongue

⁴ that has said,

“We will overcome with our tongues.

With lips such as ours, who can be our master?”

⁵ “Because oppressed people are robbed and needy people groan,
I will now arise,” says the LORD.

“I will provide safety for those who long for it.”

12:3–5 People who beat others with their words think no one can stop them. But put an end to them.
Rescue the robbed and needy. Quiet their groaning and give them safety.

⁶ The promises of the LORD are pure,
like silver refined in a furnace^[11] and purified seven times.

⁷ O LORD, you will protect them.

You will keep each one safe from those people forever.

⁸ Wicked people parade around
when immorality increases among Adam's descendants.

12:6–8 I trust your promises. I fully expect you to protect the oppressed. Don't let wicked people strut their sinfulness for everyone to see.

Psalm 13

For the choir director; a psalm by David.

- ¹ How long, O LORD? Will you forget me forever?
How long will you hide your face from me?
- ² How long must I make decisions alone
with sorrow in my heart day after day?
How long will my enemy triumph over me?

13:1–2 Will you ever remember me? When will I see you again? How long will I be stuck here all by myself, paralyzed with sadness and struggling to know what to do?

- ³ Look at me! Answer me, O LORD my God!
Light up my eyes,
or else I will die
- ⁴ and my enemy will say, “I have overpowered him.”
My opponents will rejoice because I have been shaken.
- ⁵ But I trust your mercy.
My heart finds joy in your salvation.
- ⁶ I will sing to the LORD because he has been good to me.

13:3–6 Look at me now! Answer me! Give me hope or I will die! I trust in your mercy and salvation.
I will gladly sing of your goodness to me.

Psalm 14^[12]

For the choir director; by David.

- ¹ Godless fools say in their hearts,
“There is no God.”
They are corrupt.
They do disgusting things.
There is no one who does good things.
- ² The LORD looks down from heaven on
Adam’s descendants
to see if there is anyone who acts wisely,
if there is anyone who seeks help from God.

³ Everyone has turned away.
Together they have become rotten to the core.
No one, not even one person, does good things.

14:1–3 Only a fool thinks you don't exist. But every human on earth acts stupidly and refuses to rely on you. We have all run from you and become rotten to the core. None of us does good.

⁴ Are all those troublemakers,
those who devour my people as if they were devouring food,
so ignorant that they do not call on the LORD?
⁵ There they are—panic-stricken
because God is with the person who is righteous.
⁶ They put the advice of oppressed people to shame
because the LORD is their refuge.

14:4–6 Trouble makers eat your people like they gulp down food. Evil doers are so ignorant they don't pray to you. They panic when they see you help people who obey you.

⁷ If only salvation for Israel would come from Zion!
When the LORD restores the fortunes of his people,
Jacob will rejoice.
Israel will be glad.

14:7 Send help from your holy dwelling. Give us back our lives so we have reason to rejoice in you.

Psalm 15

A psalm by David.

¹ O LORD, who may stay in your tent?
Who may live on your holy mountain?
² The one who walks with integrity,
does what is righteous,
and speaks the truth within his heart.
³ The one who does not slander with his tongue,

do evil to a friend,
or bring disgrace on his neighbor.

15:1–3 Who is good enough to approach you? What kind of person can truly worship you? I'll never experience your presence if my life is a lie. Or if I spend my days doing wrong. Or if I spread evil words. I commit all of myself to you—thoughts, words, and actions.

⁴ The one who despises those rejected by God
but honors those who fear the LORD.

The one who makes a promise and does not break it,
even though he is hurt by it.

15:4 Train me to honor your people. Push me to keep my promises even when it hurts.

⁵ The one who does not collect interest on a loan
or take a bribe against an innocent person.

Whoever does these things will never be shaken.

Psalm 16

A miktam^[13] by David.

¹ Protect me, O God, because I take refuge in you.

² I said to the LORD,
“You are my Lord. Without you, I have nothing good.”

16:1–2 Protect me because I trust in you. You are my master. Without you I have nothing.

³ Those who lead holy lives on earth
are the noble ones who fill me with joy.^[14]

⁴ Those who quickly chase after other gods multiply their sorrows.
I will not pour out their sacrificial offerings of blood
or use my lips to speak their names.

16:3–4 I love being with your followers. Those who dedicate themselves to anything but you will encounter deep pain. I won't worship their idols.

- ⁵ The LORD is my inheritance and my cup.
You are the one who determines my destiny.
⁶ Your boundary lines mark out pleasant places for me.
Indeed, my inheritance is something beautiful.

16:5–6 You are my only real possession. You determine my future. When I live within your boundaries I find pleasure and beauty.

- ⁷ I will praise the LORD, who advises me.
My conscience warns me at night.
⁸ I always keep the LORD in front of me.
When he is by my side, I cannot be moved.
⁹ That is why my heart is glad and my soul rejoices.
My body rests securely
¹⁰ because you do not abandon my soul to the grave
or allow your holy one to decay.
¹¹ You make the path of life known to me.
Complete joy is in your presence.
Pleasures are by your side forever.

16:7–11 Lead me and warn me. I won't be shaken as long as I follow you. You are the reason I am happy, and because of you I rest. You won't let me rot in the grave but will lift me up to be with you forever.

Psalm 17

A prayer by David.

- ¹ Hear my plea for justice, O LORD.
Pay attention to my cry.
Open your ears to my prayer,

- └which comes┐ from lips free from deceit.
- ² Let the verdict of my innocence come directly from you.
Let your eyes observe what is fair.

17:1–3 Haven't you noticed my cries for justice? I need you, because you alone can declare me innocent. You constantly probe and confront me, so you know my heart is faultless.

- ³ You have probed my heart.
You have confronted me at night.
You have tested me like silver,
but you found nothing wrong.
I have determined that my mouth will not sin.
- ⁴ I have avoided cruelty because of your word.
In spite of what others have done,
⁵ my steps have remained firmly in your paths.
My feet have not slipped.

17:3–5 I've decided not to sin in what I say. Your Word keeps me from inflicting cruelty. Even when others stray from you, my feet grip your paths.

- ⁶ I have called on you because you answer me, O God.
Turn your ear toward me.
Hear what I have to say.
- ⁷ Reveal your miraculous deeds of mercy,
O Savior of those who find refuge by your side from those who attack them.
- ⁸ Guard me as if I were the pupil in your eye.
Hide me in the shadow of your wings.
- ⁹ Hide me from wicked people who violently attack me,
from my deadly enemies who surround me.

17:7–9 Show me your miraculous mercy. You save everyone who runs to you for protection, so guard me as carefully as you guard your own eye. Hide me from the violent swarm.

- ¹⁰ They have shut out all feeling.[\[15\]](#)
Their mouths have spoken arrogantly.

- ¹¹ They have tracked me down.
They have surrounded me.
They have focused their attention on throwing me to the ground.
- ¹² Each one of them is like a lion eager to tear its prey apart
and like a young lion crouching in hiding places.

17:10–12 Wicked people are numb to their own evil. Their mouths spew pride. They circle me so they can toss me to the ground and tear me apart.

- ¹³ Arise, O LORD; confront them!
Bring them to their knees!
With your sword rescue my life from wicked people.
- ¹⁴ With your power rescue me from mortals, O LORD,
from mortals who enjoy their inheritance only in this life.
You fill their bellies with your treasure.
Their children are satisfied with it, and they leave what remains to their children.
- ¹⁵ I will see your face when I am declared innocent.
When I wake up, I will be satisfied with seeing you.

17:13–15 Confront these killers like you always confront me! Knock them down! For all I care they can enjoy a rich life and pass their treasures down to their children. That's all they will get. But I want more. You alone can satisfy me.

Psalm 18^{[\[16\]](#)}

For the choir director; by David, the servant of the LORD. He sang this song to the LORD when the LORD rescued him from all his enemies, especially from Saul. He said,

- ¹ I love you, O LORD, my strength.
- ² The LORD is my rock and my fortress and my Savior,
my God, my rock in whom I take refuge,
my shield, and the strength of my salvation, my stronghold.

18:1–2 My Lord, I love you. You are my strength, rock, fortress, and Savior. You are my God, shield, salvation, and stronghold.

- ³ The LORD should be praised.
I called on him, and I was saved from my enemies.
- ⁴ The ropes of death had become tangled around me.
The torrents of destruction had overwhelmed me.
- ⁵ The ropes of the grave had surrounded me.
The clutches of death had confronted me.

18:3–5 I praise you because you saved me. I was tangled in death and drowning in destruction. Death held me in its clutches.

- ⁶ I called on the LORD in my distress.
I cried to my God for help.
He heard my voice from his temple,
and my cry for help reached his ears.
- ⁷ Then the earth shook and quaked.
Even the foundations of the mountains trembled.
They shook violently because he was angry.
- ⁸ Smoke went up from his nostrils,
and a raging fire came out of his mouth.
Glowing coals flared up from it.

18:6–8 I cried to you and you heard. In anger you shook the earth. Smoke and fire billowed from your breath.

- ⁹ He spread apart the heavens
and came down with a dark cloud under his feet.
- ¹⁰ He rode on one of the angels^[17] as he flew,
and he soared on the wings of the wind.
- ¹¹ He made the darkness his hiding place,
the dark rain clouds his covering.
- ¹² Out of the brightness in front of him,
those rain clouds passed by with hailstones and lightning.

¹³ The LORD thundered in the heavens.

The Most High made his voice heard with hailstones and lightning.

¹⁴ He shot his arrows and scattered them.

He flashed streaks of lightning and threw them into confusion.

18:9–14 You split the heavens as you rushed to my aid. You hid in the darkness. You hurled hailstones and flashed lightning as your voice thundered in the heavens. You threw my enemies into confusion and scattered them.

¹⁵ Then the ocean floor could be seen.

The foundations of the earth were laid bare

at your stern warning, O LORD,

at the blast of the breath from your nostrils.

¹⁶ He reached down from high above and took hold of me.

He pulled me out of the raging water.

¹⁷ He rescued me from my strong enemy

and from those who hated me,

because they were too strong for me.

¹⁸ On the day when I faced disaster, they confronted me,

but the LORD came to my defense.

¹⁹ He brought me out to a wide-open place.

He rescued me because he was pleased with me.

18:15–19 Your stern warning bared the ocean floor, your breath pushing back the waters. You reached down and plucked me from raging waters and rescued me from hateful enemies. You came to my defense and deposited me in a wide-open place.

²⁰ The LORD rewarded me

because of my righteousness,

because my hands are clean.

He paid me back

²¹ because I have kept the ways of the LORD

and I have not wickedly turned away from my God,

²² because all his judgments are in front of me

and I have not turned away from his laws.

²³ I was innocent as far as he was concerned.

I have kept myself from guilt.

18:20–23 You reward me because I do right. You pay me back because I keep your ways and stay close to you. I remember your laws and keep them all. You know that I'm innocent.

²⁴ The LORD paid me back
because of my righteousness,
because he can see that my hands are clean.

²⁵ „In dealing,“ with faithful people you are faithful,
with innocent people you are innocent,
²⁶ with pure people you are pure.
„In dealing,“ with devious people you are clever.

18:25–26 Because I'm faithful, you're faithful toward me. Because I live with integrity, I experience your integrity. Because I'm pure, I witness your purity. If I chose to be devious, you would outsmart me.

²⁷ You save humble people,
but you bring down a conceited look.
²⁸ O LORD, you light my lamp.
My God turns my darkness into light.
²⁹ With you I can attack a line of soldiers.
With my God I can break through barricades.

18:29 With you on my side I can conquer an army. I can break through every barrier.

³⁰ God's way is perfect!
The promise of the LORD has proven to be true.
He is a shield to all those who take refuge in him.
³¹ Who is God but the LORD?
Who is a rock except our God?

18:30–31 Your way is perfect and your promises always true. There is no God but you. There is no rock except my God.

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- ³² God arms me with strength
and makes my way perfect.
³³ He makes my feet like those of a deer
and gives me sure footing on high places.
³⁴ He trains my hands for battle
so that my arms can bend an **archer's** bow of bronze.
³⁵ You have given me the shield of your salvation.
Your right hand supports me.
Your gentleness makes me great.

18:32–35 You make me like an agile deer and give me sure footing. You train me to fight so I can bend a bow of bronze. Your salvation is like a shield. And your gentleness makes me great.

- ³⁶ You make a wide path for me to walk on
so that my feet do not slip.
³⁷ I chased my enemies and caught up with them.
I did not return until I had ended their lives.
³⁸ I wounded them so badly that they were unable to get up.
They fell under my feet.
³⁹ You armed me with strength for battle.
You made my opponents bow at my feet.
⁴⁰ You made my enemies turn their backs to me,
and I destroyed those who hated me.
⁴¹ They cried out for help, but there was no one to save them.
They cried out to the LORD, but he did not answer them.
⁴² I beat them into a powder as fine as the dust blown by the wind.
I threw them out as though they were dirt on the streets.

18:37–42 I chase my enemies until I catch them. I don't give up until they are gone, and you don't give in to them when they suddenly beg you for help. Because of you they become like dirt under my feet.

- ⁴³ You rescued me from my conflicts with the people.
You made me the leader of nations.
A people I did not know will serve me:

⁴⁴ As soon as they hear of me, they will obey me.
Foreigners will cringe in front of me.

⁴⁵ Foreigners will lose heart,
and they will tremble when they come out of their fortifications.

18:43–45 You rescue me from conflict and lift me to leadership. People obey me because you put them under my authority. Evil gets its due reward because you are my avenger.

⁴⁶ The LORD lives!

Thanks be to my rock!

May God my Savior be honored.

⁴⁷ God gives me vengeance!

He brings people under my authority.

⁴⁸ He saves me from my enemies.

You lift me up above my opponents.

You rescue me from violent people.

18:46–48 I'm convinced you are real. You're my sure and solid rock! God my Savior, may my life honor you.

⁴⁹ That is why I will give thanks to you, O LORD, among the nations
and make music to praise your name.

⁵⁰ He gives great victories to his king.
He shows mercy to his anointed,
to David, and to his descendant [\[18\]](#) a forever.

18:49–50 I sing you thanks so loudly that everyone on earth can hear. Victory and mercy come from you!

Psalm 19

For the choir director; a psalm by David.

¹ The heavens declare the glory of God,
and the sky displays what his hands have made.

² One day tells a story to the next.
One night shares knowledge with the next

³ without talking,
without words,
without their voices being heard.

19:1–3 I gaze at the stars and see your glory. I study the sky and grasp your workmanship. Both day and night spell out your greatness without speaking a word.
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⁴ Yet, their sound has gone out into the entire world,
their message to the ends of the earth.

He has set up a tent in the heavens for the sun,

⁵ which comes out of its chamber like a bridegroom.

Like a champion, it is eager to run its course.

⁶ It rises from one end of the heavens.

It circles around to the other.

Nothing is hidden from its heat.

19:4–6 Nowhere on earth is too remote to hear your message. The sun blazes your Word across the
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sky.

- ⁷ The teachings of the LORD are perfect.
They renew the soul.
The testimony of the LORD is dependable.
It makes gullible people wise.
- ⁸ The instructions of the LORD are correct.
They make the heart rejoice.
The command of the LORD is radiant.
It makes the eyes shine.
- ⁹ The fear of the LORD is pure.
It endures forever.
The decisions of the LORD are true.
They are completely fair.

19:7–9 Your flawless teachings renew me. Your trustworthy testimony makes this fool wise. Your accurate instructions cheer my heart. Your radiant commands ignite my eyes. You inspire me with unfading awe. Your true decisions strike me as completely fair.

- ¹⁰ They are more desirable than gold, even the finest gold.
They are sweeter than honey, even the drippings from a honeycomb.
- ¹¹ As your servant I am warned by them.
There is a great reward in following them.

19:10–11 Your words are far more precious than gold. Moment by moment they warn me as I serve you. Keeping your commands gives me breathtaking rewards.

- ¹² Who can notice every mistake?
Forgive my hidden faults.
- ¹³ Keep me from sinning.
Do not let anyone gain control over me.
Then I will be blameless,
and I will be free from any great offense.
- ¹⁴ May the words from my mouth and the thoughts from my heart
be acceptable to you, O LORD, my rock and my defender.

19:12–14 Forgive my faults I can't see. Keep evil habits from mastering me. Let my every word and thought please you. You are my master, my rock, and my defender.

Psalm 20

For the choir director; a psalm by David.

- ¹ The LORD will answer you in times of trouble.
The name of the God of Jacob will protect you.
- ² He will send you help from his holy place
and support you from Zion.
- ³ He will remember all your grain offerings
and look with favor on your burnt offerings. *Selah*

20:1–3 You answer me every time I hit trouble. You protect me when I rely on your name. You never forget my sincere worship.

- ⁴ He will give you your heart's desire
and carry out all your plans.
- ⁵ We will joyfully sing about your victory.
We will wave our flags in the name of our God.
The LORD will fulfill all your requests.

20:4–5 You grant my heart's wish and carry my plans to completion. You give me abundant reasons to sing with your people.

- ⁶ Now I know that the LORD will give victory to his anointed king.
He will answer him from his holy heaven
with mighty deeds of his powerful hand.
- ⁷ Some rely on chariots and others on horses,
but we will boast in the name of the LORD our God.
- ⁸ They will sink to their knees and fall,
but we will rise and stand firm.
- ⁹ Give victory to the king, O LORD.
Answer us when we call.

20:7–9 Some count on their own strength and speed, but I will never rely on anything but you. Others sink to their knees and crumble, but I will rise and stand firm. Answer me when I call!

Psalm 21

For the choir director; a psalm by David.

¹ The king finds joy in your strength, O LORD.
What great joy he has in your victory!

21:1 I feel joy when I think of your strength. I rejoice whenever you win!

² You gave him his heart's desire.
You did not refuse the prayer from his lips. *Selah*
³ You welcomed him with the blessings of good things
and set a crown of fine gold on his head.
⁴ He asked you for life.
You gave him a long life, forever and ever.

21:2–4 You give me the longings of my heart and answer my prayers. You wrap me in blessings and crown me with gold. I ask you for long life and you give it.

⁵ Because of your victory his glory is great.
You place splendor and majesty on him.
⁶ Yes, you made him a blessing forever.
You made him glad with the joy of your presence.
⁷ Indeed, the king trusts the LORD,
and through the mercy of the Most High, he will not be moved.

21:5–7 You robe me with splendor and majesty. You make me a blessing to others and energize me with your presence. Because I trust in you I won't be moved.

⁸ Your hand will discover all your enemies.

Your powerful hand will find all who hate you.

⁹ When you appear, you will make them **burn** like a blazing furnace.
The LORD will swallow them up in his anger. Fire will devour them.

¹⁰ You will destroy their children from the earth
and their offspring from among Adam's descendants.

¹¹ Although they scheme and plan evil against you,
they will not succeed.

¹² They turn their backs **and flee**
because you aim your bow at their faces.[\[19\]](#)

¹³ Arise, O LORD, in your strength.
We will sing and make music to praise your power.

21:8–13 I know you will scorch your enemies and swallow them in anger. You will end their dynasties and halt their evil schemes. When they see your judgment aimed square at their faces they will flee in terror. I will praise your power.

Psalm 22

For the choir director; according to ayyeleth hashachar;[\[20\]](#) a psalm by David.

¹ My God, my God,
why have you abandoned me?
Why are you so far away from helping me,
so far away from the words of my groaning?

² My God,
I cry out by day, but you do not answer—
also at night, but I find no rest.

22:1–2 Why have you left me? Why is your help so distant? Can't you hear my groans? I plead with you day and night, but you don't answer me.

³ Yet, you are holy, enthroned on the praises of Israel.

⁴ Our ancestors trusted you.
They trusted, and you rescued them.

⁵ They cried to you and were saved.
They trusted you and were never disappointed.

22:3–5 I worship your pure and perfect holiness. I trust you and you answer me. I cry to you and you save me.

⁶ Yet, I am a worm and not a man.
I am scorned by humanity and despised by people.
⁷ All who see me make fun of me.
Insults pour from their mouths.
They shake their heads and say,
⁸ “Put yourself in the LORD’s hands.
Let the LORD save him!
Let God rescue him since he is pleased with him!”

22:6–8 I don’t even feel like a human being. I’m a worm. People despise me and make fun of me.
They mock me for trusting myself to you. They say you won’t rescue me.

⁹ Indeed, you are the one who brought me out of the womb,
the one who made me feel safe at my mother’s breasts.
¹⁰ I was placed in your care from birth.
From my mother’s womb you have been my God.
¹¹ Do not be so far away from me.
Trouble is near, and there is no one to help.

22:9–11 You brought me into this world, and you’ve been my safety since the day of my birth.
You’ve always been my God. So don’t be so far from me. There’s no one else to help me.

¹² Many bulls have surrounded me.
Strong bulls from Bashan have encircled me.
¹³ They have opened their mouths to attack me
like ferocious, roaring lions.
¹⁴ I am poured out like water,
and all my bones are out of joint.
My heart is like wax.
It has melted within me.

¹⁵ My strength is dried up like pieces of broken pottery.
My tongue sticks to the roof of my mouth.
You lay me down in the dust of death.

22:12–15 Powerful enemies surround me. They spread their jaws to maul me. My insides melt and my life spills like water on dirt. I'm weak and can't speak. Do you like watching me die in the dust?

¹⁶ Dogs have surrounded me.
A mob has encircled me.
They have pierced my hands and feet.
¹⁷ I can count all my bones.
People stare.
They gloat over me.
¹⁸ They divide my clothes among themselves.
They throw dice for my clothing.

22:16–18 Vicious and unfaithful people surround me. A mob pierces my hands and feet. They strip me naked. They can't stop staring at this starving sack of bones.

¹⁹ Do not be so far away, O LORD.
Come quickly to help me, O my strength.
²⁰ Rescue my soul from the sword,
my life from vicious dogs.
²¹ Save me from the mouth of the lion
and from the horns of wild oxen.

You have answered me.

²² I will tell my people about your name.
I will praise you within the congregation.
²³ All who fear the LORD, praise him!
All you descendants of Jacob, glorify him!
Stand in awe of him, all you descendants of Israel.
²⁴ The LORD has not despised or been disgusted
with the plight of the oppressed one.
He has not hidden his face from that person.

The LORD heard when that oppressed person cried out to him for help.
²⁵ My praise comes from you while I am among those assembled for worship.
I will fulfill my vows in the presence of those who fear the LORD.

22:19–24 Don't be so far from me. Come quickly to my side. Save me from the hideous death my enemies plan for me. Then I will praise you for all your people to hear.

22:23–24 I praise you because you are awesome. I worship you because I belong to you. I'm confident you don't despise me. I'm sure you don't run from me in disgust. I'm certain you hear me.

²⁶ Oppressed people will eat until they are full.
Those who look to the LORD will praise him.
May you live forever.

22:26 You'll feed the starving until they're full. Everyone who looks to you will praise you.

²⁷ All the ends of the earth will remember and return to the LORD.
All the families from all the nations will worship you
²⁸ because the kingdom belongs to the LORD
and he rules the nations.
²⁹ All prosperous people on earth will eat and worship.
All those who go down to the dust will kneel in front of him,
even those who are barely alive.
³⁰ There will be descendants who serve him,
a generation that will be told about the Lord.
³¹ They will tell people yet to be born about
his righteousness—
that he has finished it.

22:27–31 One day the whole world will realize you rule all humankind. The thriving and the dying alike will kneel and worship you. Children not yet born will learn about you.

Psalm 23

A psalm by David.

¹ The LORD is my shepherd.

I am never in need.

² He makes me lie down in green pastures.

He leads me beside peaceful waters.

³ He renews my soul.

He guides me along the paths of righteousness for the sake of his name.

23:1-3 Because you are my shepherd, I will never lack. You let me stretch out in peace. You fill my soul. You guide my life so your name receives glory.

⁴ Even though I walk through the dark valley of death,

because you are with me, I fear no harm.

Your rod and your staff give me courage.

⁵ You prepare a banquet for me while my enemies watch.

You anoint my head with oil.

My cup overflows.

23:4-5 I won't fear even when I face death, because you are with me. You replace my cowardice with courage. You invite me to feast while my enemies watch. My life overflows.

⁶ Certainly, goodness and mercy will stay close to me all the days of my life,
and I will remain in the LORD's house for days without end.

23:6 Your goodness and mercy will never go away, and I will never leave your presence.

Psalm 24

A psalm by David.

¹ The earth and everything it contains are the LORD's.

The world and all who live in it are his.

² He laid its foundation on the seas
and set it firmly on the rivers.

24:1–2 There's not a thing on earth you didn't make. Everything and everyone belongs to you.

³ Who may go up the LORD's mountain?

Who may stand in his holy place?

⁴ ַThe one who ַ has clean hands and a pure heart
and does not long for what is false^[21]
or lie when he is under oath.

⁵ ַThis person ַ will receive a blessing from the LORD
and righteousness from God, his savior.

⁶ This is the person who seeks him,
who searches for the face of the God of Jacob.^[22] *Selah*

24:3–6 Who can draw close to you? People who are pure inside and out. If I seek your face and rely on your righteousness, I know I'll receive your blessing.

⁷ Lift your heads, you gates.
Be lifted, you ancient doors,
so that the king of glory may come in.

⁸ Who is this king of glory?
The LORD, strong and mighty!
The LORD, heroic in battle!

⁹ Lift your heads, you gates.
Be lifted, you ancient doors,
so that the king of glory may come in.

24:7–9 I open my heart to you. You're as welcome in me as you are in your own holy city. You're the King of Glory—strong and mighty, heroic in battle. I open my life to you. Please enter in!

¹⁰ Who, then, is this king of glory?
The LORD of Armies is the king of glory! *Selah*

Psalm 25^[23]

By David.

¹ To you, O LORD, I lift my soul.

² I trust you, O my God.

Do not let me be put to shame.

Do not let my enemies triumph over me.

25:1–2 I offer you my whole being. I trust in you with my whole heart. Don't let my enemies shame me or beat me.

³ No one who waits for you will ever be put to shame,
but all who are unfaithful will be put to shame.

⁴ Make your ways known to me, O LORD,
and teach me your paths.

⁵ Lead me in your truth and teach me
because you are God, my savior.
I wait all day long for you.

25:4–5 Show me how you want me to live. Instruct me in the real facts of life. You alone can do this for me, because you alone are my Savior.

⁶ Remember, O LORD, your compassionate and merciful deeds.
They have existed from eternity.

⁷ Do not remember the sins of my youth or my rebellious ways.
Remember me, O LORD, in keeping with your mercy and your goodness.

25:6–7 Be merciful to me today just as you have been merciful from all eternity. Forgive and forget my youthful rebellion.

⁸ The LORD is good and decent.
That is why he teaches sinners the way they should live.

⁹ He leads humble people to do what is right,
and he teaches them his way.

¹⁰ Every path of the LORD is **“one of”** mercy and truth
for those who cling to his promise^[24] and written instructions.

25:8–10 You’re always good and fair. You give your commands to give us life. You teach everyone who bows to you. And when I cling to your promises and instructions, I always discover your mercy and truth.

¹¹ For the sake of your name, O LORD,
remove my guilt, because it is great.

25:11 Forgive my great guilt, for your name is even greater.

¹² Who, then, is this person that fears the LORD?
He is the one whom the LORD will teach which path to choose.

¹³ He will enjoy good things in life,
and his descendants will inherit the land.

¹⁴ The LORD advises those who fear him.
He reveals to them the intent of his promise.

25:12–14 When I choose your path, I enjoy life’s best things. I see my children experience your presence and provision. And I comprehend your promises.

¹⁵ My eyes are always on the LORD.
He removes my feet from traps.

¹⁶ Turn to me, and have pity on me.
I am lonely and oppressed.

¹⁷ Relieve my troubled heart,
and bring me out of my distress.

¹⁸ Look at my misery and suffering,
and forgive all my sins.

25:16–18 Turn to me and meet me in my loneliness. Lift my burdens and release me from my distress. Don’t ignore my misery. Forgive my sins.

¹⁹ See how my enemies have increased in number,

- how they have hated me with vicious hatred!
- ²⁰ Protect my life, and rescue me!
Do not let me be put to shame.
I have taken refuge in you.
- ²¹ Integrity and honesty will protect me because I wait for you.
- ²² Rescue Israel, O God, from all its troubles!

25:19–22 My enemies and their hatred for me never stop multiplying. Protect me and rescue me, because I hide in you and no one else. I'm waiting for help. Save me! Save all your followers!

Psalm 26

By David.

- ¹ Judge me favorably, O LORD,
because I have walked with integrity
and I have trusted you without wavering.
- ² Examine me, O LORD, and test me.
Look closely into my heart and mind.
- ³ I see your mercy in front of me.
I walk in the light of your truth.

26:1–3 Rule in my favor, because you know my integrity and unwavering trust. Examine me up close, because you can peer into my heart and mind. Lead me with your mercy, and light my path with your truth.

- ⁴ I did not sit with liars,
and I will not be found among hypocrites.
- ⁵ I have hated the mob of evildoers
and will not sit with wicked people.
- ⁶ I will wash my hands in innocence.
I will walk around your altar, O LORD,

26:4–6 I don't partner with liars or hypocrites. You won't find me joining a mob of evildoers or plotting with the wicked. I'll keep myself pure.

⁷ so that I may loudly sing a hymn of thanksgiving and tell about all your miracles.

⁸ O LORD, I love the house where you live,
the place where your glory dwells.

26:7–8 I boldly sing you thanks and tell of the miracles you have worked on my behalf. I love to be in your presence.

⁹ Do not sweep away my soul along with hardened sinners
or my life along with bloodthirsty people.

¹⁰ Evil schemes are in their hands.
Their right hands are full of bribes.

¹¹ But I walk with integrity.
Rescue me, and have pity on me.

¹² My feet stand on level ground.
I will praise the LORD with the choirs in worship.

26:9–12 Don't sweep me away with people committed to sinning, because I live with integrity. Keep my feet firmly planted, and I'll worship you along with your people.

Psalm 27

By David.

¹ The LORD is my light and my salvation.
Who is there to fear?
The LORD is my life's fortress.
Who is there to be afraid of?

27:1 You're my light and my salvation, so I have nothing to fear. With you as my fortress, I'm scared by no one.

- ² Evildoers closed in on me to tear me to pieces.
My opponents and enemies stumbled and fell.
³ Even though an army sets up camp against me,
my heart will not be afraid.
Even though a war breaks out against me,
I will still have confidence **in the LORD**.

27:2–3 Evildoers surrounded me to tear me apart, but they tripped and fell. Even if an army declared war on me, I would count on you.

- ⁴ I have asked one thing from the LORD.
This I will seek:
to remain in the LORD's house all the days of my life
in order to gaze at the LORD's beauty
and to search for an answer in his temple.

27:4 There's only one thing I want from you—to live each day so close to you that I can gaze on your beauty and get the answers I need.

- ⁵ He hides me in his shelter when there is trouble.
He keeps me hidden in his tent.
He sets me high on a rock.
⁶ Now my head will be raised above my enemies who surround me.
I will offer sacrifices with shouts of joy in his tent.
I will sing and make music to praise the LORD.

27:5–6 You shelter me from my troubles. You raise me above my enemies. I shout joyfully to you!

- ⁷ Hear, O LORD, when I cry aloud.
Have pity on me, and answer me.
⁸ **in** When you said,
“Seek my face,”
my heart said to you,
“O LORD, I will seek your face.”^[25]
⁹ Do not hide your face from me.
Do not angrily turn me away.

You have been my help.
Do not leave me!
Do not abandon me, O God, my savior!

27:8–9 You invite me to seek you—and so my heart searches high and low for more of you. Let me see your face. Don't push me away in anger.

¹⁰ Even if my father and mother abandon me,
the LORD will take care of me.

27:9–10 Savior, don't abandon me! I will trust you to care for me even when I'm discarded by the people who should love me most.

¹¹ Teach me your way, O LORD.
Lead me on a level path
because I have enemies who spy on me.
¹² Do not surrender me to the will of my opponents.
False witnesses have risen against me.
They breathe out violence.

27:11–12 Teach me to know and do your will. Don't hand me over to people who want to do me in.

¹³ I believe that I will see the goodness of the LORD
in this world of the living.
¹⁴ Wait with hope for the LORD.
Be strong, and let your heart be courageous.
Yes, wait with hope for the LORD.

27:13–14 I'm convinced I'll live to see your goodness, so I'll keep hoping in you. Fill me with strength and courage as I await you!

Psalm 28

By David.

¹ O LORD, I call to you.

O my rock, do not turn a deaf ear to me.

If you remain silent,

I will be like those who go into the pit.

² Hear my prayer for mercy when I call to you for help,
when I lift my hands toward your most holy place.

³ Do not drag me away with wicked people,
with troublemakers who speak of peace with their neighbors
but have evil in their hearts.

28:1–3 I've built my life on you, O my rock, so answer me before I die. I'm begging for mercy.
Don't punish me along with two-faced troublemakers, people who hate and harm their neighbors.

⁴ Pay them back for what they have done,
for their evil deeds. Pay them back for what their hands have done, and give
them what they deserve.

⁵ The LORD will tear them down and never build them up again,
because they never consider what he has done or what his hands have made.

28:4–5 Pay back evildoers for their evil deeds. Give them what they deserve. Demolish them and
leave them broken. Why? Because they don't acknowledge a single thing you have done.

⁶ Thank the LORD!

He has heard my prayer for mercy!

⁷ The LORD is my strength and my shield.

My heart trusted him, so I received help.

My heart is triumphant; I give thanks to him with my song.

28:6–7 Thank you for hearing my plea for mercy! I trusted you and got help, so my heart sings in
triumph.

⁸ The LORD is the strength of his people
and a fortress for the victory of his Messiah.[\[26\]](#)

⁹ Save your people, and bless those who belong to you.

Be their shepherd, and carry them forever.

28:8–9 You are strong for your people. You ensure your Messiah’s victory. Save us. Shepherd us.
Carry us forever.

Psalm 29

A psalm by David.

- ¹ Give to the LORD, you heavenly beings.
Give to the LORD glory and power.
² Give to the LORD the glory his name deserves.
Worship the LORD in his holy splendor.

29:1–2 Let every heavenly being praise your glory and power. Let them recognize the worthiness of your name. Let them bow whenever they see your magnificence.

- ³ The voice of the LORD rolls over the water.
The God of glory thunders.
The LORD shouts over raging water.
⁴ The voice of the LORD is powerful.
The voice of the LORD is majestic.
⁵ The voice of the LORD breaks the cedars.
The LORD splinters the cedars of Lebanon.
⁶ He makes Lebanon skip along like a calf
and Mount Sirion like a wild ox.

29:3–6 Your voice thunders over the ocean, powerful and majestic. It splits towering trees. It makes the nation skip like a calf.

- ⁷ The voice of the LORD strikes with flashes of lightning.
⁸ The voice of the LORD makes the wilderness tremble.
The LORD makes the wilderness of Kadesh tremble.
⁹ The voice of the LORD splits the oaks^[27]
and strips the trees of the forests bare.

Everyone in his temple is saying, “Glory!”

29:7–9 Your voice strikes like lightning. Its thunder strips the forests bare. Everyone who sees you shouts “Glory!”

- ¹⁰ The LORD sat enthroned over the flood.
The LORD sits enthroned as king forever.
- ¹¹ The LORD will give power to his people.
The LORD will bless his people with peace.

29:10–11 You ruled mightily over the flood, and you will reign as King forever. Give your people power, and bless us with your peace.

Psalm 30

A psalm by David sung at the dedication of the temple.

- ¹ I will honor you highly, O LORD,
because you have pulled me out of the pit,
and have not let my enemies rejoice over me.
- ² O LORD my God,
I cried out to you for help, and you healed me.
- ³ O LORD, you brought me up from the grave.
You called me back to life
from among those who had gone into the pit.

30:1–3 Nothing and no one deserves more honor than you, because you plucked me from the pit. You kept my enemies from dancing on my grave. You healed me and rescued me from death itself.

- ⁴ Make music to praise the LORD, you faithful people who belong to him.
Remember his holiness by giving thanks.

30:4 Because I belong to you I make music to praise you. I think about your holiness and give you thanks.

⁵ His anger lasts only a moment.
His favor lasts a lifetime.
Weeping may last for the night,
but there is a song of joy in the morning.

30:5 Your anger lasts only a moment, but your favor lasts a lifetime. Even if I weep all night, I will sing for joy in the morning.

⁶ When all was well with me, I said,
“I will never be shaken.”
⁷ O LORD, by your favor you have made my mountain stand firm.
When you hid your face, I was terrified.
⁸ I will cry out to you, O LORD.
I will plead to the LORD for mercy:
⁹ “How will you profit if my blood is shed,
if I go into the pit?
Will the dust of my body give thanks to you?
Will it tell about your truth?”

30:6–9 When my life went well, I was sure nothing could shake me. But when you hid, I feared my own bloody death. I wondered how that would help your cause. Can my dead body thank you? Can it tell anyone your truth?

¹⁰ Hear, O LORD, and have pity on me!
O LORD, be my helper!
¹¹ You have changed my sobbing into dancing.
You have removed my sackcloth and clothed me with joy
¹² so that my soul [\[28\]](#) may praise you with music and not be silent.
O LORD my God, I will give thanks to you forever.

30:10–12 Your help turned my sobbing into dancing. You stripped off my mourning clothes and wrapped me with joy. I'll sing to you forever. I'll never be silent.

Psalm 31

For the choir director; a psalm by David.

- ¹ I have taken refuge in you, O LORD.
Never let me be put to shame.
Save me because of your righteousness.
² Turn your ear toward me.
Rescue me quickly.
Be a rock of refuge for me,
a strong fortress to save me.

31:1–2 I look to you for help. Don't make me feel stupid for counting on you. Come help me quickly and be the strength I need.

- ³ Indeed, you are my rock and my fortress.
For the sake of your name, lead me and guide me.
⁴ You are my refuge,
so pull me out of the net that they have secretly laid for me.
⁵ Into your hands I entrust my spirit.
You have rescued me, O LORD, God of truth.
⁶ I hate those who cling to false gods, but I trust the LORD.

31:3–6 Lead me and bring honor to your name. Break me free from my enemies' secret traps. You save me and speak honestly with me, so I trust my innermost self to you. I won't trust strange gods.

- ⁷ I will rejoice and be glad because of your mercy.
You have seen my misery.
You have known the troubles in my soul.
⁸ You have not handed me over to the enemy.
You have set my feet in a place where I can move freely.

31:7–8 You noticed my misery inside and out. You didn't hand me over to my enemies. You put my feet on free land.

- ⁹ Have pity on me, O LORD, because I am in distress.
My eyes, my soul, and my body waste away from grief.

¹⁰ My life is exhausted from sorrow,
my years from groaning.
My strength staggers under the weight of my guilt,
and my bones waste away.

31:9–10 Years of agony have laid waste to my entire being. I stagger under the guilty burden I've piled on my own shoulders.

¹¹ I have become a disgrace because of all my opponents.
I have become someone dreaded by my friends, even by my neighbors.
Those who see me on the street run away from me.
¹² I have faded from memory as if I were dead
and have become like a piece of broken pottery.
¹³ I have heard the whispering of many people—terror on every side—
while they made plans together against me.
They were plotting to take my life.

31:11–13 My opponents have made me such a disgrace that even my friends and neighbors dread me. They treat me like trash, a tossed-out piece of shattered pottery. They whisper plans to destroy me.

¹⁴ I trust you, O LORD.
I said, “You are my God.”
¹⁵ My future is in your hands.
Rescue me from my enemies, from those who persecute me.
¹⁶ Smile on me.
Save me with your mercy.

31:14–16 In the midst of all my troubles I still trust in you. I forever call you my God. My future belongs to you, so smile on me.

¹⁷ O LORD, I have called on you, so do not let me be put to shame.
Let wicked people be put to shame.
Let them be silent in the grave.
¹⁸ Let their lying lips be speechless,
since they speak against righteous people with arrogance and contempt.

31:17–18 I've prayed to you, so don't let me be put to shame. Let it be evildoers who experience disgrace. Stop their arrogant lies against good people.

¹⁹ Your kindness is so great!

You reserve it for those who fear you.

Adam's descendants watch as you show it to those who take refuge in you.

²⁰ You hide them in the secret place of your presence
from those who scheme against them.

You keep them in a shelter,
safe from quarrelsome tongues.

31:19–20 You burst with kindness toward those who respect you. All humankind can see how you shower love on those who count on you, protecting them with your presence and sparing them from quarrels.

²¹ Thank the LORD!

He has shown me the miracle of his mercy
in a city under attack.

²² When I was panic-stricken, I said,

"I have been cut off from your sight."

But you heard my pleas for mercy when I cried out to you for help.

31:22 I panicked when I thought I'd lost you. But you heard my cries and came to help.

²³ Love the LORD, all you godly ones!

The LORD protects faithful people,
but he pays back in full those who act arrogantly.

²⁴ Be strong, all who wait with hope for the LORD,
and let your heart be courageous.

31:23–24 Help me persist in my love for you. Protect your followers and pay back the arrogant.
Give courageous hearts to everyone who counts on you.

Psalm 32

A psalm by David; a maskil. [\[29\]](#)

¹ Blessed is the person whose disobedience is forgiven
and whose sin is pardoned.

² Blessed is the person whom the LORD no longer accuses of sin
and who has no deceitful thoughts.

32:1–2 Your forgiveness is proof that I’m blessed. My happiness returns when you pardon my guilt.

³ When I kept silent about my sins,
my bones began to weaken because of my groaning all day long.

⁴ Day and night your hand laid heavily on me.
My strength shriveled in the summer heat. *Selah*

⁵ I made my sins known to you, and I did not cover up my guilt.
I decided to confess them to you, O LORD.
Then you forgave all my sins. *Selah*

32:3–5 My bones shook when I hid my sins from you. Your judgment weighed on me day and night.
Your heat baked away all my strength. But you forgave my sins when I quit hiding my guilt.

⁶ For this reason let all godly people pray to you
when you may be found.
Then raging floodwater will not reach them.

32:6 Use my pain to teach others to pray to you quickly—before floods overwhelm them.

⁷ You are my hiding place.
You protect me from trouble.
You surround me with joyous songs of salvation. *Selah*

32:7 You're my hiding place, my protection from every trouble. You joyfully sing me songs to remind me that you save me.

- ⁸ ♫ The LORD says, ♫
 "I will instruct you.
 I will teach you the way that you should go.
 I will advise you as my eyes watch over you.
⁹ Don't be stubborn like a horse or mule.
 ♫ They need ♫ a bit and bridle in their mouth to restrain them,
 or they will not come near you."

32:8–9 You promise you'll watch me and teach me how to live. I promise I'll hear your instructions and quickly obey. You won't have to bridle me like a beast to make me listen.

- ¹⁰ Many heartaches await wicked people,
 but mercy surrounds those who trust the LORD.
¹¹ Be glad and find joy in the LORD, you righteous people.
 Sing with joy, all whose motives are decent.

32:10–11 Take me far away from the heartaches of sin. Surround me with mercy as I trust you. You are my joy!

Psalm 33

- ¹ Joyfully sing to the LORD, you righteous people.
 Praising ♫ the LORD ♫ is proper for decent people.
² Give thanks with a lyre to the LORD.
 Make music for him on a ten-stringed harp.
³ Sing a new song to him.
 Play beautifully and joyfully on stringed instruments.

33:1–3 I'll sing joyfully to you. I'll sing thanks to you. I refuse to sing tired old words to you. I'll find beautiful new songs.

- ⁴ The word of the LORD is correct,
and everything he does is trustworthy.
- ⁵ The LORD loves righteousness and justice.
His mercy fills the earth.

33:4–5 Your every word is true. Your every deed is dependable. You love doing right and acting justly. Your mercy spills over on the whole earth.

- ⁶ The heavens were made by the word of the LORD
and all the stars by the breath of his mouth.
- ⁷ He gathers the water in the sea like a dam
and puts the oceans in his storehouses.
- ⁸ Let all the earth fear the LORD.
Let all who live in the world stand in awe of him.
- ⁹ He spoke, and it came into being.
He gave the order, and there it stood.

33:6–9 Your Word lit up the heavens. Your hands stretched the ocean shores. I stand in awe of you.
A command from your mouth brought everything into existence.

- ¹⁰ The LORD blocks the plans of the nations.
He frustrates the schemes of the people of the world.
- ¹¹ The LORD's plan stands firm forever.
His thoughts stand firm in every generation.
- ¹² Blessed is the nation whose God is the LORD.
Blessed are the people he has chosen as his own.

33:10–12 You frustrate evildoers' goals but your own plans always succeed. Your chosen people live in your blessing.

- ¹³ The LORD looks down from heaven.
He sees all of Adam's descendants.
- ¹⁴ From the place where he sits enthroned,
he looks down upon all who live on earth.
- ¹⁵ The one who formed their hearts
understands everything they do.

33:13–15 From your throne you watch all humankind. Because you made our hearts, you understand everything we do.

¹⁶ No king achieves a victory with a large army.
No warrior rescues himself by his own great strength.

¹⁷ Horses are not a guarantee for victory.
Their great strength cannot help someone escape.

¹⁸ The LORD's eyes are on those who fear him,
on those who wait with hope for his mercy
¹⁹ to rescue their souls from death
and keep them alive during a famine.

²⁰ We wait for the LORD.
He is our help and our shield.

33:16–20 There's not a single battle I can win in my own strength. There's no mighty thing or powerful person who can help me like you do. You watch out for me because I live in awe of you. I look to you to save me from hunger and death. I wait for you.

²¹ In him our hearts find joy.
In his holy name we trust.

²² Let your mercy rest on us, O LORD,
since we wait with hope for you.

33:21–22 In you I find joy. In your perfect holiness I discover calm. Show mercy to me and everyone who relies on you.

Psalm 34^[30]

*By David when he pretended to be insane in the presence of Abimelech;
Abimelech threw him out, so David left.*

¹ I will thank the LORD at all times.

- My mouth will always praise him.
² My soul will boast about the LORD.
Those who are oppressed will hear it and rejoice.

34:1–2 I won't stop thanking you or praising you or boasting about you. Oppressed people will be glad to hear of your greatness.

- ³ Praise the LORD's greatness with me.
Let us highly honor his name together.
⁴ I went to the LORD for help.
He answered me and rescued me from all my fears.
⁵ All who look to him will be radiant.[\[31\]](#)
Their faces will never be covered with shame.

34:5 I shine because of you. Shame never covers my face.

- ⁶ Here is a poor man who called out.
The LORD heard him and saved him from all his troubles.
⁷ The Messenger of the LORD camps around those who fear him,
and he rescues them.

34:6–7 Even at my poorest I can count on you to answer. You stand watch over all who respect you.

- ⁸ Taste and see that the LORD is good.
Blessed is the person who takes refuge in him.
⁹ Fear the LORD, you holy people who belong to him.
Those who fear him are never in need.
¹⁰ Young lions go hungry and may starve,
but those who seek the LORD's help have all the good things they need.

34:8–10 I test you in real life and you prove your goodness. Because I hide in you, I'm blessed.
Because I belong to you, I never lack. You promise to meet my every real need.

- ¹¹ Come, children, listen to me.

I will teach you the fear of the LORD.

34:11 I come to you like a trusting child. Teach me to live in awe of you.

¹² Which of you wants a full life?

Who would like to live long enough to enjoy good things?

¹³ Keep your tongue from saying evil things
and your lips from speaking deceitful things.

¹⁴ Turn away from evil, and do good.
Seek peace, and pursue it!

34:12–14 I can't expect a long and full life if I don't quit evil. Help me do good and find peace.

¹⁵ The LORD's eyes are on righteous people.

His ears hear their cry for help.

¹⁶ The LORD confronts those who do evil
in order to wipe out all memory of them from the earth.

34:15–16 Moment by moment you keep watch over me, but you erase every sign that evildoers even existed.

¹⁷ „Righteous people„ cry out.

The LORD hears and rescues them from all their troubles.

¹⁸ The LORD is near to those whose hearts are humble.

He saves those whose spirits are crushed.

¹⁹ The righteous person has many troubles,
but the LORD rescues him from all of them.

²⁰ The LORD guards all of his bones.
Not one of them is broken.

34:18–20 You feel nearest when I bow to you. You save me when I'm crushed. You rescue me when I'm in trouble. You keep me whole.

²¹ Evil will kill wicked people,

and those who hate righteous people will be condemned.
²² The LORD protects the souls of his servants.
All who take refuge in him will never be condemned.

Psalm 35

By David.

¹ O LORD, attack those who attack me.
Fight against those who fight against me.
² Use your shields, “both” small and large.
Arise to help me.
³ Hold your spear to block the way of those who pursue me.
Say to my soul, “I am your savior.”

35:1–3 Fight those who fight me. Raise your shields and block my pursuers. Convince my quaking heart that you will save me.

⁴ Let those who seek my life be put to shame and disgraced.
Let those who plan my downfall be turned back in confusion.
⁵ Let them be like husks blown by the wind
as the Messenger of the LORD chases them.
⁶ Let their path be dark and slippery
as the Messenger of the LORD pursues them.

35:4–6 Disgrace the people aiming to do me in. Confuse their plans. Scatter them. Chase them down a dark and slippery path.

⁷ For no reason they hid their net in a pit.
For no reason they dug the pit “to trap me.”
⁸ Let destruction surprise them.
Let the net that they hid catch them.
Let them fall into their own pit and be destroyed.

35:7–8 My enemies turned on me for no reason. Catch them when they won’t see you coming. Push them into the same pit they dug for me.

-
- ⁹ My soul will find joy in the LORD
and be joyful about his salvation.
- ¹⁰ All my bones will say, “O LORD, who can compare with you?
You rescue the weak person from the one who is too strong for him
and weak and needy people from the one who robs them.”

35:9–10 My soul thrills at the thought of you and your salvation. In the core of my bones I know
that nothing compares with you. You rescue me from enemies too strong for me.

- ¹¹ Malicious people bring charges against me.
They ask me things I know nothing about.
- ¹² I am devastated
because they pay me back with evil instead of good.
- ¹³ But when they were sick, I wore sackcloth.
I humbled myself with fasting.
When my prayer returned unanswered,
¹⁴ I walked around as if I were mourning for my friend or my brother.
I was bent over as if I were mourning for my mother.
- ¹⁵ Yet, when I stumbled,
they rejoiced and gathered together.
They gathered together against me.
Unknown attackers tore me apart without stopping.

35:11–15 Hateful people accuse me of things I know nothing about. Even when I do them good they
pay me back with evil. I see them hurting and respond by mourning for their pain. I fast and pray
for them. Yet they attack me and won't stop.

- ¹⁶ With crude and abusive mockers,
they grit their teeth at me.
- ¹⁷ O LORD, how long will you look on?
Rescue me from their attacks.
Rescue my precious life from the lions.
¹⁸ I will give you thanks in a large gathering.
I will praise you in a crowd of worshipers.
-

35:16–18 Can't you see how these crude mockers threaten me? How long will you watch and do nothing? Lions pounce on me. Rescue me now! Then I will praise you for all your people to hear.

- ¹⁹ Do not let my treacherous enemies gloat over me.
Do not let those who hate me for no reason wink └at me┐.
²⁰ They do not talk about peace.
Instead, they scheme against the peaceful people in the land.
²¹ They open their big mouths and say about me,
“Aha! Aha! Our own eyes have seen it.”
²² You have seen it, O LORD.
Do not remain silent.
O Lord, do not be so far away from me.

35:19–22 My enemies pretend to talk peace at the same time they plot to destroy me. They drum up false charges against me, but you have seen the truth. Stop their gloating. End their laughter.

- ²³ Wake up, and rise to my defense.
Plead my case, O my God and my Lord.
²⁴ Judge me by your righteousness, O LORD my God.
Do not let them gloat over me

35:22–24 Don't be silent. Don't wander from me. Wake up and defend me. Measure me by your perfect standard.

- ²⁵ or think, “Aha, just what we wanted!”
Do not let them say, “We have swallowed him up.”
²⁶ Let those who gloat over my downfall
be thoroughly put to shame and confused.
Let those who promote themselves at my expense
be clothed with shame and disgrace.
²⁷ Let those who are happy when I am declared innocent
joyfully sing and rejoice.
Let them continually say, “The LORD is great.
He is happy when his servant has peace.”
²⁸ Then my tongue will tell about your righteousness,
about your praise all day long.

35:25–28 My enemies assume they’ve beat me. They think they’ve swallowed me alive. Disgrace those gloaters. Warm the hearts of everyone who believes in my innocence. Give them reason to praise your greatness.

Psalm 36

For the choir director; by David, the LORD’s servant.

- ¹ There is an inspired truth about the wicked person
who has rebellion in the depths of his heart:
He is not terrified of God.
² He flatters himself and does not hate or *“even”*
recognize his guilt.
³ The words from his mouth are *“nothing but”* trouble
and deception.
He has stopped doing what is wise and good.
⁴ He invents trouble while lying on his bed
and chooses to go the wrong direction.
He does not reject evil.

36:1–4 You’ve convinced me: Rebellion flows from a heart that forgets to fear you. So don’t let me flatter myself or overlook my guilt. Make my words true and my actions wise. When I map out my life, I’ll choose to go your direction.

- ⁵ O LORD, your mercy reaches to the heavens,
your faithfulness to the skies.
⁶ Your righteousness is like the mountains of God,
your judgments like the deep ocean.
You save people and animals, O LORD.

36:5–6 Your mercy and faithfulness stretch to the skies. Your righteousness looms as large as the mountains. Your wisdom runs as deep as the sea.

- ⁷ Your mercy is so precious, O God,

that Adam's descendants take refuge
in the shadow of your wings.

⁸ They are refreshed with the rich foods in your house,
and you make them drink from the river of your pleasure.

⁹ Indeed, the fountain of life is with you.
In your light we see light.

36:7–9 Your mercy reaches everyone who hides in your shadow. Refresh me with your richness. Let me drink full of everything you delight in. Light my life.

¹⁰ Continue to show your mercy to those who know you
and your righteousness to those whose motives are decent.

¹¹ Do not let the feet of arrogant people step on me
or the hands of wicked people push me away.

36:10–11 Keep showing me mercy, and let me see your righteousness one more time. Don't let arrogant people walk all over me.

¹² Look at the troublemakers who have fallen.
They have been pushed down and are unable to stand up again.

Psalm 37 [\[32\]](#)

By David.

¹ Do not be preoccupied with evildoers.
Do not envy those who do wicked things.

² They will quickly dry up like grass
and wither away like green plants.

37:1–2 I refuse to let evildoers cloud my mind for even a minute. They're just like grass that quickly dries and withers.

³ Trust the LORD, and do good things.
Live in the land, and practice being faithful.

⁴ Be happy with the LORD,

and he will give you the desires of your heart.
⁵ Entrust your ways to the LORD.
Trust him, and he will act **⌋**on your behalf**⌋**.

37:3–5 I'll trust in you and do good. I'll live close to you and practice being faithful. When I make you my greatest happiness, you'll grant me my heart's desire. When I trust my life to you, you'll act on my behalf.

⁶ He will make your righteousness shine like a light,
your just cause like the noonday sun.
⁷ Surrender yourself to the LORD, and wait patiently for him.
Do not be preoccupied with **⌋**an evildoer**⌋** who succeeds in his way
when he carries out his schemes.
⁸ Let go of anger, and leave rage behind.
Do not be preoccupied.
It only leads to evil.
⁹ Evildoers will be cut off **⌋**from their inheritance**⌋**,
but those who wait with hope for the LORD will inherit the land.
¹⁰ In a little while a wicked person will vanish.
Then you can carefully examine where he was,
but there will be no trace of him.
¹¹ Oppressed people will inherit the land
and will enjoy unlimited peace.

37:7–11 I'll let go of my rage. I won't allow myself to envy the prosperity of evildoers. I'll quit pondering their supposed success before I'm tempted to join them in sin. Evildoers will vanish, but if I count on you I'll endure and enjoy peace.

¹² The wicked person plots against a righteous one
and grits his teeth at him.
¹³ The Lord laughs at him
because he has seen that his time is coming.
¹⁴ Wicked people pull out their swords and bend their bows
to kill oppressed and needy people,
to slaughter those who are decent.
¹⁵ **⌋**But**⌋** their own swords will pierce their hearts,

and their bows will be broken.

37:12–15 The wicked plot my ruin because I do good. But you laugh at them, knowing their end is near. They'll be destroyed by their own weapons.

- ¹⁶ The little that the righteous person has is better
than the wealth of many wicked people.
- ¹⁷ The arms of wicked people will be broken,
but the LORD continues to support righteous people.
- ¹⁸ The LORD knows the daily „struggles„ of innocent people.
Their inheritance will last forever.

37:16–18 I would rather do good and have a little than sin and have a lot. I trust you to support me
in my everyday struggles.

- ¹⁹ They will not be put to shame in trying times.
Even in times of famine they will be satisfied.

37:19 Don't let me be put to shame. Feed me even when I'm surrounded by famine.

- ²⁰ But wicked people will disappear.
The LORD's enemies will vanish like the best part of a meadow.
They will vanish like smoke.
- ²¹ A wicked person borrows, but he does not repay.
A righteous person is generous and giving.
- ²² Those who are blessed by him will inherit the land.
Those who are cursed by him will be cut off.

37:21–22 I'll repay my debts and be generous with all I have.

- ²³ A person's steps are directed by the LORD,
and the LORD delights in his way.
- ²⁴ When he falls, he will not be thrown down headfirst
because the LORD holds on to his hand.

37:23–24 You direct my steps. You like the path you plan for me. If I stumble you'll catch me, because you hold on to my hand.

²⁵ I have been young, and now I am old,
but I have never seen a righteous person abandoned
or his descendants begging for food.

²⁶ He is always generous and lends freely.
His descendants are a blessing.

²⁷ Avoid evil, do good, and live forever.

37:25–27 You'll never abandon me or let me go hungry. You provide for me so I can give and lend freely. I'll do good with eternity in mind.

²⁸ The LORD loves justice,
and he will not abandon his godly ones.
They will be kept safe forever,
but the descendants of wicked people will be cut off.

²⁹ Righteous people will inherit the land
and live there permanently.

37:28–29 You love justice. You won't abandon people committed to you. I'll live close to you forever.

³⁰ The mouth of the righteous person reflects on wisdom.
His tongue speaks what is fair.

³¹ The teachings of his God are in his heart.
His feet do not slip.

³² The wicked person watches the righteous person
and seeks to kill him.

³³ But the LORD will not abandon him to the wicked person's power
or condemn him when he is brought to trial.

37:31–33 Your teachings fill my heart, and I follow them wherever I go. Evildoers want to kill me, but you protect me from their power.

- ³⁴ Wait with hope for the LORD, and follow his path,
and he will honor you by giving you the land.
When wicked people are cut off, you will see it.
- ³⁵ I have seen a wicked person *ḥ*acting likeḥ a tyrant,
spreading himself out like a large cedar tree.
- ³⁶ But he moved on, and now there is no trace of him.
I searched for him, but he could not be found.

37:34–36 When I follow your path, I encounter blessings of every kind. Though the wicked seem strong and healthy, they die and vanish.

- ³⁷ Notice the innocent person,
and look at the decent person,
because the peacemaker has a future.
- ³⁸ But rebels will be completely destroyed.
The future of wicked people will be cut off.
- ³⁹ The victory for righteous people comes from the LORD.
He is their fortress in times of trouble.
- ⁴⁰ The LORD helps them and rescues them.
He rescues them from wicked people.
He saves them because they have taken refuge in him.

37:37–40 Innocent people have hope and a future, but rebels will be utterly destroyed. I depend on you as my fortress and victory, my help and my rescuer. I'll always take refuge in you.

Psalm 38

A psalm by David; to be kept in mind.[\[33\]](#)

- ¹ O LORD, do not angrily punish me
or discipline me in your wrath.
- ² Your arrows have struck me.
Your hand has struck me hard.
- ³ No healthy spot is left on my body
because of your rage.

There is no peace in my bones
because of my sin.

- ⁴ My guilt has overwhelmed me.
Like a heavy load, it is more than I can bear.

38:1–4 Quit punishing me! Your hand has already struck me hard and bruised my whole body. My bones shake because of my sin. My guilt crushes me.

- ⁵ My wounds smell rotten.
They fester because of my stupidity.
- ⁶ I am bent over and bowed down very low.
All day I walk around in mourning.
- ⁷ My insides are filled with burning pain,
and no healthy spot is left on my body.
- ⁸ I am numb and completely devastated.
I roar because my heart's in turmoil.

38:5–8 My wounds stink because my sins were so stupid. My shoulders sag as I walk around in mourning. My insides burn. I'm numb. My heart reels with such turmoil I do nothing but groan.

- ⁹ You know all my desires, O Lord,
and my groaning has not been hidden from you.
- ¹⁰ My heart is pounding.
I have lost my strength.
Even the light of my eyes has left me.
- ¹¹ My loved ones and my friends keep their distance
and my relatives stand far away because of my sickness.
- ¹² Those who seek my life lay traps for me.
Those who are out to harm me talk about ruining me. All day long they
think of ways to deceive me.

38:10–12 My heart pounds and my strength has vanished. I can't even see straight. People who love me stay away because I'm diseased, and my enemies plot ways to ruin me.

- ¹³ But I am like a person who cannot hear
and like a person who cannot speak.

- ¹⁴ I am like one who cannot hear
and who can offer no arguments.
- ¹⁵ But I wait with hope for you, O LORD.
You will answer, O Lord, my God.
- ¹⁶ I said, “Do not let them gloat over me.
When my foot slips,
do not let them promote themselves at my expense.”

38:13–16 I’m deaf, mute, defenseless. But I’m sure you’ll answer me. You’ll keep my enemies from gloating and gaining an edge over me.

- ¹⁷ I am ready to fall.
I am continually aware of my pain.
- ¹⁸ I confess my guilt.
My sin troubles me.

38:17–18 I’m ready to fall over. Pain constantly nags me. I confess my guilt to you because my sin troubles me.

- ¹⁹ My mortal enemies are growing stronger.
Many hate me for no reason.
- ²⁰ They pay me back with evil instead of good,
and they accuse me because I try to do what is good.
- ²¹ Do not abandon me, O LORD.
O my God, do not be so distant from me.
- ²² Come quickly to help me, O Lord, my savior.

38:19–22 My enemies keep getting stronger, many who hate me for no reason. They punish me for doing good. So don’t be distant from me. Come quickly to help me, my Savior!

Psalm 39

For the choir director; for Jeduthun; a psalm by David.

¹ I said,
“I will watch my ways so that I do not sin with my tongue.
I will bridle my mouth while wicked people are in my presence.”

² I remained totally speechless.
I kept silent, although it did me no good.
While I was deep in thought, my pain grew worse.
³ My heart burned like a fire flaring up within me.
Then I spoke with my tongue:

39:1–3 I tried hard not to sin with my words, but keeping silent did me no good. My mind raced and my pain grew worse. My heart burned until I spoke up.

⁴ “Teach me, O LORD, about the end of my life.
Teach me about the number of days I have left
so that I may know how temporary my life is.
⁵ Indeed, you have made the length of my days *only* a few inches.
My life span is nothing compared to yours.
Certainly, everyone alive is like a whisper in the wind. *Selah*

39: 4–5 I need you to remind me that my days are short. The span of my life is nothing compared to your eternal existence. I’m just a whisper in the wind.

⁶ Each person who walks around is like a shadow.
They are busy for no reason.
They accumulate riches without knowing who will get them.”

39:6 People are just shadows. They act busy but accomplish nothing, because someone else always gets what they accumulate.

⁷ And now, Lord, what am I waiting for?
My hope is in you!

⁸ Rescue me from all my rebellious acts.
Do not disgrace me in front of godless fools.

39:7–8 I'm waiting for you to help me! Rescue me from my rebellion. Don't disgrace me in front of fools who don't believe in you.

⁹ I remained speechless.

I did not open my mouth
because you are the one who has done this.

¹⁰ Remove the sickness you laid upon me.

My life is over because you struck me with your hand.

¹¹ With stern warnings you discipline people for their crimes.

Like a moth you eat away at what is dear to them.
Certainly, everyone is like a whisper in the wind. *Selah*

39:9–11 I've kept silent because you're the one who makes me suffer. Remove my sickness and save me before I die. You have disciplined me for my crimes.

¹² Listen to my prayer, O LORD.

Open your ear to my cry for help.
Do not be deaf to my tears,
for I am a foreign resident with you,
a stranger like all my ancestors.

¹³ Look away from me so that I may smile again
before I go away and am no more.

39:12–13 Hear my prayers. I feel like a stranger to you. Turn away your wrath so I can live.

Psalm 40

For the choir director; a psalm by David.

¹ I waited patiently for the LORD.

He turned to me and heard my cry for help.

² He pulled me out of a horrible pit,
out of the mud and clay.

He set my feet on a rock
and made my steps secure.

40:1–2 I waited for you and you helped me. You pulled me out of a muddy pit, then set my feet on solid rock.

³ He placed a new song in my mouth,
a song of praise to our God.
Many will see this and worship.
They will trust the LORD.

40:3 You filled me with a new song of praise to you. Many will see how you rescued me. They'll worship and trust you.

⁴ Blessed is the person
who places his confidence in the LORD
and does not rely on arrogant people
or those who follow lies.

40:4 I'm completely satisfied when I count on you instead of trusting proud people.

⁵ You have done many miraculous things, O LORD my God.
You have made many wonderful plans for us.
No one compares to you!
I will tell others about your miracles,
which are more than I can count.

40:5 You do more miracles than I can count. You have wonderful plans for me. No one compares to you!

⁶ You were not pleased with sacrifices and offerings.
You have dug out two ears for me.[\[34\]](#)
You did not ask for burnt offerings or sacrifices for sin.
⁷ Then I said, "I have come!
(It is written about me in the scroll of the book.)
⁸ I am happy to do your will, O my God."
Your teachings are deep within me.

40:6–8 You don't want my sacrifices. You want my obedience. I'm happy to do your will. Your words live deep inside me.

⁹ I will announce the good news of righteousness
among those assembled for worship.
I will not close my lips.
You know that, O LORD.

¹⁰ I have not buried your righteousness deep in my heart.
I have been outspoken about your faithfulness and your salvation.
I have not hidden your mercy and your truth
from those assembled for worship.

40:9–10 You know I can't keep quiet about you. I won't keep silent about your righteousness and faithfulness and salvation. I promise to tell others about your mercy and truth.

¹¹ Do not withhold your compassion from me, O LORD.
May your mercy and your truth always protect me.
¹² Countless evils have surrounded me.
My sins have caught up with me so that I can no longer see.
They outnumber the hairs on my head.
I have lost heart.

40:11–12 Don't hold back your kindness. Protect me with your mercy and truth. I'm surrounded by countless evils and my own wrongdoing blinds me.

¹³ O LORD, please rescue me!
Come quickly to help me, O LORD![\[35\]](#)
¹⁴ Let all those who seek to end my life
be confused and put to shame.
Let those who want my downfall
be turned back and disgraced.
¹⁵ Let those who say to me, "Aha! Aha!"
be stunned by their own shame.

40:12–15 My sins outnumber the hairs on my head—and I am discouraged. Rescue me quickly. Confuse those who want to kill me. Disgrace those who want my downfall. Stun them with their own shame.

¹⁶ Let all who seek you rejoice and be glad because of you.
Let those who love your salvation continually say,
“The LORD is great!”

¹⁷ But I am oppressed and needy.
May the Lord think of me.
You are my help and my savior.
O my God, do not delay!

40:16–17 I will rejoice and be glad because of you. Because I love your salvation, I will continually speak of your greatness. You are my Savior. Help me now!

Psalm 41

For the choir director; a psalm by David.

¹ Blessed is the one who has concern for helpless people.
The LORD will rescue him in times of trouble.
² The LORD will protect him and keep him alive.
He will be blessed in the land.
Do not place him at the mercy of his enemies.
³ The LORD will support him on his sickbed.
You will restore this person to health when he is ill.

41:1–3 Because I worry about the helpless, you’ll rescue me from my own troubles. You’ll protect me and keep me alive. You’ll shower me with your blessings and restore my health.

⁴ I said, “O LORD, have pity on me!
Heal my soul because I have sinned against you.”
⁵ My enemies say terrible things about me:
“When will he die, and when will his family
name disappear?”

⁶ When one of them comes to visit me, he speaks foolishly.
His heart collects gossip.
Then he leaves to tell others.

41:4–6 I cry to you for pity because I’ve sinned against you. My enemies can’t wait for me to die and disappear. The only reason they visit me is to see my suffering and gossip about me.

⁷ Everyone who hates me whispers about me.
They think evil things about me and say,
⁸ “A devilish disease has attached itself to him.
He will never leave his sickbed.”
⁹ Even my closest friend whom I trusted,
the one who ate my bread,
has lifted his heel against me.

41:7–9 People who hate me are whispering about me. They say I’m too sick to recover. Even my most trusted friend has turned on me.

¹⁰ Have pity on me, O LORD!
Raise me up so that I can pay them back
¹¹ and my enemy cannot shout in triumph over me.
When you do this, I know that you are pleased with me.

41:10–11 Pity me! Heal me so I can pay back my enemies and silence their shouts of victory. Then I will know that I please you.

¹² You defend my integrity,
and you set me in your presence forever.
¹³ Thank the LORD God of Israel through all eternity!
Amen and amen!

41:12–13 Defend my integrity. Let me live close to you forever. I’ll thank you now and forever!

BOOK TWO

(Psalms 42–72)

Psalm 42

For the choir director; a maskil^[36] by Korah's descendants.

- ¹ As a deer longs for flowing streams,
so my soul longs for you, O God.
² My soul thirsts for God, for the living God.
When may I come to see God's face?

42:1–2 I long for you like a deer thirsts for fresh streams. I want more and more of the living God.
When can I see your face?

- ³ My tears are my food day and night.
People ask me all day long, "Where is your God?"
⁴ I will remember these things as I pour out my soul:
how I used to walk with the crowd
and lead it in a procession to God's house.
I sang songs of joy and thanksgiving
while crowds of people celebrated a festival.

42:3–4 Everyone hears my crying and wonders why you've deserted me. I used to lead crowds in
jubilant worship.

- ⁵ Why are you discouraged, my soul?
Why are you so restless?
Put your hope in God,
because I will still praise him.
He is my savior and my God.
⁶ My soul is discouraged.
That is why I will remember you

in the land of Jordan, on the peaks of Hermon, on Mount Mizar.

42:5–6 Why am I so discouraged and agitated when I have you as my Savior? When sadness takes me down, I'll purposely focus on you.

⁷ One deep sea calls to another at the roar of your waterspouts.
All the whitecaps on your waves have swept over me.[\[37\]](#)

⁸ The LORD commands his mercy during the day,
and at night his song is with me—
a prayer to the God of my life.

⁹ I will ask God, my rock,
“Why have you forgotten me?
Why must I walk around in mourning
while the enemy oppresses me?”

42:7–9 My soul's despair runs as deep as the sea. Your judgment sweeps over me like waves. All day and night you send me mercy, but still I wonder why you've forgotten me.

¹⁰ With a shattering blow to my bones,
my enemies taunt me.
They ask me all day long, “Where is your God?”

¹¹ Why are you discouraged, my soul?
Why are you so restless?
Put your hope in God,
because I will still praise him.
He is my savior and my God.

42:10–11 My enemies keep asking where you are. Their taunts shatter my bones. I keep telling myself to trust you. I praise you, my Savior and God.

Psalm 43

¹ Judge me, O God,
and plead my case against an ungodly nation.

Rescue me from deceitful and unjust people.

² You are my fortress, O God!

Why have you rejected me?

Why must I walk around in mourning
while the enemy oppresses me?

43:1–2 Examine me, O God, then plead my case against liars. I've run to you for protection. So why do you reject me and force me to mourn and suffer?

³ Send your light and your truth.

Let them guide me.

Let them bring me to your holy mountain and to your dwelling place.

⁴ Then let me go to the altar of God, to God my highest joy,
and I will give thanks to you on the lyre, O God, my God.

43:3–4 Send your light and truth to guide me home to you. Welcome me close and I'll sing thanks to you. You are God, my highest joy.

⁵ Why are you discouraged, my soul?

Why are you so restless?

Put your hope in God,
because I will still praise him.
He is my savior and my God.

43:5 I'm discouraged and restless. But I keep reminding myself to trust and praise you. You'll always be my Savior and God.

Psalm 44

For the choir director; a maskil by Korah's descendants.

¹ O God,

we have heard it with our own ears.

Our ancestors have told us

about the miracle you performed in their day, in days long ago.

² By your power you forced nations *“out of the land,”*
but you planted our ancestors *“there.”*
You shattered many groups of people,
but you set our ancestors free.[\[38\]](#)

44:1–2 I’ve heard the story of the miracle you did long ago. With brute strength you pushed out nations and planted your followers in a good land. You shattered others but set us free.

³ It was not with their swords that they took possession of the land.
They did not gain victory with their own strength.
It was your right hand, your arm,
and the light of your presence *“that did it,”*
because you were pleased with them.

44:3 No human power gave your people victory. Only you did. Your might and your presence accomplished your purpose.

⁴ You alone are my king, O God.
You won those victories for Jacob.
⁵ With you we can walk over our enemies.
With your name we can trample those who attack us.
⁶ I do not rely on my bow,
and my sword will never save me.

44:4–6 You alone are my King and God. You’re my victory. You give me power to walk over my enemies. Human weapons can’t save me.

⁷ But you saved us from our enemies.
You put to shame those who hate us.
⁸ All day long we praise our God.
We give thanks to you forever. *Selah*

44:7–8 You save me, putting people who hate me to shame. All day long I praise and thank you.

⁹ But now you have rejected and disgraced us. You do not even go along with our armies.

¹⁰ You make us retreat from the enemy.

Those who hate us rob us at will.

¹¹ You hand us over to be butchered like sheep
and scatter us among the nations.

¹² You sell your people for almost nothing,
and at that price you have gained nothing.

44:9–12 Long ago you did a miracle. But now you've rejected me and left me to fight my battles alone. I'm forced to retreat. I'm feeling robbed, butchered, and lost. You're selling me out.

¹³ You made us a disgrace to our neighbors
and an object of ridicule and contempt to those around us.

¹⁴ You made our "defeat" a proverb among the nations
so that people shake their heads at us.

¹⁵ All day long my disgrace is in front of me.
Shame covers my face

¹⁶ because of the words of those who insult and slander us,
because of the presence of the enemy and the avenger.

44:13–16 My neighbors ridicule me. In fact, the story of my defeat has become legend. People shake their heads at me. Shame smears my face. My enemies spare no insult.

¹⁷ Although all of this happened to us,
we never forgot you.
We never ignored your promise.[\[39\]](#)

¹⁸ Our hearts never turned away.
Our feet never left your path.

¹⁹ Yet, you crushed us in a place for jackals
and covered us with the shadow of death.

44:17–19 Despite my suffering I never gave up on your promises. I never stopped loving or obeying you. Yet you crushed me and shrouded me in death.

²⁰ If we forgot the name of our God
or stretched out our hands to pray to another god,
²¹ wouldn't God find out,
since he knows the secrets in our hearts?
²² Indeed, we are being killed all day long because of you.
We are thought of as sheep to be slaughtered.

44:20–22 You'd know if I forgot you. You'd overhear if I prayed to another god. But I'm dying because of you. I'm nothing but a sheep ready for slaughter.

²³ Wake up! Why are you sleeping, O Lord?
Awake! Do not reject us forever!
²⁴ Why do you hide your face?
Why do you forget our suffering and misery?
²⁵ Our souls are bowing in the dust.
Our bodies cling to the ground.
²⁶ Arise! Help us!
Rescue us because of your mercy!

44:23–26 Wake up! Why are you sleeping? Why are you hiding from me and forgetting my misery? My body lies in the dirt. Be merciful and help me!

Psalm 45

For the choir director; according to shoshannim;[\[40\]](#) a maskil by Korah's descendants; a love song.

¹ My heart is overflowing with good news.
I will direct my song to the king.
My tongue is a pen for a skillful writer.
² You are the most handsome of Adam's descendants.
Grace is poured on your lips.
That is why God has blessed you forever.

45:1–2 My heart overflows with good news. You, O King, inspire my song. You are the most handsome of all human beings. Grace fills your lips.

- ³ O warrior, strap your sword to your side
with your splendor and majesty.
- ⁴ Ride on victoriously in your majesty
for the cause of truth, humility, and righteousness.
Let your right hand teach you awe-inspiring things.

45:3–4 Mount your steed for the cause of truth, humility, and goodness. Show off your splendor and majesty.

- ⁵ Your arrows are sharp in the heart of the king's enemies.
Nations fall beneath you.
- ⁶ Your throne, O God, is forever and ever.
The scepter in your kingdom is a scepter for justice.
- ⁷ You have loved what is right and hated what is wrong.
That is why God, your God, has anointed you,
rather than your companions, with the oil of joy.

45:6–7 Your throne, O God, endures forever. Your reign stands for justice. You love what's right and hate what's wrong.

- ⁸ All your robes are «fragrant» with myrrh, aloes, and cassia.
From ivory palaces the music of stringed instruments delights you.
- ⁹ The daughters of kings are among your noble ladies.
The queen takes her place at your right hand and wears gold from Ophir.
- ¹⁰ Listen, daughter! Look closely!
Turn your ear «toward me».
Forget your people, and forget your father's house.
- ¹¹ The king longs for your beauty.
He is your Lord.
Worship him.

45:9–11 Your bride is at your right hand. Her beauty is all for you. She worships you.

- ¹² The people of Tyre, the richest people,
want to win your favor with a gift.
- ¹³ The daughter of the king is glorious inside ⌈the palace⌋.
Her dress is embroidered with gold.
- ¹⁴ Wearing a colorful gown, she is brought to the king.
Her bridesmaids follow her.
They will be brought to you.
- ¹⁵ With joy and delight they are brought in.
They enter the palace of the king.

45:12–15 Outsiders will honor your bride. She is dazzling as she enters your presence.

- ¹⁶ Your sons will take the place of your father.
You will make them princes over the whole earth.
- ¹⁷ I will cause your name to be remembered throughout every generation.
That is why the nations will give thanks to you forever and ever.

45:17 Every generation will recall your majestic name. Every nation will thank you forever and ever.

Psalm 46

For the choir director; a song by the descendants of Korah; according to alamoth.[\[41\]](#)

¹ God is our refuge and strength,
an ever-present help in times of trouble.

² That is why we are not afraid

even when the earth quakes
or the mountains topple into the depths of the sea.

³ Water roars and foams,

and mountains shake at the
surging waves. *Selah*

46:1–3 You're my refuge and strength, my always-present help in trouble. So I won't fear when the ground shakes or mountains tumble, when waters roar or waves surge against the mountains.

⁴ There is a river
whose streams bring joy to the city of God,
the holy place where the Most High lives.

⁵ God is in that city.
It cannot fall.
God will help it at the break of dawn.

46:4–5 Your presence brings joy to your people. Nothing can topple your holy city, because you are there.

⁶ Nations are in turmoil, and kingdoms topple.
The earth melts at the sound of ᵀGod'sᵀ voice.

⁷ The LORD of Armies is with us.
The God of Jacob is our stronghold. *Selah*

46:6–7 Turmoil engulfs the world and kingdoms tumble. The earth melts when it hears your voice.
But you're my strength.

⁸ Come, see the works of the LORD,
the devastation he has brought to the earth.

⁹ He puts an end to wars all over the earth.
He breaks an archer's bow.
He cuts spears in two.
He burns chariots.

46:8–9 I can see your works, the judgments you pour out on earth. You end wars and halt violence.

¹⁰ Let go ᵀof your concernsᵀ!

Then you will know that I am God.
I rule the nations.
I rule the earth.

- ¹¹ The LORD of Armies is with us.
The God of Jacob is our stronghold. *Selah*

46:10–11 When I let go of my concerns, I find rest in you, ruler of the whole earth. Your strength is with me. You're my stronghold.

Psalm 47

For the choir director; a psalm by Korah's descendants.

- ¹ Clap your hands, all you people.
Shout to God with a loud, joyful song.
² We must fear the LORD, the Most High.
He is the great king of the whole earth.
³ He brings people under our authority
and «puts» nations under our feet.
⁴ He chooses our inheritance for us,
the pride of Jacob, whom he loved. *Selah*

47:1–4 I'll clap and shout a joyful song to you. I live in awe of you, Lord Most High. You're the great King of the whole world. You're the source of my power. You're the gift-giver of everything I have.

- ⁵ God has gone up with a joyful shout.
The LORD has gone up with the sound of a ram's horn.
⁶ Make music to praise God.
Play music for him!
Make music to praise our king.
Play music for him!
⁷ God is the king of the whole earth.
Make your best music for him!

47:6–7 I'll make music to praise my King. You rule the whole earth, so I'll bring you my very best.

⁸ God rules the nations.

He sits upon his holy throne.

⁹ The influential people from the nations gather together

as the people of the God of Abraham.

The rulers of the earth belong to God.

He rules everything.

47:8–9 From your holy throne you rule the world. Powerful people from every nation gather as your own. Every human ruler belongs to you. You rule it all!

Psalm 48

A song; a psalm by Korah's descendants.

¹ The LORD is great.

He should be highly praised.

His holy mountain is in the city of our God.

² Its beautiful peak is the joy of the whole earth.

Mount Zion is on the northern ridge.

It is the city of the great king.

³ God is in its palaces.

He has proved that he is a stronghold.

48:1–3 You're great—and you deserve the highest praise. You dwell among your people on your holy mountain. Your presence graces your palace.

⁴ The kings have gathered.

They marched together.

⁵ ⌋When⌋ they saw ⌋Mount Zion⌋,

they were astonished.

They were terrified and ran away in fear.

⁶ Trembling seized them
like the trembling that a woman experiences during labor.

48:4–6 Kings march against you only to flee in fear when they see your dwelling. They tremble like women in labor.

⁷ With the east wind you smash the ships of Tarshish.
⁸ The things we had only heard about, we have now seen
in the city of the LORD of Armies, in the city of our God.
God makes Zion stand firm forever. *Selah*

48:8 I'd only heard of your power, but now I've seen it with my own eyes.

⁹ Inside your temple we carefully reflect on your mercy, O God.
¹⁰ Like your name, O God,
your praise *reaches* to the ends of the earth.
Your right hand is filled with righteousness.

48:9–10 As I come near you I'll reflect on your mercy. Praise for you reaches to the ends of the earth.

¹¹ Let Mount Zion be glad
and the cities of Judah rejoice
because of your judgments.
¹² Walk around Zion.
Go around it.
Count its towers.
¹³ Examine its embankments.
Walk through its palaces.
Then you can tell the next generation,
¹⁴ "This God is our God forever and ever.
He will lead us beyond death."

48:11–14 I'm glad because of your wise judgments. I'll tell everyone who comes after me that you

are God forever and ever. You'll guide us to death and beyond.

Psalm 49

For the choir director; a psalm by Korah's descendants.

- ¹ Listen to this, all you people.
Open your ears, all who live in the world—
² common people and important ones,
rich people and poor ones.
³ My mouth will speak wise sayings,
the insights I have carefully considered.

49:1–3 Let everyone in the world hear my words—everyday people and powerful people, the poor and the rich. Let them hear the wisdom you've taught me.

- ⁴ I will turn my attention to a proverb.
I will explain my riddle with the "music of" a lyre.
⁵ Why should I be afraid in times of trouble,
when slanderers surround me with evil?
⁶ They trust their riches
and brag about their abundant wealth.
⁷ No one can ever buy back another person
or pay God a ransom for his life.
⁸ The price to be paid for his soul is too costly.

He must always give up

⁹ in order to live forever and never see the pit.

49:5–9 Why should I fear when slanderers surround me with evil? They think money means everything and brag about their abundance. But money can't buy a life. Wealth won't save a soul from death.

¹⁰ Indeed, one can see that wise people die,
that foolish and stupid people meet the same end.
They leave their riches to others.

¹¹ Although they named their lands after themselves,
their graves[\[42\]](#) have become their homes for ages to come,

their dwelling places throughout
every generation.

- ¹² But mortals will not continue here with what they treasure.
They are like animals that die.

49:10–12 Everyone dies. Both the smart and the stupid die and leave their wealth behind. No mortal
can enjoy earthly treasures forever.

- ¹³ This is the final outcome for fools and their followers
who are delighted by what they say: *Selah*
¹⁴ Like sheep, they are driven to hell
with death as their shepherd.
(Decent people will rule them in the morning.)
Their forms will decay in the grave,
far away from their comfortable homes.
¹⁵ But God will buy me back from the power of hell
because he will take me. *Selah*

49:14–15 Death pushes fools and their followers to the grave as if they were sheep. But you will buy
my freedom from hell and welcome me to yourself.

- ¹⁶ Do not be afraid when someone becomes rich,
when the greatness of his house increases.
¹⁷ He will not take anything with him when he dies.
His greatness cannot follow him.
¹⁸ Even though he blesses himself while he is alive
(and they praise you when you do well for yourself),
¹⁹ he must join the generation of his ancestors,
who will never see light again.
²⁰ Mortals, with what they treasure, still don't
have understanding.
They are like animals that die.

49:16–20 I won't fear when people pile up wealth or build big houses. They can't take anything with them, and their greatness will end when they die. The wealthy congratulate themselves and others who do well at making money, but they don't understand they will die like animals.

Psalm 50

A psalm by Asaph.

¹ The LORD, the only true God, has spoken.

He has summoned the earth
from where the sun rises to where it sets.
² God shines from Zion,
the perfection of beauty.

50:1–2 You’re the one true God, shining with beauty on your throne.

³ Our God will come and will not remain silent.
A devouring fire is in front of him and a raging storm around him.
⁴ He summons heaven and earth to judge his people:
⁵ “Gather around me, my godly people
who have made a pledge to me through sacrifices.”
⁶ The heavens announce his righteousness
because God is the judge. *Selah*

50:1–6 You’ve gathered your people and won’t keep your thoughts to yourself. A devouring fire warns your judgment is near. The heavens announce your righteousness.

⁷ “Listen, my people, and I will speak.
Listen, Israel, and I will testify against you:
I am God, your God!
⁸ I am not criticizing you for your sacrifices or
burnt offerings,
which are always in front of me.
⁹ “But” I will not accept “another” young bull from

your household
or a single male goat from your pens.

50:7–9 You're God, deserving every kind of worship. Yet you don't want another sacrifice. You don't need any more offerings.

- ¹⁰ Every creature in the forest,
 even the cattle on a thousand hills, is mine.
¹¹ I know every bird in the mountains.
 Everything that moves in the fields is mine.
¹² If I were hungry, I would not tell you,
 because the world and all that it contains are mine.
¹³ Do I eat the meat of bulls or drink the blood of goats?

50:10–13 Everything in the world is yours. If you were hungry you wouldn't ask people for something to eat, because everything in the world is yours.

- ¹⁴ Bring your thanks to God as a sacrifice,
 and keep your vows to the Most High.
¹⁵ Call on me in times of trouble.
 I will rescue you, and you will honor me."

50:14–15 You don't need sacrifices and offerings. What you really long for is gratitude and obedience and worship.

- ¹⁶ But God says to wicked people,
 "How dare you quote my decrees and mouth my promises![\[43\]](#)
¹⁷ You hate discipline.
 You toss my words behind you.

50:16–17 You hate when I mouth your commands but don't keep them. I need your discipline. I want to hold tight to your words.

- ¹⁸ When you see a thief, you want to make friends
 with him. You keep company with people who commit adultery.

¹⁹ You let your mouth say anything evil. Your tongue plans deceit.

50:18–20 Don't let me partner with thieves or sexual sinners. Stop me when I lie and spread gossip.

²⁰ You sit and talk against your own brother.
You slander your own mother's son.

²¹ When you did these things, I remained silent.

└That┐ made you think I was like you.

I will argue my point with you
and lay it all out for you to see.

²² Consider this, you people who forget God.
Otherwise, I will tear you to pieces,
and there will be no one left to rescue you.

50:21–22 If you don't confront me when I sin, I'll think you don't care. Speak to me now! Tear me to pieces if I ever forget you.

²³ Whoever offers thanks as a sacrifice honors me.
I will let everyone who continues in my way
see the salvation that comes from God."

50:23 Thanksgiving is the sacrifice that truly honors you. I want to obey you fully and see your salvation.

Psalm 51

For the choir director; a psalm by David when the prophet Nathan came to him after David's adultery with Bathsheba.

¹ Have pity on me, O God, in keeping with your mercy.
In keeping with your unlimited compassion, wipe
out my rebellious acts.

² Wash me thoroughly from my guilt,
and cleanse me from my sin.

51:1–2 Pity me because of your mercy. With your unlimited compassion wipe away my rebellion.
Cleanse every bit of my sin.

- ³ I admit that I am rebellious.
My sin is always in front of me.
- ⁴ I have sinned against you, especially you.
I have done what you consider evil.
So you hand down justice when you speak,
and you are blameless when you judge.
- ⁵ Indeed, I was born guilty.
I was a sinner when my mother conceived me.

51:3–5 I admit I'm rebellious. I've sinned against many but against none more than you. You're right to judge me. I've been sinful my whole life.

- ⁶ Yet, you desire truth and sincerity.[\[44\]](#)
Deep down inside me you teach me wisdom.
- ⁷ Purify me from sin with hyssop,[\[45\]](#) and I will be clean.[\[46\]](#)
Wash me, and I will be whiter than snow.
- ⁸ Let me hear ⌌sounds of⌌ joy and gladness.
Let the bones that you have broken dance.

51:6–8 You desire genuine truth and sincerity, so teach me wisdom deep inside. Scour me thoroughly, and I'll finally be clean. Give me joy and fix my broken places.

- ⁹ Hide your face from my sins,
and wipe out all that I have done wrong.
- ¹⁰ Create a clean heart in me, O God,
and renew a faithful spirit within me.
- ¹¹ Do not force me away from your presence,
and do not take your Holy Spirit from me.
- ¹² Restore the joy of your salvation to me,
and provide me with a spirit of willing obedience.

51:9–12 Wipe away my guilt and give me a clean and faithful heart. Don't push me away or take back your Spirit. Make me glad to be saved and eager to obey.

¹³ Then I will teach your ways to those who are rebellious,
and sinners will return to you.

51:13 Give me the chance to teach rebels and lead sinners back to you.

¹⁴ Rescue me from the guilt of murder,
O God, my savior.
Let my tongue sing joyfully about your righteousness!

¹⁵ O Lord, open my lips,
and my mouth will tell about your praise.

51:14–15 Rescue me from the worst of my sins. I'll let my tongue praise your righteousness.

¹⁶ You are not happy with any sacrifice.
Otherwise, I would offer one to you.
You are not pleased with burnt offerings.
¹⁷ The sacrifice pleasing to God is a broken spirit.
O God, you do not despise a broken and
sorrowful heart.

¹⁸ Favor Zion with your goodness.
Rebuild the walls of Jerusalem.
¹⁹ Then you will be pleased with sacrifices offered in the right spirit—
with burnt offerings and whole burnt offerings.
Young bulls will be offered on your altar.

51:16–19 If a sacrifice could satisfy you I'd give it. But I'll bring the broken heart you desire. Favor me with your goodness. Rebuild me and the people I've hurt. Then you'll be pleased.

Psalm 52

For the choir director; a maskil; a psalm by David when Doeg (who was from

Edom) told Saul that David had come to Ahimelech's home.

¹ Why do you brag about the evil you've done, you hero?
The mercy of God lasts all day long!

² Your tongue makes up threats.
It's like a sharp razor, you master of deceit.

³ You prefer evil to good.
You prefer lying to speaking the truth. *Selah*

52:1-3 Why do evildoers brag about their sins? These masters of deceit speak razor-sharp lies. They prefer evil to good.

⁴ You love every destructive accusation, you
deceitful tongue!

⁵ But God will ruin you forever.
He will grab you and drag you out of your tent.
He will pull your roots out of this world of the living. *Selah*

52:4-5 Evildoers love to hurt others. But you'll ruin the wicked. You'll drag them out of this world of the living.

⁶ Righteous people will see „this„ and be struck with fear.
They will laugh at you and say,

⁷ “Look at this person who refused to make God his fortress!
Instead, he trusted his great wealth
and became strong through his greed.”

52:6-7 I'll be filled with awe when I see you act. Show me the foolishness of trusting money instead of you.

⁸ But I am like a large olive tree in God's house.
I trust the mercy of God forever and ever.

⁹ I will give thanks to you forever
for what you have done.

In the presence of your godly people,
I will wait with hope in your good name.

52:8–9 Make me flourish as I'm planted close to you. I'll forever trust in your mercy. I'll always give you thanks. Together with your people I'll continue to count on you.

Psalm 53^[47]

For the choir director; according to mahalath,^[48] a maskil by David.

¹ Godless fools say in their hearts,
“There is no God.”
They are corrupt.
They do disgusting things.
There is no one who does good things.

53:1 Fools think you don't exist. They sin and do nothing good.

² God looks down from heaven on Adam's descendants
to see if there is anyone who acts wisely,
if there is anyone who seeks help from God.
³ Everyone has fallen away.
Together they have become rotten to the core.
No one, not even one person, does good things.

53:2–3 You study all humankind to see if anyone acts wisely or seeks your help. But all of us have sinned and become rotten to the core. I don't do good. Nor does anyone else.

⁴ Are all those troublemakers,
those who devour my people as if they were devouring food,
so ignorant that they do not call on God?

53:4 Troublemakers swallow up your people. Are evildoers completely ignorant of you?

⁵ There they are—panic-stricken—
 but there was no reason to panic,
 because God has scattered the bones
 of those who set up camp against you.[\[49\]](#)
 You put them to shame.
 After all, God has rejected them.

53:5 Give our enemies reason to panic. Scatter their bones. Shame and reject them.

⁶ If only salvation for Israel would come from Zion!
 When God restores the fortunes of his people,
 Jacob will rejoice.
 Israel will be glad.

53:6 Send victory from your throne! Restore the fortunes of your people and give us reason to be glad.

Psalm 54

For the choir director; on stringed instruments; a maskil by David when people from the city of Ziph told Saul that David was hiding among them.

¹ O God, save me by your name,
 and defend me with your might.
² O God, hear my prayer,
 and open your ears to the words from my mouth.

³ Strangers have attacked me.
 Ruthless people seek my life.
 They do not think about God.[\[50\]](#) *Selah*

54:1–3 Save me because of your character. Defend me with your power. I'm under attack by people who ignore you, so don't ignore my pleas.

- ⁴ God is my helper!
The Lord is the provider for my life.
⁵ My enemies spy on me.
Pay them back with evil.
Destroy them with your truth!

54:4–5 You help me and provide for my life. Pay back evil to people who spy on me. Destroy them with your truth!

- ⁶ I will make a sacrifice to you along with a freewill offering.
I will give thanks to your good name, O LORD.
⁷ Your name rescues me from every trouble.
My eyes will gloat over my enemies.

54:6–7 I offer everything to you because you're good. When you rescue me I'll watch my enemies go down in defeat.

Psalm 55

For the choir director; on stringed instruments; a maskil by David.

- ¹ Open your ears to my prayer, O God.
Do not hide from my plea for mercy.
² Pay attention to me, and answer me.
My thoughts are restless, and I am confused

55:1–2 Pay attention to me! Hear my prayers and don't hide when I plead for mercy.

- ³ because my enemy shouts at me
and a wicked person persecutes me.
They bring misery crashing down on me,
and they attack me out of anger.

55:2–3 I can't think straight with my enemy shouting so loudly. Protect me from the misery crashing down on me.

- ⁴ My heart is in turmoil.
The terrors of death have seized me.
⁵ Fear and trembling have overcome me.
Horror has overwhelmed me.
⁶ I said, "If only I had wings like a dove—
I would fly away and find rest.
⁷ Indeed, I would run far away.
I would stay in the desert. *Selah*
⁸ I would hurry to find shelter
from the raging wind and storm."

55:4–8 Trembling overwhelms me. Deathly terrors seize me. Horrors bury me. I wish I could fly away to find rest or run away to the desert. I need shelter from the raging storm.

- ⁹ Completely confuse their language, O Lord,
because I see violence and conflict in the city.
¹⁰ Day and night they go around on ^{the} top of the city walls.
Trouble and misery are everywhere.
¹¹ Destruction is everywhere.
Oppression and fraud never leave the streets.[\[51\]](#)

55:9–11 Confuse my enemies, the violent ones who creep around spreading misery.

- ¹² If an enemy had insulted me,
then I could bear it.
If someone who hated me had attacked me,
then I could hide from him.
¹³ But it is you, my equal,
my best friend,
one I knew so well!
¹⁴ We used to talk to each other in

complete confidence
and walk into God's house with the
festival crowds.

55:12–14 I wouldn't be so grief-stricken if an enemy had attacked me. But it was my best friend who turned on me, someone I trusted and considered an equal in faith.

- ¹⁵ Let death suddenly take "wicked people"!
Let them go into the grave while they are still alive,
because evil lives in their homes as well as in their hearts.
- ¹⁶ But I call on God,
and the LORD saves me.
- ¹⁷ Morning, noon, and night I complain and groan,
and he listens to my voice.
- ¹⁸ With "his" peace, he will rescue my soul
from the war waged against me,
because there are many "soldiers fighting" against me.

55:16–18 I call on you and you save me. I groan day and night and you hear me. Your peace will rescue my soul. You'll deal with my enemies from your eternal throne.

- ¹⁹ God will listen.
The one who has sat enthroned from the beginning
will deal with them. *Selah*
They never change. They never fear God.
- ²⁰ "My best friend" has betrayed his friends.
He has broken his solemn promise.
- ²¹ His speech is smoother than butter,
but there is war in his heart.
His words are more soothing than oil,
but they are like swords ready to attack.

55:19–21 Evildoers never change. I'm not the only one my best friend has betrayed. Over and over he's broken his promises then smoothed things over with slippery words.

- ²² Turn your burdens over to the LORD,
and he will take care of you.
He will never let the righteous person stumble.
- ²³ But you, O God, will throw **“wicked people”** into the deepest pit.
Bloodthirsty and deceitful people will not live out half their days.
But I will trust you.

55:22–23 I give you my burdens and trust myself to your care. Keep me from stumbling. I'll always keep trusting you.

Psalm 56

For the choir director; according to yonath elem rechokim; [\[52\]](#) a miktam by David when the Philistines captured him in Gath.

- ¹ Have pity on me, O God, because people are harassing me.
All day long warriors oppress me.
- ² All day long my enemies spy on me.
They harass me.
There are so many fighting against me.

56:1–2 Pity me! I'm harassed and oppressed, the target of spies watching me without a break. I'm surrounded by enemies.

- ³ Even when I am afraid, I still trust you.
- ⁴ I praise the word of God.
I trust God.
I am not afraid.
What can mere flesh **“and blood”** do to me?

56:3–4 Even when fear grips me I keep trusting you. You quiet my fears. How can mere people hurt me?

- ⁵ All day long my enemies twist my words.
Their every thought is an evil plan against me.
- ⁶ They attack, and then they hide.
They watch my every step as they wait to take my life.
- ⁷ With the wrong they do, can they escape?
O God, angrily make the nations fall.

56:5–7 My enemies never stop twisting my words. They attack me, then retreat to prepare another attack. Are you really going to let them escape?

- ⁸ (You have kept a record of my wanderings.
Put my tears in your bottle.
They are already in your book.)

56:8 You remember the times I've wandered from you. You keep all my tears in a bottle.

- ⁹ Then my enemies will retreat when I call „to you“.
This I know: God is on my side.
- ¹⁰ I praise the word of God.
I praise the word of the LORD.
- ¹¹ I trust God.
I am not afraid.
What can mortals do to me?

56:9–11 My enemies flee when I pray to you. My fears fade when I trust in you. Nothing any humans do can hurt me.

- ¹² I am bound by my vows to you, O God.
I will keep my vows by offering songs of thanksgiving to you.
- ¹³ You have rescued me from death.
You have kept my feet from stumbling
so that I could walk in your presence, in the light of life.
-

56:13 You've rescued me from death. Now keep me walking in the light of your presence.

Psalm 57

For the choir director; al tashcheth;[53] a miktam by David when he fled from Saul into the cave.

¹ Have pity on me, O God. Have pity on me,
because my soul takes refuge in you.
I will take refuge in the shadow of your wings
until destructive storms pass by.

57:1 Take pity on me, because I hide my whole being in you. I tuck under your wings while life's storms pass by.

² I call to God Most High,
to the God who does everything for me.
³ He sends his help from heaven and saves me.
He disgraces the one who is harassing me. *Selah*
God sends his mercy and his truth!

57:2-3 I cry to you, God Most High. You do everything for me, sending help from heaven.

⁴ My soul is surrounded by lions.
I must lie down with man-eating lions.
Their teeth are spears and arrows.
Their tongues are sharp swords.

57:4 I feel trapped by man-eating lions with mouths like swords.

⁵ May you be honored above the heavens, O God.
Let your glory extend over the whole earth.

57:5 You deserve honor higher than the heavens. Your glory reaches to the whole earth.

⁶ *My enemies* spread out a net to catch me.
(My soul is bowed down.)[\[54\]](#)
They dug a pit to trap me,
but then they fell into it. *Selah*

57:6 When my enemies try to trap me, let them fall into their own pit.

⁷ My heart is confident, O God.
My heart is confident.
I want to sing and make music.[\[55\]](#)
⁸ Wake up, my soul![\[56\]](#)
Wake up, harp and lyre!
I want to wake up at dawn.
⁹ I want to give thanks to you among the people, O Lord.
I want to make music to praise you among the nations
¹⁰ because your mercy is as high as the heavens.
Your truth reaches the skies.

57:7–10 Because of you I'm confident. I'll sing and make music to you. I'll wake up at dawn to say thanks. I'll praise you so everyone realizes that your mercy and truth reach to the skies.

¹¹ May you be honored above the heavens, O God.
Let your glory extend over the whole earth.

57:11 You deserve honor higher than the heavens. Your glory reaches to the whole earth.

Psalm 58

For the choir director; al tashcheth; a miktam by David.

¹ Do you rulers really give fair verdicts?
Do you judge Adam's descendants fairly?

² No, you invent new crimes on earth,
and your hands spread violence.

³ “Even” inside the womb wicked people are strangers “to God”.
From their birth liars go astray.

58:1–3 Rulers judge unjustly, while they themselves commit violent crimes. Evildoers are strangers to you from the time they’re conceived.

⁴ They have poisonous venom like snakes.
They are like a deaf cobra that shuts its ears
⁵ so that it cannot hear the voice of a snake charmer
or of anyone trained to cast spells.

⁶ O God, knock the teeth out of their mouths.
Break the young lions’ teeth, O LORD.
⁷ Let them disappear like water that drains away.
When they aim their bows, let their arrows miss the target.[\[57\]](#)
⁸ Let them become like a snail that leaves behind a slimy trail
or like a stillborn child who never sees the sun.

58:4–8 The wicked bite with deadly venom, so knock out their teeth! Make them like water draining away. Let their arrows miss their targets. Make them nothing more than snails leaving slimy trails.

⁹ Let “God” sweep them away
faster than a cooking pot is heated by burning twigs.[\[58\]](#)

¹⁰ Righteous people will rejoice when they see “God” take revenge.
They will wash their feet in the blood of wicked people.

¹¹ Then people will say,
“Righteous people certainly have a reward.
There is a God who judges on earth.”

58:9–11 Sweep evildoers away! Good people will be glad when they see you take your revenge. Show us that you’re real—and that you’re fair.

Psalm 59

For the choir director; al tashcheth; a miktam by David when Saul sent men to watch David's home and kill him.

- ¹ Rescue me from my enemies, O my God.
Protect me from those who attack me.
- ² Rescue me from troublemakers.
Save me from bloodthirsty people.
- ³ They lie in ambush for me right here!
Fierce men attack me, O LORD,
but not because of any disobedience,

59:1–3 Rescue me. Protect me. Save me from bloodthirsty troublemakers. Can't you see my enemies waiting in ambush?

- ⁴ or any sin, or any guilt on my part.
They hurry to take positions against me.
Wake up, and help me; see ^לfor yourself^ל.
- ⁵ O LORD God of Armies, God of Israel,
arise to punish all the nations.
Have no pity on any traitors. *Selah*

59:4–5 My enemies attack me for no reason. See for yourself, then rise up and stop them.

- ⁶ They return in the evening.
They howl like dogs.
They prowl the city.
- ⁷ See what pours out of their mouths—
swords from their lips!
^לThey think,^ל “Who will hear us?”
- ⁸ O LORD, you laugh at them.
You make fun of all the nations.

59:6–8 My enemies howl at me like dogs. They speak deadly words, thinking you won't hear them.
But you do—and you laugh at them.

⁹ O my strength, I watch for you!
God is my stronghold, my merciful God!

¹⁰ God will come to meet me.
He will let me gloat over those who spy on me.
¹¹ Do not kill them.
Otherwise, my people may forget.
Make them wander aimlessly by your power.
Bring them down, O Lord, our shield,

59:9–11 Because you're my strength, I'll watch for your help. You'll meet me with mercy and make me victorious over my foes. Keep my enemies alive so others can see how aimlessly they wander.

¹² ᵊbecause ofᵊ the sins from their mouths and the words on their lips.
Let them be trapped by their own arrogance
because they speak curses and lies.
¹³ Destroy them in your rage.
Destroy them until not one of them is left.
Then they will know that God rules Jacob
to the ends of the earth. *Selah*

59:12–13 Trap my enemies with their own arrogant words. Don't let a single one escape. Bring an end to their evil.

¹⁴ They return in the evening.
They howl like dogs.
They prowl the city.
¹⁵ They wander around to find something to eat.
If they are not full enough,
they will stay all night.

59:14–15 My foes prowl the city hunting for something to eat. They stay up all night until they fill their stomachs with kills.

¹⁶ But I will sing about your strength.

In the morning I will joyfully sing about your mercy.

You have been my stronghold
and a place of safety in times of trouble.

¹⁷ O my strength, I will make music to praise you!
God is my stronghold, my merciful God!

59:16–17 I sing about your strength. I joyfully hum of your mercy. You're my safe place when trouble strikes. I'll always make music to you, my strong and merciful God!

Psalm 60

For the choir director; according to shushan eduth;^[59] a miktam by David; for teaching. When David fought Aram Naharaim and Aram Zobah, and „when„ Joab came back and killed 12,000 men from Edom in the Dead Sea region.

¹ O God, you have rejected us.
You have broken down our defenses.
You have been angry.
Restore us!

² You made the land quake.
You split it wide open.

Heal the cracks in it
because it is falling apart.

60:1–2 You’ve rejected your people and left us defenseless. You shook the land and split it wide open. Heal the land, because it’s falling apart.

- ³ You have made your people experience hardships.
You have given us wine that makes us stagger.
- ⁴ Yet, you have raised a flag for those who fear you
so that they can rally to it
when attacked by bows and arrows. *Selah*

60:3–4 You’re the reason we endure hardship and stagger in confusion. So pull us to safety. Gather us to yourself.

⁵ Save us with your powerful hand, and answer us
so that those who are dear to you may be rescued.[\[60\]](#)

- ⁶ God has promised the following through his holiness:
“I will triumph!
I will divide Shechem.
I will measure the valley of Succoth.
⁷ Gilead is mine.
Manasseh is mine.
Ephraim is the helmet on my head.
Judah is my scepter.
⁸ Moab is my washtub.
I will throw my shoe over Edom.
I will shout in triumph over Philistia.”

60:6–8 You’ve spoken and said you’re in charge, ruler of all of us. Every place and people belong to you. You’re Lord over every enemy.

- ⁹ Who will bring me into the fortified city?
Who will lead me to Edom?
- ¹⁰ Isn’t it you, O God, who rejected us?

Isn't it you, O God, who refused to accompany our armies?

¹¹ Give us help against the enemy
because human assistance is worthless.

¹² With God we will display great strength.
He will trample our enemies.

60:10–12 How can we count on you for help when you've rejected your people? Isn't it true that you've refused to stand with us? Human assistance is worthless, so help us now. You alone make us strong.

Psalm 61

For the choir director; on a stringed instrument; by David.

¹ Listen to my cry for help, O God.

Pay attention to my prayer.

² From the ends of the earth, I call to you
when I begin to lose heart.

Lead me to the rock that is high above me.

61:1–2 Hear my cry for help. Pay attention to the words I pray from far-off places. Carry me to a safe and solid place.

³ You have been my refuge,
a tower of strength against the enemy.

⁴ I would like to be a guest in your tent forever
and to take refuge under the protection of your wings. *Selah*

61:3–4 You're the place that I run, my safe place. I want to stay and enjoy your protection forever.

⁵ O God, you have heard my vows.
You have given me the inheritance
that belongs to those who fear your name.

⁶ Add days upon days to the life of the king.
May his years endure throughout every generation.

⁷ May he sit enthroned in the presence of God forever.
May mercy and truth protect him.

⁸ Then I will make music to praise your name forever,
as I keep my vows day after day.

61:5–7 You hear everything I promise you—and you give me every gift you promise your people. Give me a long life and let me enjoy your presence forever. Protect me with your mercy and truth.

Psalm 62

For the choir director; according to Jeduthun; a psalm by David.

- ¹ My soul waits calmly for God alone.
My salvation comes from him.
- ² He alone is my rock and my savior—my stronghold.
I cannot be severely shaken.

62:1–2 My soul waits calmly for you alone, because only you can save me. You're my rock and Savior. Nothing can shake me.

- ³ How long will all of you attack a person?
How long will you try to murder him,
as though he were a leaning wall or a sagging fence?
- ⁴ They plan to force him out of his high position.
They are happy to lie.
They bless with their mouths,
but in their hearts they curse. *Selah*

62:3–4 How long do I have to endure these attacks? People try to topple me like a sagging fence. They'll do anything to take me down.

- ⁵ Wait calmly for God alone, my soul,
because my hope comes from him.
- ⁶ He alone is my rock and my savior—my stronghold.
I cannot be shaken.
- ⁷ My salvation and my glory depend on God.
God is the rock of my strength, my refuge.

62:5–7 I wait calmly for you alone, because my hope comes from you. You're my rock and my fortress.

⁸ Trust him at all times, you people.
Pour out your hearts in his presence.
God is our refuge. *Selah*

62:8 Show your people that they can always trust you. Invite them to come close and pour out their hearts to you.

⁹ Common people are only a whisper in the wind.
Important people are only a delusion.
When all of them are weighed on a scale, they amount to nothing.
They are less than a whisper in the wind.

62:9 Common people and powerful people all amount to nothing. Like them I'm less than a whisper in the wind.

¹⁰ Do not count on extortion _⌋to make you rich_⌋.
Do not hope to gain anything through robbery.
When riches increase, do not depend on them.

¹¹ God has spoken once.
I have heard it _⌋said_⌋ twice:
“Power belongs to God.
¹² Mercy belongs to you, O Lord.
You reward a person based on what he has done.”

62:10–12 I won't turn to extortion or robbery to get rich, and even if you make me wealthy I'll still cling to you. Power and mercy belong to you alone.

Psalm 63

A psalm by David when he was in the wilderness of Judah.

¹ O God, you are my God.
At dawn I search for you.

My soul thirsts for you.

My body longs for you
in a dry, parched land where there is no water.

63:1 You are my God. I start searching for you at dawn, because my whole being wants more of you. I thirst for you like a desert wanderer.

- ² So I look for you in the holy place
to see your power and your glory.
- ³ My lips will praise you
because your mercy is better than life *itself*.
- ⁴ So I will thank you as long as I live.
I will lift up my hands *to pray* in your name.

63:2–4 I look for you to see your power and glory. I'll praise you because your mercy is better than life. I'll thank you forever and lift my hands to you in prayer.

- ⁵ You satisfy my soul with the richest foods.
My mouth will sing *your* praise with joyful lips.
- ⁶ As I lie on my bed, I remember you.
Through the long hours of the night, I think about you.
- ⁷ You have been my help.
In the shadow of your wings, I sing joyfully.
- ⁸ My soul clings to you.
Your right hand supports me.

63:5–8 You fill me up like rich food. I remember you all night long. I sing to you from the shadow of your protection. I cling to you and you hold me up.

- ⁹ But those who try to destroy my life
will go into the depths of the earth.
- ¹⁰ They will be cut down by swords.
Their dead bodies will be left as food for jackals.
- ¹¹ But the king will find joy in God.
Everyone who takes an oath by God will brag,
but the mouths of liars will be shut.

63:9–11 Those who try to destroy me are done for. Others will finish them off and devour them. I'll find joy in you.

Psalm 64

For the choir director; a psalm by David.

- ¹ Hear my voice, O God, when I complain.
Protect my life from a terrifying enemy.
- ² Hide me from the secret plots of criminals,
from the mob of troublemakers.
- ³ They sharpen their tongues like swords.
They aim bitter words like arrows
- ⁴ to shoot at innocent people from their hiding places.
They shoot at them suddenly, without any fear.

64:1–4 Hear my worried prayers, because I need your protection from terrifying enemies. They take aim at innocent people from safe hideouts.

- ⁵ They encourage one another in their evil plans.
They talk about setting traps and say,
“Who can see them?”
- ⁶ They search for the perfect crime and say,
“We have perfected a foolproof scheme!”
Human nature and the human heart are a mystery!

64:4–6 Evildoers don't worry about getting caught. They think no one is looking. They cook up foolproof schemes.

- ⁷ But God will shoot them with an arrow.
Suddenly, they will be struck dead.
- ⁸ They will trip over their own tongues.
Everyone who sees them will shake his head.

⁹ Everyone will be afraid and conclude,
“This is an act of God!”
They will learn from what he has done.

¹⁰ Righteous people will find joy in the LORD and take refuge in him.
Everyone whose motives are decent will be able to brag.

64:7–10 But you will put an end to evil people and their plans. Their own words will give them away. Everyone will know you caught them and will learn a lesson. You’ll make good people happy.

Psalm 65

For the choir director; a psalm by David; a song.

¹ You are praised with silence in Zion, O God,
and vows *made* to you must be kept.

² You are the one who hears prayers.
Everyone will come to you.

65:1–2 I worship you in silent awe. You hear our prayers. We all look to you.

³ Various sins overwhelm me.
You are the one who forgives our rebellious acts.

65:3 My sins overwhelm me, but you forgive all my rebellion.

⁴ Blessed is the person you choose
and invite to live with you in your courtyards.
We will be filled with good food from your house, from your holy temple.

⁵ You answer us with awe-inspiring acts *done* in righteousness,
O God, our savior,
the hope of all the ends of the earth and of the most distant sea,

65:4–5 There’s nothing greater than living close to you. You fill me with good food. You do

awesome acts of goodness. You're the hope of everyone on earth.

⁶ the one who set the mountains in place with his strength,
the one who is clothed with power,
⁷ the one who calms the roar of the seas,
their crashing waves,
and the uproar of the nations.

65:6–7 You built the mountains. Your power calms the chaos of the oceans and the uproar of humankind.

⁸ Those who live at the ends of the earth are in awe of your miraculous signs.
The lands of the morning sunrise and evening sunset sing joyfully.

⁹ You take care of the earth, and you water it.
You make it much richer than it was.
(The river of God is filled with water.)
You provide grain for them.
Indeed, you even prepare the ground.

65:8–9 Everyone on earth lives in awe of you. They know you make the sun rise and set. You care for the earth and make it a good place to live.

¹⁰ You drench plowed fields with rain and level their clumps of soil.
You soften them with showers and bless what grows in them.

¹¹ You crown the year with your goodness,
and richness overflows wherever you are.

65:9–11 You prepare the earth and water our fields. You soften hard soil and bless our crops. The rich harvest shouts your goodness.

¹² The pastures in the desert overflow with richness.
The hills are surrounded with joy.
¹³ The pastures are covered with flocks.
The valleys are carpeted with grain.
All of them shout triumphantly. Indeed, they sing.

65:12–13 You fill the hills with joy. You cover the pastures with flocks and carpet the valleys with grain. Your whole creation shouts to you.

Psalm 66

For the choir director; a song; a psalm.

- ¹ Shout happily to God, all the earth!
² Make music to praise the glory of his name.
 Make his praise glorious.
³ Say to God,
 “How awe-inspiring are your deeds!
 Your power is so great that your enemies will cringe in front of you.
⁴ The whole earth will worship you.
 It will make music to praise you.
 It will make music to praise your name.” *Selah*

66:1–4 I shout with happiness to you! I praise your bright shining greatness! I can’t stop repeating to you all the amazing things you do. The whole earth will join me in worship.

- ⁵ Come and see what God has done—
 his awe-inspiring deeds for Adam’s descendants.
⁶ He turned the sea into dry land.
 They crossed the river on foot.
 We rejoiced because of what he did there.

66:5–6 I want others to notice the awe-inspiring things you’ve done for humankind. You dried up the sea so your people could escape from slavery in Egypt.

- ⁷ He rules forever with his might.
 His eyes watch the nations.
 Rebels will not be able to oppose him. *Selah*

66:7 You rule the whole world. Anyone who picks a fight with you won't win.

- ⁸ Thank our God, you nations.
Make the sound of his praise heard.
⁹ He has kept us alive
and has not allowed us to fall.

66:8–9 Let the whole world thank you, because you keep us alive. You never let us fall.

- ¹⁰ You have tested us, O God.
You have refined us in the same way silver is refined.
¹¹ You have trapped us in a net.
You have laid burdens on our backs.
¹² You let people ride over our heads.
We went through fire and water,
but then you brought us out and refreshed us.

66:10–12 You test and refine your people. You put burdens on our backs. We face fire and water.
But then you rescue and refresh us.

- ¹³ I will come into your temple with burnt offerings.
I will keep my vows to you,
¹⁴ the vows made by my lips and spoken by my **own** mouth
when I was in trouble.
¹⁵ I will offer you a sacrifice of fattened livestock for burnt offerings
with the smoke from rams.
I will offer cattle and goats. *Selah*

66:13–15 I'll draw close to you to worship. I'll keep the promises I made when I was in trouble. I'll
always offer you my very best.

- ¹⁶ Come and listen, all who fear God,
and I will tell you what he has done for me.

- ¹⁷ With my mouth I cried out to him.
High praise was on my tongue.
- ¹⁸ If I had thought about doing anything sinful,
the Lord would not have listened *to me*.
- ¹⁹ But God has heard me.
He has paid attention to my prayer.

66:16–19 I want the God-fearers to hear what you’ve done for me. I cried to you. I praised you as best I know how. If my mind had been set on sinning, you wouldn’t have heard me. But you paid attention to my prayers.

- ²⁰ Thanks be to God,
who has not rejected my prayer
or taken away his mercy from me.

Psalm 67

For the choir director; on stringed instruments; a psalm; a song.

- ¹ May God have pity on us and bless us!
May he smile on us. *Selah*
- ² Then your ways will be known on earth,
your salvation throughout all nations.

67:1–2 Pity us. Bless us. Smile on us. Then everyone will know your ways. The whole world will see your salvation.

- ³ Let everyone give thanks to you, O God.
Let everyone give thanks to you.
- ⁴ Let the nations be glad and sing joyfully
because you judge everyone with justice
and guide the nations on the earth. *Selah*

67:3–4 We thank you. We sing to you with joy because you’re just and guide every nation on earth.

- ⁵ Let the people give thanks to you, O God.
Let all the people give thanks to you.
- ⁶ The earth has yielded its harvest.
May God, our God, bless us.
- ⁷ May God bless us,
and may all the ends of the earth worship him.

67:5–7 May all humankind experience your blessing. May all of us say thanks for the food the earth produces. May the whole world worship you.

Psalm 68

For the choir director; a psalm by David; a song.

- ¹ God will arise.
His enemies will be scattered.
Those who hate him will flee from him.
- ² Blow them away like smoke.
Let wicked people melt in God's presence like wax next to a fire.

68:1–2 You scatter people who hate you. You blow them away like smoke. You melt them like wax next to a flame.

- ³ But let righteous people rejoice.
Let them celebrate in God's presence.
Let them overflow with joy.
- ⁴ Sing to God; make music to praise his name.
Make a highway for him to ride through the deserts.[\[61\]](#)
The LORD is his name.
Celebrate in his presence.

68:3–4 Let good people celebrate in your presence. Let them spill over with joy as they sing to you. They'll clear a wide path for you in the deserts.

⁵ The God who is in his holy dwelling place
is the father of the fatherless and the defender of widows.

⁶ God places lonely people in families.
He leads prisoners out of prison into productive lives,
but rebellious people must live in an unproductive land.

68:5–6 You act as Father to the fatherless. You defend widows and put the lonely in families. You make prisoners whole.

⁷ O God, when you went in front of your people,
when you marched through the desert, *Selah*
⁸ the earth quaked and the sky poured
in the presence of the God of Sinai,
in the presence of the God of Israel.

⁹ You watered the land with plenty of rain, O God.
You refreshed it when your land was exhausted.
¹⁰ Your flock settled there.
Out of your goodness, O God,
you provided for oppressed people.

68:7–10 The earth shook and the sky poured rain when you marched your people through the desert. You refreshed the land and gave your flock a home.

¹¹ The LORD gives instructions.
The women who announce the good news are a large army.
¹² “They say,” “The kings of the armies flee; they run away.
The women who remained at home will divide the goods.
¹³ Though you stayed among the sheep pens,
you will be like the wings of a dove covered with silver,
its feathers with yellow gold.
¹⁴ Meanwhile, the Almighty was still scattering kings there
like snow falling on Mount Zalmon.”
¹⁵ The mountain of Bashan is the mountain of God.

The mountain of Bashan is the mountain with many peaks.

¹⁶ Why do you look with envy, you mountains with many peaks,
at the mountain where God has chosen to live?
Certainly, the LORD will live there forever.

68:15–16 Though the mountains are high, none measure up to the mountain where you dwell. You'll live there forever.

¹⁷ The chariots of God are twenty thousand in number,
thousands upon thousands.
The Lord is among them.
The God of Sinai is in his holy place.

¹⁸ You went to the highest place.
You took prisoners captive.
You received gifts from people,
even from rebellious people, so that the LORD God may live there.

68:17–18 Your power is beyond imagination. You live on a high holy mountain. Even rebellious people bring you gifts.

¹⁹ Thanks be to the Lord,
who daily carries our burdens for us.
God is our salvation. *Selah*

²⁰ Our God is the God of victories.
The Almighty LORD is our escape from death.

68:19–20 Thanks for carrying our burdens day by day. You're the one who saves us. You're the God of victories.

²¹ Certainly, God will crush the heads of his enemies
and destroy even the hair on the heads
of those who continue to be guilty.

²² The LORD said, "I will bring them back from Bashan.
I will bring them back from the depths of the sea

²³ so that you, “my people,” may bathe^[62] your feet in blood
and the tongues of your dogs
may lick the blood of your enemies.”

68:21–23 You crush people who continue in sin, bringing them from near and far so your people
can see your justice.

²⁴ Your festival processions, O God, can be seen by everyone.
They are the processions for my God, my king, into the holy place.
²⁵ The singers are in front.
The musicians are behind them.
The young women beating tambourines are between them.
²⁶ Thank God, the Lord, the source of Israel, with the choirs.
²⁷ Benjamin, the youngest, is leading them,
“next” the leaders of Judah with their noisy crowds,
“then” the leaders of Zebulun,
“then” the leaders of Naphtali.

68:24–27 Everyone can see the festive parades that usher you to your throne. Singers lead.
Musicians follow. The young women beat tambourines. All your people honor you with songs and
noisy cheer.

²⁸ Your God has decided you will be strong.
Display your strength, O God,
as you have for us before.
²⁹ Kings will bring you gifts
because of your temple high above Jerusalem.

68:28–29 You are strong. Show your strength as you have before. Kings will honor you because of
your greatness.

³⁰ Threaten the beast who is among the cattails,
the herd of bulls with the calves of the nations,
until it humbles itself with pieces of silver.

Scatter the people who find joy in war.[\[63\]](#)

³¹ Ambassadors will come from Egypt.

Sudan will stretch out its hands to God *in prayer*.

³² You kingdoms of the world, sing to God.

Make music to praise the Lord. *Selah*

68:30–32 Humble the powerful of this world and scatter the people who love war. Let every kingdom on earth sing to you.

³³ God rides through the ancient heaven, the highest heaven.

Listen! He makes his voice heard, his powerful voice.

³⁴ Acknowledge the power of God.

His majesty is over Israel, and his power is in the skies.

³⁵ God, the God of Israel, is awe-inspiring in his holy place.

He gives strength and power to his people. Thanks be to God!

68:33–35 You ride through the heavens and speak with a booming voice. We acknowledge your power. We bow in awe to you. Give us strength!

Psalm 69

For the choir director; according to shoshannim; by David.

¹ Save me, O God!

The water is already up to my neck!

² I am sinking in deep mud.

There is nothing to stand on.

I am in deep water.

A flood is sweeping me away.

69:1–2 Save me before I drown! I'm sinking in muck and can't touch bottom. I'm being swept away by a flood.

³ I am exhausted from crying for help.

My throat is hoarse.
My eyes are strained └from┐ looking for my God.
⁴ Those who hate me for no reason
outnumber the hairs on my head.
Those who want to destroy me are mighty.
They have no reason to be my enemies.
I am forced to pay back what I did not steal.

69:3–4 My throat is hoarse from crying. My eyes hurt from looking for you. People who hate me for no reason outnumber the hairs on my head.

⁵ O God, you know my stupidity,
and the things of which I am guilty are not hidden from you.
⁶ Do not let those who wait with hope for you
be put to shame because of me, O Almighty LORD of Armies.
Do not let those who come to you for help
be humiliated because of me, O God of Israel.

69:5–6 You know I've been stupid. You and I both know I sin. Don't let my failures humiliate your faithful people.

⁷ Indeed, for your sake I have endured insults.
Humiliation has covered my face.

69:7 People insult me because of you. My humiliation feels like a bag over my head.

⁸ I have become a stranger to my └own┐ brothers,
a foreigner to my mother's sons.
⁹ Indeed, devotion for your house has consumed me,
and the insults of those who insult you have fallen on me.
¹⁰ I cried and fasted, but I was insulted for it.
¹¹ I dressed myself in sackcloth, but I became the object of ridicule.
¹² Those who sit at the gate gossip about me,
and drunkards make up songs about me.

69:8–12 My own family treats me like a stranger. My devotion to you draws insults. My godly mourning makes me a joke. Even drunks make up songs about me.

¹³ May my prayer come to you at an acceptable time,
O LORD. O God, out of the greatness of your mercy,
answer me with the truth of your salvation.

¹⁴ Rescue me from the mud.
Do not let me sink into it.
I want to be rescued from those who hate me
and from the deep water.

¹⁵ Do not let floodwaters sweep me away.
Do not let the ocean swallow me up,
or the pit close its mouth over me.

69:13–15 I hope my prayer reaches you at the right time. Answer me because of your great love.
Rescue me from this muddy pit. Don't let the floods sweep me away.

¹⁶ Answer me, O LORD, because your mercy is good.
Out of your unlimited compassion, turn to me.

¹⁷ I am in trouble, so do not hide your face from me.
Answer me quickly!

69:16–17 Answer my prayers because your compassion is unlimited. Don't hide from me. Answer me quickly!

¹⁸ Come close, and defend my soul.
Set me free because of my enemies.

¹⁹ You know that I have been insulted, put to shame, and humiliated.
All my opponents are in front of you.

²⁰ Insults have broken my heart, and I am sick.
I looked for sympathy, but there was none.
I looked for people to comfort me, but I found no one.

²¹ They poisoned my food,

and when I was thirsty, they gave me vinegar to drink.

69:19–21 You have heard all the insults and seen my shame. You know who my opponents are—
how their insults break my heart and make me sick. They poison my food and pour vinegar in my
cup.

²² Let the table set for them become a trap
and a snare for their friends.

²³ Let their vision become clouded so that they cannot see.
Let their thighs continually shake.

²⁴ Pour your rage on them.
Let your burning anger catch up with them.

69:22–24 Trap these enemies. Ensnare their friends. Cloud their vision. Make their thighs shake.
Pour your rage on them. Don't let them outrun your anger.

²⁵ Let their camp be deserted
and their tents empty.

²⁶ They persecute the one you have struck,
and they talk about the pain of those you have wounded.

²⁷ Charge them with one crime after another.
Do not let them be found innocent.

²⁸ Let their names be erased from the Book of Life.
Do not let them be listed with righteous people.

69:26–28 You struck me, and they mock my pain. Charge them and find them guilty. Erase their
names from your book.

²⁹ I am suffering and in pain.
Let your saving power protect me, O God.

³⁰ I want to praise the name of God with a song.
I want to praise its greatness with a song of thanksgiving.

- ³¹ This will please the LORD more than *“sacrificing”* an ox
or a bull with horns and hoofs.
- ³² Oppressed people will see *“this”* and rejoice.
May the hearts of those who look to God for help be refreshed.

69:30–32 My praise means more to you than burning sacrifices. Let hurting people see my worship
and be refreshed.

- ³³ The LORD listens to needy people.
He does not despise his own who are in prison.
- ³⁴ Let heaven and earth, the seas, and everything that moves in them, praise him.
- ³⁵ When God saves Zion, he will rebuild the cities of Judah.
His servants will live there and take possession of it.
- ³⁶ The descendants of his servants will inherit it.
Those who love him will live there.

69:33–36 You listen to the needy and cherish the captives. Let all heaven and earth praise you. Give
your servants a safe and holy home.

Psalm 70^[64]

For the choir director; by David; to be kept in mind.

- ¹ Come quickly to rescue me, O God!
Come quickly to help me, O LORD!
- ² Let those who seek my life
be confused and put to shame.
Let those who want my downfall
be turned back and disgraced.
- ³ Let those who say, “Aha! Aha!”
be turned back because of their own shame.

70:1–3 Help me now! Confuse everyone who wants to kill me. Chase them away in disgrace!

⁴ Let all who seek you rejoice and be glad because of you.
Let those who love your salvation continually say,
“God is great!”

⁵ But I am oppressed and needy.
O God, come to me quickly.
You are my help and my savior.
O LORD, do not delay!

70:4–5 I'll always seek you and smile because of you. I love your salvation. It makes me shout about your greatness. But help me quickly. You're my help and my Savior. Don't delay!

Psalm 71

¹ I have taken refuge in you, O LORD.
Never let me be put to shame.
² Rescue me and free me because of your righteousness.
Turn your ear toward me, and save me.

71:1–2 I count on your protection from people who want to shame me. Set me free because of your goodness.

³ Be a rock on which I may live,
a place where I may always go.
You gave the order to save me!
Indeed, you are my rock and my fortress.
⁴ My God, free me from the hands of a wicked person,
from the grasp of one who is cruel and unjust.

71:3–4 Be my solid home, the place I run for safety. Set me loose from wicked hands.

⁵ You are my hope, O Almighty LORD.
You have been my confidence ever since I was young.
⁶ I depended on you before I was born.

You took me from my mother's womb.
My songs of praise constantly speak about you.

71:5–6 You're my hope, the one I've depended on since before I was born. You brought me safely from my mother's womb.

⁷ I have become an example to many people,
but you are my strong refuge.

⁸ My mouth is filled with your praise,
with your glory all day long.

71:6–8 I constantly sing about you. All day long my mouth is full of your glory.

⁹ Do not reject me when I am old
or abandon me when I lose my strength.

¹⁰ My enemies talk about me.
They watch me as they plot to take my life.

¹¹ They say, "God has abandoned him.
Pursue him and grab him because there is no one to
rescue him."

71:9–11 Don't reject me when I'm old and weak, because my enemies already plot to kill me. They think you've abandoned me. They scheme to hunt me down because they assume no one will help me.

¹² O God, do not be so distant from me.
O my God, come quickly to help me.

¹³ Let those who accuse me come to a shameful end.
Let those who want my downfall be covered
with disgrace and humiliation.

¹⁴ But I will always have hope.
I will praise you more and more.

71:12–14 Don't be so far from me. Come quickly to help me. You're my only hope!

¹⁵ My mouth will tell about your righteousness,
about your salvation all day long.
Even then, it is more than I can understand.

¹⁶ I will come with the mighty deeds of the
Almighty LORD. I will praise your
righteousness, yours alone.

71:15–16 I won't stop talking about your goodness and deliverance, even though they're greater than I'll ever understand. I'll tell everyone you alone do right.

¹⁷ O God, you have taught me ever since I was young,
and I still talk about the miracles you have done.

¹⁸ Even when I am old and gray, do not abandon me,
O God.
Let me live to tell the people of this age
what your strength has accomplished, to tell about
your power to all who will come.

71:17–18 You've taught me since I was young, so don't desert me when I'm gray. Let me grow old and tell people what your power has done.

¹⁹ Your righteousness reaches to the heavens, O God.
You have done great things. O
God, who is like you?

71:19 Your righteousness reaches the skies. You do awesome things. No one is like you.

²⁰ You have made me endure many terrible troubles.
You restore me to life again.
You bring me back from the depths of the earth.

²¹ You comfort me and make me greater than ever.

71:20–21 You've made me face terrible troubles, yet you bring me back from death. You comfort me and make me stronger than ever.

- ²² Because of your faithfulness, O my God,
even I will give thanks to you as I play on a lyre.
I will make music with a harp to praise you, O Holy
One of Israel.
- ²³ My lips will sing with joy when I make music to
praise you.
My soul, which you have rescued, also will
sing joyfully.
- ²⁴ My tongue will tell about your righteousness all day long,
because those who wanted my downfall
have been disgraced and put to shame.

71:22–24 Because you're faithful, I'll always sing you thanks. I'll sing with a heart full of joy and my tongue won't stop recounting your goodness.
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Psalm 72

By Solomon.

- ¹ O God, give the king your justice
and the king's son [\[65\]](#) your righteousness
- ² so that he may judge your people

with righteousness
and your oppressed **people** with justice.

72:1–2 Be just and good, my King, and judge the oppressed with justice.

- ³ May the mountains bring peace to the people
and the hills bring righteousness.
- ⁴ May he grant justice to the people who are oppressed.
May he save the children of needy people
and crush their oppressor.
- ⁵ May they fear you as long as the sun and
moon **shine**—
throughout every generation.

72:4–5 Bring justice to the broken. Save the children of the needy. Fend off every oppressor. May you receive the utter respect you deserve.

- ⁶ May he be like rain that falls on **freshly** cut grass,
like showers that water the land.
- ⁷ May righteous people blossom in his day.
May there be unlimited peace until the moon no
longer **shines**.

72:6–7 You are like rain watering my soul. You make me blossom and bring peace to my world.

- ⁸ May he rule from sea to sea,
from the Euphrates River to the ends of the earth.
- ⁹ May the people of the desert kneel in front of him.
May his enemies lick the dust.
- ¹⁰ May the kings from Tarshish and the islands
bring presents.
May the kings from Sheba and Seba bring gifts.
- ¹¹ May all kings worship him.
May all nations serve him.

72:8–11 You reign over the whole world. May every person on earth bow to worship you. I want rulers and everyday people alike to serve you.

- ¹² He will rescue the needy person who cries for help
and the oppressed person who has no one's help.
- ¹³ He will have pity on the poor and needy
and will save the lives of the needy.
- ¹⁴ He will rescue them from oppression and violence.
Their blood will be precious in his sight.

72:12–14 You rescue the impoverished and powerless who call on you. Save their lives and spare them from violence.

- ¹⁵ May he live long.
May the gold from Sheba be given to him.
May *the people* pray for him continually.
May *they* praise him all day long.
- ¹⁶ May there be plenty of grain in the land.
May it wave *in the breeze* on the mountaintops,
its fruit like *the treetops of* Lebanon.
May those from the city flourish like the grass on
the ground.
- ¹⁷ May his name endure forever.
May his name continue as long as the sun *shines*.
May all nations be blessed through him and call him blessed.

72:16–17 Feed our world. Cause our cities to flourish. Make your name famous for all time. You bless every nation.

- ¹⁸ Thank the LORD God, the God of Israel,
who alone does miracles.
- ¹⁹ Thanks be to his glorious name forever.
May the whole earth be filled with his glory.

Amen and amen!

72:18–19 You alone do miracles. I won't stop telling you thanks. Show your splendor to the whole earth. Amen!

²⁰ The prayers by David, son of Jesse, end here.

BOOK THREE

(Psalms 73–89)

Psalm 73

A psalm by Asaph.

- ¹ God is truly good to Israel,
to those whose lives are pure.
- ² But my feet had almost stumbled.

- They had almost slipped
3 because I was envious of arrogant people
when I saw the prosperity that wicked people enjoy.
- 4 They suffer no pain.
Their bodies are healthy.
- 5 They have no drudgery in their lives like
ordinary people.
They are not plagued ַwith problems, like others.

73:1–5 I know you’re good to people who are pure. But I don’t understand why you let evildoers prosper. They feel no pain. They enjoy good health. They’re never bored or troubled.

- 6 That is why they wear arrogance like a necklace
and acts of violence like clothing.
- 7 Their eyes peer out from their fat faces,[\[66\]](#)
and their imaginations run wild.
- 8 They ridicule.
They speak maliciously.
They speak arrogantly about oppression.
- 9 They verbally attack heaven,
and they order people around on earth.
- 10 That is why God’s people turn to wickedness[\[67\]](#)
and swallow their words.

73:6–10 The wicked strut and do violence. They mock and speak maliciously. Their eyes study the world from well-fed faces, dreaming up new ways to hurt others. They boast against you in heaven and bark at people here on earth. All of this is why your people turn to wickedness.

- 11 Then wicked people ask, “What does God know?”
“Does the Most High know anything?”
- 12 Look how wicked they are!
They never have a worry.
They grow more and more wealthy.
- 13 I’ve received no reward for keeping my life pure
and washing my hands of any blame.

¹⁴ I'm plagued _{with problems} all day long,
and every morning my punishment _{begins again}.

73:11–14 The wicked think you don't see their sins. Do you? They continually prosper while I get nothing for living for you. I face nonstop problems. Every day I take another beating.

¹⁵ If I had said, "I will continue to talk like that,"
I would have betrayed God's people.

¹⁶ But when I tried to understand this,
it was too difficult for me.

73:15–16 If I tell others my struggles, I will lead them astray. All of this is too difficult for me to understand.

¹⁷ Only when I came into God's holy place
did I _{finally} understand what would happen to them.

¹⁸ You put them in slippery places
and make them fall into ruin.

¹⁹ They are suddenly destroyed.
They are completely swept away by terror!

²⁰ As _{someone} gets rid of a dream when he wakes up,
so you, O Lord, get rid of the thought of them
when you wake up.

73:17–20 Only when I bow to you do I see the truth. You put evil people in slippery places, then push them to destruction. You shake them off like a bad dream.

²¹ When my heart was filled with bitterness
and my mind was seized _{with envy},
²² I was stupid, and I did not understand.
I was like a dumb animal in your presence.

²³ Yet, I am always with you.
You hold on to my right hand.

²⁴ With your advice you guide me,
and in the end you will take me to glory.

73:21–24 I was stupid to feel bitter and envious. I realize now that I'm always with you. You hold my hand and guide me in every step of life. When I die you'll welcome me home.

²⁵ As long as I have you,
I don't need anyone else in heaven or on earth.

²⁶ My body and mind may waste away,
but God remains the foundation of my life
and my inheritance forever.

73:25–26 As long as I have you I don't need anything else. Even if my body and mind waste away, you'll always be my strength.

²⁷ Without a doubt, those who are far from you will die.
You destroy all who are unfaithful to you.

²⁸ Being united with God is my highest good.
I have made the Almighty LORD my refuge
so that I may report everything that he has done.

73:27–28 People who live far from you will die. But living close to you is better than my biggest dreams.

Psalm 74

A maskil^[68] by Asaph.

¹ Why, O God, have you rejected us forever?

Why does your anger
smolder against the sheep in your care?

² Remember your congregation.

Long ago you made it your own.
You bought this tribe to be your possession.
This tribe is Mount Zion, where you have
made your home.

74:1–2 Why do you reject your people? Why does your anger smoke against your flock? Remember that you called us to be your people. You made our hearts your home.

³ Turn your steps toward [\[69\]](#) these pathetic ruins.

The enemy has destroyed everything in the
holy temple.

⁴ Your opponents have roared inside your meeting place.

They have set up their own emblems as symbols.

74:3–4 Look at us—we're pathetic ruins! Your enemies have destroyed your holy house and claimed it as their own.

⁵ Starting from its entrance, they hacked away
like a woodcutter in a forest. [\[70\]](#)

⁶ They smashed all its carved paneling with axes
and hatchets.

⁷ They burned your holy place to the ground.
They dishonored the place where you live among us.

⁸ They said to themselves, "We will crush them."
They burned every meeting place of God in the land.

74:5–8 Your enemies have hacked and burned your house. They want to crush us by burning the places we meet to honor you.

⁹ We no longer see miraculous signs.

There are no prophets anymore.
No one knows how long this will last.

¹⁰ How long, O God, will the enemy insult us?

- Will the enemy despise you forever?
- ¹¹ Why do you hold back your hand, especially your right hand?
Take your hands out of your pockets.
Destroy your enemies![\[71\]](#)

74:9–11 There are no more miracles, no more prophets. We don't know when we'll hear from you again or see you act. Get your hands out of your pockets and help us!

- ¹² And yet, from long ago God has been my king,
the one who has been victorious throughout the earth.
- ¹³ You stirred up the sea with your own strength.
You smashed the heads of sea monsters in the water.
- ¹⁴ You crushed the heads of Leviathan[\[72\]](#)
and gave them to the creatures of the desert for food.
- ¹⁵ You opened the springs and brooks.
You dried up the ever-flowing rivers.
- ¹⁶ The day and the night are yours.
You set the moon and the sun in their places.
- ¹⁷ You determined all the boundaries of the earth.
You created summer and winter.

74:12–17 Despite my grief you've always been my King. You rule earth and sea. You make streams start and stop. All of nature marches to your orders—day and night, sun and moon, summer and winter.

- ¹⁸ Remember how the enemy insulted you, O LORD.
Remember how an entire nation of godless fools despised your name.
- ¹⁹ Do not hand over the soul of your dove to wild animals.
Do not forget the life of your oppressed people forever.

74:18–19 Godless fools hate you. Don't forget how they insult you. Don't hand over your treasured people to be mauled and eaten.

- ²⁰ Consider your promise^[73]
because every dark corner of the land is filled
with violence.
- ²¹ Do not let oppressed people come back in disgrace.
Let weak and needy people praise your name.
- ²² Arise, O God!
Fight for your own cause!
Remember how godless fools insult you all day long.

74:20–22 In these dark days remember your promises to us. The weak and needy praise you. Stand up and fight for your people!

- ²³ Do not forget the shouting of your opponents.
Do not forget the uproar made by those who attack you.

Psalm 75

For the choir director; al tashcheth; a psalm by Asaph; a song.

- ¹ We give thanks to you, O God; we give thanks.
You are present, and your miracles confirm that.

75:1 Thank you. And thank you again. Your miracles prove your presence with us.

- ² When I choose the right time,
I will judge fairly.
- ³ When the earth and everyone who lives on it begin
to melt,
I will make its foundations as solid as rock. *Selah*
- ⁴ I said to those who brag, “Don’t brag,”
and to wicked people,
“Don’t raise your weapons.”
- ⁵ Don’t raise your weapons so proudly
or speak so defiantly.”

75:2–5 You set the perfect time for judgment. When the earth melts, you alone make it solid. I keep telling the proud not to brag. I warn them not to shake their weapons and words at you.

- ⁶ The **“authority”** to reward someone does not **“come”**
from the east,
from the west,
or **“even”** from the wilderness.
- ⁷ God alone is the judge.
He punishes one person and rewards another.
- ⁸ A cup is in the LORD’s hand.
(Its foaming wine is thoroughly mixed with spices.)
He will empty it,
“and” all the wicked people on earth
will have to drink every last drop.

75:6–8 You alone have real authority. Only you can judge, punish, and reward. You pour your cup of wrath and make the wicked drink every last drop.

- ⁹ But I will speak **“about your miracles”** forever.
I will make music to praise the God of Jacob.
- ¹⁰ I will destroy all the weapons of wicked people,
but the weapons of righteous people will be
raised proudly.

75:9–10 I’ll always talk about your miracles. I’ll always praise you. You destroy the weapons of evildoers, but you empower your followers.

Psalm 76

For the choir director; on stringed instruments; a psalm by Asaph; a song.

- ¹ God is known in Judah.
His name is great in Israel.
- ² His tent is in Salem.
His home is in Zion.

76:1–2 Your people know you. You make your home with us.

³ There he destroyed flaming arrows,
shields, swords, and weapons of war. *Selah*

⁴ You are the radiant one.
You are more majestic than the ancient mountains.[\[74\]](#)

76:4 No person shines brighter than you. No mountain rises more majestic than you.

⁵ Brave people were robbed.
They died.
None of the warriors were able to lift a hand.

⁶ At your stern warning, O God of Jacob,
chariot riders and horses were put to sleep.

⁷ You alone must be feared!
Who can stand in your presence when you become angry?

76:5–7 No power can stand against you. You strike down armies. You prove that you alone must be feared. No one can stand in your anger.

⁸ From heaven you announced a verdict.
The earth was fearful and silent
⁹ when you rose to judge, O God,
when you rose to save every oppressed person
on earth. *Selah*

76:8–9 From heaven you announce your verdicts. You rise to judge evildoers and save the oppressed.

¹⁰ Even angry mortals will praise you.
You will wear the remainder of *their* anger.[\[75\]](#)
¹¹ Make vows to the LORD your God, and keep them.
Let everyone around him bring gifts to the one who
must be feared.

¹² He cuts short the lives of influential people.
He terrifies the kings of the earth.

76:11–12 I'll keep my promises to you. I'll bring you gifts because you fill me with awe. You put an end to influential people. Even kings fear you.

Psalm 77

For the choir director; according to Jeduthun; a psalm by Asaph.

- ¹ Loudly, I cried to God.
Loudly, I cried to God
so that he would open his ears to **hear** me.
- ² On the day I was in trouble, I went to the Lord for help.
At night I stretched out my hands in prayer without
growing tired.
Yet, my soul refused to be comforted.
- ³ I sigh as I remember God.
I begin to lose hope as I think about him. *Selah*

77:1–3 I cried loudly so you would hear me. I was in trouble so I ran to you for help. I even prayed all night long. Yet I found no comfort. I'm starting to lose hope in you.

- ⁴ (You keep my eyelids open.)
I am so upset that I cannot speak.
- ⁵ I have considered the days of old,
the years long ago.
- ⁶ I remember my song in the night
and reflect **on it**.
My spirit searches **for an answer**:
⁷ Will the LORD reject **me** for all time?
Will he ever accept me?
- ⁸ Has his mercy come to an end forever?
Has his promise been canceled throughout
every generation?

⁹ Has God forgotten to be merciful?
Has he locked up his compassion because of
his anger? *Selah*

77:4–9 Now I'm too upset even to pray. I keep thinking of the songs I used to sing. Will you ever accept me? Have you run out of mercy? Have you quit keeping your promises? Are you too angry to show me compassion?

¹⁰ Then I said, "It makes me feel sick
that the power of the Most High is no longer the same."[\[76\]](#)
¹¹ I will remember the deeds of the LORD.
I will remember your ancient miracles.
¹² I will reflect on all your actions
and think about what you have done.

77:10–12 I feel sick at your infinite power seems to have faded. I force myself to think back to your ancient miracles. I ponder what you've done.

¹³ O God, your ways are holy!
What god is as great as our God?
¹⁴ You are the God who performs miracles.
You have made your strength known among
the nations.
¹⁵ With your might you have defended your people,
the descendants of Jacob and Joseph. *Selah*

77:13–15 Your ways are holy! No god is as mighty as you. You did miracles and demonstrated your strength to the world. With your might you defended your people.

¹⁶ The water saw you, O God.
The water saw you and shook.
Even the depths of the sea trembled.
¹⁷ The clouds poured out water.
The sky thundered.
Even your arrows flashed in every direction.
¹⁸ The sound of your thunder rumbled in the sky.[\[77\]](#)

Streaks of lightning lit up the world.
The earth trembled and shook.

- ¹⁹ Your road went through the sea.
Your path went through raging water,
but your footprints could not be seen.
- ²⁰ Like a shepherd, you led your people.
You had Moses and Aaron take them by the hand.

77:16–20 The sea shook with fear when it saw you coming. The clouds burst, the sky thundered, and lightning lit the earth. You made a path through the sea for your people. You led your people like a shepherd, telling Moses and Aaron to take them by the hand.

Psalm 78

A maskil by Asaph.

- ¹ Open your ears to my teachings, my people.
Turn your ears to the words from my mouth.
- ² I will open my mouth to illustrate points.
I will explain what has been hidden long ago,
³ things that we have heard and known about,
things that our parents have told us.
- ⁴ We will not hide them from our children.
We will tell the next generation
about the LORD's power and great deeds
and the miraculous things he has done.

78:1–4 I want everyone to hear my words because I have something important to say. I'll explain what you did long ago. I'll tell the stories passed down from our parents. I won't hide the powerful deeds you've done.

- ⁵ He established written instructions for Jacob's people.
He gave his teachings to Israel.
He commanded our ancestors to make them known to their children

78:5 You wrote down your commands so no one could miss them. You made them easy for children to learn.

⁶ so that the next generation would know them.

Children yet to be born _└would learn them_┘.

They will grow up and tell their children

⁷ to trust God, to remember what he has done,
and to obey his commands.

⁸ Then they will not be like their ancestors,
a stubborn and rebellious generation.

Their hearts were not loyal.

Their spirits were not faithful to God.

⁹ The men of Ephraim, well-equipped with bows _└and arrows_┘,
turned _└and ran_┘ on the day of battle.

¹⁰ They had not been faithful to God's promise.[\[78\]](#)

They refused to follow his teachings.

78:6–10 You want each generation to teach their children to trust you, to remember your deeds, and to obey your commands. Then they won't rebel like their unfaithful ancestors, those well-equipped warriors who fled when they should have stood on your promises.

¹¹ They forgot what he had done—
the miracles that he had shown them.

¹² In front of their ancestors he performed miracles
in the land of Egypt, in the fields of Zoan.

¹³ He divided the sea and led them through it.
He made the waters stand up like a wall.

¹⁴ He guided them by a cloud during the day
and by a fiery light throughout the night.

¹⁵ He split rocks in the desert.

He gave them plenty to drink, an ocean of water.

¹⁶ He made streams come out of a rock.

He made the water flow like rivers.

78:11–16 Never let me forget your miracles. You split the sea and led your people to freedom, with a cloud by day and a fiery light by night. You split rocks in the desert and gave them plenty to drink.

- ¹⁷ They continued to sin against him,
to rebel in the desert against the Most High.
- ¹⁸ They deliberately tested God by demanding the food they craved.
- ¹⁹ They spoke against God by saying,
“Can God prepare a banquet in the desert?
- ²⁰ True, he did strike a rock,
and water did gush out,
and the streams did overflow.
But can he also give us bread or provide us, his
people, with meat?”

78:17–20 Your people saw these miracles yet continued to rebel against you. They demanded you fill their cravings for bread and meat. They questioned your ability to provide. Show me when I treat you with such disrespect.

- ²¹ When the LORD heard this, he became furious.

His fire burned against Jacob
and his anger flared up at Israel
²² because they did not believe God
or trust him to save them.

²³ In spite of that, he commanded the clouds above
and opened the doors of heaven.

²⁴ He rained manna down on them to eat
and gave them grain from heaven.

²⁵ Humans ate the bread of the mighty ones,
and God sent them plenty of food.

²⁶ He made the east wind blow in the heavens
and guided the south wind with his might.

²⁷ He rained meat down on them like dust,
birds like the sand on the seashore.

²⁸ He made the birds fall in the middle of
his camp,
all around his dwelling place.

78:21–28 You were furious when you overheard their doubts. They didn't believe your promises. They didn't trust you to save them. Yet you kindly dropped manna from heaven. You rained meat in the middle of their camp.
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²⁹ They ate more than enough.

He gave them what they wanted,

³⁰ but they still wanted more.

While the food was still in their mouths,

³¹ the anger of God flared up against them.

He killed their strongest men
and slaughtered the best young men in Israel.

³² In spite of all this, they continued to sin,
and they no longer believed in his miracles.

78:29–32 Your people ate until they were stuffed but still they wanted more. Their mouths were full but they moaned about their hunger. In your anger you killed the strong and the young. And still they continued to sin.

³³ He brought their days to an end like a whisper in
the wind.

He brought their years to an end in terror.

³⁴ When he killed „some of„ them, „the rest„
searched for him.

They turned from their sins and eagerly looked for God.

³⁵ They remembered that God was their rock,
that the Most High was their defender.

³⁶ They flattered him with their mouths
and lied to him with their tongues.

³⁷ Their hearts were not loyal to him.
They were not faithful to his promise.

78:34–37 Some searched for you. They turned from their sins and looked for you. They called you their rock and defender. But it was all an act. Their hearts weren't with you.

³⁸ But he is compassionate.

He forgave their sin.

He did not destroy them.

He restrained his anger many times.

He did not display all of his fury.

³⁹ He remembered that they were only flesh and blood,
a breeze that blows and does not return.

78:38–39 You are merciful and forgiving. You hold back your anger and remember that people are

weak. We are but a breeze that blows once and disappears.

⁴⁰ How often they rebelled against him in the wilderness!
How often they caused him grief in the desert!

⁴¹ Again and again they tested God,
and they pushed the Holy One of Israel to the limit.

⁴² They did not remember his power—
the day he freed them from their oppressor,
⁴³ when he performed his miraculous signs in Egypt,
his wonders in the fields of Zoan.

78:40–43 I don't want to push you to the limit like they did. Help me remember your power—how you used miraculous signs and wonders to free your people from slavery.

- ⁴⁴ He turned their rivers into blood
so that they could not drink from their streams.
- ⁴⁵ He sent a swarm of flies that bit them
and frogs that ruined them.
- ⁴⁶ He gave their crops to grasshoppers
and their produce to locusts.
- ⁴⁷ He killed their vines with hail
and their fig trees with frost.
- ⁴⁸ He let the hail strike their cattle
and bolts of lightning strike their livestock.

78:44–48 You turned rivers bloody and undrinkable. You sent biting flies and hopping frogs. You served the slave masters' crops to grasshoppers and destroyed their cattle with hail and lightning.

- ⁴⁹ He sent his burning anger, rage, fury, and hostility
against them.
He sent an army of destroying angels.
- ⁵⁰ He cleared a path for his anger.
He did not spare them.
He let the plague take their lives.
- ⁵¹ He slaughtered every firstborn in Egypt,
the ones born in the tents of Ham when their fathers
were young.
- ⁵² But he led his own people out like sheep
and guided them like a flock through
the wilderness.

78:49–52 Anger. Rage. Fury. Hostility. You burned against the slave masters and killed their firstborn in barns and tents and homes. But like a shepherd leading his flock to safe pasture, you led your people to freedom.

- ⁵³ He led them safely.

They had no fear while the sea covered
their enemies.

⁵⁴ He brought them into his holy land,
to this mountain that his power had won.

⁵⁵ He forced nations out of their way
and gave them the land of the nations as their inheritance.
He settled the tribes of Israel in their own tents.

78:53–55 Your people watched from dry land while the sea piled onto their enemies. You brought your people to your holy land. You forced nations out of their way and gave your people a place to live.

⁵⁶ They tested God Most High and rebelled against him.
They did not obey his written instructions.

⁵⁷ They were disloyal and treacherous like their ancestors.
They were like arrows shot from a defective bow.

⁵⁸ They made him angry because of their illegal
worship sites.
They made him furious because they worshiped idols.

78:56–58 Your people saw all this and still rebelled against you. They disobeyed your written instructions. You fumed when they built altars to other gods.

⁵⁹ When God heard, he became furious.
He completely rejected Israel.

⁶⁰ He abandoned his dwelling place in Shiloh,
the tent where he had lived among humans.

⁶¹ He allowed his power to be taken captive
and handed his glory over to an oppressor.

⁶² He let swords kill his people.
He was furious with those who belonged to him.

⁶³ Fire consumed his best young men,
so his virgins heard no wedding songs.

78:59–63 In your fury you rejected your people. You allowed the ark of your power to be captured by enemies. You let your people die in battle and sent fire to consume young men.

- ⁶⁴ His priests were cut down with swords.
The widows [⌋]of his priests[⌋] could not even
weep [⌋]for them[⌋].
- ⁶⁵ Then the Lord woke up like one who had
been sleeping,
like a warrior sobering up from [⌋]too much[⌋] wine.
- ⁶⁶ He struck his enemies from behind
and disgraced them forever.
- ⁶⁷ He rejected the tent of Joseph.
He did not choose the tribe of Ephraim,
⁶⁸ but he chose the tribe of Judah,
Mount Zion which he loved.
- ⁶⁹ He built his holy place to be like the high heavens,
like the earth which he made to last for a long time.
- ⁷⁰ He chose his servant David.
He took him from the sheep pens.
- ⁷¹ He brought him from tending the ewes that had lambs
so that David could be the shepherd of the people of Jacob,
of Israel, the people who belonged to the LORD.
- ⁷² With unselfish devotion David became their shepherd.
With skill he guided them.

78:65–72 Let me never give you reason to wake up angry, nor strike me from behind, nor disgrace me forever. Let me live as one of your chosen children. Give me the heart of David. Lift me from my mundane tasks to lead your people. Give me unselfish devotion and skill.
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Psalm 79

A psalm by Asaph.

- ¹ O God, the nations have invaded the land that belongs
to you.
They have dishonored your holy temple.

They have left Jerusalem in ruins.

² They have given the dead bodies of your servants
to the birds for food.

They have given the flesh of your godly ones
to the animals.

³ They have shed the blood of your people

around Jerusalem
as though it were water.

There is no one to bury your people.

- ⁴ We have become a disgrace to our neighbors,
an object of ridicule and contempt to those
around us.

79:1–4 The nations have invaded your land and dishonored your holy house. They serve our bodies to birds and animals, spilling our blood like water. There's no one left to bury the dead. Our neighbors mock us.

- ⁵ How long, O LORD?

Will you remain angry forever?

Will your fury continue to burn like fire?

- ⁶ Pour your fury on the nations that do not know you,
on the kingdoms that have not called you.

⁷ They have devoured Jacob.

They have destroyed his home.

79:5–7 Will you always be angry with us? Turn your fury on the people who don't worship you, those intent on destroying your people.

- ⁸ Do not hold the crimes of our ancestors against us.

Reach out to us soon with your compassion, because we are helpless.

- ⁹ Help us, O God, our savior, for the glory of your name.

Rescue us, and forgive our sins for the honor of
your name.

79:8–9 Don't hold us guilty for the sins of our ancestors. Touch us with compassion. Be our help so your name is honored. Rescue and forgive us.

- ¹⁰ Why should the nations _be allowed to_ say,

“Where is their God?”

Let us watch as the nations learn

that there is punishment for shedding the blood of your servants.

- ¹¹ Let the groans of prisoners come into your presence.

With your powerful arm rescue those who are condemned to death.

79:10–11 Why do you let everyone think you’ve left us? Teach the nations a lesson for killing your servants. Hear the groans of your imprisoned people. Rescue us from death row.

- ¹² Pay each one of our neighbors back
with seven times the number of insults they used to insult you, O Lord.
- ¹³ Then we, your people, the flock in your pasture,
will give thanks to you forever.
We will praise you throughout every generation.

79:12–13 Pay back our persecutors for their insults. Give us reason to thank you forever.

Psalm 80

For the choir director; according to shoshannim eduth; by Asaph; a psalm.

- ¹ Open your ears, O Shepherd of Israel,
the one who leads לthe descendants of ל Joseph like sheep,
the one who is enthroned over the angels.[\[79\]](#)
- ² Appear in front of Ephraim, Benjamin, and Manasseh.
Wake up your power, and come to save us.

80:1–2 Open your ears to your people. Be the Shepherd that you are. Stand high above the angels.
Show yourself and save us.

- ³ O God, restore us and smile on us
so that we may be saved.
- ⁴ O LORD God, commander of armies, how long will you smolder in anger
against the prayer of your people?
- ⁵ You made them eat tears as food.
You often made them drink לtheir own ל tears.

80:3–5 Restore us. Smile on us. Save us. Stop smoldering in anger when you hear our prayers. Our

tears are the only thing left to drink.

⁶ You made us a source of conflict to our neighbors,
and our enemies made fun of us.

⁷ O God, commander of armies, restore us and smile on us
so that we may be saved.

80:6–7 People fight over us and make fun of us. Restore us. Smile on us. Save us.

⁸ You brought a vine from Egypt.
You forced out the nations and planted it.

⁹ You cleared the ground for it
so that it took root and filled the land.

¹⁰ Its shade covered the mountains.
Its branches covered the mighty cedars.

¹¹ It reached out with its branches to the Mediterranean Sea.
Its shoots reached the Euphrates River.

¹² Why did you break down the stone fences around this vine?
All who pass by are picking its fruit.

¹³ Wild boars from the forest graze on it.
Wild animals devour it.

80:8–13 You brought your people out of Egypt and planted us like a vine. You cleared the land around us so we could take root. We grew and spread our shade far and wide. Why have you quit protecting us? People are picking us clean. Wild animals graze on us.

¹⁴ O God, commander of armies, come back!
Look from heaven and see!
Come to help this vine.

¹⁵ Take care of what your right hand planted,
the son you strengthened for yourself.

¹⁶ The vine has been cut down and burned.
Let them be destroyed by the threatening look on your face.

80:14–16 God of armies, come help! Protect what you yourself planted. Just throw your enemies a threatening glance and they will be destroyed.

- ¹⁷ Let your power rest on the man you have chosen,
the son of man you strengthened for yourself.
¹⁸ Then we will never turn away from you.
Give us life again, and we will call on you.
¹⁹ O LORD God, commander of armies, restore us, and smile on us
so that we may be saved.

80:17–19 Give power to our leaders. Give life to our souls. Then we'll stay faithful to you. Restore us. Smile on us. Then we will be saved.

Psalm 81

For the choir director; on the gittith;[\[80\]](#) by Asaph.

- ¹ Sing joyfully to God, our strength.
Shout happily to the God of Jacob.
² Begin a psalm, and strike a tambourine.
Play lyres and harps with their pleasant music.
³ Blow the ram's horn on the day of the new moon,
on the day of the full moon,
on our festival days.

81:1–3 I sing joyfully to you, my strength, and shout happily to you. I sing and strike a tambourine.
I dedicate days to celebrating you.

- ⁴ This is a law for Israel,
a legal decision from the God of Jacob.
⁵ These are the instructions God set in place for Joseph
when Joseph rose to power over Egypt.

I heard a message I did not understand:

- ⁶ “I removed the burden from his shoulder.
His hands were freed from the basket.

⁷ When you were in trouble, you called out „to me“, and I rescued you.
I was hidden in thunder, but I answered you.
I tested your „loyalty“ at the oasis of Meribah. *Selah*

81:4–7 You give clear instructions to your people. You set us free to live for you with total loyalty.

⁸ Listen, my people, and I will warn you.
Israel, if you would only listen to me!
⁹ Never keep any strange god among you.
Never worship a foreign god.
¹⁰ I am the LORD your God, the one who brought you out of Egypt.
Open your mouth wide, and I will fill it.
¹¹ “But my people did not listen to me.
Israel wanted nothing to do with me.
¹² So I let them go their own stubborn ways
and follow their own advice.

81:8–12 You warn us never to worship other gods. You’re the one who saved us from slavery. You fulfill our every need. Yet we refuse to listen to you. We turn from you and you let us walk away.

¹³ If only my people would listen to me!
If only Israel would follow me!
¹⁴ I would quickly defeat their enemies.
I would turn my power against their foes.
¹⁵ Those who hate the LORD would cringe in front of him,
and their time „for punishment“ would last forever.
¹⁶ But I would feed Israel with the finest wheat
and satisfy them with honey from a rock.”

81:13–16 You grieve when we don’t listen to you or answer your invitation to follow. Only when we come back to you will you defeat people who hate you. Only then will you feed and satisfy us.

Psalm 82

A psalm by Asaph.

- ¹ God takes his place in his own assembly.
He pronounces judgment among the gods:
² “How long are you going to judge unfairly?
How long are you going to side with wicked people?” *Selah*

82:1–2 You can’t make yourself any clearer. You don’t tolerate unfair judgments. You’re tired of people siding with the wicked.

- ³ Defend weak people and orphans.
Protect the rights of the oppressed and the poor.
⁴ Rescue weak and needy people.
Help them escape the power of wicked people.
⁵ Wicked people do not know or understand anything.
As they walk around in the dark,
all the foundations of the earth shake.

82:3–5 You call me to defend the weak and orphaned. To protect the oppressed and poor. To rescue the weak and needy. Wicked people don’t understand any of this.

- ⁶ I said, “You are gods.
You are all sons of the Most High.
⁷ You will certainly die like humans
and fall like any prince.”
⁸ Arise, O God!
Judge the earth, because all the nations belong to you.

82:6–8 The powerful will die like anyone else if they disregard your command. So rise up! Judge the world! We are yours!

Psalm 83

A song; a psalm by Asaph.

- ¹ O God, do not remain silent.
Do not turn a deaf ear to me.
Do not keep quiet, O God.
- ² Look, your enemies are in an uproar.
Those who hate you hold their heads high.
- ³ They make plans in secret against your people
and plot together against those you treasure.
- ⁴ They say, “Let’s wipe out their nation
so that the name of Israel will no longer be remembered.”

83:1–4 Don’t stay silent. Don’t pretend to be deaf. Your enemies plot to wipe out your people. They want to erase us so thoroughly that no one will know we ever existed.

- ⁵ They agree completely on their plan.
They form an alliance against you:
- ⁶ the tents from Edom and Ishmael,
Moab and Hagar,
- ⁷ Gebal, Ammon, and Amalek,
Philistia, along with those who live in Tyre.
- ⁸ Even Assyria has joined them.
They helped the descendants of Lot. *Selah*

83:5–8 This evil alliance already has a plan. The nations around us have all joined together.

- ⁹ Do to them what you did to Midian,
to Sisera and Jabin at the Kishon River.
- ¹⁰ They were destroyed at Endor.
They became manure to fertilize the ground.
- ¹¹ Treat their influential people as you treated Oreb and Zeeb.
Treat all their leaders like Zebah and Zalmunna.
- ¹² They said, “Let’s take God’s pasturelands
for ourselves.”
- ¹³ O my God, blow them away like tumbleweeds,[\[81\]](#)
like husks in the wind.
- ¹⁴ Pursue them with your storms,

and terrify them with your windstorms

83:9–14 Deal with your enemies as you have in the past. Make them manure and use them to fertilize the ground. Blow away evil leaders like tumbleweeds in the wind. Terrify them with your windstorms.

¹⁵ the way fire burns a forest
and flames set mountains on fire.[\[82\]](#)

¹⁶ Let their faces blush with shame, O LORD,
so that they must look to you for help.

¹⁷ Let them be put to shame and terrified forever.

Let them die in disgrace
¹⁸ so that they must acknowledge you.
Your name is the LORD.
You alone are the Most High God of the whole earth.

83:16–18 Make evil leaders blush with shame until they turn to you for help. Let them suffer disgrace until they acknowledge you as Lord, the Most High God of the whole world.

Psalm 84

For the choir director; on the gittith; a psalm by Korah's descendants.

¹ Your dwelling place is lovely, O LORD of Armies!
² My soul longs and yearns
for the LORD's courtyards.
My whole body shouts for joy to the living God.
³ Even sparrows find a home,
and swallows find a nest for themselves.
There they hatch their young near your altars, O LORD of Armies, my king
and my God.

84:1–3 I ache for the beauty of your presence. My whole body shouts for joy to you. Near you even birds find a home, a safe place to hatch their young. You're my King and my God.

⁴ Blessed are those who live in your house.
They are always praising you. *Selah*
⁵ Blessed are those who find strength in you.
Their hearts are on the road └that leads to you┐.[\[83\]](#)

84:4–5 You bless me when I stay close to you. I find abundant reasons to praise you. Drawing on your strength blesses me.

⁶ As they pass through a valley where balsam trees grow,[\[84\]](#)
they make it a place of springs.
The early rains cover it with blessings.[\[85\]](#)

⁷ Their strength grows as they go along
until each one of them appears in front of God in Zion.

84:5–7 My heart is on the road that leads to you. When I pass through dry valleys, you fill them with springs. With each step closer to you my strength grows.

⁸ O LORD God, commander of armies, hear my prayer.
Open your ears, O God of Jacob. *Selah*

⁹ Look at our shield, O God.
Look with favor on the face of your anointed one.

¹⁰ One day in your courtyards is better than a thousand *anywhere else*.

84:10 A single day with you is better than a thousand anywhere else. I'd rather stand on your doorstep than live inside a wicked person's palace.

I would rather stand in the entrance to my God's house than live inside wicked people's homes.

¹¹ The LORD God is a sun and shield.
The LORD grants favor and honor.
He does not hold back any blessing from those who live innocently.

¹² O LORD of Armies, blessed is the person who trusts you.

84:11–12 You warm and protect me, giving me every blessing. All-powerful God, I'm happy because I trust in you.

Psalm 85

For the choir director; a psalm by Korah's descendants.

¹ You favored your land, O LORD.
You restored the fortunes of Jacob.
² You removed your people's guilt.
You pardoned all their sins. *Selah*
³ You laid aside all your fury.
You turned away from your burning anger.

⁴ Restore us, O God, our savior.
Put an end to your anger against us.

85:1–4 In the past you showed your people your favor. You restored our fortunes and forgave our sins. Restore us once again!

⁵ Will you be angry with us forever?
Will you ever let go of your anger in the generations to come?
⁶ Won't you restore our lives again
so that your people may find joy in you?
⁷ Show us your mercy, O LORD,
by giving us your salvation.

85:5–7 Quit your anger toward us. Don't burn against us forever. Rebuild us so we find joy in you once again. Let us experience your merciful gift of salvation.

⁸ I want to hear what God the LORD says,
because he promises peace to his people, to his godly ones.
But they must not go back to their stupidity.
⁹ Indeed, his salvation is near those who fear him,
and his glory will remain in our land.

85:8–9 You promise us peace if we don't go back to our stupidity. Your salvation is near everyone who respects you fully.

¹⁰ Mercy and truth have met.
Righteousness and peace have kissed.
¹¹ Truth sprouts from the ground,
and righteousness looks down from heaven.
¹² The LORD will certainly give us what is good,
and our land will produce crops.

85:10–12 Let us enjoy your mercy and truth, your righteousness and peace, your glory and everything good.

¹³ Righteousness will go ahead of him
and make a path for his steps.

Psalm 86

A prayer by David.

¹ Turn your ear └toward me_┐, O LORD.
Answer me, because I am oppressed and needy.
² Protect me, because I am faithful └to you_┐.
Save your servant who trusts you. You are my God.

86:1–2 Listen to me! Answer me! I live for you. I count on your protection.

³ Have pity on me, O Lord,
because I call out to you all day long.
⁴ Give me joy, O Lord,
because I lift my soul to you.

86:3–4 Pity me, because I call to you all day long. Give me joy, because I've given my heart to you alone.

⁵ You, O Lord, are good and forgiving,
full of mercy toward everyone who calls out to you.
⁶ Open your ears to my prayer, O LORD.
Pay attention when I plead for mercy.
⁷ When I am in trouble, I call out to you
because you answer me.
⁸ No god is like you, O Lord.
No one can do what you do.

86:5–8 You're always good and forgiving, full of mercy to everyone who calls on you. I look to you because there's no one like you, none as able as you.

⁹ All the nations that you have made will bow in your presence, O LORD.

They will honor you.

¹⁰ Indeed, you are great, a worker of miracles.
You alone are God.

86:9–10 Your world will bow to you, great worker of miracles.

¹¹ Teach me your way, O LORD,
so that I may live in your truth.
Focus my heart on fearing you.

¹² I will give thanks to you with all my heart, O Lord my God.

I will honor you forever
13 because your mercy toward me is great.
You have rescued me from the depths of hell.

86:11–13 Teach me to live your truth with utter respect. I'll thank you with all my heart, giving you the honor you deserve for saving me from hell.

14 O God, arrogant people attack me,
and a mob of ruthless people seeks my life.
They think nothing of you.
15 But you, O Lord, are a compassionate and merciful God.
You are patient, always faithful and ready to forgive.
16 Turn toward me, and have pity on me.
Give me your strength because I am your servant.
Save me because I am the son of your female servant.
17 Grant me some proof of your goodness
so that those who hate me may see it and be put to shame.
You, O LORD, have helped me and comforted me.

86:14–17 Cruel people who think nothing of you want to kill me. But you're continually compassionate, merciful, patient, faithful, and forgiving. Strengthen me as I serve you. Prove your goodness to me and your world.

Psalm 87

By Korah's descendants; a psalm; a song.

1 ֽThe city־ the LORD has founded ֽstands־ on
holy mountains.
2 The LORD loves the city of Zion
more than any other place in Jacob.
3 Glorious things are said about you, O city
of God! *Selah*

87:1–3 You love your holy city and the people who live there. Others see it and say wonderful

things.

- ⁴ The LORD says, “I will add Egypt and Babylon
as well as Philistia, Tyre, and Sudan
to the list of those who acknowledge me.
Each nation will claim that it was born there.”
- ⁵ But it will be said of Zion,
“Every race is born in it.
The Most High will make it secure.”
- ⁶ The LORD will record this in the Book of Nations:
“Every race claims that it was born there.” *Selah*

87:4–6 May every nation and race acknowledge you as God. Make the peoples of the world citizens of your kingdom. Let them enjoy the strength and security of your home. You alone are God.

- ⁷ Singers and dancers will sing,
“Zion is the source of all our blessings.”

Psalm 88

A song; a psalm by Korah’s descendants; for the choir director; according to mahalath leannoth; [\[86\]](#) a maskil by Heman the Ezrahite.

- ¹ O LORD God, my savior,
I cry out to you during the day and at night.
- ² Let my prayer come into your presence.
Turn your ear to hear my cries.

88:1–2 You are my God and Savior to whom I cry day and night. Welcome my prayers!

- ³ My soul is filled with troubles,
and my life comes closer to the grave.
- ⁴ I am numbered with those who go into the pit.
I am like a man without any strength—
- ⁵ abandoned with the dead,
like those who have been killed and lie in graves,

like those whom you no longer remember,
who are cut off from your power.

⁶ You have put me in the bottom of the pit—in deep,
dark places.

⁷ Your rage lies heavily on me.
You make all your waves pound on me. *Selah*

88:3–7 I'm filled with troubles and my death looms near. I feel already dead, abandoned with others long forgotten and beyond your help. In anger you've buried me in a grave's dark bottom.

⁸ You have taken my friends far away from me.

You made me disgusting to them.

I'm shut in, and I can't get out.

⁹ My eyes grow weak because of my suffering.

All day long I call out to you, O LORD.

I stretch out my hands to you *in prayer*.

88:8–9 You rob me of my friends. You make me repulsive to them. I'm trapped in this grave and can't get out. I can't see anything but my suffering.

¹⁰ Will you perform miracles for those who are dead?

Will the spirits of the dead rise and give thanks to you? *Selah*

¹¹ Will anyone tell about your mercy in Sheol

or about your faithfulness in Abaddon?

¹² Will anyone know about your miracles in that dark place

or about your righteousness in the place where forgotten people live?

88:10–12 What good are your miracles once I'm gone? How can I praise you from the grave? Dead people can't tell others about your mercy and faithfulness.

¹³ I cry out to you for help, O LORD,

and in the morning my prayer will come into your presence.

¹⁴ Why do you reject my soul, O LORD?

Why do you hide your face from me?

88:13–14 I cry for your help, approaching you every morning in prayer. Why do you reject me?
Why do you hide from me?

¹⁵ Ever since I was young, I have been suffering and
near death. I have endured your terrors, and now I am in despair.[\[87\]](#)

¹⁶ Your burning anger has swept over me.
Your terrors have destroyed me.

¹⁷ They swirl around me all day long like water.
They surround me on all sides.

¹⁸ You have taken my loved ones and friends far away from me.
Darkness is my only friend![\[88\]](#)

88:15–18 I've been near death since I was born. The terrors I know too well cause me despair. Your
anger swirls around me. I'm alone except for the darkness.

Psalm 89

A maskil by Ethan the Ezrahite.

¹ I will sing forever about the evidence of your mercy,
O LORD.
I will tell about your faithfulness to every generation.

89:1 I'll sing now and forever of your mercy and faithfulness. I'll tell of the evidence I've seen with
my own eyes.

² I said, "Your mercy will last forever.
Your faithfulness stands firm in the heavens."
³ ♫ You said, ♫ "I have made a promise[\[89\]](#) to my chosen one.
I swore this oath to my servant David:
⁴ 'I will make your dynasty continue forever.
I built your throne to last throughout every generation.'" *Selah*

89:3–4 You promised David a family line that lasts forever. You swore his throne will endure to

every generation.

- ⁵ O LORD, the heavens praise your miracles
and your faithfulness in the assembly of the holy ones.
- ⁶ Who in the skies can compare with the LORD?
Who among the heavenly beings is like the LORD?
- ⁷ God is terrifying in the council of the holy ones.
He is greater and more awe-inspiring than those who surround him.

89:5–7 Who in heaven compares with you? Who is greater or more awe-inspiring than you? You strike fear in the heart of every living thing.

- ⁸ O LORD God of Armies, who is like you?
Mighty LORD, even your faithfulness surrounds you.
- ⁹ You rule the raging sea.
When its waves rise, you quiet them.
- ¹⁰ You crushed Rahab;[\[90\]](#) it was like a corpse.
With your strong arm you scattered your enemies.
- ¹¹ The heavens are yours.
The earth is also yours.
You made the world and everything in it.

89:9–11 You rule the sea's raging waves. You crush chaos and scatter your enemies. Everything from heaven to earth belongs to you, because you made it all.

- ¹² You created north and south.
Mount Tabor and Mount Hermon sing your name joyfully.
- ¹³ Your arm is mighty.
Your hand is strong.
Your right hand is lifted high.
- ¹⁴ Righteousness and justice are the foundations of your throne.
Mercy and truth stand in front of you.

89:12–14 You created every stretch of land. Majestic mountain heights sing your name with joy. Your strength rules with goodness and justice. Mercy and truth never leave you.

- ¹⁵ Blessed are the people who know how to praise you.
They walk in the light of your presence, O LORD.
¹⁶ They find joy in your name all day long.
They are joyful in your righteousness
¹⁷ because you are the glory of their strength.
By your favor you give us victory.[\[91\]](#)

89:15–17 Happiness fills people who praise you, because your presence lights their paths. They never stop celebrating your good name. You strengthen them and give them victory.

- ¹⁸ Our shield belongs to the LORD.
Our king belongs to the Holy One of Israel.
¹⁹ Once in a vision you said to your faithful ones:
“I set a boy above warriors.[\[92\]](#)
I have raised up one chosen from the people.
²⁰ I found my servant David.
I anointed him with my holy oil.

89:19–20 You passed over warriors and picked a boy as your chosen one. You raised up David to rule your people.

- ²¹ My hand is ready to help him.
My arm will also give him strength.
²² No enemy will take him by surprise.
No wicked person will mistreat him.
²³ I will crush his enemies in front of him
and defeat those who hate him.
²⁴ My faithfulness and mercy will be with him,
and in my name he will be victorious.[\[93\]](#)

89:21–24 You’re always ready to help the king, strengthening him and protecting him from evil surprises. You crush everyone who hates him. He goes to battle accompanied by your faithfulness and mercy.

- ²⁵ I will put his **left** hand on the sea

and his right hand on the rivers.

²⁶ He will call out to me,

‘You are my Father, my God, and the rock of my salvation.’

²⁷ Yes, I will make him the firstborn.

He will be the Most High to the kings of the earth.

²⁸ My mercy will stay with him forever.

My promise to him is unbreakable.

²⁹ I will make his dynasty endure forever
and his throne like the days of heaven.

89:26–29 The king calls you Father and God. You exalt your firstborn as Most High over every earthly king. To him you make an unbreakable promise that his dynasty will last forever.

³⁰ “If his descendants abandon my teachings
and do not live by my rules,

³¹ if they violate my laws

and do not obey my commandments,

³² then with a rod I will punish their rebellion
and their crimes with beatings.

³³ But I will not take my mercy away from him
or allow my truth to become a lie.

³⁴ I will not dishonor my promise
or alter my own agreement.

89:30–34 You promise to punish your people’s disobedience, but you won’t break your promise to the king. Your mercy will always endure.

³⁵ On my holiness I have taken an oath once and for all:
I will not lie to David.

³⁶ His dynasty will last forever.

His throne will be in my presence like the sun.

³⁷ Like the moon his throne will stand firm forever.
It will be like a faithful witness in heaven.”

³⁸ But you have despised, rejected,

and become angry with your anointed one.

³⁹ You have refused to recognize the promise to your servant

and have thrown his crown into the dirt.

89:35–39 You swore on your holiness that David’s line will last forever. Like the sun and the moon it will endure. Yet you haven’t kept your promise. You’ve rejected your people.

- ⁴⁰ You have broken through all his walls
and have laid his fortified cities in ruins.
⁴¹ (Everyone who passed by robbed him.
He has become the object of his neighbors’ scorn.)
⁴² You held the right hand of his enemies high
and made all of his adversaries rejoice.
⁴³ You even took his sword out of his hand
and failed to support him in battle.
⁴⁴ You put an end to his splendor
and hurled his throne to the ground.
⁴⁵ You cut short the days of his youth
and covered him with shame. *Selah*

89:40–45 You sent enemies through our walls, letting us be robbed and scorned. You grabbed the right hand of our enemies, lifting it high in victory. You left us defenseless, allowing our enemies to cut us down.

- ⁴⁶ How long, O LORD? Will you hide yourself forever?
How long will your anger continue to burn like fire?
⁴⁷ Remember how short my life is!
Have you created Adam’s descendants for no reason?

89:46–47 Will you always hide from us? Will you always be angry? Life is too short for this!

- ⁴⁸ Can a mortal go on living and never see death?
Who can set himself free from the power of the grave? *Selah*
⁴⁹ Where is the evidence of your mercy, LORD?
You swore an oath to David on “the basis of” your faithfulness.
⁵⁰ Remember, O LORD, [\[94\]](#) how your servant [\[95\]](#) has been insulted.
Remember how I have carried in my heart “the insults” from so many

people.

⁵¹ Your enemies insulted „me„.

They insulted your Messiah^[96] every step he took.

89:49–51 Where’s the proof of your mercy? Where’s the evidence of your oath? My heart aches with the insults heaped on me and on your Messiah.
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⁵² Thank the LORD forever.

Amen and amen!

BOOK FOUR

(Psalms 90–106)

Psalm 90

A prayer by Moses, the man of God.

¹ O LORD, you have been our refuge throughout every generation.

² Before the mountains were born,
before you gave birth to the earth and the world, you were God.
You are God from everlasting to everlasting.

90:1–2 Forever and ever you’ve been our refuge. Before you formed the earth you reigned as the everlasting God.

³ You turn mortals back into dust
and say, “Return, descendants of Adam.”

⁴ Indeed, in your sight a thousand years are like a single day,
like yesterday—already past—
like an hour in the night.

⁵ You sweep mortals away.
They are a dream.
They sprout again in the morning like cut grass.

90:3–5 You’ll decide when my time on earth is up and then turn me back to dust. In your eyes a thousand years flicker like a single day. I’ll come and go like a dream.

⁶ In the morning they blossom and sprout.
In the evening they wither and dry up.

⁷ Indeed, your anger consumes us.
Your rage terrifies us.

⁸ You have set our sins in front of you.

- You have put our secret sins in the light of your presence.
- ⁹ Indeed, all our days slip away because of your fury.
We live out our years like one [long](#) sigh.
- ¹⁰ Each of us lives for 70 years—
or even 80 if we are in good health.
But the best of them[\[97\]](#) [bring](#) trouble and misery.
Indeed, they are soon gone, and we fly away.

90:7–10 Your anger consumes me. Your brilliance exposes every one of my sins. Your fury makes my days slip away, so that my years add up to no more than one long sigh. The best years of my life bring trouble, and soon they'll all be gone.

- ¹¹ Who fully understands the power of your anger?
A person fears you more when he better understands your fury.[\[98\]](#)
- ¹² Teach us to number each of our days
so that we may grow in wisdom.

90:11–12 Your fury teaches me to respect you. The shortness of my life tells me to live wisely.

- ¹³ Return, LORD! How long . . . ?
Change your plans about [us](#), your servants.
- ¹⁴ Satisfy us every morning with your mercy
so that we may sing joyfully and rejoice all our days.
- ¹⁵ Make us rejoice for as many days as you have made us suffer,
for as many years as we have experienced evil.

90:14–15 Satisfy me morning by morning with your mercy. Give me reason to rejoice every day I have breath.

- ¹⁶ Let [us](#), your servants, see what you can do.
Let our children see your glorious power.
- ¹⁷ Let the kindness of the Lord our God be with us.
Make us successful in everything we do.
Yes, make us successful in everything we do.

90:16–17 Show me your power. Lead me through life with your kindness. Make me successful in everything I do!

Psalm 91

¹ Whoever lives under the shelter of the Most High
will remain in the shadow of the Almighty.

² I will say to the LORD,
“‘You are’ my refuge and my fortress, my God in whom I trust.”

91:1–2 You’re my refuge, my God, the one I trust. I live in your safety and find rest in your presence.

³ He is the one who will rescue you from hunters’ traps
and from deadly plagues.

⁴ He will cover you with his feathers,
and under his wings you will find refuge.
His truth is your shield and armor.

91:3–4 You rescue me from traps and deadly plagues. You pull me close and protect me. Your truth is my armor.

⁵ You do not need to fear
terrors of the night,
arrows that fly during the day,

⁶ plagues that roam the dark,
epidemics that strike at noon.

⁷ They will not come near you,
even though a thousand may fall dead beside you
or ten thousand at your right side.

⁸ You only have to look with your eyes
to see the punishment of wicked people.

91:5–8 Because of your care I'm unafraid of terror, no matter where it might strike. Ten thousand might die next to me, but you'll spare me. I'll see with my own eyes how you punish evil.

⁹ You, O LORD, are my refuge!

You have made the Most High your home.

¹⁰ No harm will come to you.

No sickness will come near your house.

¹¹ He will put his angels in charge of you
to protect you in all your ways.

¹² They will carry you in their hands
so that you never hit your foot against a rock.

¹³ You will step on lions and cobras.

You will trample young lions and snakes.

91:9–13 God Most High, you're my home. Keep sickness and harm far from me. Command your angels to carry me through life. Let me trample on danger before it strikes.

¹⁴ Because you love me, I will rescue you.

I will protect you because you know my name.

¹⁵ When you call to me, I will answer you.

I will be with you when you are in trouble.

I will save you and honor you.

¹⁶ I will satisfy you with a long life.

I will show you how I will save you.

91:14–16 Rescue me because you love me. Protect me because I'm yours. Answer me when I'm in trouble. Save me, honor me, and satisfy me with long life.

Psalm 92

A psalm; a song; for the day of worship.

- ¹ It is good to give thanks to the LORD,
to make music to praise your name, O Most High.
- ² It is good to announce your mercy in the morning
and your faithfulness in the evening
- ³ on a ten-stringed instrument and a harp
and with a melody on a lyre.

92:1–3 I praise you at dawn and dusk and every hour in between. It's my chance to declare your mercy and faithfulness. I sing and strum melodies to you.

- ⁴ You made me find joy in what you have done, O LORD.
I will sing joyfully about the works of your hands.
- ⁵ How spectacular are your works, O LORD!
How very deep are your thoughts!

92:4–5 Your spectacular handiwork gives me joy! Your thoughts are exceedingly deep!

- ⁶ A stupid person cannot know

and a fool cannot understand

⁷ that wicked people sprout like grass
and all troublemakers blossom like flowers,
only to be destroyed forever.

⁸ But you, O LORD, are highly honored forever.

92:6–8 Stupid people don't grasp that evildoers come and go like grass. But you deserve honor forever.

⁹ Now look at your enemies, O LORD.
Now look at your enemies.
They disappear, and all troublemakers are scattered.

¹⁰ But you make me as strong as a wild bull,
and soothing lotion is poured on me.

¹¹ My eyes gloat over those who spy on me.
My ears hear the cries of evildoers attacking me.

92:9–11 I've seen your enemies scatter even as you soothe me and make me strong. You keep me safe from lurking spies and evildoers on the attack.

¹² Righteous people flourish like palm trees
and grow tall like the cedars in Lebanon.

¹³ They are planted in the LORD's house.
They blossom in our God's courtyards.

¹⁴ Even when they are old, they still bear fruit.
They are always healthy and fresh.

¹⁵ They make it known that the LORD is decent.
He is my rock.
He is never unfair.

92:12–15 I flourish like a palm planted in your courtyard, like a tree that will bear fruit even in old age. Keep me healthy and fresh. My well-being will declare your constant goodness and fairness.

Psalm 93

- ¹ The LORD rules as king! He is clothed with majesty.
The LORD has clothed himself; he has armed himself with power.
The world was set in place; it cannot be moved.
- ² Your throne was set in place a long time ago.
You are eternal.

93:1–2 You rule! You're clothed with majesty and armed with power. You've reigned forever and you'll never cease to exist.

- ³ The ocean rises, O LORD.
The ocean rises with a roar.
The ocean rises with its pounding waves.
- ⁴ The LORD above is mighty—
mightier than the sound of raging water,
mightier than the foaming waves of the sea.

93:3–4 I'm filled with awe as I watch the ocean roar and pound. Yet raging waters are feeble compared to you.

- ⁵ Your written testimonies are completely reliable.
O LORD, holiness is what makes your house beautiful for days without end.

93:5 Your Word is completely reliable. Your holiness makes heaven eternally beautiful.

Psalm 94

- ¹ O LORD, God of vengeance,
O God of vengeance, appear!
- ² Arise, O Judge of the earth.
Give arrogant people what they deserve.

³ How long, O LORD, will wicked people triumph?
How long?

⁴ They ramble.
They speak arrogantly.
All troublemakers brag about themselves.

⁵ They crush your people, O LORD.
They make those who belong to you suffer.
⁶ They kill widows and foreigners, and they murder orphans.
⁷ They say, “The LORD doesn’t see it.
The God of Jacob doesn’t even pay attention to it.”

94:1–7 Judge of the earth, arise and give proud people what they deserve. How long will you let them succeed?

94:4–7 Evildoers boast on and on. They crush your people. They kill widows and foreigners and orphans. Then they say you can’t see them. They claim you aren’t paying attention.

⁸ Pay attention, you stupid people!
When will you become wise, you fools?
⁹ God created ears.
Do you think he can’t hear?
He formed eyes.
Do you think he can’t see?

94:8–9 Do stupid people really think you can’t hear? You created our ears! Do they think you can’t see? You formed our eyes!

¹⁰ He disciplines nations.
Do you think he can’t punish?
He teaches people.
Do you think he doesn’t know anything?

94:10 Do fools actually think you won't punish? You discipline the nations! Do they think you know nothing? You're our teacher!

¹¹ The LORD knows that people's thoughts are pointless.

¹² O LORD, blessed is the person
whom you discipline and instruct from your teachings.

94:11–12 You know the pointlessness of human thoughts. I'm happy when you train and teach me.

¹³ You give him peace and quiet from times of trouble
while a pit is dug to trap wicked people.

¹⁴ The LORD will never desert his people
or abandon those who belong to him.

94:13–14 In troubled times you give me peace and quiet. Because I'm yours you'll never abandon me.

¹⁵ The decisions of judges will again become fair,
and everyone whose motives are decent will pursue justice.[\[99\]](#)

¹⁶ Who will stand up for me against evildoers?
Who will stand by my side against troublemakers?

94:15–16 Come lead our world. Make judges decide fairly and decent people work for justice. Take my side against evildoers.

¹⁷ If the LORD had not come to help me,
my soul would have quickly fallen silent „in death“.

¹⁸ When I said, “My feet are slipping,”
your mercy, O LORD, continued to hold me up.

¹⁹ When I worried about many things,
your assuring words soothed my soul.

²⁰ Are wicked rulers who use the law to do unlawful things

able to be your partners?

²¹ They join forces to take the lives of righteous people.
They condemn innocent people to death.

²² The LORD has become my stronghold.

My God has become my rock of refuge.

²³ He has turned their own wickedness against them.

He will destroy them because of their sins.

The LORD our God will destroy them.

94:17–23 I would have died if you hadn't helped me. I was slipping but you held me up. I was worried but you soothed my soul. You're my rock and my refuge. You turn the sins of the wicked against them.

Psalm 95

¹ Come, let's sing joyfully to the LORD.

Let's shout happily to the rock of our salvation.

² Let's come into his presence with a song of thanksgiving.

Let's shout happily to him with psalms.

³ The LORD is a great God and a great king above all gods.

95:1–3 I shout my joy to you, rock of my salvation! I shout my happiness to you, great King above every so-called god!

⁴ In his hand are the deep places of the earth,
and the mountain peaks are his.

⁵ The sea is his.

He made it, and his hands formed the dry land.

95:4–5 You hold the depths and peaks of the earth in your hand. The land and sea belong to you.
You made all of it.

⁶ Come, let's worship and bow down.

Let's kneel in front of the LORD, our maker,

⁷ because he is our God
and we are the people in his care,
the flock that he leads.

If only you would listen to him today!

95:6–7 I bow and worship you, Lord my maker. You're my God. You lead me as one of your flock.

⁸ “Do not be stubborn like my people were at Meribah,
like the time at Massah in the desert.

⁹ Your ancestors challenged me and tested me there,
although they had seen what I had done.

¹⁰ For 40 years I was disgusted with those people.
So I said, ‘They are a people whose hearts continue to stray.
They have not learned my ways.’

¹¹ That is why I angrily took this solemn oath:
‘They will never enter my place of rest!’”

95:8–11 Your people witnessed your miracles yet they tested you. They constantly strayed from you and refused to learn your ways. Train me to obey you. Give me a heart that follows you. I want to enjoy your rest!

Psalm 96

¹ Sing to the LORD a new song!

Sing to the LORD, all the earth!

² Sing to the LORD! Praise his name!

Day after day announce that the LORD saves his people.

³ Tell people about his glory.

Tell all the nations about his miracles.

96:1–3 My heart has fresh songs of praise for you. Day after day I announce how you save your people. I tell everyone about your glory and miracles.

⁴ The LORD is great!
He should be highly praised.
He should be feared more than all **other** gods
⁵ because all the gods of the nations are idols.
The LORD made the heavens.

96:4–5 You're worthy of higher praise than I know how to bring. You're nothing like false gods.
You're fearsome and real.

⁶ Splendor and majesty are in his presence.
Strength and beauty are in his holy place.

⁷ Give to the LORD, you families of the nations.
Give to the LORD glory and power.
⁸ Give to the LORD the glory he deserves.
Bring an offering, and come into his courtyards.

96:6–8 Splendor and majesty fill your presence. Strength and beauty abound in your holy place. I
promise to give you the glory you deserve.

⁹ Worship the LORD in **his** holy splendor.
Tremble in his presence, all the earth!

96:9 Let me see your holy splendor. I tremble in your presence!

¹⁰ Say to the nations, "The LORD rules as king!"
The earth stands firm; it cannot be moved.
He will judge people fairly.
¹¹ Let the heavens rejoice and the earth be glad.
Let the sea and everything in it roar like thunder.
¹² Let the fields and everything in them rejoice.
Then all the trees in the forest will sing joyfully
¹³ in the LORD's presence because he is coming.
He is coming to judge the earth.
He will judge the world with righteousness

and its people with his truth.

96:10–13 You reign over every human in every nation, judging without favoritism. So let heaven and earth rejoice. Let the sea roar. Let every field and forest sing your arrival. You'll judge the world with righteousness and truth.

Psalm 97

- ¹ The LORD rules as king.
Let the earth rejoice.
Let all the islands be joyful.
- ² Clouds and darkness surround him.
Righteousness and justice are the foundations of his throne.
- ³ Fire spreads ahead of him.
It burns his enemies who surround him.

97:1–3 Because you rule as King I rejoice. You surround yourself with dark clouds. You build your throne on goodness and fairness. You scorch your enemies with purifying fire.

- ⁴ His flashes of lightning light up the world.
The earth sees them and trembles.
- ⁵ The mountains melt like wax in the presence of the LORD,
in the presence of the Lord of the whole earth.

97:4–5 People see you light up the world with lightning and they tremble. Mountains melt in the heat of your presence.

- ⁶ The heavens tell about his righteousness,
and all the people of the world see his glory.
- ⁷ Everyone who worships idols
and brags about false gods will be put to shame.
All the gods will bow to him.
- ⁸ Zion hears about this and rejoices.

The people of Judah are delighted with your judgments, O LORD.
⁹ You, O LORD, the Most High, are above the whole earth.
You are highest. You are above all the gods.

97:6–9 The skies declare your goodness, showing off your glory for everyone to see. Maybe everyone will finally understand the worthlessness of false gods. I rejoice when others discover you're real.
You're the Most High God, Lord over all.

¹⁰ Let those who love the LORD hate evil.
The one who guards the lives of his godly ones
will rescue them from the power of wicked people.
¹¹ Light dawns for righteous people [\[100\]](#)
and joy for those whose motives are decent.
¹² Find joy in the LORD, you righteous people.
Give thanks to him as you remember how holy he is.

97:10–12 You'll make dawn break through my darkness. You'll give me joy in you. Your holiness makes my heart well up with thanks.

Psalm 98

A psalm.

¹ Sing a new song to the LORD
because he has done miraculous things.
His right hand and his holy arm have gained victory for him.
² The LORD has made his salvation known.
He has uncovered his righteousness for the nations to see.
³ He has not forgotten to be merciful and faithful to Israel's descendants.
All the ends of the earth have seen how our God saves **⌋them⌋**.

98:1–3 I sing to celebrate your miraculous acts, the power that assured you of victory. Every nation can see your salvation. They witness your faithfulness to your people.

- ⁴ Shout happily to the LORD, all the earth.
Break out into joyful singing, and make music.
- ⁵ Make music to the LORD with a lyre,
with a lyre and the melody of a psalm,
⁶ with trumpets and the playing of a ram's horn.
Shout happily in the presence of the king, the LORD.

98:4–6 Let the whole world break out in music to you. Let lyres and trumpets make joyful tunes.

- ⁷ Let the sea, everything in it,
the world, and those who live in it roar like thunder.
- ⁸ Let the rivers clap their hands

and the mountains sing joyfully
9 in the LORD's presence
because he is coming to judge the earth.
He will judge the world with justice
and its people with fairness.

98:7–9 The sea roars with worship and rivers clap their hands to you. Mountains sing because you're coming to judge the earth with fairness.

Psalm 99

- ¹ The LORD rules as king.
Let the people tremble.
He is enthroned over the angels.[\[101\]](#)
Let the earth quake.
- ² The LORD is mighty in Zion.
He is high above all people.
- ³ Let them give thanks to your great and fearful name.
- He is holy!

99:1–3 You rule as King. Let everyone tremble! Let the earth quake with respect! You reign over every angel and every human being. I offer thanks to your awesome name. You are holy!

- ⁴ The king's strength is that he loves justice.
You have established fairness.
You have done what is fair and right for Jacob.
- ⁵ Highly honor the LORD our God.
Bow down at his footstool.
- He is holy!

99:4–5 Your love of justice makes you strong. You're always fair and always right. You're worthy of the highest honor and I bow to you. You are holy!

-
- ⁶ Moses and Aaron were among his priests.
Samuel was among those who prayed to him.
They called to the LORD, and he answered them.
⁷ He spoke to them from a column of smoke.
They obeyed his written instructions and the laws that he gave them.
- ⁸ O LORD, our God, you answered them.
You showed them that you are a forgiving God
and that you are a God who punishes their sinful deeds.
- ⁹ Highly honor the LORD our God.
Bow at his holy mountain.
- The LORD our God is holy!

99:6–9 You answered the prayers of Moses and Aaron and Samuel. You spoke to them from a column of smoke and put your laws in writing. You're a God who forgives yet you'll punish the unrepentant. You're worthy of the highest honor. I bow to you. You are holy!

Psalm 100

A psalm of thanksgiving.

- ¹ Shout happily to the LORD, all the earth.
² Serve the LORD cheerfully.
Come into his presence with a joyful song.
³ Realize that the LORD alone is God.
He made us, and we are his.[\[102\]](#)
We are his people and the sheep in his care.

100:1–3 I shout happily to you. I serve you gladly. I enter your presence with a joyful song. Why? Because you alone are God. You made me and I'm yours. I'm one of your flock.

- ⁴ Enter his gates with a song of thanksgiving.
Come into his courtyards with a song of praise.

Give thanks to him; praise his name.

⁵ The LORD is good.

His mercy endures forever.

His faithfulness endures throughout every generation.

100:4–5 I enter your presence with a song of praise and thanksgiving. Why? Because you're always good. Your faithfulness endures forever.

Psalm 101

A psalm by David.

¹ I will sing about mercy and justice.
O LORD, I will make music to praise you.

² I want to understand the path to integrity.
When will you come to me?

I will live in my own home with integrity.

101:2 Help me grasp what integrity is all about. Come and show me! I want to live with integrity toward my family.

³ I will not put anything wicked in front of my eyes.
I hate what unfaithful people do.
I want no part of it.

⁴ I will keep far away from devious minds.
I will have nothing to do with evil.

⁵ I will destroy anyone who secretly slanders his neighbor.
I will not tolerate anyone with a conceited look or arrogant heart.

101:3–5 I want nothing to do with unfaithfulness. I stay far from people who plot evil. I don't tolerate conceit.

⁶ My eyes will be watching the faithful people in the land
so that they may live with me.
The person who lives with integrity will serve me.

⁷ The one who does deceitful things will not stay in my home.
The one who tells lies will not remain in my presence.

⁸ Every morning I will destroy all the wicked people in the land
to rid the LORD's city of all troublemakers.

101:6–8 I’m studying the people around me. I’m on the lookout for faithfulness and failure. I won’t follow the lead of deceivers or liars. I’ll stay far from troublemakers.

Psalm 102

A prayer by someone who is suffering, when he is weary and pours out his troubles in the LORD’s presence.

- ¹ O LORD, hear my prayer,
and let my cry for help come to you.
² Do not hide your face from me when I am in trouble.
Turn your ear toward me.
Answer me quickly when I call.

102:1–2 Hear me when I cry to you for help. Don’t turn away when I’m in trouble.

- ³ My days disappear like smoke.
My bones burn like hot coals.
⁴ My heart is beaten down and withered like grass
because I have forgotten about eating.
⁵ I am nothing but skin and bones
because of my loud groans.

102:3–5 My life is going up in smoke. My bones burn and my heart is beaten down. I’m too sad to eat. I’ve shrunk to skin and bones.

- ⁶ I am like a desert owl,
like an owl living in the ruins.
⁷ I lie awake.
I am like a lonely bird on a rooftop.
⁸ All day long my enemies insult me.
Those who ridicule me use my name as a curse.
⁹ I eat ashes like bread
and my tears are mixed with my drink
¹⁰ because of your hostility and anger,

because you have picked me up and thrown me away.

102:8–10 My enemies use my name to curse. Ashes are all I eat and my tears fall into my cup—all because of your anger. You’ve tossed me into the trash.

¹¹ My days are like a shadow that is getting longer,
and I wither away like grass.

¹² But you, O LORD, remain forever.
You are remembered throughout every generation.

¹³ You will rise and have compassion on Zion,
because it is time to grant a favor to it.
Indeed, the appointed time has come.

102:11–13 I’m dying like grass but you’ll last forever. Soon you’ll rise and show me compassion, because the time to show me favor has finally come.

¹⁴ Your servants value Zion’s stones,
and they pity its rubble.

¹⁵ The nations will fear the LORD’s name.
All the kings of the earth will fear your glory.

¹⁶ When the LORD builds Zion,
he will appear in his glory.

¹⁷ He will turn his attention to the prayers
of those who have been abandoned.
He will not despise their prayers.

¹⁸ This will be written down for a future generation
so that a people yet to be created may praise the LORD:
¹⁹ “The LORD looked down from his holy place high above.
From heaven he looked at the earth.

²⁰ He heard the groans of the prisoners
and set free those who were condemned to death.

²¹ The LORD’s name is announced in Zion

and his praise in Jerusalem
22 when nations and kingdoms gather
to worship the LORD.”

102:16–22 One day you’ll rebuild your people. You’ll hear the prayers of the abandoned. You’ll look down from heaven and see our suffering. You’ll listen closely and hear our groans. You’ll free us from death row. And one day all the world will gather to worship you.

23 He has weakened my strength along the way.
He has reduced ⌋the number of⌋ my days.
24 I said, “My God, don’t take me now in the middle of my life.
Your years ⌋continue on⌋ throughout every generation.

102:23–24 You’ve taken strength from my body and days from my life. Don’t cut me down now.

25 Long ago you laid the foundation of the earth.
Even the heavens are the works of your hands.
26 They will come to an end, but you will still go on.
They will all wear out like clothing.
You will change them like clothes,
and they will be thrown away.
27 But you remain the same, and your life will never end.
28 The children of your servants will go on living ⌋here⌋.
Their descendants will be secure in your presence.”

102:25–28 Long ago you formed the earth and the heavens. One day they’ll be finished, but you’ll live on. This world will wear out like old clothes. You’ll toss it aside, but you’ll live on. And your people will live forever in your presence.

Psalm 103

By David.

1 Praise the LORD, my soul!

Praise his holy name, all that is within me.
² Praise the LORD, my soul,
and never forget all the good he has done:

103:1–2 I praise you with all my might. I'll never forget the good you've done me.

³ He is the one who forgives all your sins,
the one who heals all your diseases,
⁴ the one who rescues your life from the pit,
the one who crowns you with mercy and compassion,
⁵ the one who fills your life with blessings
so that you become young again like an eagle.

⁶ The LORD does what is right and fair
for all who are oppressed.

103:3–6 You forgive my sins and heal my diseases. You rescue me from death and treat me with compassion. You fill my life with blessings and make me young again. You do right on behalf of all the oppressed.

⁷ He let Moses know his ways.
He let the Israelites know the things he had done.
⁸ The LORD is compassionate, merciful, patient,
and always ready to forgive.

⁹ He will not always accuse us of wrong
or be angry with us forever.
¹⁰ He has not treated us as we deserve for our sins
or paid us back for our wrongs.

103:8–10 Be compassionate to me. Be merciful, patient, and quick to forgive. Don't pay me back for my sins or give me what I deserve.

¹¹ As high as the heavens are above the earth—
that is how vast his mercy is toward those who fear him.

¹² As far as the east is from the west—
that is how far he has removed our rebellious acts from himself.

103:11–12 As far as the sky stretches above the earth—that's the vastness of your mercy to me. As far as the east runs from the west—that's how far you've cast away my rebellion.

¹³ As a father has compassion for his children,
so the LORD has compassion for those who fear him.

¹⁴ He certainly knows what we are made of.
He bears in mind that we are dust.

¹⁵ Human life is as short-lived as grass.
It blossoms like a flower in the field.

¹⁶ When the wind blows over the flower, it disappears,
and there is no longer any sign of it.

103:14–16 You know I'm dust and my life is brief. Winds will blow over me and I will disappear.

¹⁷ But from everlasting to everlasting,
the LORD's mercy is on those who fear him.

His righteousness belongs
to their children and grandchildren,
¹⁸ to those who are faithful to his promise,[\[103\]](#)
to those who remember to follow his guiding principles.

103:17–18 Though my life is short your mercy lasts forever—mercy you give to those who live in awe of you. Your righteousness belongs to my children and grandchildren. Each of your promises and principles is a gift to us.

- ¹⁹ The LORD has set his throne in heaven.
His kingdom rules everything.
- ²⁰ Praise the LORD, all his angels,
you mighty beings who carry out his orders
and are ready to obey his spoken orders.
- ²¹ Praise the LORD, all his armies,
his servants who carry out his will.
- ²² Praise the LORD, all his creatures
in all the places of his empire.
Praise the LORD, my soul!

103:19–22 You've established your throne in heaven and you rule everything that exists. Your angels will praise you. Your servants will praise you. Your creatures will praise you. And I too will praise you!

Psalm 104

- ¹ Praise the LORD, my soul!
O LORD my God, you are very great.
You are clothed with splendor and majesty.
- ² You cover yourself with light as though it were a robe.
You stretch out the heavens as though they were curtains.
- ³ You lay the beams of your home in the water.
You use the clouds for your chariot.
You move on the wings of the wind.
- ⁴ You make your angels winds

and your servants flames of fire.

⁵ You set the earth on its foundations
so that it can never be shaken.

104:1–5 Praise you! Praise your splendor and majesty! You wrap yourself in light. You stretch out the heavens. You lay the foundation of an unshakable earth.

⁶ You covered the earth with an ocean as though it were a robe.

Water stood above the mountains
7 and fled because of your threat.
Water ran away at the sound of your thunder.
8 The mountains rose and the valleys sank
to the place you appointed for them.
9 Water cannot cross the boundary you set
and cannot come back to cover the earth.

104:6–9 You covered the earth with water and raised the mountains to tower above the seas. You created peaks and valleys and hold back waters from flooding the earth.

10 You make water gush from springs into valleys.
It flows between the mountains.
11 Every wild animal drinks ַfrom them׃.
Wild donkeys quench their thirst.
12 The birds live by the streams.
They sing among the branches.
13 You water the mountains from your home above.
You fill the earth with the fruits of your labors.
14 You make grass grow for cattle
and make vegetables for humans to use
in order to get food from the ground.
15 You make wine to cheer human hearts,
olive oil to make faces shine,
and bread to strengthen human hearts.

104:10–15 You make springs gush forth to give animals water to drink and birds a place to sing.
You make grass grow for cattle and feed me with every good thing.

16 The LORD's trees, the cedars in Lebanon which he planted,
drink their fill.
17 Birds build their nests in them.
Storks makes their homes in fir trees.
18 The high mountains are for wild goats.

The rocks are a refuge for badgers.

104:16–18 You plant the tallest trees and let them drink from the ground. You create a home on earth for every living thing.

- ¹⁹ He created the moon, which marks the seasons,
and the sun, which knows when to set.
²⁰ He brings darkness, and it is nighttime,
when all the wild animals in the forest come out.
²¹ The young lions roar for their prey
and seek their food from God.
²² When the sun rises,
they gather and lie down in their dens.
²³ Then people go to do their work,
to do their tasks until evening.

104:19–23 You made the moon to mark the seasons and the sun to mark the day. By night young lions get their food from you. By day I arise and work.

- ²⁴ What a large number of things you have made, O LORD!
You made them all by wisdom.
The earth is filled with your creatures.
²⁵ The sea is so big and wide with countless creatures,
living things both large and small.

104:24–25 You made countless things. You wisely created all of them, filling the earth and seas with living things both large and small.

- ²⁶ Ships sail on it,
and Leviathan,[\[104\]](#) which you made, plays in it.
²⁷ All of them look to you to give them their food at the right time.
²⁸ You give it to them, and they gather it up.
You open your hand, and they are filled with blessings.
²⁹ You hide your face, and they are terrified.

You take away their breath, and they die and return to dust.

³⁰ You send out your Spirit, and they are created.

You renew the face of the earth.

104:27–30 All of your creatures look to you for food. At the right time you open your hand of blessing, and when you take away their breath they die. By your Spirit you continually renew the earth.

³¹ May the glory of the LORD endure forever.

May the LORD find joy in what he has made.

³² He looks at the earth, and it trembles.

He touches the mountains, and they smoke.

³³ I will sing to the LORD throughout my life.

I will make music to praise my God as long as I live.

³⁴ May my thoughts be pleasing to him.

I will find joy in the LORD.

³⁵ May sinners vanish from the world.

May there no longer be any wicked people.

Praise the LORD, my soul!

Hallelujah!

104:31–35 May your glory last forever. May you be happy with everything you made. I'll never stop singing to you. I want you to be happy with my joyful thoughts of you. Praise you!

Psalm 105

¹ Give thanks to the LORD.

Call on him.

Make known among the nations what he has done.

² Sing to him.

Make music to praise him.

Meditate on all the miracles he has performed.

³ Brag about his holy name.

Let the hearts of those who seek the LORD rejoice.

- ⁴ Search for the LORD and his strength.
Always seek his presence.
- ⁵ Remember the miracles he performed,
the amazing things he did, and the judgments he pronounced,
⁶ you descendants of his servant Abraham,
you descendants of Jacob, his chosen ones.

105:1–6 I thank you. I call on you. I tell the world what you have done. I make music to you and think hard about the miracles you’ve done for your people. Your amazing works give me reason upon reason to brag about you.

- ⁷ He is the LORD our God.
His judgments are pronounced throughout the earth.
- ⁸ He always remembers his promise, [\[105\]](#)
the word that he commanded for a thousand generations,
⁹ the promise that he made to Abraham,
and his sworn oath to Isaac.
- ¹⁰ He confirmed it as a law for Jacob,
as an everlasting promise to Israel,

105:7–10 You are our God. And you always remember the promises you made long ago.

- ¹¹ by saying, “I will give you the land of Canaan.
It is your share of the inheritance.”
- ¹² While the people of Israel were few in number,
a small group of foreigners living in that land,
¹³ they wandered from nation to nation,
from one kingdom to another.
- ¹⁴ He didn’t permit anyone to oppress them.
He warned kings about them:
¹⁵ “Do not touch my anointed ones
or harm my prophets.”

105:11–15 You promised Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob a homeland—just as you promise me rest. You didn't let anyone oppress your chosen ones.

- ¹⁶ He brought famine to the land.
He took away their food supply.
- ¹⁷ He sent a man ahead of them.
He sent Joseph, who was sold as a slave.
- ¹⁸ They hurt his feet with shackles,
and cut into his neck with an iron collar.
- ¹⁹ The LORD's promise tested him through fiery trials
until his prediction came true.
- ²⁰ The king sent someone to release him.
The ruler of nations set him free.
- ²¹ He made Joseph the master of his palace
and the ruler of all his possessions.
- ²² Joseph trained the king's officers the way he wanted
and taught his respected leaders wisdom.

105:16–22 You brought famine to the land, but you sent Joseph as a protector and provider. You allowed him to be sold into slavery, but you raised him up as a ruler of Egypt. You tested him with fiery trials, but your promise still held true.

- ²³ Then Israel came to Egypt.
Jacob lived as a foreigner in the land of Ham.
- ²⁴ The LORD made his people grow rapidly in number
and stronger than their enemies.
- ²⁵ He changed their minds so that they hated his people,
and they dealt treacherously with his servants.
- ²⁶ He sent his servant Moses, and he sent Aaron, whom he had chosen.
- ²⁷ They displayed his miraculous signs among them
and did amazing things in the land of Ham.
- ²⁸ He sent darkness and made 「their land」 dark.
They did not rebel against his orders.
- ²⁹ He turned their water into blood
and caused their fish to die.

- ³⁰ He made their land swarm with frogs,
even in the kings' bedrooms.
- ³¹ He spoke, and swarms of flies and gnats
infested their whole territory.
- ³² He gave them hail and lightning
instead of rain throughout their land.
- ³³ He struck their grapevines and fig trees
and smashed the trees in their territory.
- ³⁴ He spoke, and countless locusts and grasshoppers came.
³⁵ They devoured all the plants in the land.
They devoured the crops in the fields.
- ³⁶ He killed all the firstborn sons,
the first ones born in the land when their fathers were young.

105:24–36 You made your people many. You made them strong. When their enemies turned on them, you sent Moses and Aaron as deliverers. You sent darkness and plagues to defend your people—blood and frogs, flies and gnats, hail and lightning, locusts and death.

- ³⁷ He brought Israel out with silver and gold,
and no one among his tribes stumbled.
- ³⁸ The Egyptians were terrified of Israel,
so they were glad when Israel left.
- ³⁹ He spread out a cloud as a protective covering
and a fire to light up the night.
- ⁴⁰ The Israelites asked, and he brought them quail
and filled them with bread from heaven.
- ⁴¹ He opened a rock, and water gushed
and flowed like a river through the dry places.

105:37–41 You freed Israel from slavery. You sent them into the desert loaded down with gifts of silver and gold from their slave masters. You led them through the wilderness with a cloud by day and a fire by night. You fed them with quail and manna. You quenched their thirst with water from a rock. You met their every need.

- ⁴² He remembered his holy promise to his servant Abraham.
- ⁴³ He brought his people out with joy,

his chosen ones with a song of joy.

- ⁴⁴ He gave them the lands of other nations,
and they inherited what others had worked for
⁴⁵ so that they would obey his laws
and follow his teachings.

Hallelujah!

105:42–45 You'll always remember your promises to your people. You'll always save us with joy.
You'll always bring us home and teach us to obey you. Hallelujah!

Psalm 106

- ¹ Hallelujah!

Give thanks to the LORD because he is good,
because his mercy endures forever.

- ² Who can speak about all the mighty things the LORD has done?
Who can announce all the things for which he is worthy of praise?

106:1–2 Hallelujah! Thanks for your goodness and unending mercy. Your mighty acts are too
awesome for words.

- ³ Blessed are those who defend justice
and do what is right at all times.

- ⁴ Remember me, O LORD, when you show favor to your people.
Come to help me with your salvation
⁵ so that I may see the prosperity of your chosen ones,
find joy in our people's happiness,
and brag with the people who belong to you.

106:3–5 I'll live in your blessing when I defend justice and do right. Save me so I can share in your
people's happiness and brag about what you've done.

⁶ We have sinned, and so did our ancestors.

We have done wrong.

We are guilty.

⁷ When our ancestors were in Egypt,

they gave no thought to your miracles.

They did not remember your numerous acts of mercy,
so they rebelled at the sea, the Red Sea.

⁸ He saved them because of his reputation

so that he could make his mighty power known.

⁹ He angrily commanded the Red Sea, and it dried up.

He led them through deep water as though it were a desert.

¹⁰ He rescued them from the power of the one who hated them.

He rescued them from the enemy.

¹¹ Water covered their adversaries.

Not one Egyptian survived.

106:7–11 Back in Egypt your people forgot your mercy and miracles. They halted when you commanded them to move on. They couldn't see your path to freedom. But you made a way through the Red Sea. Help me always remember your miracles!

¹² Then our ancestors believed what he said.

They sang his praise.

¹³ They quickly forgot what he did.

They did not wait for his advice.

106:12–13 Your people saw what you did and believed. So they sang your praises. But they quickly forgot your mighty acts—and just as quickly they rebelled against you. Help me always remember your powerful kindness toward me!

¹⁴ They had an unreasonable desire „for food„ in the wilderness.

In the desert they tested God.

¹⁵ He gave them what they asked for.

He „also„ gave them a degenerative disease.

¹⁶ In the camp certain men became envious of Moses.

They also became envious of Aaron, the LORD's holy one.

¹⁷ The ground split open and swallowed Dathan.
It buried Abiram's followers.

¹⁸ A fire broke out among their followers.
Flames burned up wicked people.

¹⁹ At Mount Horeb they made a statue of a calf.
They worshiped an idol made of metal.

²⁰ They traded their glorious God^[106]
for the statue of a bull that eats grass.

²¹ They forgot God, their savior,
the one who did spectacular things in Egypt,

106:19–21 Your people traded their glorious God for a metal statue of a grass-eating bull. They forgot you had spectacularly saved them. Help me always remember you've saved me!

²² miracles in the land of Ham,
and terrifying things at the Red Sea.

²³ God said he was going to destroy them,
but Moses, his chosen one, stood in his way
to prevent him from exterminating them.

²⁴ They refused to enter the pleasant land.
They did not believe what he said.

²⁵ They complained in their tents.
They did not obey the LORD.

²⁶ Raising his hand, he swore
that he would kill them in the wilderness,

²⁷ kill their descendants among the nations,
and scatter them throughout various lands.

²⁸ They joined in worshiping the god Baal while they were at Peor,
and they ate what was sacrificed to the dead.

106:24–28 Your people refused to enter the pleasant land you had sworn to them—all because they didn't believe your promises. Instead they grumbled and disobeyed. They infuriated you by bowing to the false god Baal. Help me always worship you as God!

- ²⁹ They infuriated God by what they did,
and a plague broke out among them.
- ³⁰ Then Phinehas stood between God and the people,
and the plague was stopped.
- ³¹ Because of this, Phinehas was considered righteous forever,
throughout every generation.
- ³² They made God angry by the water at Meribah.
Things turned out badly for Moses because of what they did,
³³ since they made him bitter so that he spoke recklessly.
- ³⁴ They did not destroy the people as the LORD had told them.
³⁵ Instead, they intermarried with other nations.
They learned to do what other nations did,
³⁶ and they worshiped their idols,
which became a trap for them.
- ³⁷ They sacrificed their sons and daughters to demons.
³⁸ They shed innocent blood,
the blood of their own sons and daughters
whom they sacrificed to the idols of Canaan.
The land became polluted with blood.

106:35–38 Your people married with people who didn't know you. They worshiped their neighbors' idols. They even sacrificed their children to false gods. Help me always obey your commands!

- ³⁹ They became filthy because of what they did.
They behaved like prostitutes.
- ⁴⁰ The LORD burned with anger against his own people.
He was disgusted with those who belonged to him.
- ⁴¹ He handed them over to other nations,
and those who hated them ruled them.
- ⁴² Their enemies oppressed them
and made them subject to their power.
- ⁴³ He rescued them many times,
but they continued to plot rebellion against him
and to sink deeper because of their sin.

106:40–43 Your anger burned against your people and you handed them over to other nations. You rescued your people over and over, but they continued to rebel against you. Help me to make a clean break with sin!

⁴⁴ He saw that they were suffering
when he heard their cry for help.

⁴⁵ He remembered his promise^[107] to them.
In keeping with his rich mercy, he changed his plans.

⁴⁶ He let them find compassion
from all those who held them captive.

⁴⁷ Rescue us, O LORD our God, and gather us from the nations
so that we may give thanks to your holy name
and make your praise our glory.

⁴⁸ Thanks be to the LORD God of Israel
from everlasting to everlasting.
Let all the people say amen.

Hallelujah!

106:43–48 You saw your people sinking and heard their cries. You remembered your promise and showed them compassion. Thanks to you now and forevermore! Amen! Hallelujah!

BOOK FIVE

(Psalms 107–150)

Psalm 107

¹ Give thanks to the LORD because he is good,
because his mercy endures forever.

² Let the people the LORD defended repeat these words.
They are the people he defended from the power of their enemies
³ and gathered from other countries,
from the east and from the west,
from the north and from the south.

⁴ They wandered around the desert on a deserted road
without finding an inhabited city.

⁵ They were hungry and thirsty.
They began to lose hope.

⁶ In their distress they cried out to the LORD.
He rescued them from their troubles.

⁷ He led them on a road that went straight to an
inhabited city.

107:1–7 Thanks for your unending goodness and mercy. We were desert wanderers when you found us hungry, thirsty, and out of hope. You heard our cries and saved us! You led us to everything we needed to live.

⁸ Let them give thanks to the LORD because of his mercy.
He performed his miracles for Adam's descendants.

⁹ He gave plenty to drink to those who were thirsty.
He filled those who were hungry with good food.

¹⁰ Those who lived in the dark, in death's shadow were prisoners in misery.
They were held in iron chains

- ¹¹ because they had rebelled against God's words
and had despised the advice given by the Most High.
¹² So he humbled them with hard work.
They fell down, but no one was there to help them.
¹³ In their distress they cried out to the LORD.
He saved them from their troubles.
¹⁴ He brought them out of the dark, out of death's shadow.
He broke apart their chains.

107:8–14 Thanks for your mercy and miracles. We were prisoners of misery, living in death's shadow. You kept us in chains for rebelling against your words. You humbled us with hard work. But you heard our cries and saved us! You brought us out of the darkness.

- ¹⁵ Let them give thanks to the LORD because of his mercy.
He performed his miracles for Adam's descendants.
¹⁶ He shattered bronze gates
and cut iron bars in two.
¹⁷ Fools suffered because of their disobedience
and because of their crimes.
¹⁸ All food was disgusting to them,
and they came near death's gates.
¹⁹ In their distress they cried out to the LORD.
He saved them from their troubles.
²⁰ He sent his message and healed them.
He rescued them from the grave.

107:15–20 Thanks for your mercy and miracles. We were fools suffering for our disobedience and crimes. We couldn't stomach the sight of food and we came close to dying. But you heard our cries and saved us! You healed us and spared us from the grave.

- ²¹ Let them give thanks to the LORD because of his mercy.
He performed his miracles for Adam's descendants.
²² Let them bring songs of thanksgiving as their sacrifice.
Let them tell in joyful songs what he has done.
²³ Those who sail on the sea in ships,
who do business on the high seas,

- ²⁴ have seen what the LORD can do,
the miracles he performed in the depths of the sea.
²⁵ He spoke, and a storm began to blow,
and it made the waves rise high.
²⁶ The sailors aboard ship rose toward the sky.
They plunged into the depths.
Their courage melted in the face of disaster.
²⁷ They reeled and staggered like drunks,
and all their skills as sailors became useless.
²⁸ In their distress they cried out to the LORD.
He led them from their troubles.
²⁹ He made the storm calm down,
and the waves became still.
³⁰ The sailors were glad that the storm was quiet.
He guided them to the harbor they had longed for.

107:21–30 Thanks for your mercy and miracles. We were sailing the sea when a storm began to blow. Our ship rose toward the sky and plunged to the depths. We staggered like drunks and our sailing skills became useless. But you heard our cries and saved us! You stilled the sea and guided us to safe harbor.

- ³¹ Let them give thanks to the LORD because of his mercy.
He performed his miracles for Adam's descendants.
³² Let them glorify him when the people are gathered for worship.
Let them praise him in the company of respected leaders.

107:31–32 Thanks for your mercy and miracles. We promise to praise you whenever we gather.

- ³³ He changes rivers into a desert,
springs into thirsty ground,
³⁴ and fertile ground into a layer of salt
because of the wickedness of the people living there.
³⁵ He changes deserts into lakes
and dry ground into springs.
³⁶ There he settles those who are hungry,
and they build cities to live in.

³⁷ They plant in fields and vineyards
that produce crops.

³⁸ He blesses them, and their numbers multiply,
and he does not allow a shortage of cattle.

107:33–38 You drive the wicked from the land and make us a place to live. You turn dry ground
into springs and give us crops and cattle. You bless us and we multiply.

³⁹ They became few in number and were humiliated
because of oppression, disaster, and sorrow.

⁴⁰ He poured contempt on their influential people
and made them stumble around in a pathless desert.

⁴¹ But now he lifts needy people high
above suffering and makes their families like flocks.

⁴² Decent people will see this and rejoice,
but all the wicked people will shut their mouths.

107:39–42 Our pride turned into humiliation. We suffered oppression, disaster, and sorrow. But
you lift the needy high above suffering. You make us multiply again. Good people will see this and
be glad.

⁴³ Let those who “think” they are wise

pay attention to these things
so that they may understand the LORD 's blessings.

107:43 Make me truly wise! I'll pay attention to the past so I can understand your blessings today.

Psalm 108^[108]

A song; a psalm by David.

- ¹ My heart is confident, O God.
I want to sing and make music even with my soul.^[109]
² Wake up, harp and lyre!
I want to wake up at dawn.
³ I want to give thanks to you among the people, O LORD.
I want to make music to praise you among the nations

108:1–3 In you my heart swells with confidence. I get up at dawn to worship. Let everyone everywhere hear!

- ⁴ because your mercy is higher than the heavens.
Your truth reaches the skies.
⁵ May you be honored above the heavens, O God.
Let your glory extend over the whole earth.

108:4–5 Your mercy and truth reach past the heavens. Your glory shines to the whole earth.
Receive the honor you deserve!

- ⁶ Save **us** with your powerful hand, and answer us
so that those who are dear to you may be rescued.

⁷ God has promised the following through his holiness:
“I will triumph!
I will divide Shechem.

I will measure the valley of Succoth.

108:7 Your perfect holiness guarantees your promises. Thanks for every blessing you've sworn to your people!

⁸ Gilead is mine.

Manasseh is mine.

Ephraim is the helmet on my head.

Judah is my scepter.

⁹ Moab is my washtub.

I will throw my shoe over Edom.

I will shout in triumph over Philistia.”

¹⁰ Who will bring me into the fortified city?

Who will lead me to Edom?

¹¹ Isn't it you, O God, who rejected us?

Isn't it you, O God, who refused to accompany our armies?

¹² Give us help against the enemy

because human assistance is worthless.

¹³ With God we will display great strength.

He will trample our enemies.

108:10–13 You alone will lead me in triumph. No human can help me. Show me your strength!

Psalm 109

For the choir director; a psalm by David.

¹ O God, whom I praise, do not turn a deaf ear to me.

² Wicked and deceitful people have opened their mouths against me.

They speak against me with lying tongues.

³ They surround me with hateful words.

They fight against me for no reason.

⁴ In return for my love, they accuse me,

but I pray for them.[\[110\]](#)

⁵ They reward me with evil instead of good

and with hatred instead of love.

109:1–5 Evildoers and liars speak hateful words against me. I show them love yet they accuse me. I pray for them but they pay me back with evil.

⁶ “I said, “Appoint the evil one to oppose him.

Let Satan stand beside him.

⁷ When he stands trial,

let him be found guilty.

Let his prayer be considered sinful.

⁸ Let his days be few “in number”.

Let someone else take his position.

109:7–8 I trust you to act with justice at my enemy’s trial. Open my eyes to my sins large and small so I can see them and turn from them.

⁹ “Let his children become fatherless and his wife a widow.

¹⁰ Let his children wander around and beg.

Let them seek help far from their ruined homes.

¹¹ Let a creditor take everything he owns.

Let strangers steal what he has worked for.

¹² Let no one be kind to him anymore.

Let no one show any pity to his fatherless children.

109:9–12 Teach me to show compassion to the fatherless and widowed and needy. Train me to imitate your kindness.

¹³ Let his descendants be cut off
and their family name be wiped out by the next generation.

¹⁴ Let the LORD remember the guilt of his ancestors
and not wipe out his mother’s sin.

¹⁵ Let their guilt and sin always remain on record
in front of the LORD.

Let the LORD remove every memory of him^[111] from the earth,

¹⁶ because he did not remember to be kind.

“He drove oppressed, needy,
and brokenhearted people to their graves.

¹⁷ He loved to put curses └on others┐,
so he, too, was cursed.
He did not like to bless └others┐,
so he never received a blessing.

109:16–17 Prompt me to constant acts of kindness. Teach me to show mercy to the oppressed and needy and brokenhearted. Make me a blessing to everyone I encounter.

¹⁸ He wore cursing as though it were clothing,
so cursing entered his body like water
and his bones like oil.

¹⁹ Let cursing be his clothing,
a belt he always wears.”

²⁰ This is how the LORD rewards those who accuse me,
those who say evil things against me.

²¹ O LORD Almighty, deal with me out of the goodness of your name.
Rescue me because of your mercy.

²² I am oppressed and needy.
I can feel the pain in my heart.

²³ I fade away like a lengthening shadow.
I have been shaken off like a grasshopper.

²⁴ My knees give way because I have been fasting.
My body has become lean, without any fat.

109:20–24 Pain pierces my heart and my knees wobble. Grief starves my body. So treat me with your goodness. Rescue me because of your mercy.

²⁵ I have become the victim of my enemies’ insults.
They look at me and shake their heads.

²⁶ Help me, O LORD my God.
Save me because of your mercy.

- ²⁷ Then they will know that this is your doing,
that you, O LORD, are the one who saved me.
- ²⁸ They may curse, but you will bless.
Let those who attack me be ashamed, but let me rejoice.

109:25–28 My enemies hurl insults at me. But when you save me they'll know you've come to my side. Bless me despite their curses. Let their attacks become their shame.

- ²⁹ Let those who accuse me wear disgrace as though it were clothing.
Let them be wrapped in their shame as though it were a robe.
- ³⁰ With my mouth I will give many thanks to the LORD.
I will praise him among many people,
³¹ because he stands beside needy people
to save them from those who would condemn them to death.

109:30–31 I'll shout my thanks so everyone can hear. You side with the needy and save them from death.

Psalm 110

A psalm by David.

- ¹ The LORD said to my Lord,
“Sit in the highest position in heaven
until I make your enemies your footstool.”
- ² The LORD will extend your powerful scepter from Zion.
Rule your enemies who surround you.

110:1–2 You're seated at the highest position in heaven. You make your enemies a footstool and extend your reign in every direction. Let me gaze on your holy splendor.

- ³ Your people will volunteer when you call up your army.

Your young people will come to you in holy splendor
like dew in the early morning.[\[112\]](#)

⁴ The LORD has taken an oath and will not change his mind:
“You are a priest forever, in the way Melchizedek was a priest.”

⁵ The Lord is at your right side.
He will crush kings on the day of his anger.
⁶ He will pass judgment on the nations
and fill them with dead bodies.
Throughout the earth he will crush their heads.
⁷ He will drink from the brook along the road.
He will hold his head high.

110:4–7 The Lord’s promise to his chosen one will not change: You’ll be a priest forever. You’ll crush kings and pass judgment on the nations. You’ll hold your head high in victory.
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Psalm 111[\[113\]](#)

¹ Hallelujah!

I will give thanks to the LORD with all my heart
in the company of decent people and in the congregation.

² The LORD’s deeds are spectacular.
They should be studied by all who enjoy them.

³ His work is glorious and majestic.
His righteousness continues forever.

111:1–3 Your spectacular deeds command my attention. I enjoy studying your glorious and majestic work. Hallelujah!

⁴ He has made his miracles unforgettable.
The LORD is merciful and compassionate.

- ⁵ He provides food for those who fear him.
He always remembers his promise.[\[114\]](#)
- ⁶ He has revealed the power of his works to his people
by giving them the lands of other nations as an inheritance.
- ⁷ His works are done with truth and justice.
All his guiding principles are trustworthy.

111:3–7 Your goodness lasts forever and your miracles are unforgettable. You feed people who live with awe toward you. You do your work with truth and justice.

- ⁸ They last forever and ever.
They are carried out with truth and decency.
- ⁹ He has sent salvation to his people.
He has ordered that his promise should continue forever.
His name is holy and terrifying.

111:7–9 I can always count on your principles. They last forever like you. You save your people and never stop keeping your promises.

- ¹⁰ The fear of the LORD is the beginning of wisdom.
Good sense is shown by everyone who follows „God’s guiding principles.“
His praise continues forever.

111:10 I’ve begun to learn wisdom when I live in awe of you. Your principles give me good sense.

Psalm 112[\[115\]](#)

- ¹ Hallelujah!

Blessed is the person who fears the LORD and is happy to obey his commands.

- ² His descendants will grow strong on the earth.
The family of a decent person will be blessed.
-

112:1–2 I live in your blessing as I happily follow your commands. My children grow strong and you show kindness to my family.

³ Wealth and riches will be in his home.

His righteousness continues forever.

⁴ Light will shine in the dark for a decent person.

He is merciful, compassionate, and fair.

⁵ All goes well for the person who is generous and lends willingly.

He earns an honest living.

112:3–5 You're the source of my wealth. Train me to be merciful, compassionate, and fair. Open doors for me to be generous and do honest work.

⁶ He will never fail.

A righteous person will always be remembered.

⁷ He is not afraid of bad news.

His heart remains secure, full of confidence in the LORD.

⁸ His heart is steady, and he is not afraid.

In the end he will look triumphantly at his enemies.

112:6–8 Because of you I'll never really fail. I don't fear bad news because my heart stays confident in you. You sweep away my worries.

⁹ He gives freely to poor people.

His righteousness continues forever.

His head is raised in honor.

112:9 When I give freely to the poor, you'll make my good acts endure. You'll raise my head in honor.

¹⁰ The wicked person sees this and becomes angry.

He angrily grits his teeth and disappears.

The hope that wicked people have will vanish.

Psalm 113

¹ Hallelujah!

You servants of the LORD, praise him.
Praise the name of the LORD.

² Thank the name of the LORD now and forever.

³ From where the sun rises to where the sun sets,
the name of the LORD should be praised.

113:1–3 Let all your servants praise you now and forever. Let people everywhere praise your name.

⁴ The LORD is high above all the nations.
His glory is above the heavens.

⁵ Who is like the LORD our God?
He is seated on his high throne.

113:4–5 You're more glorious than anything in heaven or on earth. No one compares to you.

⁶ He bends down to look at heaven and earth.

⁷ He lifts the poor from the dust.
He lifts the needy from a garbage heap.

⁸ He seats them with influential people,
with the influential leaders of his people.

113:5–8 You're seated on high, yet you stoop to lift the poor out of the dust. You honor the needy and make them equals with influential people. Teach me your kind grace!

⁹ He makes a woman who is in a childless home a joyful mother.

Hallelujah!

Psalm 114

¹ When Israel left Egypt,
when Jacob's family left people who spoke a foreign language,

² Judah became his holy place and Israel became

his kingdom.

³ The Red Sea looked at this and ran away.

The Jordan River turned back.

⁴ The mountains jumped like rams.

The hills jumped like lambs.

114:1–4 You rescued your people from slavery in Egypt. You led them into your holy land. You made the Red Sea and the Jordan River turn back. You made the mountains and the hills jump.

⁵ Red Sea, why did you run away?

Jordan River, what made you turn back?

⁶ Mountains, what made you jump like rams?

Hills, what made you jump like lambs?

⁷ Earth, tremble in the presence of the Lord,
in the presence of the God of Jacob.

⁸ He turns a rock into a pool filled with water
and turns flint into a spring flowing with water.

114:7–8 The earth recognizes you as Lord and trembles before you. You turn rock into pools of water. You make flint into flowing springs.

Psalm 115

¹ Don't give glory to us, O LORD.

Don't give glory to us.

Instead, give glory to your name because of your mercy and faithfulness.

115:1 Don't give me even a bit of glory. You deserve it all. Your mercy and faithfulness are boundless.

² Why should other nations say, "Where is their God?"

³ Our God is in heaven.

He does whatever he wants.

115:2–3 Others wonder where you are. But beyond any doubt I know you're in heaven. You do whatever you wish.

- ⁴ Their idols are made of silver and gold.
They were made by human hands.[\[116\]](#)
⁵ They have mouths, but they cannot speak.
They have eyes, but they cannot see.
⁶ They have ears, but they cannot hear.
They have noses, but they cannot smell.
⁷ They have hands, but they cannot feel.
They have feet, but they cannot walk.
They cannot **even** make a sound with their throats.
⁸ Those who make idols end up like them.
So does everyone who trusts them.

115:4–8 Idols made by human hands can't speak or see. They can't smell or feel. They can't walk or make a noise. If I serve false gods I'll end up as senseless as the idols I worship.

- ⁹ Israel, trust the LORD.
He is your helper and your shield.
¹⁰ Descendants of Aaron, trust the LORD.
He is your helper and your shield.
¹¹ If you fear the LORD, trust the LORD.
He is your helper and your shield.
¹² The LORD, who is **always** thinking about us, will bless us.
He will bless the descendants of Israel.
He will bless the descendants of Aaron.
¹³ He will bless those who fear the LORD,
from the least important to the most important.

115:9–13 I'll trust in you, my helper and shield. I fear and trust you. I count on you to remember me and bless me and my children. You bless everyone who respects you. You don't care whether the world thinks they're important or ordinary.

- ¹⁴ May the LORD continue to bless you and your children.
¹⁵ You will be blessed by the LORD, the maker of heaven and earth.

- ¹⁶ The highest heaven belongs to the LORD,
but he has given the earth to the descendants of Adam.
- ¹⁷ Those who are dead do not praise the LORD,
nor do those who go into the silence of the grave.
- ¹⁸ But we will thank the LORD now and forever.

Hallelujah!

115:14–18 I boldly believe you will bless me and my family. Heaven belongs to you and you entrust the world to our care. We'll thank you now and forever! Hallelujah!

Psalm 116

- ¹ I love the LORD because he hears my voice, my pleas for mercy.
- ² I will call on him as long as I live
because he turns his ear toward me.

116:1–2 I love you because you hear my desperate pleas. I keep calling on you because you listen.

- ³ The ropes of death became tangled around me.
The horrors of the grave took hold of me.
I experienced pain and agony.
- ⁴ But I kept calling on the name of the LORD :
“Please, LORD, rescue me!”
- ⁵ The LORD is merciful and righteous.
Our God is compassionate.
- ⁶ The LORD protects defenseless people.
When I was weak, he saved me.

116:3–6 I was tangled in death and overcome with horror. But I begged you to rescue me and you showed me compassion. You saved me at my weakest.

- ⁷ Be at peace again, my soul,
because the LORD has been good to you.

⁸ You saved me from death.

You saved my eyes from tears and my feet from stumbling.

⁹ I will walk in the LORD's presence in this world of the living.

116:7-9 I'm at peace because you did good to me. You dried my tears and steadied my feet. I'll walk in your presence as long as I live.

¹⁰ I kept my faith even when I said,
"I am suffering terribly."

¹¹ I also said when I was panic-stricken,
"Everyone is undependable."

116:10-11 I kept trusting you even when I lamented my terrible suffering. I panicked when I couldn't count on anyone else.

¹² How can I repay the LORD
for all the good that he has done for me?

¹³ I will take the cup of salvation
and call on the name of the LORD.

¹⁴ I will keep my vows to the LORD
in the presence of all his people.

¹⁵ Precious in the sight of the LORD
is the death of his faithful ones.

116:12-15 How can I repay your amazing goodness? I'll gratefully accept your saving grace and keep calling on you. Everyone will see me keep my promises to you. My death will open the door to your presence.

¹⁶ O LORD, I am indeed your servant.
I am your servant,
the son of your female servant.
You have freed me from my chains.

¹⁷ I will bring a song of thanksgiving to you as a sacrifice.
I will call on the name of the LORD.

¹⁸ I will keep my vows to the LORD
in the presence of all his people,
¹⁹ in the courtyards of the LORD 's house,
in the middle of Jerusalem.

Hallelujah!

116:16–19 Because you loosed my chains I'll always be your servant. I'll sing thanks to you and live close to you always. Hallelujah!

Psalm 117

¹ Praise the LORD, all you nations!
Praise him, all you people of the world!
² His mercy toward us is powerful.
The LORD 's faithfulness endures forever.

Hallelujah!

117:1–2 I praise your powerful mercy! I praise your unending faithfulness! Hallelujah!

Psalm 118

¹ Give thanks to the LORD because he is good,
because his mercy endures forever.
² Israel should say,
“His mercy endures forever.”
³ The descendants of Aaron should say,
“His mercy endures forever.”
⁴ Those who fear the LORD should say,
“His mercy endures forever.”

118:1–4 Thanks for your goodness and unending mercy. I'll say it once and I'll say it again: “Your mercy endures forever.”

⁵ During times of trouble I called on the LORD.

The LORD answered me and set me free from all of them.

⁶ The LORD is on my side.

I am not afraid.

What can mortals do to me?

118:5–6 I called on you when I was in trouble. You showed that you're on my side. How can I ever again be afraid of mere people?

⁷ The LORD is on my side as my helper.

I will see the defeat of those who hate me.

⁸ It is better to depend on the LORD

than to trust mortals.

⁹ It is better to depend on the LORD

than to trust influential people.

118:8–9 It's better to depend on you than trust people—even people with obvious power.

¹⁰ All the nations surrounded me,

but armed with the name of the LORD, I defeated them.

¹¹ They surrounded me. Yes, they surrounded me,

but armed with the name of the LORD, I defeated them.

¹² They swarmed around me like bees,

but they were extinguished like burning thornbushes.

So armed with the name of the LORD, I defeated them.

¹³ They pushed hard to make me fall,

but the LORD helped me.

118:10–13 My enemies swarm around me like bees but you extinguish them. They push me hard but you hold me steady.

¹⁴ The LORD is my strength and my song.

He is my savior.

¹⁵ The sound of joyful singing and victory is heard

in the tents of righteous people.
The right hand of the LORD displays strength.

¹⁶ The right hand of the LORD is held high.
The right hand of the LORD displays strength.

¹⁷ I will not die,
but I will live and tell what the LORD has done.

118:15–17 I joyfully sing songs of victory because you showed your strength. You keep me alive to tell others what you've done.

¹⁸ The LORD disciplined me severely,
but he did not allow me to be killed.

¹⁹ Open the gates of righteousness for me.
I will go through them and give thanks to the LORD.

²⁰ This is the gate of the LORD
through which righteous people will enter.

²¹ I give thanks to you,
because you have answered me.
You are my savior.

118:18–21 You let me be struck down but you didn't allow me to die. Let me come close to you so I can thank you. You're my Savior!

²² The stone that the builders rejected
has become the cornerstone.

²³ The LORD is responsible for this,
and it is amazing for us to see.

²⁴ This is the day the LORD has made.
Let's rejoice and be glad today!

118:22–24 Builders rejected your hand-carved stone. But you made it the cornerstone of your work. You amaze me! I'll rejoice because you made this day.

²⁵ We beg you, O LORD, save us!
We beg you, O LORD, give us success!

118:25 I beg you to save me. I beg you to give me success!

²⁶ Blessed is the one who comes in the name of the LORD.
We bless you from the LORD 's house.
²⁷ The LORD is God, and he has given us light.

- March in a festival procession
with branches to the horns of the altar.
- ²⁸ You are my God, and I give thanks to you.
My God, I honor you highly.
- ²⁹ Give thanks to the LORD because he is good,
because his mercy endures forever.

118:27–29 You're my God and you've given me light. I'll march into your presence to say thanks and to honor you above everything else. Thanks for your goodness and unending mercy!

Psalm 119^[117]

- ¹ Blessed are those whose lives have integrity,
those who follow the teachings of the LORD.

119:1 When I follow your teachings I live in your blessing.

- ² Blessed are those who obey his written instructions.
They wholeheartedly search for him.
- ³ They do nothing wrong.
They follow his directions.
- ⁴ You have commanded
that your guiding principles be carefully followed.
- ⁵ I pray that my ways may become firmly established
so that I can obey your laws.

119:2–5 You wrote down your instructions so I could understand them. You command me to follow your principles carefully. Make me unwavering in obeying you.

- ⁶ Then I will never feel ashamed
when I study all your commandments.
- ⁷ I will give thanks to you
as I learn your regulations, which are based on your righteousness.
- ⁸ I will obey your laws.

Never abandon me.

119:7–8 Thank you for teaching me your rules, ways of living based on your own righteousness.
Don't abandon me as I obey you.

- ⁹ How can a young person keep his life pure?
 He can do it by holding on to your word.
- ¹⁰ I wholeheartedly searched for you.
 Do not let me wander away from your commandments.

119:9–10 How can I keep pure? By holding tight to your Word. I searched hard for you. Don't let me lose sight of you now.

- ¹¹ I have treasured your promise in my heart
 so that I may not sin against you.
- ¹² Thanks be to you, O LORD.
 Teach me your laws.
- ¹³ With my lips I have repeated
 every regulation that comes from your mouth.

119:11–13 I keep reminding myself of your promises to keep from sinning against you.

- ¹⁴ I find joy in the way shown by your written instructions
 more than I find joy in all kinds of riches.
- ¹⁵ I want to reflect on your guiding principles
 and study your ways.
- ¹⁶ Your laws make me happy.
 I never forget your word.

119:14–16 Your instructions give me more joy than anything else in life. The more I know of your laws the happier I become.

- ¹⁷ Be kind to me so that I may live
 and hold on to your word.
- ¹⁸ Uncover my eyes

- so that I may see the miraculous things in your teachings.
- ¹⁹ I am a foreigner in this world.
Do not hide your commandments from me.
- ²⁰ My soul is overwhelmed with endless longing for
your regulations.

119:18–20 Open my eyes to your miraculous teachings. I can't understand them without your help.
My heart aches for your instructions.

- ²¹ You threaten arrogant people, who are condemned
and wander away from your commandments.
- ²² Remove the insults and contempt that have fallen on me
because I have obeyed your written instructions.
- ²³ Even though influential people plot against me,
I reflect on your laws.
- ²⁴ Indeed, your written instructions make me happy.
They are my best friends.

119:22–24 People mock me because I follow your teachings. But I won't let them scare me away
from your laws. Your Word is my best friend.

- ²⁵ I am close to death.
Give me a new life as you promised.
- ²⁶ I told you what I have done, and you answered me.
Teach me your laws.
- ²⁷ Help me understand your guiding principles
so that I may reflect on your miracles.
- ²⁸ I am drowning in tears.
Strengthen me as you promised.

119:25–28 When I'm close to death, I'll cling to your promise of new life. When I'm drowning in
tears, I'll look for your strength.

- ²⁹ Turn me away from a life of lies.
Graciously provide me with your teachings.

- ³⁰ I have chosen a life of faithfulness.
I have set your regulations in front of me.
- ³¹ I have clung tightly to your written instructions.
O LORD, do not let me be put to shame.

119:29–31 Don't let me get caught up in lies. Teach me to choose faithfulness instead. I cling tightly to your Word. Don't let others shame me.

- ³² I will eagerly pursue your commandments
because you continue to increase my understanding.

- ³³ Teach me, O LORD, how to live by your laws,
and I will obey them to the end.
- ³⁴ Help me understand so that I can follow your teachings.
I will guard them with all my heart.

119:32–34 I hunt for your commandments because they always increase my understanding. Teach me to live what I know. Don't let me forget what I learn.

- ³⁵ Lead me on the path of your commandments,
because I am happy with them.
- ³⁶ Direct my heart toward your written instructions
rather than getting rich in underhanded ways.
- ³⁷ Turn my eyes away from worthless things.
Give me a new life in your ways.
- ³⁸ Keep your promise to me
so that I can fear you.

119:37–38 I refuse to lust for worthless things. New life with you is so much better. Keep your promises to me so I have abundant reasons to respect you.

- ³⁹ Take away insults, which I dread,
because your regulations are good.
- ⁴⁰ I long for your guiding principles.

Give me a new life in your righteousness.

⁴¹ Let your blessings reach me, O LORD.

Save me as you promised.

⁴² Then I will have an answer for the one who insults me
since I trust your word.

119:41–42 Don't let me miss out on your blessings. Save me so I can silence people who insult me for trusting your Word.

⁴³ Do not take so much as a single word of truth from my mouth.

My hope is based on your regulations.

⁴⁴ I will follow your teachings forever and ever.

⁴⁵ I will walk around freely
because I sought out your guiding principles.

119:43–45 Don't let me forget a single word of your truth. Your rules give me hope. Your principles make me free.

⁴⁶ I will speak about your written instructions in the presence of kings
and not feel ashamed.

⁴⁷ Your commandments, which I love, make me happy.

119:46–47 I'll talk about your Word to the most important people in my life. I won't feel ashamed because I love your commands.

⁴⁸ I lift my hands ⌌in prayer⌋ because of your commandments,
which I love.

I will reflect on your laws.

⁴⁹ Remember the word ⌌you gave⌋ me.

Through it you gave me hope.

⁵⁰ This is my comfort in my misery:
Your promise gave me a new life.

119:49–50 Don't forget what you've told me. Your words give me hope. They comfort me in misery and promise me new life.

⁵¹ Arrogant people have mocked me with cruelty,
yet I have not turned away from your teachings.

119:51 The mocking of arrogant people won't keep me from obeying you.

⁵² I remembered your regulations from long ago, O LORD,
and I found comfort in them.

⁵³ I am burning with anger because of wicked people,
who abandon your teachings.

⁵⁴ Your laws have become like psalms to me
in this place where I am only a foreigner.

⁵⁵ At night I remember your name, O LORD,
and I follow your teachings.

119:54–55 Your laws are my songs in a lonely place. I remember you in the dark of night and resolve to obey you.

⁵⁶ This has happened to me
because I have obeyed your guiding principles.

⁵⁷ You are my inheritance, O LORD.
I promised to hold on to your words.

⁵⁸ With all my heart I want to win your favor.
Be kind to me as you promised.

119:56–58 You're a gift to me in this world. I promise to keep my grip on your words. Please keep your kind promises to me.

⁵⁹ I have thought about my life,
and I have directed my feet back to your written instructions.

⁶⁰ Without any hesitation I hurry to obey
your commandments.

⁶¹ Though the ropes of wicked people are tied around me,
I never forget your teachings.

119:59–61 I thought about running from you, but I came back to your instructions. I'll obey you without hesitation. I won't let wicked people drag me into disobedience.

⁶² At midnight I wake up to give thanks to you
for the regulations, which are based on your righteousness.

⁶³ I am a friend to everyone who fears you
and to everyone who follows your guiding principles.

119:63 I make friends with anyone who shows you the respect you deserve. Give me partners in following your principles.

⁶⁴ Your mercy, O LORD, fills the earth.
Teach me your laws.

⁶⁵ You have treated me well, O LORD,
as you promised.

⁶⁶ Teach me to use good judgment and knowledge,
because I believe in your commandments.

⁶⁷ Before you made me suffer, I used to wander off,
but now I hold on to your word.

⁶⁸ You are good, and you do good things.
Teach me your laws.

⁶⁹ Arrogant people have smeared me with lies,
yet I obey your guiding principles with all my heart.

⁷⁰ Their hearts are cold and insensitive,
yet I am happy with your teachings.

⁷¹ It was good that I had to suffer
in order to learn your laws.

119:66–71 Give me knowledge and good judgment as I trust your commands. I learned my lesson when I wandered from your Word. Learning your laws was worth the suffering I endured.

⁷² The teachings “that come” from your mouth are worth more to me
than thousands in gold or silver.

⁷³ Your hands created me and made me what I am.
Help me understand so that I may learn your commandments.

119:73 Your hands made me all that I am. Help me know how to apply your commands to my life.

⁷⁴ Those who fear you will see me and rejoice,
because my hope is based on your word.

⁷⁵ I know that your regulations are fair, O LORD,
and that you were right to make me suffer.

⁷⁶ Let your mercy comfort me
as you promised.

⁷⁷ Let your compassion reach me so that I may live,
because your teachings make me happy.

119:75–77 You’re right when you use suffering to teach me. You show me mercy and compassion.
You give me happiness through your teachings.

⁷⁸ Let arrogant people be put to shame
because they lied about me,
“yet” I reflect on your guiding principles.

⁷⁹ Let those who fear you turn to me
so that they can come to know your written instructions.

119:79 I long to teach people who respect you. Send them to me so I can pass on your instructions.

⁸⁰ Let my heart be filled with integrity in regard to
your laws so that I will not be put to shame.

⁸¹ My soul is weak from waiting for you to save me.
My hope is based on your word.

⁸² My eyes have become strained from looking for your promise.
I ask, “When will you comfort me?”

⁸³ Although I have become like a shriveled and dried out wineskin,
I have not forgotten your laws.

119:81–83 My soul can't wait much longer for you to save me. But your Word compels me to hope in you. My eyes hurt from watching for your promise. But I won't forget your laws.

⁸⁴ What is left of my life?

When will you bring those who persecute me to justice?

⁸⁵ Arrogant people have dug pits to trap me
in defiance of your teachings.

⁸⁶ (All your commandments are reliable.)
Those people persecute me with lies. Help me!

⁸⁷ They almost wiped me off the face of the earth.
But I did not abandon your guiding principles.

119:85–87 Proud people entrap me. They persecute me with lies. They aim to wipe me off the face of the earth. But I won't stop following your principles.

⁸⁸ Give me a new life through your mercy
so that I may obey the written instructions, which came from your mouth.

⁸⁹ O LORD, your word is established in heaven forever.

⁹⁰ Your faithfulness endures throughout
every generation. You set the earth in place, and it continues to stand.

⁹¹ All things continue to stand today because of your regulations,
since they are all your servants.

119:88–91 Your Word lasts forever. Your faithfulness reaches every generation. Your rules hold everything together.

⁹² If your teachings had not made me happy,
then I would have died in my misery.

⁹³ I will never forget your guiding principles,
because you gave me a new life through them.

⁹⁴ I am yours.
Save me, because I have searched for your guiding principles.

119:92–94 I would die in misery if I didn't have your commands to make me happy. I can live a new

life because of your principles. I belong to you.

⁹⁵ The wicked people have waited for me in order to destroy me,
 “yet” I want to understand your written instructions.

⁹⁶ I have seen a limit to everything else,
 “but” your commandments have no limit.

119:96 Everything on earth has its limits. Only your commands know no bounds.

⁹⁷ Oh, how I love your teachings!
 They are in my thoughts all day long.

⁹⁸ Your commandments make me wiser than my enemies,
 because your commandments are always with me.

⁹⁹ I have more insight than all my teachers,
 because your written instructions are in my thoughts.

¹⁰⁰ I have more wisdom than those with many years of experience,
 because I have obeyed your guiding principles.

119:97–100 I love your teachings! I think of them all day long. I’m smarter than my teachers because your instructions fill my thoughts. I’m wiser than my elders because I obey your principles.

¹⁰¹ I have kept my feet “from walking” on any evil path
 in order to obey your word.

¹⁰² I have not neglected your regulations,
 because you have taught me.

¹⁰³ How sweet the taste of your promise is!
 It tastes sweeter than honey.

119:101–103 I won’t venture down evil paths. I’ll choose instead to obey your Word. I pay attention to everything you’ve taught me. Your promise is sweeter than honey.

¹⁰⁴ From your guiding principles I gain understanding.
 That is why I hate every path that leads to lying.

¹⁰⁵ Your word is a lamp for my feet

and a light for my path.

119:105 Your Word lights my path so I don't stumble. Don't let me settle for walking in darkness.

¹⁰⁶ I took an oath, and I will keep it.
I took an oath to follow your regulations, which are based on your righteousness.

119:106 I promised to keep your rules when I realized they flow from your goodness.

¹⁰⁷ I have suffered so much.
Give me a new life, O LORD, as you promised.
¹⁰⁸ Please accept the praise I gladly give you, O LORD,
and teach me your regulations.
¹⁰⁹ I always take my life into my own hands,
but I never forget your teachings.

119:109 I face danger at every turn, but I rely on your teachings to keep me safe.

¹¹⁰ Wicked people have set a trap for me,
but I have never wandered away from your guiding principles.
¹¹¹ Your written instructions are mine forever.
They are the joy of my heart.
¹¹² I have decided to obey your laws.
They offer a reward that never ends.

119:111–112 Your written instructions never wear out. They make me glad and give me an eternal reward.

¹¹³ I hate two-faced people,
but I love your teachings.
¹¹⁴ You are my hiding place and my shield.
My hope is based on your word.

- 115 Get away from me, you evildoers,
so that I can obey the commandments of my God.
- 116 Help me God, as you promised, so that I may live.
Do not turn my hope into disappointment.
- 117 Hold me, and I will be safe,
and I will always respect your laws.

119:113–117 I hate two-faced people, but your teachings never deceive me. I count on you to protect me, and your words tell me why I should trust you. Hold me close, and I'll always be safe.

- 118 You reject all who wander away from your laws,
because their lies mislead them.[\[118\]](#)
- 119 You get rid of all wicked people on earth as if they were rubbish.
That is why I love your written instructions.
- 120 My body shudders in fear of you,
and I am afraid of your regulations.

119:120 My body shudders when I think about your awesome greatness. I tremble when I hear your rules.

- 121 I have done what is fair and right.
Do not leave me at the mercy of those who oppress me.
- 122 Guarantee my well-being.
Do not let arrogant people oppress me.
- 123 My eyes are strained from looking for you to save me
and from looking for the fulfillment of your righteous promise.

119:121–123 Don't leave me at the mercy of cruel oppressors. My eyes hurt from searching for you to fulfill your promise to save me.

- 124 Treat me with kindness,
and teach me your laws.
- 125 I am your servant.
Help me understand so that I may come to know your written instructions.

119:125 I'm your servant. Help me understand your instructions so I can do your bidding.

¹²⁶ It is time for you to act, O LORD.[\[119\]](#)
Even though people have abolished your teachings,
¹²⁷ I love your commandments more than gold, more than pure gold.

119:126–127 Other people do away with your teachings, but I treasure your commands more than gold.

¹²⁸ I follow the straight paths of your guiding principles.
I hate every pathway that leads to lying.

¹²⁹ Your written instructions are miraculous.
That is why I obey them.

¹³⁰ Your word is a doorway that lets in light,
and it helps gullible people understand.

119:130 Your Word sheds light on life. Use it to help me understand your way.

¹³¹ I open my mouth and pant
because I long for your commandments.

119:131 My mouth opens wide panting for your Word. Fill me up!

¹³² Turn toward me, and have pity on me
as you have pledged to do for those who love your name.

¹³³ Make my steps secure through your promise,
and do not let any sin control me.

¹³⁴ Save me from human oppression
so that I may obey your guiding principles.

119:133–134 Help me live obediently by relying on your promises. Don't let sin control me or people push me around.

¹³⁵ Smile on me,
and teach me your laws.

¹³⁶ Streams of tears flow from my eyes
because others do not follow your teachings.

119:135–136 You smile at me as you teach me your laws. But I weep when others don't listen.

¹³⁷ You are righteous, O LORD,

- and your regulations are fair.
- ¹³⁸ You have issued your written instructions.
They are fair and completely dependable.
- ¹³⁹ My devotion ⌋for your words⌋ consumes me,
because my enemies have forgotten your words.
- ¹⁴⁰ Your promise has been thoroughly tested,
and I love it.

119:137–140 Every one of your commands is fair and reliable. I've tested your promise and I love it.

- ¹⁴¹ I am unimportant and despised,
⌋yet⌋ I never forget your guiding principles.
- ¹⁴² Your righteousness is an everlasting righteousness,
and your teachings are reliable.
- ¹⁴³ Trouble and hardship have found me,
but your commandments ⌋still⌋ make me happy.

119:141–143 On my own I'm insignificant. But your guiding principles make my life count. Even when I struggle your commands make me happy.

- ¹⁴⁴ Your written instructions are always right.
Help me understand ⌋them⌋ so that I will live.
- ¹⁴⁵ I have called out with all my heart. Answer me, O LORD.
I want to obey your laws.

119:144–145 Your instructions lead to life. So help me understand them. With all my heart I want to obey you!

- ¹⁴⁶ I have called out.
Save me, so that I can obey your written instructions.
- ¹⁴⁷ I got up before dawn, and I cried out for help.
My hope is based on your word.
- ¹⁴⁸ My eyes are wide-open throughout the nighttime hours
to reflect on your word.

¹⁴⁹ In keeping with your mercy, hear my voice.
O LORD, give me a new life guided by your regulations.

119:146–149 Rescue me from anything that keeps me from obeying you. Give me a fresh start in following your guidance.

¹⁵⁰ Those who carry out plots against me are near,
yet they are far away from your teachings.

¹⁵¹ You are near, O LORD,
and all your commandments are reliable.

119:150–151 People nearby plot to take my life. But you and your Word are even nearer.

¹⁵² Long ago I learned from your written instructions
that you made them to last forever.

¹⁵³ Look at my misery, and rescue me,
because I have never forgotten your teachings.

119:152–153 Your instructions will last forever. Help me never to forget them.

¹⁵⁴ Plead my case for me, and save me.
Give me a new life as you promised.

¹⁵⁵ Wicked people are far from being saved,
because they have not searched for your laws.

¹⁵⁶ Your acts of compassion are many in number, O LORD.
Give me a new life guided by your regulations.

119:155–156 Wicked people won't experience your salvation because they don't search your Word.
I want your rules to guide me.

¹⁵⁷ I have many persecutors and opponents,
yet I have not turned away from your written instructions.

¹⁵⁸ I have seen traitors,
and I am filled with disgust.

They have not accepted your promise.
159 See how I have loved your guiding principles!
O LORD, in keeping with your mercy, give me a new life.

119:157–159 People rage against me, but they can't keep me from obeying your instructions. I love your principles because they lead me into life.

160 There is nothing but truth in your word,
and all of your righteous regulations endure forever.
161 Influential people have persecuted me for no reason,
but it is only your words that fill my heart with terror.
162 I find joy in your promise
like someone who finds a priceless treasure.

119:160 –162 Your Word is wholly true and your rules last forever. Learning your promises is like unearthing priceless treasure.

163 I hate lying; I am disgusted with it.
I love your teachings.
164 Seven times a day I praise you
for your righteous regulations.
165 There is lasting peace for those who love your teachings.
Nothing can make those people stumble.

119:163 –165 I love your teachings. I praise you all day long for your goodness. Your teachings bring me peace.

166 I have waited with hope for you to save me, O LORD.
I have carried out your commandments.
167 I have obeyed your written instructions. I have loved them very much.
168 I have followed your guiding principles and your written instructions,
because my whole life is in front of you.

119:167–168 You don't have to force me to keep your instructions. I love to obey them. I follow your

principles and do life in your presence.

- ¹⁶⁹ Let my cry for help come into your presence, O LORD.
Help me understand as you promised.
- ¹⁷⁰ Let my plea for mercy come into your presence.
Rescue me as you promised.
- ¹⁷¹ Let my lips pour out praise
because you teach me your laws.
- ¹⁷² Let my tongue sing about your promise
because all your commandments are fair.
- ¹⁷³ Let your hand help me
because I have chosen *to follow* your guiding principles.

119:171–173 I praise you for teaching me your laws. I sing because your commands are fair. Help me live up to my choice to follow you.

- ¹⁷⁴ I have longed for you to save me, O LORD,
and your teachings make me happy.
- ¹⁷⁵ Let my soul have new life so that it can praise you. Let your regulations help me.
- ¹⁷⁶ I have wandered away like a lost lamb.
Search for me, because I have never forgotten your commandments.

119:174–176 My heart overflows with happiness because of your teachings. Give me new life so I have even more reason to praise you. When I wander away, search for me. I'll never forget your commands.

Psalm 120

A song for going up to worship.

- ¹ When I was in trouble, I cried out to the LORD,
and he answered me.
- ² O LORD, rescue me from lying lips
and from a deceitful tongue.

120:1–2 You answer me when I cry about my troubles. I need you to save me from deceitful tongues.

- ³ You deceitful tongue, what can the LORD give you?
What more can he do for you?
⁴ He will give you a warrior's sharpened arrows
and red-hot coals.
⁵ How horrible it is to live as a foreigner in Meshech
or to stay in the tents of Kedar.
⁶ I have lived too long with those who hate peace.
⁷ I am for peace, but when I talk about it,
they only talk about war.

120:5–7 I live in a world of peace haters. I dream of peace but they only want war. Bring us peace as only you can!

Psalm 121

A song for going up to worship.

- ¹ I look up toward the mountains.
Where can I find help?
² My help comes from the LORD,
the maker of heaven and earth.

121:1–2 I look toward your dwelling place. Where can I get help? Only from you, maker of heaven and earth.

- ³ He will not let you fall.
Your guardian will not fall asleep.
⁴ Indeed, the Guardian of Israel never rests or sleeps.

121:3–4 You won't let me fall. You never doze off when you watch over me.

- ⁵ The LORD is your guardian.
The LORD is the shade over your right hand.
⁶ The sun will not beat down on you during the day,
nor will the moon at night.
⁷ The LORD guards you from every evil.
He guards your life.
⁸ The LORD guards you as you come and go,
now and forever.

121:5–8 You shade me with your tender hand. You protect me from every bad thing. You guard me not only today but always.

Psalm 122

A song by David for going up to worship.

- ¹ I was glad when they said to me,
“Let’s go to the house of the LORD.”
² Our feet are standing inside your gates, Jerusalem.
³ Jerusalem is built to be a city
where the people are united.[\[120\]](#)

122:1–3 Thanks for giving me people who encourage me to worship you. Give us one heart and mind when we approach you.

- ⁴ All of the LORD ’s tribes go to that city
because it is a law in Israel to give thanks to the name of the LORD.
⁵ The court of justice sits there.
It consists of ᵀprinces who areᵀ David’s descendants.
⁶ Pray for the peace of Jerusalem:
“May those who love you prosper.
⁷ May there be peace inside your walls
and prosperity in your palaces.”

122:4–7 I worship you willingly. I’d bow before you even if worship weren’t a command. I offer you thanks. I praise you for your justice. Give your peace and prosperity to everyone who loves you.

- ⁸ For the sake of my relatives and friends, let me say,
“May it go well for you!”
- ⁹ For the sake of the house of the LORD our God,
I will seek what is good for you.

122:8–9 Send your very best to my family and friends. They’ll receive your good gifts and bow to you in worship.

Psalm 123

A song for going up to worship.

- ¹ I look up to you,
to the one who sits enthroned in heaven.
- ² As servants depend on their masters,
as a maid depends on her mistress,
so we depend on the LORD our God until he has pity on us.

123:1–2 You reign from your throne in heaven. Just as a servant depends on his master, I depend on your help here on earth.

- ³ Have pity on us, O LORD.

- Have pity on us
because we have suffered more than our share of contempt.
- ⁴ We have suffered more than our share of ridicule from those who are carefree.
We have suffered more than our share of contempt from those who are arrogant.

123:3–4 Show me pity, because I’ve suffered more than my share of contempt. Raise me up, because arrogant people never stop ridiculing me.

Psalm 124

A song by David for going up to worship.

- ¹ “If the LORD had not been on our side . . .”
(Israel should repeat this.)
- ² “If the LORD had not been on our side when people
attacked us,
³ then they would have swallowed us alive
when their anger exploded against us.
⁴ Then the floodwaters would have swept us away.
An overflowing stream would have washed us away.
⁵ Then raging water would have washed us away.”
- ⁶ Thank the LORD, who did not let them sink their teeth
into us.
- ⁷ We escaped like a bird caught in a hunter’s trap.
The trap was broken, and we escaped.
- ⁸ Our help is in the name of the LORD, the maker of
heaven and earth.

124:1–8 Without you on my side my enemies swallow me alive. Without you on my side raging floods sweep me away. Without you on my side my enemy’s teeth sink deep in my flesh. Maker of heaven and earth, you’re my one source of help.

Psalm 125

A song for going up to worship.

- ¹ Those who trust the LORD are like Mount Zion,
which can never be shaken.
It remains firm forever.
- ² „As„ the mountains surround Jerusalem,
so the LORD surrounds his people now and forever.

125:1–2 You hold me together and keep life from shaking me apart. You surround me with your strong protection like mountains ring your holy city.

- ³ A wicked ruler will not be allowed to govern
the land set aside for righteous people.
That is why righteous people do not use their power to do wrong.
- ⁴ Do good, O LORD, to those who are good,
to those whose motives are decent.
- ⁵ But when people become crooked,
the LORD will lead them away with troublemakers.
Let there be peace in Israel!

125:3–5 Don't let evildoers rule over your followers. Do good to me because my motives are good, but discipline me when my heart becomes crooked.

Psalm 126

A song for going up to worship.

- ¹ When the LORD restored the fortunes of Zion,
it was as if we were dreaming.
- ² Then our mouths were filled with laughter
and our tongues with joyful songs.
Then the nations said,

“The LORD has done spectacular things for them.”

126:1–2 When I finally experienced your goodness, it felt like a dream. My mouth spilled laughter and I sang joyful songs. Everyone sees the spectacular things you’ve done for me.

³ The LORD has done spectacular things for us.
We are overjoyed.

⁴ Restore our fortunes, O LORD,
as you restore streams ַto dry riverbedsַ in the Negev.

⁵ Those who cry while they plant
will joyfully sing while they harvest.

⁶ The person who goes out weeping, carrying his bag of seed,
will come home singing, carrying his bundles of grain.

126:4–6 Make my life flow again like you make streams well up in the desert. Even if I weep during this season of planting, I’ll sing for joy at the harvest.

Psalm 127

A song by Solomon for going up to worship.

¹ If the LORD does not build the house,
it is useless for the builders to work on it.
If the LORD does not protect a city,
it is useless for the guard to stay alert.

127:1 If I don’t put you first in my planning and building, my work is useless. If I don’t let you protect me and my loved ones, all my defenses are worthless.

² It is useless to work hard for the food you eat
by getting up early and going to bed late.
The LORD gives ַfoodַ to those he loves while they sleep.
³ Children are an inheritance from the LORD.
They are a reward from him.

127:2–3 You give me food and sleep as gifts, so call me back to your rhythm when I’m tempted to work myself to death. You give me children as a gift, so send me the help I need to raise them.

⁴ The children born to a man when he is young
are like arrows in the hand of a warrior.

⁵ Blessed is the man who has filled his quiver with them.
He will not be put to shame
when he speaks with his enemies in the city gate.

Psalm 128

A song for going up to worship.

¹ Blessed are all who fear the LORD and live his way.

² You will certainly eat what your own hands have provided.
Blessings to you!
May things go well for you!

128:1–2 I’m blessed whenever I choose to live your way. You let me eat what I earn and make things go well for me.

³ Your wife will be like a fruitful vine inside your home.
Your children will be like young olive trees around your table.

⁴ This is how the LORD will bless the person who fears him.

⁵ May the LORD bless you from Zion
so that you may see Jerusalem prospering all the days of your life.

⁶ May you live to see your children’s children.

Let there be peace in Israel!

128:3–6 You sent my spouse as your blessing for every moment of life. My children come as gifts straight from your hand. Send us your blessing from heaven. Prosper us. Grant us long life. Give us peace!

Psalm 129

A song for going up to worship.

¹“From the time I was young, people have attacked me . . .”
(Israel should repeat this.)

²“From the time I was young, people have attacked me,
but they have never overpowered me.

³ They have plowed my back ᵐlike farmers plow fieldsᵐ.
They made long slashes ᵐlike furrowsᵐ.”

⁴ The LORD is righteous.

He has cut me loose
from the ropes that wicked people tied around me.

129:1–4 People attack me again and again, but they never overpower me. They slice my back like a farmer plowing rows, but you always set me free.

- ⁵ Put to shame all those who hate Zion.
Force them to retreat.
- ⁶ Make them be like grass on a roof,
like grass that dries up before it produces a stalk.
- ⁷ It will never fill the barns of those who harvest
or the arms of those who gather bundles.
- ⁸ Those who pass by will never say “to them,”
“May you be blessed by the LORD”
or “We bless you in the name of the LORD.”

129:5–8 Put to shame people who won’t stop hating you. Let them dry up like sun-baked grass.
Don’t let me do evil and die before the harvest. Don’t let me miss out on your blessings.

Psalm 130

A song for going up to worship.

- ¹ O LORD, out of the depths I call to you.
- ² O Lord, hear my voice.
Let your ears be open to my pleas for mercy.

130:1–2 I call to you from a deep dark place. Can you hear my prayers for mercy?

- ³ O LORD, who would be able to stand
if you kept a record of sins?
- ⁴ But with you there is forgiveness
so that you can be feared.
-

130:3–4 I could never survive your anger if you kept track of my sins. But your forgiveness wins my grateful respect.

- ⁵ I wait for the LORD, my soul waits,
and with hope I wait for his word.
- ⁶ My soul waits for the LORD
more than those who watch for the morning,
more than those who watch for the morning.
- ⁷ O Israel, put your hope in the LORD,
because with the LORD there is mercy
and with him there is unlimited forgiveness.
- ⁸ He will rescue Israel from all its sins.

130:5–8 I long for your help. I hope for your mercy. I count on your unlimited forgiveness. I depend on you to rescue me from sin.

Psalm 131

A song by David for going up to worship.

- ¹ O LORD, my heart is not conceited.
My eyes do not look down on others.
I am not involved in things too big or too difficult for me.

131:1 Humble my heart and keep me from looking down on others. Don't let me think too much of myself.

- ² Instead, I have kept my soul calm and quiet.
My soul is content as a weaned child is content in its mother's arms.
- ³ Israel, put your hope in the LORD now and forever.

131:2–3 I'll calm my soul as I rest in your arms. I'll hope in you now and always.

Psalm 132

A song for going up to worship.

¹ O LORD, remember David and all the hardships he endured.

² Remember how he swore an oath to the LORD
and made this vow to the Mighty One of Jacob:

³“I will not step inside my house,

⁴ get into my bed, shut my eyes, or close my eyelids

⁵ until I find a place for the LORD,
a dwelling place for the Mighty One of Jacob.”

132:1–5 David longed to build you a house of worship. He swore he wouldn’t sleep until it was done.
Give me that heart toward you. I don’t want to rest until I give you the worship you deserve.

⁶ Now, we have heard about the ark [└]of the promise[┘]
being in Ephrathah.

We have found it in Jaar.

⁷ Let’s go to his dwelling place.

Let’s worship at his footstool.

⁸ O LORD, arise, and come to your resting place
with the ark of your power.

⁹ Clothe your priests with righteousness.
Let your godly ones sing with joy.

132:7–9 I want to come to your dwelling and worship at your feet. Clothe me with righteousness and
teach me a joyful song.

¹⁰ For the sake of your servant David,
do not reject your anointed one.

¹¹ The LORD swore an oath to David.

This is a truth he will not take back:

“I will set one of your own descendants on your throne.

¹² If your sons are faithful to my promise [\[121\]](#)
and my written instructions that I will teach them,
then their descendants will also sit on your throne forever.”

132:11–12 Praise you for your unbreakable promise to David that his descendant will always reign from his throne. Praise you for the righteous King born to David's line.

- ¹³ The LORD has chosen Zion.
He wants it for his home.
¹⁴ “This will be my resting place forever.
Here I will sit enthroned because I want Zion.
¹⁵ I will certainly bless all that Zion needs.
I will satisfy its needy people with food.
¹⁶ I will clothe its priests with salvation.
Then its godly ones will sing joyfully.
¹⁷ There I will make a horn sprout up for David.
I will prepare a lamp for my anointed one.
¹⁸ I will clothe his enemies with shame,
but the crown on my anointed one will shine.”

132:14–18 You've made your chosen people your resting place. Bless me by meeting my every real need. Give me food and salvation and joyful songs. Crown me with your glory.

Psalm 133

A song by David for going up to worship.

- ¹ See how good and pleasant it is
when brothers and sisters live together in harmony!
² It is like fine, scented oil on the head,
running down the beard—down Aaron's beard—
running over the collar of his robes.
³ It is like dew on ַMountֶּ֫֫ Hermon,
dew which comes down on Zion's mountains.
That is where the LORD promised the blessing of eternal life.

133:1–3 It's right and good when your people get along. It's like pouring fine perfume on your chosen ones. Train me to live in harmony with others!

Psalm 134

A song for going up to worship.

- ¹ Praise the LORD, all you servants of the LORD,
all who stand in the house of the LORD night after night.
² Lift your hands toward the holy place, and praise the LORD.
³ May the LORD, the maker of heaven and earth, bless you from Zion.

134:1–3 I stand to worship you. I lift my hands to praise you. I'll come to adore you night after night.

Psalm 135

- ¹ Hallelujah!
- Praise the name of the LORD.
Praise him, you servants of the LORD
² who are standing in the house of the LORD,
in the courtyards of the house of our God.
³ Praise the LORD because he is good.
Make music to praise his name because his name is beautiful.
⁴ The LORD chose Jacob to be his own
and chose Israel to be his own special treasure.

135:1–4 Hallelujah! I enter your presence to worship. I praise you because you're good. I make music because your name is beautiful. I thank you because you chose me to be your own special treasure.

- ⁵ I know that the LORD is great,
that our Lord is greater than all the false gods.
⁶ The LORD does whatever he wants in heaven or on earth,
on the seas or in all the depths of the oceans.

⁷ He is the one who makes the clouds rise from the ends of the earth,
who makes lightning for the thunderstorms,
and who brings wind out of his storerooms.

⁸ He is the one who killed every firstborn male in Egypt.
He killed humans and animals alike.

⁹ He sent miraculous signs and amazing things into the heart of Egypt
against Pharaoh and all his officials.

¹⁰ He is the one who defeated many nations and killed mighty kings:
¹¹ King Sihon of the Amorites,
King Og of Bashan,
and all the kingdoms in Canaan.

135:5–11 You're greater than every false god. You do whatever you want. You rule over nature and reign over your enemies. You defend your people and defeat anyone who dares rise up against you.

¹² He gave their land as an inheritance,
an inheritance to his people Israel.
¹³ O LORD, your name endures forever.
O LORD, you will be remembered throughout every generation.
¹⁴ The LORD will provide justice for his people
and have compassion on his servants.

135:13–14 Your fame lasts forever. You always show me justice and compassion.

¹⁵ The idols of the nations are made of silver and gold.
They were made by human hands.[\[122\]](#)
¹⁶ They have mouths, but they cannot speak.
They have eyes, but they cannot see.
¹⁷ They have ears, but they cannot hear.
They cannot breathe.
¹⁸ Those who make idols end up like them.
So does everyone who trusts them.

135:15–18 Idols are just metal objects shaped by human hands. They can't speak or see. They can't hear or breathe. If I serve false gods, I'll end up as senseless as the idols I worship.

- ¹⁹ Descendants of Israel, praise the LORD.
Descendants of Aaron, praise the LORD.
- ²⁰ Descendants of Levi, praise the LORD.
You people who fear the LORD, praise the LORD.
- ²¹ Thank the LORD in Zion.
Thank the one who lives in Jerusalem.
- Hallelujah!

135:19–21 I praise you because I'm one of your chosen people. I live for you with utter respect.
Thank you for dwelling close to me!

Psalm 136

- ¹ Give thanks to the Lord because he is good,
because his mercy endures forever.
- ² Give thanks to the God of gods
because his mercy endures forever.
- ³ Give thanks to the Lord of lords
because his mercy endures forever.

136:1–3 I thank you because you're perfectly good—and your mercy lasts forever. I thank you
because you're Lord of lords— and your mercy lasts forever.

- ⁴ Give thanks to the only one who does miraculous things—
because his mercy endures forever.
- ⁵ to the one who made the heavens by his understanding—
because his mercy endures forever.
- ⁶ to the one who spread out the earth on the water—

- because his mercy endures forever.
- ⁷ to the one who made the great lights—
because his mercy endures forever.
- ⁸ the sun to rule the day—
because his mercy endures forever.
- ⁹ the moon and stars to rule the night—
because his mercy endures forever.

136:4–9 I thank you because you do miracles—and your mercy lasts forever. I thank you because you made the skies by your wisdom. You strung out the sun, moon, and stars—and your mercy lasts forever.

- ¹⁰ Give thanks to the one who killed the firstborn males in Egypt—
because his mercy endures forever.
- ¹¹ He brought Israel out from among them—
because his mercy endures forever.
- ¹² with a mighty hand and a powerful arm—
because his mercy endures forever.
- ¹³ Give thanks to one who divided the Red Sea—
because his mercy endures forever.
- ¹⁴ He led Israel through the middle of it—
because his mercy endures forever.
- ¹⁵ He swept Pharaoh and his army into the Red Sea—
because his mercy endures forever.

136:11–15 I thank you because you rescued your people from slavery—and your mercy lasts forever. You saved us with your mighty power and swept away your enemies—and your mercy lasts forever.

- ¹⁶ Give thanks to the one who led his people through the desert—
because his mercy endures forever.
- ¹⁷ Give thanks to the one who defeated powerful kings—
because his mercy endures forever.
- ¹⁸ He killed mighty kings—

- because his mercy endures forever.
¹⁹ King Sihon of the Amorites—
because his mercy endures forever.
²⁰ and King Og of Bashan—
because his mercy endures forever.

136:16–20 I thank you because you led your people through the wilderness—and your mercy lasts forever. I thank you because you defeated powerful enemies—and your mercy lasts forever.

- ²¹ He gave their land as an inheritance—
because his mercy endures forever.
²² as an inheritance for his servant Israel—
because his mercy endures forever.

²³ He remembered us when we were humiliated—
because his mercy endures forever.
²⁴ He snatched us from the grasp of our enemies—
because his mercy endures forever.
²⁵ He gives food to every living creature—
because his mercy endures forever.

136:23–25 I thank you because you didn't abandon us in our humiliation—and your mercy lasts forever. I thank you because you feed every living thing—and your mercy lasts forever.

- ²⁶ Give thanks to the God of heaven
because his mercy endures forever.

Psalm 137

- ¹ By the rivers of Babylon, we sat down and cried as we remembered Zion.
² We hung our lyres on willow trees.
³ It was there that those who had captured us demanded that we sing.
Those who guarded us wanted us to entertain them.
They said, "Sing a song from Zion for us!"

137:1–3 I weep when I remember what it was like to live close to you. I ran away in sinful rebellion and you let me be captured. My captors make my praise a joke.

⁴ How could we sing the LORD's song in a foreign land?

⁵ If I forget you, Jerusalem,
let my right hand forget how to play the lyre.

⁶ Let my tongue stick to the roof of my mouth
if I don't remember you,
if I don't consider Jerusalem my highest joy.

137:4–6 How can I sing when I'm so far from you? But how can I forget your holy city? I remember what it was like to live close to you. Oh how I long to return!

⁷ O LORD, remember the people of Edom.
Remember what they did the day Jerusalem was captured.
They said, "Tear it down! Tear it down to its foundation."

⁸ You destructive people of Babylon,
blessed is the one who pays you back
with the same treatment you gave us.

⁹ Blessed is the one who grabs your little children
and smashes them against a rock.

137:7–9 Don't overlook the evil others have done—the utter destruction they caused. I trust you to calm my rage.

Psalm 138

By David.

¹ I will give thanks to you with all my heart.
I will make music to praise you in front of the false gods.

² I will bow toward your holy temple.
I will give thanks to your name because of your mercy and truth.
You have made your name and your promise greater than everything.

138:1–2 I thank you with every part of my heart. I worship you even when so-called gods are watching. I bow to you and say thanks for your mercy and truth.

³ When I called, you answered me.
You made me bold by strengthening my soul.[\[123\]](#)

138:2–3 You and your promise are greater than anything I can imagine. You answer my cries and make me bold.

⁴ All the kings of the earth will give thanks to you, O LORD,
because they have heard the promises you spoke.
⁵ They will sing this about the ways of the LORD:
“The LORD’s honor is great!”
⁶ Even though the LORD is high above, he sees humble people └close up┐,
and he recognizes arrogant people from a distance.

138:6 Even though you reign from on high, you know the humble up close. You spot the proud from miles away.

⁷ Even though I walk into the middle of trouble,
you guard my life against the anger of my enemies.
You stretch out your hand, and your right hand saves me.
⁸ The LORD will do everything for me.
O LORD, your mercy endures forever.
Do not let go of what your hands have made.

138:7–8 Even when I walk into trouble you guard my life. You reach out and save me. You mercifully do everything I need.

Psalm 139

For the choir director; a psalm by David.

¹ O LORD, you have examined me, and you know me.

² You alone know when I sit down and when I get up.
You read my thoughts from far away.

³ You watch me when I travel and when I rest.
You are familiar with all my ways.

⁴ Even before there is a _single_ word on my tongue, you know all about it,
LORD.

139:1–4 You’ve studied me up close and you see my every move. You know my thoughts before I think them and my words before I speak.

⁵ You are all around me—in front of me and in back of me.
You lay your hand on me.

⁶ Such knowledge is beyond my grasp.
It is so high I cannot reach it.

139:5–6 I can’t escape your grip on me. There’s nowhere I can go to get away from you. Up or down, right or left—you always hold me tight.

⁷ Where can I go _to get away_ from your Spirit?
Where can I run _to get away_ from you?

⁸ If I go up to heaven, you are there.
If I make my bed in hell, you are there.

⁹ If I climb upward on the rays of the morning sun
or land on the most distant shore of the sea where the sun sets,

¹⁰ even there your hand would guide me
and your right hand would hold on to me.

139:7–10 There’s no corner of heaven where you can’t find me. I can’t escape to hell or the sun or a distant shore. You always hold me tight.

¹¹ If I say, “Let the darkness hide me
and let the light around me turn into night,”

¹² even the darkness is not too dark for you.
Night is as bright as day.
Darkness and light are the same _to you_.

139:11–12 When I step into darkness, you see me as if it were broad daylight. You follow me wherever I go.

- ¹³ You alone created my inner being.
You knitted me together inside my mother.
- ¹⁴ I will give thanks to you
because I have been so amazingly and miraculously made.
Your works are miraculous, and my soul is fully aware of this.
- ¹⁵ My bones were not hidden from you
when I was being made in secret,
when I was being skillfully woven in an underground workshop.

139:13–15 You made me inside and out, a pure miracle of complexity. My mother's womb couldn't hide me. It was you who was weaving me with great skill.

- ¹⁶ Your eyes saw me when I was only a fetus.
Every day ^{of my life} was recorded in your
book before one of them had taken place.
- ¹⁷ How precious are your thoughts concerning me, O God!
How vast in number they are!
- ¹⁸ If I try to count them,
there would be more of them than there are grains of sand.
When I wake up, I am still with you.

139:16–18 Your eyes saw me before I was born. You saw my whole life stretched out before me before a single day had passed. Your thoughts amaze me! You think of me all day long.

- ¹⁹ I wish that you would kill wicked people, O God,
and that bloodthirsty people would leave me alone.
- ²⁰ They say wicked things about you.
Your enemies misuse your name.
- ²¹ Shouldn't I hate those who hate you, O LORD?
Shouldn't I be disgusted with those who attack you?
- ²² I hate them with all my heart.
They have become my enemies.

²³ Examine me, O God, and know my mind.

Test me, and know my thoughts.

²⁴ See whether I am on an evil path.

Then lead me on the everlasting path.

139:23–24 Examine me, my God. Keep checking my thoughts. Test me. Tell me when I’m headed into evil and put me back on the path toward you.

Psalm 140

For the choir leader; a psalm by David.

¹ Rescue me from evil people, O LORD.

Keep me safe from violent people.

² They plan evil things in their hearts.

They start fights every day.

140:1–2 Rescue me from evildoers. Keep me safe from people who pick fights.

³ They make their tongues as sharp as a snake’s ִfang.

Their lips hide the venom of poisonous snakes. *Selah*

⁴ Protect me from the hands of wicked people, O LORD.

Keep me safe from violent people.

They try to trip me.

⁵ Arrogant people have laid a trap for me.

They have spread out a net with ropes.

They have set traps for me along the road. *Selah*

140:3–5 Protect me from violent people. Their words are like the fangs of venomous snakes. Their hands build traps to catch me unaware.

⁶ I said to the LORD, “You are my God.”
O LORD, open your ears to hear my plea for pity.
⁷ O LORD Almighty, the strong one who saves me,
you have covered my head in the day of battle.
⁸ O LORD, do not give wicked people what they want.
Do not let their evil plans succeed,
for they will become arrogant. *Selah*

140:6–8 I declare to you that you’re my God, so hear my plea for pity. You’re the strong one, so save me. If you let evil people succeed, their plans will only get bigger.

⁹ Let the heads of those who surround me
be covered with their own threats.
¹⁰ Let burning coals fall on them.
Let them be thrown into a pit, never to rise again.
¹¹ Do not let slanderers prosper on earth.
Let evil hunt down violent people with one blow after another.

140:9–11 Turn my enemies’ threats back against them. Let them be caught in their own traps.
Don’t let them prosper until they turn to you.

¹² I know that the LORD will defend the rights of those who are oppressed
and the cause of those who are needy.
¹³ Indeed, righteous people will give thanks to your name.
Decent people will live in your presence.

140:12–13 You will defend the oppressed and needy. Good people will live close to you.

Psalm 141

A psalm by David.

¹ O LORD, I cry out to you, “Come quickly.”
Open your ears to me when I cry out to you.

² Let my prayer be accepted
as sweet-smelling incense in your presence.
Let the lifting up of my hands in prayer be accepted
as an evening sacrifice.

141:1–2 I need you now! Accept my prayer like incense and my lifted hands as a sacrifice.

³ O LORD, set a guard at my mouth.
Keep watch over the door of my lips.
⁴ Do not let me be persuaded to do anything evil
or to become involved with wickedness,
with people who are troublemakers.
Do not let me taste their delicacies.

141:3–4 Silence me before I speak evil. Stop me when I'm about to step into wickedness. Don't let me taste the rewards of doing wrong and develop a liking for them.

⁵ A righteous person may strike me or correct me out of kindness.
It is like lotion for my head.
My head will not refuse it,
because my prayer is directed against evil deeds.

141:5 I'll gladly accept the correction of good people. I need their help to avoid evil.

⁶ When their judges are thrown off a cliff,
they will listen to what I have to say.
It will sound pleasant to them.
⁷ As someone plows and breaks up the ground,
so our bones will be planted at the mouth of the grave. [\[124\]](#)

141:6–7 Put an end to evil judges at the time and place of your choosing.

⁸ My eyes look to you, LORD Almighty.
I have taken refuge in you.
Do not leave me defenseless.

⁹ Keep me away from the trap they set for me
and from the traps set by troublemakers.

141:8–9 I keep looking for you and your might. I count on your keeping me safe. Don't leave me to
fight my battles on my own. And save me from traps meant to hurt me.

¹⁰ Let wicked people fall into their own nets,
while I escape unharmed.

Psalm 142

A maskil^[125] by David when he was in the cave; a prayer.

¹ Loudly, I cry to the LORD.
Loudly, I plead with the LORD for mercy.
² I pour out my complaints in his presence
and tell him my troubles.

142:1–2 I cry out to you. I plead for mercy and pour out my complaints.

³ When I begin to lose hope,
you [⌋]already[⌋] know what I am experiencing.
[⌋]My enemies[⌋] have hidden a trap for me on the path where I walk.
⁴ Look to my right and see that no one notices me.
Escape is impossible for me.
No one cares about me.

142:3–4 I'm losing hope—and you know why. My enemies want to trap me and there's no escape.

⁵ I call out to you, O LORD.
I say, "You are my refuge,
my own inheritance in this world of the living."

142:4–5 No one cares for me but you. So I cry out to you, my refuge. You're the only thing I have in
this life.

- ⁶ Pay attention to my cry for help
because I am very weak.
Rescue me from those who pursue me
because they are too strong for me.
- ⁷ Release my soul from prison
so that I may give thanks to your name.

Righteous people will surround me
because you are good to me.

142:6–7 Pay attention to me because I am far too weak to fight. Set me free from this prison and I will thank you again and again.

Psalm 143

A psalm by David.

- ¹ O LORD, listen to my prayer.
Open your ears to hear my urgent requests.
Answer me because you are faithful and righteous.
- ² Do not take me to court for judgment,
because there is no one alive
who is righteous in your presence.

143:1–2 Hear my urgent request! Answer me because you are good! Don't judge me, because no human can measure up to your standards.

- ³ The enemy has pursued me.
He has ground my life into the dirt.
He has made me live in dark places
like those who have died long ago.
- ⁴ That is why I begin to lose hope
and my heart is in a state of shock.
- ⁵ I remember the days long ago.
I reflect on all that you have done.
I carefully consider what your hands have made.
- ⁶ I stretch out my hands to you in prayer.
Like parched land, my soul thirsts for you. *Selah*

143:3–6 The enemy has ground me into the dirt and made me lose hope. My heart is in shock. I feel parched as I pray. Yet I recall one by one all the awesome things you have done.

- ⁷ Answer me quickly, O LORD.
My spirit is worn out.
Do not hide your face from me,
or I will be like those who go into the pit.
- ⁸ Let me hear about your mercy in the morning,
because I trust you.
Let me know the way that I should go,
because I long for you.

143:7–8 Answer me soon because my spirit is worn out. I'm as good as dead if you keep hiding from me. Send your mercy and show me what to do. I long for you!

- ⁹ Rescue me from my enemies, O LORD.
I come to you for protection.
- ¹⁰ Teach me to do your will, because you are my God.
May your good Spirit lead me on level ground.
- ¹¹ O LORD, keep me alive for the sake of your name.
Because you are righteous, lead me out of trouble.
- ¹² In keeping with your mercy, wipe out my enemies
and destroy all who torment me,
because I am your servant.

143:9–12 Rescue me when I come to you for protection. You're my Lord, so train me to do your will. I'm your servant, so keep me alive for the sake of your good reputation.

Psalm 144

By David.

- ¹ Thank the LORD,
my rock, who trained my hands to fight
and my fingers to do battle,
² my merciful one, my fortress,
my stronghold, and my savior,

my shield, the one in whom I take refuge,
and the one who brings people under my authority.

144:1–2 Thank you, my rock, for making me tough. Train me to stay in the fight. You're my merciful one, my stronghold and Savior.

- ³ O LORD, what are humans that you should care about them?
What are mere mortals that you should think about them?
⁴ Humans are like a breath of air.
Their life span is like a fleeting shadow.

144:3–4 Why do you care about me? I'm nothing more than a breath of air. My life comes and goes like a shadow.

- ⁵ O LORD, bend your heaven low, and come down.
Touch the mountains, and they will smoke.
⁶ Hurl bolts of lightning, and scatter them.
Shoot your arrows, and throw them into confusion.
⁷ Stretch out your hands from above.
Snatch me, and rescue me from raging waters
and from foreigners' hands.
⁸ Their mouths speak lies.
Their right hands take false pledges.

144:5–8 Bring heaven to me here on earth. Come down to me now. Battle against my enemies.
Scatter and confuse them. They tell lies and make phony promises.

- ⁹ O God, I will sing a new song to you.
I will sing a psalm to you on a ten-stringed harp.
¹⁰ You are the one who gives victory to kings.
You are the one who snatches your servant David
away from a deadly sword.
¹¹ Snatch me, and rescue me from foreigners' hands.
Their mouths speak lies.
Their right hands take false pledges.

144:9–11 I'll sing a fresh song to you because you give me victory. You snatch me from my enemies, the ones who tell lies and make promises they don't intend to keep.

- ¹² May our sons be like full-grown, young plants.
May our daughters be like stately columns
that adorn the corners of a palace.
- ¹³ May our barns be filled with all kinds of crops.
May our sheep give birth to thousands of lambs,
tens of thousands in our fields.
- ¹⁴ May our cattle have many calves.[\[126\]](#)

May no one break in, and may no one be dragged out.
May there be no cries of distress in our streets.

¹⁵ Blessed are the people who have these blessings!
Blessed are the people whose God is the LORD!

144:12–15 Make my children strong and mature. Fill our house with food. Protect us from enemies who want to break into our lives and snatch us away. Keep our world free from distress. We're blessed to call you our Lord!

Psalm 145[\[127\]](#)

A song of praise by David.

- ¹ I will highly praise you, my God, the king.
I will bless your name forever and ever.
- ² I will bless you every day.
I will praise your name forever and ever.
- ³ The LORD is great, and he should be highly praised.
His greatness is unsearchable.

145:1–3 I have endless reasons to praise you, so I'll praise you today and forever. Your greatness is

more than I can comprehend.

- ⁴ One generation will praise your deeds to the next.
Each generation will talk about your mighty acts.
- ⁵ I will think about the glorious honor of your majesty
and the miraculous things you have done.
- ⁶ People will talk about the power of your terrifying deeds,
and I will tell about your greatness.
- ⁷ They will announce what they remember of your great goodness,
and they will joyfully sing about your righteousness.

145:4–7 Let each generation of your people tell the next what you’ve done. We’ll all sing of your goodness when I tell of your glorious honor and miraculous deeds.

- ⁸ The LORD is merciful, compassionate, patient,
and always ready to forgive.
- ⁹ The LORD is good to everyone
and has compassion for everything that he has made.
- ¹⁰ Everything that you have made will give thanks to you, O LORD,
and your faithful ones will praise you.

145:8–10 You’re merciful and ready to forgive. You’re compassionate toward everything you’ve made. Everything you’ve made thanks you.

- ¹¹ Everyone will talk about the glory of your kingdom
and will tell the descendants of Adam about your might
¹² in order to make known your mighty deeds
and the glorious honor of your kingdom.
- ¹³ Your kingdom is an everlasting kingdom.
Your empire endures throughout every generation.

145:11–13 All of your followers praise you as they talk about your glorious might. Your kingdom lasts forever.

- ¹⁴ The LORD supports everyone who falls.

He straightens ʘthe backsʘ of those who are bent over.

¹⁵ The eyes of all creatures look to you,
and you give them their food at the proper time.

¹⁶ You open your hand,
and you satisfy the desire of every living thing.

¹⁷ The LORD is fair in all his ways
and faithful in everything he does.

145:14–17 You support the fallen. You straighten the bent over. You feed us and satisfy our every desire. You’re always fair and faithful.

¹⁸ The LORD is near to everyone who prays to him,
to every faithful person who prays to him.

¹⁹ He fills the needs of those who fear him.
He hears their cries for help and saves them.

²⁰ The LORD protects everyone who loves him,
but he will destroy all wicked people.

²¹ My mouth will speak the praise of the LORD,
and all living creatures will praise his holy name forever and ever.

145:18–21 You’re near to everyone who prays to you, and you meet the needs of people who live for you with utter respect. When we ask you for help, you save us. Praise you now and forever!

Psalm 146

¹ Hallelujah!

Praise the LORD, my soul!

² I want to praise the LORD throughout my life.
I want to make music to praise my God as long as I live.

146:1–2 Hallelujah! Praise you! I’ll live my whole life as an act of worship. I’ll sing to you each day of my life.

- ³ Do not trust influential people,
mortals who cannot help you.
⁴ When they breathe their last breath, they return to the ground.
On that day their plans come to an end.
- ⁵ Blessed are those who receive help from the God of Jacob.
Their hope rests on the LORD their God,
⁶ who made heaven, earth,
the sea, and everything in them.
The LORD remains faithful forever.

146:3–6 I'm done with depending on influential people. They die and their plans die with them. Real help comes from you, the maker of heaven and earth. Your faithfulness never ends.

- ⁷ He brings about justice for those who are oppressed.
He gives food to those who are hungry.
The LORD sets prisoners free.
- ⁸ The LORD gives sight to blind people.
The LORD straightens └the backs┐ of those who are bent over.
The LORD loves righteous people.
- ⁹ The LORD protects foreigners.
The LORD gives relief to orphans and widows.
But he keeps wicked people from reaching their goal.
- ¹⁰ The LORD rules as king forever.
Zion, your God rules throughout every generation.

Hallelujah!

146:7–10 You grant justice to the oppressed and feed the hungry. You free prisoners and open blind eyes. You raise up the hurting, defend the outcast, and care for the needy. Rule as our King forever and ever!

Psalm 147

¹ Hallelujah!

It is good to sing psalms to our God.

It is pleasant to sing _his_ praise beautifully.

147:1 Hallelujah! It's good to sing beautiful songs to you.

² The LORD is the builder of Jerusalem.
He is the one who gathers the outcasts of Israel together.
³ He is the healer of the brokenhearted.
He is the one who bandages their wounds.
⁴ He determines the number of stars.
He gives each one a name.
⁵ Our Lord is great, and his power is great.
There is no limit to his understanding.
⁶ The LORD gives relief to those who are oppressed.
He brings wicked people down to the ground.

147:2–6 You make outcasts into a people and bandage the brokenhearted. You set stars in the sky and name each one. There's no limit to your power and knowledge. You relieve the oppressed and bring down evildoers.

⁷ Sing to the LORD a song of thanksgiving.
Make music to our God with a lyre.
⁸ He covers the sky with clouds.
He provides rain for the ground.
He makes grass grow on the mountains.
⁹ He is the one who gives food to animals
and to young ravens when they call out.

147:7–9 I'll sing thanks to you for sending rain and growing grass and feeding every living thing.

¹⁰ He finds no joy in strong horses,
nor is he pleased by brave soldiers.
¹¹ The LORD is pleased with those who fear him,
with those who wait with hope for his mercy.

147:10–11 You aren't impressed by human strength. You love hearts that hold you in awe and look

to you for mercy.

¹² Praise the LORD, Jerusalem!

Praise your God, Zion!

¹³ He makes the bars across your gates strong.

He blesses the children within you.

¹⁴ He is the one who brings peace to your borders
and satisfies your └hunger┘ with the finest wheat.

147:13–14 Strengthen our cities and build up our children. Bring peace to our land and satisfy our hunger.

¹⁵ He is the one who sends his promise throughout the earth.
His word travels with great speed.

¹⁶ He is the one who sends snow like wool
and scatters frost like ashes.

¹⁷ He is the one who throws his hailstones like breadcrumbs.
Who can withstand his chilling blast?

¹⁸ He sends out his word and melts his hailstones.
He makes wind blow └and┘ water flow.

¹⁹ He speaks his word to Jacob,
his laws and judicial decisions to Israel.

²⁰ He has done nothing like this for any other nation.
The other nations do not know the decisions he has handed down.

Hallelujah!

147:15–20 Your promises speed around the world. They carry out your will and convey wisdom to your people. Hallelujah!

Psalm 148

¹ Hallelujah!

Praise the LORD from the heavens.

Praise him in the heights above.

- ² Praise him, all his angels.
Praise him, his entire heavenly army.
- ³ Praise him, sun and moon.
Praise him, all shining stars.

148:3 Hallelujah! Let your praises sound from the heavens. Let them ring from sun, moon, and stars.

- ⁴ Praise him, you highest heaven
and the water above the sky.
- ⁵ Let them praise the name of the LORD
because they were created by his command.
- ⁶ He set them in their places forever and ever.
He made it a law that no one can break.

148:5–6 The heavens exist because of your command. They stay in place because of your law.

- ⁷ Praise the LORD from the earth.
Praise him, large sea creatures and all the ocean depths,
⁸ lightning and hail,
snow and fog,
strong winds that obey his commands,
⁹ mountains and all hills,
fruit trees and all cedar trees,

148:7–9 Let your praises sound from the earth. Let them ring from sea and sky, from mountains and hills, from snow and fog, from strong winds that obey you.

- ¹⁰ wild animals and all domestic animals,
crawling animals and birds,
¹¹ kings of the earth and all its people,
officials and all judges on the earth,
¹² young men and women,
old and young together.

148:10–12 Let your praises sound from your creatures. Let them ring from animals and birds, kings and commoners, women and men, old and young.

- ¹³ Let them praise the name of the LORD
because his name is high above all others.
His glory is above heaven and earth.
- ¹⁴ He has given his people a strong leader,[\[128\]](#)
someone praiseworthy for his faithful ones,
for the people of Israel, the people who are close to him.
Hallelujah!

148:13–14 Let your praises keep sounding forever. Your name is above any other name. Hallelujah!

Psalm 149

- ¹ Hallelujah!
- Sing a new song to the LORD.
Sing his praise in the assembly of godly people.
- ² Let Israel find joy in their creator.
Let the people of Zion rejoice over their king.

149:1–2 Hallelujah! I'll sing a new song to you. My Creator, I find joy in you. My King, I rejoice in you.

- ³ Let them praise his name with dancing.
Let them make music to him with tambourines and lyres,
⁴ because the LORD takes pleasure in his people.
He crowns those who are oppressed with victory.

149:3–4 I'll praise you with dancing and music. You smile at me and crown me with victory.

- ⁵ Let godly people triumph in glory.
Let them sing for joy on their beds.

⁶ Let the high praises of God be in their throats
and two-edged swords in their hands
⁷ to take vengeance on the nations,
to punish the people of the world,
⁸ to put their kings in chains
and their leaders in iron shackles,
⁹ to carry out the judgment that is written against them.
This is an honor that belongs to all his godly ones.

149:5–9 You declare judgment and avenge your honor. You shackle kings and punish people. Spare me from your day of wrath.

Hallelujah!

Psalm 150

¹ Hallelujah!

Praise God in his holy place.
Praise him in his mighty heavens.
² Praise him for his mighty acts.
Praise him for his immense greatness.

150:1–2 Hallelujah! I'll praise your holiness here on earth. I'll praise you when I come home to heaven. I'll praise you for your immense greatness.

³ Praise him with sounds from horns.
Praise him with harps and lyres.
⁴ Praise him with tambourines and dancing.
Praise him with stringed instruments and flutes.
⁵ Praise him with loud cymbals.
Praise him with crashing cymbals.
⁶ Let everything that breathes praise the LORD!

150:3–6 I'll praise you with instruments and dancing. I'll praise you with loud crashing cymbals.
Let every living thing join me in worship. Hallelujah!

Hallelujah!

- [1] 1:3 Or “and its leaves do not wither, and whatever it produces thrives.”
- [2] 2:2 Or “anointed one.”
- [3] 6:1 Unknown musical term
- [4] Unknown musical term
- [5] 7:4 Hebrew meaning of this line uncertain.
- [6] 7:6 Greek; Masoretic Text “Wake up to me.”
- [7] 8:1 Unknown musical term.
- [8] 8:1 Hebrew meaning of this line uncertain.
- [9] 9:1 Or “*almuth labben*”; unknown musical term.
- [10] 9:1 Some Hebrew manuscripts, Greek, and Latin treat Psalms 9 and 10 as one psalm.
- [11] 12:6 Hebrew meaning uncertain.
- [12] 14:1 Psalm 14 is virtually identical in wording to Psalm 53.
- [13] 16:1 Unknown musical term.
- [14] 16:3 English equivalent of this verse difficult.
- [15] 17:10 Hebrew meaning uncertain.
- [16] 18:1 Psalm 18 is virtually identical in wording to 2 Samuel 22.
- [17] 18:10 Or “cherubim.”
- [18] 18:50 Or “to his descendants.”
- [19] 21:12 Hebrew meaning of this verse uncertain.
- [20] 22:1 Unknown musical term.
- [21] 24:4 Hebrew meaning uncertain.
- [22] 24:6 A few Hebrew manuscripts, Greek, Syriac; Masoretic Text “your face, Jacob.”
- [23] 25:1 Psalm 25 is a poem in Hebrew alphabetical order.
- [24] 25:10 Or “covenant.”
- [25] 27:8 Hebrew meaning uncertain; Greek “My heart said to you, ‘I have sought your face. O LORD, I will seek your face.’”
- [26] 28:8 Or “anointed one.”
- [27] 29:9 Hebrew meaning of “splits the oaks” uncertain.

- [28] 30:12 Or “glory.”
- [29] 32:1 Unknown musical term.
- [30] 34:1 Psalm 34 is a poem in Hebrew alphabetical order.
- [31] 34:5 Hebrew meaning uncertain.
- [32] 37:1 Psalm 37 is a poem in Hebrew alphabetical order.
- [33] 38:1 Hebrew meaning of “to be kept in mind” uncertain.
- [34] 40:6 Hebrew meaning of this line uncertain.
- [35] 40:13 Verses 13–17 are virtually identical in wording to Psalm 70.
- [36] 42:1 Unknown musical term.
- [37] 42:7 Hebrew meaning of this verse uncertain.
- [38] 44:2 Or “and you sent them away.”
- [39] 44:17 Or “covenant.”
- [40] 45:1 Unknown musical term.
- [41] 46:1 Unknown musical term.
- [42] 49:11 Greek, Syriac, Targum; Masoretic Text “their insides.”
- [43] 50:16 Or “covenant.”
- [44] 51:6 Hebrew meaning uncertain/
- [45] 51:7 Branches from the hyssop plant were used in purification rites.
- [46] 51:7 “Clean” refers to anything that Moses’ Teachings say is presentable to God.
- [47] 53:1 Psalm 53 is virtually identical in wording to Psalm 14.
- [48] 53:1 Unknown musical term.
- [49] 53:5 Hebrew meaning uncertain.
- [50] 54:3 Hebrew meaning of this line uncertain.
- [51] 55:11 Or “its marketplace.”
- [52] 56:1 Unknown musical term.
- [53] 57:1 Unknown musical term.
- [54] 57:6 Hebrew meaning of this line uncertain.
- [55] 57:7 Verses 7–11 are virtually identical in wording to Psalm 108:1–5.
- [56] 57:8 Or “my glory.”
- [57] 58:7 Hebrew meaning of this sentence uncertain.
- [58] 58:9 Hebrew meaning uncertain.
- [59] 60:1 Unknown musical term.
- [60] 60:5 Verses 5–12 are virtually identical in wording to Psalm 108:6–13.

- [61] 68:4 Or “Lift a song to him who rides upon the clouds.”
- [62] 68:23 Greek, Targum, Syriac; Masoretic Text “shatter.”
- [63] 68:30 Hebrew meaning of this verse uncertain.
- [64] 70:1 Psalm 70 is virtually identical in wording to Psalm 40:13–17.
- [65] 72:1 According to ancient Jewish and Christian tradition, “king” and “king’s son” refer to the Messiah.
- [66] 73:7 Hebrew meaning uncertain.
- [67] 73:10 Hebrew meaning uncertain.
- [68] 74:1 Unknown musical term.
- [69] 74:3 Hebrew meaning uncertain.
- [70] 74:5 Hebrew meaning of this verse uncertain.
- [71] 74:11 Hebrew meaning of this verse uncertain.
- [72] 74:14 Hebrew meaning uncertain.
- [73] 74:20 Or “covenant.”
- [74] 76:4 Greek, Syriac; Masoretic Text “mountains of prey.”
- [75] 76:10 Hebrew meaning of this line uncertain.
- [76] 77:10 Hebrew meaning of this line uncertain.
- [77] 77:18 Hebrew meaning of this line uncertain.
- [78] 78:10 Or “covenant.”
- [79] 80:1 Or “cherubim.”
- [80] 81:1 Unknown musical term.
- [81] 83:13 Or “whirling dust.”
- [82] 83:15 Verse 15 (in Hebrew) has been placed in front of verse 14 to express the complex Hebrew sentence structure more clearly in English.
- [83] 84:5 Hebrew meaning of this line uncertain.
- [84] 84:6 Or “As they pass through the valley of Weeping.”
- [85] 84:6 Or “pools.”
- [86] 88:1 Unknown musical term.
- [87] 88:15 Hebrew meaning uncertain.
- [88] 88:18 Hebrew meaning uncertain.
- [89] 89:3 Or “covenant.”
- [90] 89:10 Rahab is the name of a demonic creature who opposes God.
- [91] 89:17 Hebrew meaning of “give us victory” uncertain.
- [92] 89:19 Hebrew meaning of this line uncertain.

- [93] 89:24 Hebrew meaning of “he will be victorious” uncertain.
- [94] 89:50 Many Hebrew manuscripts; other Hebrew manuscripts “LORD.”
- [95] 89:50 Many Hebrew manuscripts, Greek, Syriac; other Hebrew manuscripts “your servants.”
- [96] 89:51 Or “anointed one.”
- [97] 90:10 Hebrew meaning of “the best of them” uncertain.
- [98] 90:11 Hebrew meaning of this line uncertain.
- [99] 94:15 English equivalent of this verse difficult.
- [100] 97:11 One Hebrew manuscript, Greek, Syriac, Latin; other Hebrew manuscripts “Light is planted for righteous people.”
- [101] 99:1 Or “cherubim.”
- [102] 100:3 Many Hebrew manuscripts, Greek, Targum, Latin; other Hebrew manuscripts “and not we ourselves.”
- [103] 103:18 Or “covenant.”
- [104] 104:26 Hebrew meaning uncertain.
- [105] 105:8 Or “covenant.”
- [106] 106:20 Or “their glory.”
- [107] 106:45 Or “covenant.”
- [108] 108:1 Verses 1–5 are virtually identical in wording to Psalm 57:7–11; verses 6–13 are virtually identical in wording to Psalm 60:5–12.
- [109] 108:1 Or “my glory.”
- [110] 109:4 Or “but I am a man of prayer.”
- [111] 109:15 Or “them.”
- [112] 110:3 Or “You have the dew of your youth.”
- [113] 111:1 Psalm 111 is a poem in Hebrew alphabetical order.
- [114] 111:5 Or “covenant.”
- [115] 112:1 Psalm 112 is a poem in Hebrew alphabetical order.
- [116] 115:4 Verses 4–8 are virtually identical in wording to Psalm 135:15–18.
- [117] 119:1 Psalm 119 is a poem in Hebrew alphabetical order.
- [118] 119:118 Hebrew meaning of this line uncertain.
- [119] 119:126 One Hebrew manuscript, Latin; other Hebrew manuscripts “It is time to act for the LORD.”
- [120] 122:3 Hebrew meaning of this verse uncertain.
- [121] 132:12 Or “covenant.”
- [122] 135:15 Verses 15–18 are virtually identical in wording to Psalm 115:4–8.

- [[123](#)] 138:3 Hebrew meaning of this line uncertain.
- [[124](#)] 141:7 Hebrew meaning of verses 5–7 uncertain.
- [[125](#)] 142:1 Unknown musical term.
- [[126](#)] 144:14 Hebrew meaning of this verse uncertain.
- [[127](#)] 145:1 Psalm 145 is a poem in Hebrew alphabetical order.
- [[128](#)] 148:14 Or “given his people strength.”

Introduction to Proverbs

Like no other book of the Bible, Proverbs instructs you to sit down and listen closely. Again and again it plainly tells the good it seeks to accomplish. It offers “wisdom and discipline,” “deep thoughts.” It provides everything you need to “acquire the discipline of wise behavior” along with “righteousness and justice and fairness.” It gives “insight to gullible people” and “knowledge and foresight to the young.” It lets even the wise “listen and continue to learn” and the discerning “gain direction” (Proverbs 1:1–5).

The first part of this book (Proverbs 1–9) introduces wisdom, explaining what it is and why you need it. The remainder of the book contains pithy sayings. A mostly random collection of 375 of these proverbs (Proverbs 10:1–22:16) comes from Solomon, a man uniquely gifted with God’s wisdom (1 Kings 3:12). Other sayings of the wise fill out the book, with material arranged more thematically (Proverbs 22:17–31:31).

Though the topics covered range from relationships and money to work, sex, parenting, and more, a single truth connects them all: Wisdom begins and ends with respect for God (Proverbs 1:7). The sayings in the book

frequently use parallelism to make a point, repeating similar and contrasting thoughts.

Praying this book invites you to open yourself to God's wisdom, to ask God to let these words permeate your heart and mind and change your life. Explore Proverbs not just as a collection of human sayings but as a gift of insight to you from the all-wise God.

PROVERBS

The Reasons for Proverbs

- 1¹ The proverbs of Solomon, David's son who was king of Israel, **given**
2 to grasp wisdom and discipline,
to understand deep thoughts,
3 to acquire the discipline of wise behavior—
righteousness and justice and fairness—
4 to give insight to gullible people,
to give knowledge and foresight to the young—

1:1–4 I crave wisdom! I need discipline! Teach me deep thoughts that train me to be good and fair.
Expose my blind spots and give me insight beyond my years.

- 5 a wise person will listen and continue to learn,
and an understanding person will gain direction—
6 to understand a proverb and a clever saying,
the words of wise people and their riddles.
7 The fear of the LORD is the beginning of knowledge.
Stubborn fools despise wisdom and discipline.

1:5–7 I'm willing to learn and keep learning from smart people you put in my path. I'm finally
starting to wise up when I give you the respect you deserve.

Listen to Wisdom

- 8 My son,
listen to your father's discipline,
and do not neglect your mother's teachings,
9 because discipline and teachings
are a graceful garland on your head

and a “golden” chain around your neck.

1:8–9 I won’t shut out my parents’ words or resent the ways they discipline me. I’ll let their wisdom grace my life.

¹⁰ My son,
if sinners lure you, do not go along.
¹¹ If they say,
“Come with us.
Let’s set an ambush to kill someone.
Let’s hide to ambush innocent people for fun.
¹² We’ll swallow them alive like the grave,
like those in good health who go into the pit.
¹³ We’ll find all kinds of valuable possessions.
We’ll fill our homes with stolen goods.
¹⁴ Join us.
We’ll split the loot equally.”

1:10–14 Help me be on guard against anyone aiming to lure me into sin. I won’t let them sell me on the so-called fun of hurting innocent people or taking what isn’t mine.

¹⁵ My son,
do not follow them in their way.
Do not even set foot on their path,
¹⁶ because they rush to do evil
and hurry to shed blood.
¹⁷ It does no good to spread a net
within the sight of any bird.
¹⁸ But these people set an ambush for their own murder.
They go into hiding only to lose their lives.
¹⁹ This is what happens to everyone
who is greedy for unjust gain.
Greed takes away his life.

1:15–19 I choose not to take a single step down the path to sin, because people who rush to do evil will get what they deserve. They’ll be killed in the ambush they set for others. Sooner or later their

greed will catch up with them.

²⁰ Wisdom sings her song in the streets.

In the public squares she raises her voice.

²¹ At the corners of noisy streets she calls out.

At the entrances to the city she speaks her words,

²² “How long will you gullible people love being so gullible?

How long will you mockers find joy in your mocking?

How long will you fools hate knowledge?

1:20–22 Your wisdom sings to me. You call me by name. You want to know how much longer I’ll be so gullible. You can’t figure out why I hate knowledge.

²³ “Turn to me when I warn you.

I will generously pour out my spirit for you.

I will make my words known to you.

²⁴ “I called, and you refused to listen.

I stretched out my hands to you, and no one paid attention.

²⁵ You ignored all my advice.

You did not want me to warn you.

1:23–25 Warn me. Pour out your Spirit for me. Teach me wise words. I won’t let your efforts go to waste. I’ll act on your advice.

²⁶ I will laugh at your calamity.

I will make fun of you
when panic strikes you,

²⁷ when panic strikes you like a violent storm,
when calamity strikes you like a wind storm,
when trouble and anguish come to you.

²⁸ “They will call to me at that time, but I will not answer.

They will look for me, but they will not find me,

²⁹ because they hated knowledge
and did not choose the fear of the LORD.

1:26–29 I refuse to bring calamity on myself or give people reason to laugh at my panic. I don’t

want anyone to say I ignored your advice. Don't ever stop trying to get through to me!

³⁰ They refused my advice.

They despised my every warning.

³¹ They will eat the fruit of their lifestyle.

They will be stuffed with their own schemes.

³² “Gullible people kill themselves because of their turning away.

Fools destroy themselves because of their indifference.

³³ But whoever listens to me will live without worry
and will be free from the dread of disaster.”

1:32–33 I have enough problems in life without bringing trouble on myself. I'd rather listen to you
and live without worry.

The Benefit of Wisdom

²¹ My son,

if you take my words _{to heart}

and treasure my commands within you,

² if you pay close attention to wisdom,
and let your mind reach for understanding,

³ if indeed you call out for insight,
if you ask aloud for understanding,

⁴ if you search for wisdom as if it were money
and hunt for it as if it were hidden treasure,

⁵ then you will understand the fear of the LORD
and you will find the knowledge of God.

2:1–5 Your wisdom never comes cheap or easy. So I'll take your words to heart. I'll pay close
attention to everything you say. I'll cry for understanding and hunt for wisdom like buried treasure.
Then I'll know and fear you.

⁶ The LORD gives wisdom.

From his mouth come knowledge and understanding.

⁷ He has reserved priceless wisdom for decent people.

He is a shield for those who walk in integrity
⁸ in order to guard those on paths of justice
and to watch over the way of his godly ones.
⁹ Then you will understand what is right and just and fair—
every good course ⌋in life⌋.

2:6–9 Wisdom comes straight from you—and you save your best wisdom for people who won't squander it. Guard me as I act on your wisdom. Show me how and where to do good.

¹⁰ Wisdom will come into your heart.
Knowledge will be pleasant to your soul.
¹¹ Foresight will protect you.
Understanding will guard you.
¹² ⌋Wisdom will⌋ save you
from the way of evil,
from the person who speaks devious things,
¹³ from those who abandon the paths of righteousness
to walk the ways of darkness,
¹⁴ from those who enjoy doing evil,
from those who find joy in the deviousness of evil.
¹⁵ Their paths are crooked.
Their ways are devious.

2:10–15 Your wisdom pleases me. It guards me and saves me from evil. It protects me from people who want to pull me down dark crooked paths.

¹⁶ ⌋Wisdom will⌋ also save you
from an adulterous woman,
from a loose woman with her smooth talk,
¹⁷ who leaves ⌋her husband⌋, the closest friend of her youth,
and forgets her marriage vows to her God.
¹⁸ Her house sinks down to death.
Her ways lead to the souls of the dead.
¹⁹ None who have sex with her come back.
Nor do they ever reach the paths of life.

2:16–19 Wisdom saves me from sinning against my spouse. It shows me the stupidity of abandoning my best friend and the vows we made in your presence. Wisdom shouts that sexual sin will ravage my world and kill my soul.

²⁰ So walk in the way of good people
and stay on the paths of righteous people.

²¹ Decent people will live in the land.
People of integrity will remain in it.

²² But wicked people will be cut off from the land
and treacherous people will be torn^[1] from it.

2:21–22 I'll live in your blessings when I follow your ways. Don't let anything tear me away from you!

Using Wisdom

³¹ My son,
do not forget my teachings,
and keep my commands in mind,
² because they will bring you
long life, good years, and peace.
³ Do not let mercy and truth leave you.
Fasten them around your neck.
Write them on the tablet of your heart.
⁴ Then you will find favor and much success
in the sight of God and humanity.

3:1–4 Your teachings bring me long life, good years, and peace. So I'll never forget your commands. I'll keep mercy and truth close to my heart. They bring me success.

⁵ Trust the LORD with all your heart,
and do not rely on your own understanding.

⁶ In all your ways acknowledge him,
and he will make your paths smooth.^[2]

3:5–6 I trust you with all my heart. Your wisdom is so much bigger than mine. I count on you to lead my every step. Smooth my path!

⁷ Do not consider yourself wise.
Fear the LORD, and turn away from evil.

⁸ Then your body will be healed,
and your bones will have nourishment.

⁹ Honor the LORD with your wealth
and with the first and best part of all your income.^[3]

¹⁰ Then your barns will be full,
and your vats will overflow with fresh wine.

3:7–10 When I turn from evil, you heal and nourish me. When I honor you with my wealth, you surprise me with abundance.

¹¹ Do not reject the discipline of the LORD, my son,
and do not resent his warning,
¹² because the LORD warns the one he loves,
even as a father warns a son with whom he is pleased.

3:11–12 I welcome your discipline as a sign you love me. I accept your warnings as proof I'm your child.

¹³ Blessed is the one who finds wisdom
and the one who obtains understanding.

¹⁴ The profit gained from wisdom is greater than
the profit gained from silver.
Its yield is better than fine gold.

¹⁵ Wisdom is more precious than jewels,
and all your desires cannot equal it.

3:14–15 Your wisdom brings riches greater than pure gold, true wealth more precious than my largest desires.

¹⁶ Long life is in [⌋]wisdom's[⌋] right hand.
In [⌋]wisdom's[⌋] left hand are riches and honor.
¹⁷ [⌋]Wisdom's[⌋] ways are pleasant ways,
and all its paths lead to peace.
¹⁸ [⌋]Wisdom[⌋] is a tree of life
for those who take firm hold of it.
Those who cling to it are blessed.

3:17–18 Your wisdom points me down pleasant paths, leading me to life and peace. I'll forever cling to your insights.

¹⁹ By Wisdom the LORD laid the foundation of the earth.
By understanding he established the heavens.
²⁰ By his knowledge the deep waters were divided,
and the skies dropped dew.

²¹ My son,
do not lose sight of these things.
Use priceless wisdom and foresight.
²² Then they will mean life for you,
and they will grace your neck.
²³ Then you will go safely on your way,
and you will not hurt your foot.
²⁴ When you lie down, you will not be afraid.
As you lie there, your sleep will be sweet.

²⁵ Do not be afraid of sudden terror
or of the destruction of wicked people when it comes.
²⁶ The LORD will be your confidence.
He will keep your foot from getting caught.

3:21–26 I'll never let your wisdom out of my sight. It brings me life and leads me to safety. It lets me lie down unafraid and sleep sweetly. It spares me from fear. You are my confidence!

²⁷ Do not hold back anything good
from those who are entitled to it

when you have the power to do so.

²⁸ When you have the good thing with you, do not tell your neighbor,

“Go away!

Come back tomorrow.

I’ll give you something then.”

3:27–28 You have the power to give me everything I truly need. Don’t hold back! I’ll share everything you give me.

²⁹ Do not plan to do something wrong to your neighbor while he is sitting there with you and suspecting nothing.

³⁰ Do not quarrel with a person for no reason if he has not harmed you.

³¹ Do not envy a violent person.

Do not choose any of his ways.

³² The devious person is disgusting to the LORD.

The LORD’s intimate advice is with decent people.

3:29–32 I won’t plot evil against my neighbor or quarrel without cause. I won’t envy or imitate the violent. You guide and empower people intent on doing good.

³³ The LORD curses the house of wicked people, but he blesses the home of righteous people.

³⁴ When he mocks the mockers, he is gracious to humble people.

³⁵ Wise people will inherit honor, but fools will bear disgrace.

3:33–35 If I chase wickedness, I miss your blessing. I suffer disgrace when I act like a fool.

Cherish Wisdom

4¹ Sons,

listen to **your** father’s discipline,
and pay attention in order to gain understanding.

² After all, I have taught you well.
Do not abandon my teachings.
³ When I was a boy 「learning」 from my father,
when I was a tender and only child of my mother,
⁴ they used to teach me and say to me,
“Cling to my words wholeheartedly.
Obey my commands so that you may live.

4:1–4 You use my parents to discipline me and give me understanding. They teach me your life-giving commands.

⁵ Acquire wisdom.
Acquire understanding.
Do not forget.
Do not turn away from the words that I have spoken.
⁶ Do not abandon wisdom, and it will watch over you.
Love wisdom, and it will protect you.

4:5–6 I’m determined to acquire your wisdom. I won’t forget what you teach, and I’ll stay true to the words you speak. They guard and protect me.

⁷ The beginning of wisdom is to acquire wisdom.
Acquire understanding with all that you have.
⁸ Cherish wisdom.
It will raise you up.
It will bring you honor when you embrace it.
⁹ It will give you a graceful garland for your head.
It will hand you a beautiful crown.”

4:8–9 I love your wisdom. It raises me up and honors me. It graces my head like a beautiful crown.

Stay on the Path of Wisdom

¹⁰ My son,
listen and accept my words,

and they will multiply the years of your life.

¹¹ I have taught you the way of wisdom.

I have guided you along decent paths.

¹² When you walk, your stride will not be hampered.

Even if you run, you will not stumble.

4:10–12 Your wisdom lengthens my life and leads me down good paths. With your wisdom I run strong and don't stumble.

¹³ Cling to discipline.

Do not relax your grip on it.

Keep it because it is your life.

4:13 I'll grab hold of your wisdom and never let go. Your wisdom is my life.

¹⁴ Do not stray onto the path of wicked people.

Do not walk in the way of evil people.

¹⁵ Avoid it.

Do not walk near it.

Turn away from it,
and keep on walking.

¹⁶ Wicked people cannot sleep
unless they do wrong,
and they are robbed of their sleep
unless they make someone stumble.

4:14–16 Lead me out of evil habits. Help me run fast and hard from evil ways. I want the peaceful slumber that comes from doing right.

¹⁷ They eat food obtained through wrongdoing
and drink wine obtained through violence.

¹⁸ But the path of righteous people is like the light of dawn
that becomes brighter and brighter until it reaches midday.

¹⁹ The way of wicked people is like deep darkness.
They do not know what makes them stumble.

4:18–19 You light up my path like the dawn, shining brighter and brighter as the hours pass. You keep me from stumbling in darkness.

Stay Focused on Wisdom

²⁰ My son,
pay attention to my words.
Open your ears to what I say.
²¹ Do not lose sight of these things.
Keep them deep within your heart
²² because they are life to those who find them
and they heal the whole body.

4:20–22 I'll listen closely to your words. Your wisdom gives me life and heals my whole body.

²³ Guard your heart more than anything else,
because the source of your life flows from it.

4:23 Whatever I let flourish in my heart flows out to my whole life. So I'll guard my heart above all else.

²⁴ Remove dishonesty from your mouth.
Put deceptive speech far away from your lips.
²⁵ Let your eyes look straight ahead
and your sight be focused in front of you.
²⁶ Carefully walk a straight path,
and all your ways will be secure.
²⁷ Do not lean to the right or to the left.
Walk away from evil.

4:25–27 Keep me focused straight ahead as I walk toward you. Don't let me veer off the path into evil.

Avoid Adultery

5¹ My son,
pay attention to my wisdom.
Open your ears to my understanding
² so that you may act with foresight
and speak with insight.

5:1–2 I won't plug my ears to your wisdom. I'll listen and act with understanding.

³ The lips of an adulterous woman drip with honey.
Her kiss is smoother than oil,
⁴ but in the end she is as bitter as wormwood,
as sharp as a two-edged sword.
⁵ Her feet descend to death.
Her steps lead straight to hell.
⁶ She doesn't even think about the path of life.
Her steps wander, and she doesn't realize it.

5:3–6 Sexual sin sounds sweet and smooth, but it cuts like a double-bladed sword. It leads straight to death.

⁷ But now, sons,
listen to me,
and do not turn away from what I say to you.
⁸ Stay far away from her.
Do not even go near her door.

5:7–8 I won't run from your wise advice. I won't go anywhere near the door of sexual sin. I'll stay far from every person, place, or situation that tempts me to unfaithfulness. Help me!

⁹ Either you will surrender your reputation to others
and the rest of your years to some cruel person,
¹⁰ or strangers will benefit from your strength
and you will have to work hard in a pagan's house.

¹¹ Then you will groan when your end comes,
when your body and flesh are consumed.
You will say,
¹² “Oh, how I hated discipline!
How my heart despised correction!
¹³ I didn’t listen to what my teachers said to me,
nor did I keep my ear open to my instructors.
¹⁴ I almost reached total ruin
in the assembly and in the congregation.”

5:11–14 The cost of adultery is total destruction, consuming bodies and hearts that hate correction.
Convince me my teachers are right so I don’t end in ruin.

¹⁵ Drink water out of your own cistern
and running water from your own well.
¹⁶ Why should water flow out of your spring?
Why should your streams flow into the streets?
¹⁷ They should be yours alone,
so do not share them with strangers.
¹⁸ Let your own fountain be blessed,
and enjoy the girl you married when you were young,
¹⁹ a loving doe and a graceful deer.[\[4\]](#)
Always let her breasts satisfy you.
Always be intoxicated with her love.

5:15–19 I’ll share myself only with my spouse, because my body and heart belong to my love and no one else. I’ll delight in my spouse today even more than the day we wed. Fill us with intoxicating love!

²⁰ Why should you, my son,
be intoxicated with an adulterous woman
and fondle a loose woman’s breast?

²¹ Each person’s ways are clearly seen by the LORD,
and he surveys all his actions.
²² A wicked person will be trapped by his own wrongs,

and he will be caught in the ropes of his own sin.
²³ He will die for his lack of discipline
and stumble around because of his great stupidity.

5:21–23 You see everything I do. Keep me from stumbling into deeper and deeper sin. Don't let me die as a result of my own stupidity.

Avoid Disaster

⁶¹ My son,
if you guarantee a loan for your neighbor
or pledge yourself for a stranger with a handshake,
² you are trapped by the words of your own mouth,
caught by your own promise.
³ Do the following things, my son, so that you may free yourself,
because you have fallen into your neighbor's hands:
Humble yourself,
and pester your neighbor.
⁴ Don't let your eyes rest
or your eyelids close.
⁵ Free yourself like a gazelle from the hand of a hunter
and like a bird from the hand of a hunter.

6:1–5 Don't let me be so dumb I make disastrous promises. Show me how to break free of pledges I've come to regret.

⁶ Consider the ant, you lazy bum.
Watch its ways, and become wise.
⁷ Although it has no overseer, officer, or ruler,
⁸ in summertime it stores its food supply.
At harvest time it gathers its food.

6:6–8 Teach me to take charge of myself and work hard even when no one stands over me telling me what to do. Train me not to squander seasons of ease and plenty.

⁹ How long will you lie there, you lazy bum?
When will you get up from your sleep?

¹⁰ “Just a little sleep,
just a little slumber,
just a little nap.”

¹¹ Then your poverty will come *to you* like a drifter,
and your need will come *to you* like a bandit.

6:9–11 Wake me when I want to doze off instead of working hard at everything you plan for me.
Don’t let me sleep my life away or make rest my highest goal.

¹² A good-for-nothing scoundrel is a person who has a dishonest mouth.

¹³ He winks his eye,
makes a signal with his foot,
and points with his fingers.

¹⁴ He devises evil all the time with a twisted mind.
He spreads conflict.

¹⁵ That is why disaster will come on him suddenly.
In a moment he will be crushed beyond recovery.

¹⁶ There are six things that the LORD hates,
even seven that are disgusting to him:

¹⁷ arrogant eyes,
a lying tongue,
hands that kill innocent people,

¹⁸ a mind devising wicked plans,
feet that are quick to do wrong,

¹⁹ a dishonest witness spitting out lies,
and a person who spreads conflict among relatives.

6:16–19 Free me from everything that displeases you—from arrogance and deceit, from rage and evil schemes, from chasing after sin, from speaking lies instead of truth, from provoking conflict in my family.

More Advice About Avoiding Adultery

²⁰ My son,

obey the command of your father,
and do not disregard the teachings of your mother.

²¹ Fasten them on your heart forever.

Hang them around your neck.

²² When you walk around, they will lead you.

When you lie down, they will watch over you.

When you wake up, they will talk to you

²³ because the command is a lamp,

the teachings are a light,

and the warnings from discipline are the path of life

6:20–23 My parents taught me right from wrong, so I'll continually remind myself of what they said. Their wisdom watches over me and fills my ears. It warns me and puts me on your path to life.

²⁴ to keep you from an evil woman
and from the smooth talk of a loose woman.

²⁵ Do not desire her beauty in your heart.

Do not let her catch you with her eyes.

²⁶ A prostitute's price is only a loaf of bread,
but a married woman hunts for your life itself.

²⁷ Can a man carry fire in his lap
without burning his clothes?

²⁸ Can anyone walk on red-hot coals
without burning his feet?

²⁹ So it is with a man who has sex with his neighbor's wife.
None who touch her will escape punishment.

6:24–29 Keep my mind clear when sexual sin beckons me. Remind me that beauty is a trap and charming eyes deceive. Sexual sin always burns.

³⁰ People do not despise a thief who is hungry
when he steals to satisfy his appetite,

³¹ but when he is caught,
he has to repay it seven times.

He must give up all the possessions in his house.

6:30–31 It's too easy to explain away and justify my sins. Remind me that I can't escape the consequences of doing wrong.

³² Whoever commits adultery with a woman has no sense.
Whoever does this destroys himself.

³³ An adulterous man will find disease⁵ and dishonor,
and his disgrace will not be blotted out,

³⁴ because jealousy arouses a husband's fury.
The husband will show no mercy when he takes revenge.

³⁵ No amount of money will change his mind.
The largest bribe will not satisfy him.

6:32–35 Sexual sin makes no sense. Don't let me ever forget how it leads to destruction, disease, and dishonor. It arouses a spouse's fury

⁷¹ My son,
pay attention to my words.
Treasure my commands that are within you.
² Obey my commands so that you may live.
Follow my teachings just as you protect the pupil of your eye.

7:1–2 I pay close attention to your words. I treasure your commands deep in my heart. I keep your teachings as carefully as I protect my own eyes.

³ Tie them on your fingers.
Write them on the tablet of your heart.

⁴ Say to wisdom, "You are my sister."
Give the name "my relative" to understanding

⁵ in order to guard yourself from an adulterous woman,
from a loose woman with her smooth talk.

⁶ From a window in my house I looked through my screen.

⁷ I was looking at gullible people
when I saw a young man without much sense among youths.
⁸ He was crossing a street near her corner

and walking toward her house
⁹ in the twilight,
in the evening,
in the dark hours of the night.

¹⁰ A woman with an ulterior motive meets him.
She is dressed as a prostitute.

¹¹ She is loud and rebellious.
Her feet will not stay at home.

¹² One moment she is out on the street,
the next she is at the curb,
on the prowl at every corner.

7:4–12 Your wisdom guards me from sexual sin. But I'm surrounded by gullible people. I see them everywhere I look. Young men hook up with women on the prowl. They're blind to each others' evil motives. Give me more sense than that!

¹³ She grabs him and kisses him and brazenly says to him,

¹⁴ "I have some sacrificial meat.
Today I kept my vows.

¹⁵ That's why I came to meet you.
Eagerly, I looked for you,
and I've found you.

¹⁶ I've made my bed,
with colored sheets of Egyptian linen.

¹⁷ I've sprinkled my bed with myrrh, aloes, and cinnamon.

¹⁸ Come, let's drink our fill of love until morning.
Let's enjoy making love,

¹⁹ because my husband's not home.
He has gone on a long trip.

²⁰ He took lots of money with him.
He won't be home for a couple of weeks."

²¹ With all her seductive charms, she persuades him.
With her smooth lips, she makes him give in.

7:13–21 Temptation never stays on the edge of my life. It hunts me down and grabs hold of me. It

recites all the reasons I should give in to sin, promising me evil pleasures at no cost. Make your truth louder than these lies.

²² He immediately follows her
like a steer on its way to be slaughtered,
like a ram hobbling into captivity^[6]
²³ until an arrow pierces his heart,
like a bird darting into a trap.
He does not realize that it will cost him his life.

7:22–23 Sexual sin will lead me to slaughter. It will hobble me and pierce my heart. It will cost me my life. Remind me of these realities!

²⁴ Now, sons,
listen to me.
Pay attention to the words from my mouth.
²⁵ Do not let your heart be turned to her ways.
Do not wander onto her paths,
²⁶ because she has brought down many victims,
and she has killed all too many.
²⁷ Her home is the way to hell
and leads to the darkest vaults of death.

7:24–27 I want a heart stubbornly committed to staying on your path. Help me see sexual sin for what it is—a stop on the way to the darkest place in hell.

Wisdom's Announcement

⁸¹ Does not wisdom call out?
Does not understanding raise its voice?
² „Wisdom„ takes its stand on high ground,
by the wayside where the roads meet,
³ near the gates to the city.
At the entrance „wisdom„ sings its song,
⁴ “I am calling to all of you,
and my appeal is to all people.

⁵ You gullible people, learn how to be sensible.
You fools, get a heart that has understanding.[\[7\]](#)

8:1–5 Your wisdom calls out to every human being. It shouts from high ground so the crowds can hear. Let your wisdom teach me good sense. Let it give me the understanding I need for real life.

⁶ Listen! I am speaking about noble things,
and my lips will say what is right.

⁷ My mouth expresses the truth,
and wickedness is disgusting to my lips.

⁸ Everything I say is fair,
and there is nothing twisted or crooked in it.

⁹ All of it is clear to a person who has understanding
and right to those who have acquired knowledge.

8:6–9 In a world full of lies you speak pure truth. Your every word is fair. Not a single one twists the facts. Your wisdom is clear to anyone who wants it.

¹⁰ Take my discipline, not silver,
and my knowledge rather than fine gold,

¹¹ because wisdom is better than jewels.
Nothing you desire can equal it.

8:10–11 I want your discipline more than silver, your knowledge more than gold, your wisdom more than jewels. Nothing in the world equals your wisdom.

Wisdom's Authority

¹² “I, Wisdom, live with insight,
and I acquire knowledge and foresight.

¹³ To fear the LORD is to hate evil.
I hate pride, arrogance, evil behavior, and twisted speech.

¹⁴ Advice and priceless wisdom are mine.
I, Understanding, have strength.

¹⁵ Through me kings reign,

and rulers decree fair laws.

¹⁶ Through me princes rule,
so do nobles and all fair judges.

8:12–16 Your wisdom gives insight and knowledge. It teaches me to hate evil—whether pride or arrogance, evil acts or twisted words. It gives kings power and compels judges to be fair.

¹⁷ I love those who love me.
Those eagerly looking for me will find me.

¹⁸ I have riches and honor,
lasting wealth and righteousness.

¹⁹ What I produce is better than gold, pure gold.
What I yield is better than fine silver.

²⁰ I walk in the way of righteousness, on the paths of justice,

²¹ to give an inheritance to those who love me
and to fill their treasuries.

8:17–21 You love those who love your insights, and you grant your wisdom to anyone who eagerly looks for it. Your wisdom bestows riches greater than pure gold. It points me to righteousness and justice.

Wisdom as Creator

²² “The LORD already possessed me long ago,
when his way began,
before any of his works.

²³ I was appointed from everlasting from the first,
before the earth began.

8:22–23 Your wisdom is an indispensable part of your heart and mind. It comes from the core of who you are. Your wisdom is as ancient as you.

²⁴ I was born
before there were oceans,
before there were springs filled with water.

²⁵ I was born
before the mountains were settled in their places and before the hills,
²⁶ when he had not yet made land or fields or the first dust of the world.
²⁷ “When he set up the heavens, I was there.
When he traced the horizon on the surface of the ocean,
²⁸ when he established the skies above,
when he determined the currents in the ocean,
²⁹ when he set a limit for the sea
so the waters would not overstep his command,
when he traced the foundations of the earth,

8:24–29 Your wisdom existed before earth began, before oceans and mountains, before fields and skies. It’s been around since before anything began.

³⁰ I was beside him as a master craftsman. [\[8\]](#)
I made him happy day after day,
I rejoiced in front of him all the time,
³¹ found joy in his inhabited world,
and delighted in the human race.

8:30–31 Your wisdom makes you a master craftsman. It gives you joy in everything you made. It makes you happy with the people you created.

Wisdom as Lifegiver

³² “Now, sons, listen to me.
Blessed are those who follow my ways.
³³ Listen to discipline, and become wise.
Do not leave my ways.
³⁴ Blessed is the person who listens to me,
watches at my door day after day,
and waits by my doorposts.
³⁵ Whoever finds me finds life
and obtains favor from the LORD.
³⁶ Whoever sins against me harms himself.
All those who hate me love death.”

8:32–36 When I live according to your wisdom, I experience your blessing. So I listen to your every word. I watch and wait for your advice. Finding your wisdom brings me life, but forsaking your insights puts me in harm's way.

Wisdom's Hosts a Banquet

- 9¹ Wisdom has built her house.
She has carved out her seven pillars.
² She has prepared her meat.
She has mixed her wine.
She has set her table.
³ She has sent out her servant girls.
She calls from the highest places in the city,
⁴ “Whoever is gullible turn in here!”
- She says to a person without sense,
⁵ “Come, eat my bread,
and drink the wine I have mixed.
⁶ Stop being gullible and live.
Start traveling the road to understanding.”

9:1–6 Your wisdom stands like a well-built house, beautiful and complete. Your wisdom prepares a feast, calling out to me and other gullible people. It invites us to eat and enjoy.

Wisdom Prolongs Life

- ⁷ Whoever corrects a mocker receives abuse.
Whoever warns a wicked person gets hurt.
⁸ Do not warn a mocker, or he will hate you.
Warn a wise person, and he will love you.
⁹ Give advice to a wise person,
and he will become even wiser.
Teach a righteous person,
and he will learn more.

9:7–9 I fear correcting belligerent people, but often I have no choice. Make me brave and bold. Help me notice opportunities to share wisdom with people who want it. We can help each other grow.

¹⁰ The fear of the LORD is the beginning of wisdom.
The knowledge of the Holy One is understanding.

¹¹ You will live longer because of me,
and years will be added to your life.

¹² If you are wise, your wisdom will help you.
If you mock, you alone will be held responsible.

9:10–12 I'm finally starting to wise up when I give you the respect you deserve. Your wisdom will add years to my life. But if I mock your ways, I'll never get the insight I need.

Stupidity Imitates Wisdom's Banquet

¹³ The woman Stupidity is loud, gullible, and ignorant.[\[9\]](#)

¹⁴ She sits at the doorway of her house.
She is enthroned on the high ground of the city

¹⁵ and calls to those who pass by,
those minding their own business,

¹⁶ “Whoever is gullible turn in here!”

She says to a person without sense,

¹⁷ “Stolen waters are sweet,
and food eaten in secret is tasty.”

¹⁸ But he does not know
that the souls of the dead are there,
that her guests are in the depths of hell.

9:13–18 Wisdom calls out to me. But so does stupidity—in a loud and gullible and ignorant voice. I'm trying hard to do right, but stupidity still makes its case for doing wrong. Remind me that stupidity puts my soul on a path to death.

10¹ The proverbs of Solomon: **A Wise Son Is Righteous**

A wise son makes his father happy,
but a foolish son brings grief to his mother.

² Treasures gained dishonestly profit no one,
but righteousness rescues from death.

³ The LORD will not allow a righteous person to starve,
but he intentionally ignores the desires of a wicked person.

⁴ Lazy hands bring poverty,
but hard-working hands bring riches.

10:2–4 Train me to do right in every part of life, because living your way will rescue me from death.
You won't let me go hungry, and my hard work will bear fruit.

⁵ Whoever gathers in the summer is a wise son.
Whoever sleeps at harvest time brings shame.

⁶ Blessings cover the head of a righteous person,
but violence covers the mouths of wicked people.

⁷ The name of a righteous person remains blessed,
but the names of wicked people will rot away.

10:5–7 Teach me to seize moments when I need to put wisdom into action. I'll miss out on your blessings if I don't act.

Proverbs Concerning the Mouth

⁸ The one who is truly wise accepts commands,
but the one who talks foolishly will be thrown down headfirst.

⁹ Whoever lives honestly will live securely,
but whoever lives dishonestly will be found out.

¹⁰ Whoever winks with his eye causes heartache.
The one who talks foolishly will be thrown down headfirst.
¹¹ The mouth of a righteous person is a fountain of life,
but the mouths of wicked people conceal violence.

10:8–11 Foolish words hurl me down headfirst. Save me from tripping myself up with my words.
Let my words be a fountain of life to everyone who listens.

¹² Hate starts quarrels,
but love covers every wrong.

10:12 I'm quick to talk on and on about how I've been wronged. Teach me to make up and move ahead.

¹³ Wisdom is found on the lips of a person who has understanding,
but a rod is for the back of one without sense.
¹⁴ Those who are wise store up knowledge,
but the mouth of a stubborn fool invites ruin.

10:14 I don't want your wisdom to come in one ear and go out the other. I promise to remember everything you teach me.

¹⁵ The rich person's wealth is his strong city.
Poverty ruins the poor.
¹⁶ A righteous person's reward is life.
A wicked person's harvest is sin.
¹⁷ Whoever practices discipline is on the way to life,
but whoever ignores a warning strays.

¹⁸ Whoever conceals hatred has lying lips.
Whoever spreads slander is a fool.
¹⁹ Sin is unavoidable when there is much talk,
but whoever seals his lips is wise.
²⁰ The tongue of a righteous person is pure silver.
The hearts of wicked people are worthless.

10:18–20 I'm a fake when my words don't match my thoughts. I'm a fool when I spread insults. Whenever I open my mouth too much I'm bound to sin. So help me make my every word count for good.

²¹ The lips of a righteous person feed many,
but stubborn fools die because they have no sense.

²² It is the LORD's blessing that makes a person rich,
and hard work adds nothing to it.

10:22 I can't take credit for anything I've accomplished in life. Even my ability to work hard is a gift from you. Thank you!

²³ Like the laughter of a fool when he carries out an evil plan,
so is wisdom to a person who has understanding.

Righteous People Contrasted to Wicked People

²⁴ That which wicked people dread happens to them,
but **the LORD** grants the desire of righteous people.

²⁵ When the storm has passed, the wicked person has vanished,
but the righteous person has an everlasting foundation.

²⁶ Like vinegar to the teeth,
like smoke to the eyes,
so is the lazy person to those who send him **on a mission**.

²⁷ The fear of the LORD lengthens **the number of** days,
but the years of wicked people are shortened.

²⁸ The hope of righteous people **leads to** joy,
but the eager waiting of wicked people comes to nothing.

10:25–28 You're my everlasting foundation, my place to stand in a storm. Give me long days as I live completely for you. Give me joy as I hope in you.

²⁹ The way of the LORD is a fortress for an innocent person

but a ruin to those who are troublemakers.

10:29 Your ways protect me like a fortress. They're my place to run when evil comes my way.
Troublemakers can't make sense of you.

³⁰ A righteous person will never be moved,
but wicked people will not continue to live in the land.

³¹ The mouth of a righteous person increases wisdom,
but a devious tongue will be cut off.

³² The lips of a righteous person announce good will,
but the mouths of wicked people are devious.

10:31–32 Good people's words make me wise. Wicked people say nothing that helps me.

The Value of Righteousness

11¹ Dishonest scales are disgusting to the LORD,
but accurate weights are pleasing to him.

² Arrogance comes,
then comes shame,
but wisdom remains with humble people.

³ Integrity guides decent people,
but hypocrisy leads treacherous people to ruin.

11:1–3 You won't settle for subtle changes in me. You aim to make me righteous in everything I do.
You want honesty rather than lies, humility instead of arrogance, integrity in place of hypocrisy.
Build those qualities in me!

⁴ Riches are of no help on the day of fury,
but righteousness saves from death.

⁵ The righteousness of innocent people makes their road smooth,
but wicked people fall by their own wickedness.

⁶ Decent people are saved by their righteousness,
but treacherous people are trapped by their own greed.

⁷ At the death of a wicked person, hope vanishes.

Moreover, his confidence in strength vanishes.

⁸ A righteous person is rescued from trouble,
and a wicked person takes his place.

⁹ With his talk a godless person can ruin his neighbor,
but righteous people are rescued by knowledge.

¹⁰ When righteous people prosper, a city is glad.
When wicked people die, there are songs of joy.

11:5–10 Let your warnings about wickedness sink deep in my soul. Sin trips me up and entraps me. It steals my hope and strength. It puts me in line for trouble. And the more I sin, the louder people will rejoice when I die.

¹¹ With the blessing of decent people a city is raised up,
but by the words of wicked people, it is torn down.

¹² A person who despises a neighbor has no sense,
but a person who has understanding keeps quiet.

¹³ Whoever gossips gives away secrets,
but whoever is trustworthy in spirit can keep a secret.

11:11–13 Evil words can destroy a whole city. They spill secrets and senselessly expose a neighbor. Show me when my words go bad.

¹⁴ A nation will fall when there is no direction,
but with many advisers there is victory.

11:14 Without vision a nation falls. Point our country in your direction.

¹⁵ Whoever guarantees a stranger's loan will get into trouble,
but whoever hates the closing of a deal remains secure.

¹⁶ A gracious woman wins respect,
but ruthless men gain riches.

¹⁷ A merciful person helps himself,
but a cruel person hurts himself.

¹⁸ A wicked person earns dishonest wages,
but whoever spreads righteousness earns honest pay.

¹⁹ As righteousness leads to life,
so whoever pursues evil finds his own death.

²⁰ Devious people are disgusting to the LORD,
but he is delighted with those whose ways are innocent.

²¹ Certainly, an evil person will not go unpunished,
but the descendants of righteous people will escape.

11:18–21 Righteousness opens the door to honest work and leads me into life. You delight in my innocence and won't let evil go unpunished.

²² **Like** a gold ring in a pig's snout,
so is a beautiful woman who lacks good taste.

11:22 Grant me good taste or I'll be a pig with a gold ring in its snout.

²³ The desire of righteous people ends only in good,
but the hope of wicked people ends only in fury.

²⁴ One person spends freely and yet grows richer,
while another holds back what he owes and yet grows poorer.

²⁵ A generous person will be made rich,
and whoever satisfies others will himself be satisfied.[\[10\]](#)

11:25 Convince me I can trust you with my money. As I meet others' needs I count on you to meet mine.

²⁶ People will curse the one who hoards grain,
but a blessing will be upon the head of the one who sells it.

²⁷ Whoever eagerly seeks good searches for good will,

but whoever looks for evil finds it.

11:27 I don't have to look hard to find evil. Keep me searching for real good.

²⁸ Whoever trusts his riches will fall,
but righteous people will flourish like a green leaf.

11:28 Riches aren't enough to keep me going. But following your ways will make me flourish.

²⁹ Whoever brings trouble upon his family inherits only
wind, and that stubborn fool becomes a slave to the wise in heart.

³⁰ The fruit of a righteous person is a tree of life,
and a winner of souls is wise.

11:30 Make me wise. Show me how to win people to you.

³¹ If the righteous person is rewarded on earth,
how much more the wicked person and the sinner!

12¹ Whoever loves discipline loves to learn,
but whoever hates correction is a dumb animal.

12:1 I hate when I act like a mindless beast. I'll choose to learn from your discipline.

² A good person obtains favor from the LORD,
but the LORD condemns everyone who schemes.

³ A person cannot stand firm on a foundation of wickedness,
and the roots of righteous people cannot be moved.

12:3 I can't build a life on wickedness. I'll make righteousness my unshakable foundation.

⁴ A wife with strength of character is the crown of her husband,
but the wife who disgraces him is like bone cancer.

⁵ The thoughts of righteous people are fair.
The advice of wicked people is treacherous.

⁶ The words of wicked people are a deadly ambush,
but the words^[11] of decent people rescue.

12:5–6 I want my thoughts to be fair and my advice truly helpful. Warn me when I’m about to ambush others with my words.

⁷ Overthrow wicked people, and they are no more,
but the families of righteous people continue to stand.

⁸ A person will be praised based on his insight,
but whoever has a twisted mind will be despised.

12:8 Give me insights worth hearing. Shield others from my twisted moments.

⁹ Better to be unimportant and have a slave
than to act important and have nothing to eat.

¹⁰ A righteous person cares even about the life of his animals,
but the compassion of wicked people is nothing but cruelty.

¹¹ Whoever works his land will have plenty to eat,
but the one who chases unrealistic dreams has no sense.

12:11 Teach me to work hard at the jobs you provide me. Give me sense to know when my dreams won’t work out.

¹² A wicked person delights in setting a trap for other evil people,
but the roots of righteous people produce fruit.^[12]

¹³ An evil person is trapped by his own sinful talk,
but a righteous person escapes from trouble.

12:13 When I do evil, my own words will convict me. Keep my speech straightforward and true.

¹⁴ One person enjoys good things as a result of his speaking ability.
Another is paid according to what his hands have accomplished.

¹⁵ A stubborn fool considers his own way the right one,

but a person who listens to advice is wise.

¹⁶ When a stubborn fool is irritated, he shows it immediately,
but a sensible person hides the insult.

12:15–16 Don't let me think I'm too smart to listen to others' advice. Don't let me be so sensitive
that I react to every insult.

¹⁷ A truthful witness speaks honestly,
but a lying witness speaks deceitfully.

¹⁸ Careless words stab like a sword,
but the words of wise people bring healing.

12:18 Give me a taste of the pain I inflict on others when I stab them with my words. Make my
words wise and soothing.

¹⁹ The word of truth lasts forever,
but lies last only a moment.

²⁰ Deceit is in the heart of those who plan evil,
but joy belongs to those who advise peace.

²¹ No *lasting* harm comes to a righteous person,
but wicked people have lots of trouble.

12:21 I won't stop following your ways. Help me bounce back from every hurt I endure.

²² Lips that lie are disgusting to the LORD,
but honest people are his delight.

²³ A sensible person *discreetly* hides knowledge,
but foolish minds preach stupidity.

12:23 Stop me when I show off my knowledge—and when I put my stupidity on display.

²⁴ Hard-working hands gain control,
but lazy hands do slave labor.

²⁵ A person's anxiety will weigh him down,
but an encouraging word makes him joyful.

12:25 Free me from the weight of my anxieties. Lift me up with an encouraging word.

²⁶ A righteous person looks out for his neighbor,
but the path of wicked people leads others astray.

12:26 Show me when I'm only looking out for myself. I want to lead people to real life.

²⁷ A lazy hunter does not catch^[13] his prey,
but a hard-working person becomes wealthy.^[14]
²⁸ Everlasting life is on the way of righteousness.
Eternal death is not along its path.

A Wise Son Lives Righteously

13¹ A wise son listens to his father's discipline,
but a mocker does not listen to reprimands.

13:1 I choose to embrace my father's discipline. I won't plug my ears to reprimands.

² A person eats well as a result of his speaking ability,
but the appetite of treacherous people 「craves」 violence.
³ Whoever controls his mouth protects his own life.
Whoever has a big mouth comes to ruin.

13:3 At times my mouth puts my life at risk. Teach me to filter.

⁴ A lazy person craves food and there is none,
but the appetite of hard-working people is satisfied.
⁵ A righteous person hates lying,
but a wicked person behaves with shame and disgrace.
⁶ Righteousness protects the honest way of life,

but wickedness ruins a sacrifice for sin.

13:5–6 Good people hate lying. They always stand up for honesty. Teach me to speak truth without compromise.

⁷ One person pretends to be rich but has nothing.
Another pretends to be poor but has great wealth.

13:7 Don't let me pretend to be rich when I'm not. Don't let me brag about the things I have.

⁸ A person's riches are the ransom for his life,
but the poor person does not pay attention to threats.
⁹ The light of righteous people beams brightly,
but the lamp of wicked people will be snuffed out.
¹⁰ Arrogance produces only quarreling,
but those who take advice gain wisdom.

13:10 Make me wise through the advice of others. Help me escape stupid arguments.

¹¹ Wealth _⌋gained_⌋ through injustice dwindles away,
but whoever gathers little by little has plenty.
¹² Delayed hope makes one sick at heart,
but a fulfilled longing is a tree of life.

13:12 When hope dies I feel sick. I count on you to keep my dreams alive.

¹³ Whoever despises _⌋God's_⌋ words will pay the penalty,
but the one who fears _⌋God's_⌋ commands will be rewarded.

13:13 You won't let me escape the terrible consequences of despising your words. But you never let me miss the rewards of following your commands.

¹⁴ The teachings of a wise person are a fountain of life
to turn one away from the grasp of death.

¹⁵ Good sense brings favor,
but the way of treacherous people is always the same.[\[15\]](#)

¹⁶ Any sensible person acts with knowledge,
but a fool displays stupidity.

13:15–16 Give me good sense and wide-ranging knowledge. I'm beyond stupid without your help.

¹⁷ An undependable messenger gets into trouble,
but a dependable envoy brings healing.

¹⁸ Poverty and shame come to a person who ignores discipline,
but whoever pays attention to constructive criticism will be honored.

13:18 Lack of discipline will send me into poverty. Thanks for helpful criticism that keeps me alive.

¹⁹ A fulfilled desire is sweet to the soul,
but turning from evil is disgusting to fools.

²⁰ Whoever walks with wise people will be wise,
but whoever associates with fools will suffer.

13:20 Give me wise people to walk through life with. I won't let fools drag me in the wrong direction.

²¹ Disaster hunts down sinners,
but righteous people are rewarded with good.

²² Good people leave an inheritance to their grandchildren,
but the wealth of sinners is stored away for a righteous person.

²³ When poor people are able to plow, there is much food,
but a person is swept away where there is no justice.

13:23 Show me when my own bad habits keep the poor from earning a living. Alert me to my unjust ways.

²⁴ Whoever refuses to spank his son hates him,
but whoever loves his son disciplines him from early on.

²⁵ A righteous person eats to satisfy his appetite,
but the bellies of wicked people are always empty.

Wise People Live Righteously

14¹ The wisest of women builds up her home,
but a stupid one tears it down with her own hands.

² Whoever lives right fears the LORD,
but a person who is devious in his ways despises him.

14:2 I want my whole life to show I respect you. Teach me to live right in every way.

³ Because of a stubborn fool's words a whip is lifted against him,
but wise people are protected by their speech.

⁴ Where there are no cattle, the feeding trough is empty,
but the strength of an ox produces plentiful harvests.

14:4 I can't even feed myself without your help. I count on you for the resources I need to live and thrive.

⁵ A trustworthy witness does not lie,
but a dishonest witness breathes lies.

⁶ A mocker searches for wisdom without finding it,
but knowledge comes easily to a person who has understanding.

⁷ Stay away from a fool,
because you will not receive knowledge from his lips.

⁸ The wisdom of a sensible person guides his way of life,
but the stupidity of fools misleads them.

14:7-8 Fools can't give me the knowledge I need for life. They stumble over their own advice. Show me when I'm allowing fools to lead me.

⁹ Stubborn fools make fun of guilt,
but there is forgiveness among decent people.

14:9 Fools make fun of guilt and refuse to admit their wrongs. Show me when I'm not owning up to my sins.

¹⁰ The heart knows its own bitterness,
and no stranger can share its joy.
¹¹ The houses of wicked people will be destroyed,
but the tents of decent people will continue to expand.
¹² There is a way that seems right to a person,
but eventually it ends in death.

14:12 I can be completely convinced I'm right and still be dead wrong. I welcome your correction!

¹³ Even while laughing a heart can ache,
and joy can end in grief.
¹⁴ A heart that turns „from God„ becomes bored with its own ways,
but a good person is satisfied with God's ways.

14:14 My life fades to nothing when my heart turns from you. You and your ways satisfy me fully!

¹⁵ A gullible person believes anything,
but a sensible person watches his step.
¹⁶ A wise person is cautious and turns away from evil,
but a fool is careless^[16] and overconfident.
¹⁷ A short-tempered person acts stupidly,
and a person who plots evil is hated.
¹⁸ Gullible people are gifted with stupidity,
but sensible people are crowned with knowledge.

14:15–18 Free me from my foolish faults—gullibility, carelessness, overconfidence, a short temper,

and outright stupidity.

¹⁹ Evil people will bow to good people.
Wicked people will bow at the gates of a righteous person.

²⁰ A poor person is hated even by his neighbor,
but a rich person is loved by many.

14:19–20 I don't want cheap admiration. Help me earn respect through genuine acts of goodness and generosity.

²¹ Whoever despises his neighbor sins,
but blessed is the one who is kind to humble people.

²² Don't those who stray plan what is evil,
while those who are merciful and faithful plan what is good?

14:22 Good acts don't happen by accident. Help me plan good deeds that flow from the mercy and faithfulness you show me.

²³ In hard work there is always something gained,
but idle talk leads only to poverty.

²⁴ The crown of wise people is their wealth.
The stupidity of fools is just that—stupidity!

²⁵ An honest witness saves lives,
but one who tells lies is dangerous.

²⁶ In the fear of the LORD there is strong confidence,
and his children will have a place of refuge.

²⁷ The fear of the LORD is a fountain of life
to turn **one** away from the grasp of death.

14:26–27 Respect for you gives me strong confidence. It creates a hiding place for my children.
Respect for you is a life-giving fountain flowing inside me.

²⁸ A large population is an honor for a king,
but without people a ruler is ruined.

²⁹ A person of great understanding is patient,
but a short temper is the height of stupidity.

14:29 I won't ever be patient if I don't first take time to understand. Stop me when I make assumptions and rush to conclusions.

³⁰ A tranquil heart makes for a healthy body,
but jealousy is like bone cancer.

³¹ Whoever oppresses the poor insults his maker,
but whoever is kind to the needy honors him.

14:31 When I oppress the poor I insult not just people but you. I want to honor you through acts of kindness.

³² A wicked person is thrown down by his own wrongdoing,
but even in his death a righteous person has a refuge.

³³ Wisdom finds rest in the heart of an understanding person.
Even fools recognize this.[\[17\]](#)

14:33 Fill my heart with so much wisdom that everyone can see that it comes from you.

Wise Ways to Live

³⁴ Righteousness lifts up a nation,
but sin is a disgrace in any society.

³⁵ A king is delighted with a servant who acts wisely,
but he is furious with one who acts shamefully.

15¹ A gentle answer turns away rage,
but a harsh word stirs up anger.

² The tongues of wise people give good expression to knowledge,
but the mouths of fools pour out a flood of stupidity.

15:1–2 My harsh words only make a situation worse. Train me to answer gently and turn away rage. Don't let my words pour out a food of stupidity.

³ The eyes of the LORD are everywhere.
They watch evil people and good people.

15:3 You see everything I do. Comfort and warn me with that fact!

⁴ A soothing tongue is a tree of life,
but a deceitful tongue breaks the spirit.
⁵ A stubborn fool despises his father's discipline,
but whoever appreciates a warning shows good sense.

15:5 I welcome the discipline of my parents and other wise people. Send them my way when I need their advice.

⁶ Great treasure is in the house of a righteous person,
but trouble comes along with the income of a wicked person.
⁷ The lips of wise people spread knowledge,
but a foolish attitude does not.

⁸ A sacrifice brought by wicked people is disgusting to the LORD,
but the prayers of decent people please him.
⁹ The way of wicked people is disgusting to the LORD,
but he loves those who pursue righteousness.

15:8–9 My prayers and religious rituals disgust you when I keep making a habit of sin. Call me to account.

¹⁰ Discipline is a terrible „burden„ to anyone who leaves the „right„ path.
Anyone who hates a warning will die.
¹¹ If Sheol and Abaddon lie open in front of the LORD
how much more the human heart!

15:11 If you can see into the darkest corners of death, I know you can see straight through my heart!

¹² A mocker does not appreciate a warning.
He will not go to wise people.

¹³ A joyful heart makes a cheerful face,
but with a heartache comes depression.

¹⁴ The mind of a person who has understanding searches for knowledge,
but the mouths of fools feed on stupidity.

¹⁵ Every day is a terrible day for a miserable person,
but a cheerful heart has a continual feast.

15:13–15 Let the joy of my heart show on my face. Quiet the pains that linger inside me. I'll make every day a celebration of you.

¹⁶ Better to have a little with the fear of the LORD
than great treasure and turmoil.

¹⁷ Better to have a dish of vegetables where there is love
than juicy steaks where there is hate.

15:16–17 I'm content with having little as long as I can hang on to you. I'm happy with simple things as long as I have love in my home.

¹⁸ A hothead stirs up a fight,
but one who holds his temper calms disputes.

¹⁹ The path of lazy people is like a thorny hedge,
but the road of decent people is an "open" highway.

A Wise Son Brings Blessings to Others

²⁰ A wise son makes his father happy,
but a foolish child despises its mother.

²¹ Stupidity is fun to the one without much sense,
but a person who has understanding forges straight ahead.

15:21 Stupidity feels fun until I obtain good sense. Teach me wisdom that takes me in a good direction.

²² Without advice plans go wrong,
but with many advisers they succeed.

15:22 I'm not smart enough to do life on my own. Lead me to advisers who can help my plans succeed.

²³ A person is delighted to hear an answer from his own mouth,
and a timely word—oh, how good!

²⁴ The path of life for a wise person leads upward
in order to turn him away from hell below.

²⁵ The LORD tears down the house of an arrogant person,
but he protects the property of widows.

²⁶ The thoughts of evil people are disgusting to the LORD,
but pleasant words are pure to him.

15:24–26 Lead me upward. Turn me away from hell. Watch over my property. Don't tear down my house. Let my words please you. Push evil from my mind.

²⁷ Whoever is greedy for unjust gain brings trouble to his family,
but whoever hates bribes will live.

15:27 Take away my greed for unjust gain. Show me when I'm wrongly working the system to my advantage.

²⁸ The heart of a righteous person carefully considers how to answer,
but the mouths of wicked people pour out a flood of evil things.

²⁹ The LORD is far from wicked people,
but he hears the prayers of righteous people.

³⁰ A twinkle in the eye delights the heart.
Good news refreshes the body.

15:29–30 Be close to me and hear my prayers. Refresh my body with good news.

³¹ The ear that listens to a life-giving warning
will be at home among wise people.

³² Whoever ignores discipline despises himself,
but the person who listens to warning gains understanding.

³³ The fear of the LORD is discipline [leading to] wisdom,
and humility comes before honor.

15:31–33 I want to hear your life-giving warnings. I long to hear them and gain understanding. I'll
humble myself and accept your discipline.

Wisdom's Blessings Come from the LORD

16¹ The plans of the heart belong to humans,
but an answer on the tongue comes from the LORD.

² A person thinks all his ways are pure,
but the LORD weighs motives.

³ Entrust your efforts to the LORD,
and your plans will succeed.

16:1–3 I can make plans and even put them into action, but you still check my motives. You want
me to put all my efforts in your hands.

⁴ The LORD has made everything for his own purpose,
even wicked people for the day of trouble.

⁵ Everyone with a conceited heart is disgusting to the LORD.
Certainly, [such a person] will not go unpunished.

⁶ By mercy and faithfulness, peace is made with the LORD.
By the fear of the LORD, evil is avoided.

16:5–6 It doesn't please you when I put myself first or make myself most important. I won't live at peace with you as long as I stray from mercy and faithfulness. So I'll humble myself and follow your ways.

⁷ When a person's ways are pleasing to the LORD,
he makes even his enemies to be at peace with him.

⁸ Better a few possessions gained honestly
than many gained through injustice.

⁹ A person may plan his own journey,
but the LORD directs his steps.

16:9 No matter how many plans I make, you still control where I go. I count on you to lead me.

¹⁰ When a divine revelation is on a king's lips,
he cannot voice a wrong judgment.

¹¹ Honest balances and scales belong to the LORD.
He made the entire set of weights.

16:11 You alone decide what's honest. I submit to your truth.

¹² Wrongdoing is disgusting to kings
because a throne is established through righteousness.

¹³ Kings are happy with honest words,
and whoever speaks what is right is loved.

¹⁴ A king's anger announces death,
but a wise man makes peace with him.

¹⁵ When the king is cheerful, there is life,
and his favor is like a cloud bringing spring rain.

16:12–15 Give the authorities in my life a love for righteousness and honesty. Make their judgments fair and full of life.

¹⁶ How much better it is to gain wisdom than gold,
and the gaining of understanding should be chosen over silver.

16:16 Your wisdom is more important than money. I'll choose it over any kind of wealth.

¹⁷ The highway of decent people turns away from evil.
Whoever watches his way preserves his own life.

¹⁸ Pride precedes a disaster,
and an arrogant attitude precedes a fall.

16:18 When I'm proud I'm headed for disaster. When I'm arrogant I'm about to fall.

¹⁹ Better to be humble with lowly people
than to share stolen goods with arrogant people.

²⁰ Whoever gives attention to the LORD's word prospers,
and blessed is the person who trusts the LORD.

16:20 I'll pay attention to your Word and trust everything I learn from you.

²¹ The person who is truly wise is called understanding,
and speaking sweetly helps others learn.

²² Understanding is a fountain of life to the one who has it,
but stubborn fools punish themselves with their stupidity.

²³ A wise person's heart controls his speech,
and what he says helps others learn.

²⁴ Pleasant words are like honey from a honeycomb—
sweet to the spirit and healthy for the body.

16:21–24 Make my words sweet to people who long to learn. Give us all greater understanding as
you help me choose my words.

Words of Advice to a Wise Son

²⁵ There is a way that seems right to a person,

but eventually it ends in death.

16:25 Stop me when I think I'm going in the right direction but I'm actually headed toward death.

²⁶ A laborer's appetite works to his advantage,
because his hunger drives him on.

²⁷ A worthless person plots trouble,
and his speech is like a burning fire.

²⁸ A devious person spreads quarrels.
A gossip separates the closest of friends.

²⁹ A violent person misleads his neighbor
and leads him on a path that is not good.

16:27–29 There's no end to the troubles I cause when I let my mouth run. I ignite fires and spread quarrels. I separate friends and send people down evil paths. Teach me a better way!

³⁰ Whoever winks his eye is plotting something devious.
Whoever bites his lips has finished his evil work.

³¹ Silver hair is a beautiful crown found in a righteous life.

³² Better to get angry slowly than to be a hero.
Better to be even-tempered than to capture a city.

³³ The dice are thrown,
but the LORD determines every outcome.

16:33 Everything changes when you get involved in a situation. You decide every outcome.

17¹ Better a bite of dry bread [eaten] in peace
than a family feast filled with strife.

17:1 Peace at home matters more than fancy feasts. Put your peace at the heart of my family.

² A wise slave will become master over a son who acts shamefully,
and he will share the inheritance with the brothers.

³ The crucible is for refining silver and the smelter for gold,
but the one who purifies hearts ⌋by fire⌋ is the LORD.

17:3 You purify my heart like a crucible refines silver. I need your refining fire.

⁴ An evildoer pays attention to wicked lips.

A liar opens his ears to a slanderous tongue.

⁵ Whoever makes fun of a poor person insults his maker.

Whoever is happy ⌋to see someone's⌋ distress will not escape punishment.

17:5 When I make fun of the poor, I insult you. I won't escape punishment if I smile when others suffer.

⁶ Grandchildren are the crown of grandparents,
and parents are the glory of their children.

17:6 My grandparents are my crown and my parents my glory. I'll look for ways to honor them.

The Consequences of Being a Fool

⁷ Refined speech is not fitting for a godless fool.

How much less does lying fit a noble person!

⁸ A bribe seems ⌋like⌋ a jewel to the one who gives it.[\[18\]](#)

Wherever he turns, he prospers.

⁹ Whoever forgives an offense seeks love,

but whoever keeps bringing up the issue separates the closest of friends.

17:9 I have love as my goal. I commit myself to forgiving wrongs instead of bringing them up again and again.

¹⁰ A reprimand impresses a person who has understanding
more than a hundred lashes impress a fool.

17:10 I want to be quick to respond to your discipline. Don't let me miss your words of correction.

¹¹ A rebel looks for nothing but evil.
Therefore, a cruel messenger will be sent *“to punish”* him.
¹² Better to meet a bear robbed of its cubs
than a fool *“carried away”* with his stupidity.
¹³ Whoever pays back evil for good—
evil will never leave his home.

17:13 When others wrong me, give me your strength to pay them back with good.

¹⁴ Starting a quarrel is *“like”* opening a floodgate,
so stop before the argument gets out of control.
¹⁵ Whoever approves of wicked people
and whoever condemns righteous people is disgusting to the LORD.
¹⁶ Why should a fool have money in his hand to buy wisdom
when he doesn’t have a mind to grasp anything?
¹⁷ A friend always loves,
and a brother is born to share trouble.

17:17 I need friends who love me nonstop and share my troubles. Guide me to people who will share the worst and best of our lives.

¹⁸ A person without good sense closes a deal with a handshake.
He guarantees a loan in the presence of his friend.
¹⁹ Whoever loves sin loves a quarrel.
Whoever builds his city gate high invites destruction.
²⁰ A twisted mind never finds happiness,
and one with a devious tongue *“repeatedly”* gets into trouble.

17:20 Straighten out my mind so I find happiness in life. Make me see the world like you do.

²¹ The parent of a fool has grief,
and the father of a godless fool has no joy.
²² A joyful heart is good medicine,
but depression drains one’s strength.

17:22 Joy fills my heart and fixes my whole body. Give me strength when my heart grows weary.

²³ A wicked person secretly accepts a bribe to corrupt the ways of justice.

²⁴ Wisdom is directly in front of an understanding person,
but the eyes of a fool are looking around all over the world.

17:24 You don't make wisdom hard to find. You want me to act on what I already know is right.

How Fools Live

²⁵ A foolish son is a heartache to his father
and bitter grief to his mother.

²⁶ To punish an innocent person is not good.
To strike down noble people is not right.

²⁷ Whoever has knowledge controls his words,
and a person who has understanding is even-tempered.

²⁸ Even a stubborn fool is thought to be wise if he keeps silent.
He is considered intelligent if he keeps his lips sealed.

17:27–28 Train me to filter what comes from my lips. People will think I'm wise if I keep my foolish thoughts to myself.

18¹ A loner is out to get what he wants for himself.
He opposes all sound reasoning.

² A fool does not find joy in understanding
but only in expressing his own opinion.

18:1–2 Don't let me go through life only looking out for myself. I need to stop talking and understand what other people think.

³ When wickedness comes, contempt also comes,
and insult comes along with disgrace.

⁴ The words of a person's mouth are like deep waters.
The fountain of wisdom is an overflowing stream.

18:4 My words reveal who I am inside. Make wisdom spill from me like an overflowing stream.

⁵ It is not good to be partial toward a wicked person,
thereby depriving an innocent person of justice.

⁶ By talking, a fool gets into an argument,
and his mouth invites a beating.

⁷ A fool's mouth is his ruin.
His lips are a trap to his soul.

18:6–7 At times I use words to pick fights or to make sure I end them. Change me before my mouth ruins me.

⁸ The words of a gossip are swallowed greedily,
and they go down into a person's innermost being.

How to Avoid Fools and Foolishness

⁹ Whoever is lazy in his work is related to a vandal.

¹⁰ The name of the LORD is a strong tower.
A righteous person runs to it and is safe.

18:10 Your name is a strong tower. When I run to it I find safety.

¹¹ A rich person's wealth is his strong city
and is like a high wall in his imagination.

¹² Before destruction a person's heart is arrogant,
but humility comes before honor.

18:12 Arrogance leads to my destruction. Humility brings me honor. Why do I allow my pride to live?

¹³ Whoever gives an answer before he listens is stupid and shameful.

¹⁴ A person's spirit can endure sickness,
but who can bear a broken spirit?

18:14 Heal the places I'm broken. Mend me in both body and spirit.

¹⁵ The mind of a person who has understanding acquires knowledge.
The ears of wise people seek knowledge.

¹⁶ A gift opens doors for the one who gives it
and brings him into the presence of great people.

¹⁷ The first to state his case seems right
until his neighbor comes to cross-examine him.

18:17 Don't let me fall for the first argument I hear. Teach me to think critically and not swallow everything whole.

¹⁸ Flipping a coin ends quarrels
and settles issues between powerful people.

¹⁹ An offended brother is more resistant than a strong city,
and disputes are like the locked gate of a castle tower.

²⁰ A person's speaking ability provides for his stomach.
His talking provides him a living.

²¹ The tongue has the power of life and death,
and those who love to talk will have to eat their own words.

18:21 My tongue can kill or give life. But talking too much always gets me in trouble.

²² Whoever finds a wife finds something good
and has obtained favor from the LORD.

18:22 My spouse is my life's greatest blessing, a gift straight from your hand.

²³ A poor person is timid when begging,
but a rich person is blunt when replying.

²⁴ Friends can destroy one another,^[19]
but a loving friend can stick closer than family.

19¹ Better to be a poor person who lives innocently
than to be one who talks dishonestly and is a fool.

19:1 I'd rather be innocent and poor than dishonest and rich.

² A person without knowledge is no good.
A person in a hurry makes mistakes.

³ The stupidity of a person turns his life upside down,
and his heart rages against the LORD.

19:2–3 Grant me the knowledge I need to get through life. Teach me to pace myself and do things
right the first time. Don't let me turn my life upside down by stupidly raging against you.

⁴ Wealth adds many friends,
but a poor person is separated from his friend.

⁵ A lying witness will not go unpunished.
One who tells lies will not escape.

19:5 Sooner or later even little lies will catch up with me. With your help I'll aim for total honesty.

⁶ Many try to win the kindness of a generous person,
and everyone is a friend to a person who gives gifts.

⁷ The entire family of a poor person hates him.
How much more do his friends keep their distance from him!
When he chases them with words, they are gone.

⁸ A person who gains sense loves himself.
One who guards understanding finds something good.

19:8 Getting your wisdom is good for me. Gaining understanding benefits my entire life.

⁹ A lying witness will not go unpunished.
One who tells lies will die.

¹⁰ Luxury does not fit a fool,
much less a slave ruling princes.

¹¹ A person with good sense is patient,
and it is to his credit that he overlooks an offense.

19:11 I want to have the same patience with others that you show to me. Help me see when it's smart just to overlook an offense.

¹² The rage of a king is like the roar of a lion,
but his favor is like dew on the grass.

A Foolish Son Brings Ruin to Others

¹³ A foolish son ruins his father,
and a quarreling woman is like constantly dripping water.

¹⁴ Home and wealth are inherited from fathers,
but a sensible wife comes from the LORD.

19:14 My family can give me wealth, but a good spouse comes only from you.

¹⁵ Laziness throws one into a deep sleep,
and an idle person will go hungry.

¹⁶ Whoever obeys the law preserves his life,
└but┐ whoever despises the LORD's ways will be put to death.

19:16 Obeying you gives me life. Despising your ways leads to certain death.

¹⁷ Whoever has pity on the poor lends to the LORD,
and he will repay him for his good deed.

¹⁸ Discipline your son while there is still hope.
Do not be the one responsible for his death.

19:18 Show me how and when to discipline my children. When I set boundaries, I protect them from self-destruction.

¹⁹ A person who has a hot temper will pay for it.
If you rescue him, you will have to do it over and over.

²⁰ Listen to advice and accept discipline
so that you may be wise the rest of your life.

²¹ Many plans are in the human heart,
but the advice of the LORD will endure.

19:21 I can dream enormous dreams, but your advice allows me to build a life that lasts.

²² Loyalty is desirable in a person,
and it is better to be poor than a liar.

²³ The fear of the LORD leads to life,
and such a person will rest easy without suffering harm.[\[20\]](#)

19:23 Living with proper fear of you brings me peace and rest.

²⁴ A lazy person puts his fork in his food.
He doesn't even bring it back to his mouth.

²⁵ Strike a mocker, and a gullible person may learn a lesson.
Warn an understanding person, and he will gain more knowledge.

19:25 I hate to learn lessons the hard way. I'm open to whatever you want to teach me.

Foolproof Instructions

²⁶ A son who assaults his father and who drives away his mother
brings shame and disgrace.

²⁷ If you stop listening to instruction, my son,
you will stray from the words of knowledge.

19:27 I won't quit listening to your wisdom. I won't stray from anything you teach me.

²⁸ A worthless witness mocks justice,
and the mouths of wicked people swallow up trouble.

²⁹ Punishments are set for mockers
and beatings for the backs of fools.

20¹ Wine *ˈ*makes peopleˌ mock,
liquor *ˈ*makes themˌ noisy, and everyone under their influence is unwise.

20:1 Warn me whenever alcohol makes me anything less than you want me to be.

² The rage of a king is like the roar of a lion.
Whoever makes him angry forfeits his life.

³ Avoiding a quarrel is honorable.
After all, any stubborn fool can start a fight.

20:3 Help me think clearly and step back from fights.

⁴ A lazy person does not plow in the fall.^{[\[21\]](#)}
He looks for something in the harvest but finds nothing.

20:4 I can't expect a harvest if I never put seed in the ground. Work in me so I learn to work hard.

⁵ A motive in the human heart is like deep water,
and a person who has understanding draws it out.

⁶ Many people declare themselves loyal,
but who can find someone who is *ˈ*reallyˌ trustworthy?

20:6 Teach me true loyalty— not just words but constant trustworthiness.

⁷ A righteous person lives on the basis of his integrity.
Blessed are his children after he is gone.

⁸ A king who sits on his throne to judge sifts out every evil with his eyes.

⁹ Who can say,
“I’ve made my heart pure.
I’m cleansed from my sin”?

20:9 I can’t escape when you charge me with sin. I can’t claim to be pure, inside or out. I can’t cleanse myself, but you can. Wash me clean.

¹⁰ A double standard of weights and measures—
both are disgusting to the LORD.

¹¹ Even a child makes himself known by his actions,
whether his deeds are pure or right.

20:11 You’ve seen the real me since my first day of life. Even though I’ve failed in the past, make me pure and right.

¹² The ear that hears,
the eye that sees—
the LORD made them both.

¹³ Do not love sleep or you will end up poor.
Keep your eyes open, and you will have plenty to eat.

¹⁴ “Bad! Bad!” says the buyer.
Then, as he goes away, he brags about his bargain.

¹⁵ There are gold and plenty of jewels,
but the lips of knowledge are precious gems.

20:15 Your wise words are more precious than gemstones. Keep speaking to me.

¹⁶ Hold on to the garment of one who guarantees a stranger’s loan,
and hold responsible the person who makes a loan on behalf of a foreigner.

¹⁷ Food gained dishonestly tastes sweet to a person,

but afterwards his mouth will be filled with gravel.

20:17 Catch me when I cheat or steal or deceive to get what I want. Don't let me get by with anything less than honesty and integrity.

¹⁸ Plans are confirmed by getting advice,
and with guidance one wages war.

¹⁹ Whoever goes around as a gossip tells secrets.
Do not associate with a person whose mouth is always open.

20:19 You hate gossip. Nudge me when my mouth hangs open.

²⁰ The lamp of the person who curses his father and mother
will be snuffed out in total darkness.[\[22\]](#)

²¹ An inheritance quickly obtained in the beginning
will never be blessed in the end.

²² Do not say, "I'll get even with you!"
Wait for the LORD, and he will save you.

20:22 My bones ache to take revenge on my enemies. But I'll wait for you to save me.

²³ A double standard of weights is disgusting to the LORD,
and dishonest scales are no good.

²⁴ The LORD is the one who directs a person's steps.
How then can anyone understand his own way?

20:24 I need you to direct my steps. As hard as I try, I can't find my way through life.

²⁵ It is a trap for a person to say impulsively, "This is a holy offering!"
and later to have second thoughts about those vows.

²⁶ A wise king scatters the wicked
and then runs them over.

²⁷ A person's soul is the LORD's lamp.

It searches his entire innermost being.

20:27 You light up my soul and see everything going on inside me. Thanks that there are no secrets between us.

²⁸ Mercy and truth protect a king,
and with mercy he maintains his throne.

²⁹ While the glory of young men is their strength,
the splendor of older people is their silver hair.

20:29 Let me enjoy being young and strong. But let me celebrate being silver and wise.

³⁰ Brutal beatings cleanse away wickedness.
Such beatings cleanse the innermost being.

The LORD Controls Wise and Foolish People

21¹ The king's heart is like streams of water.

Both are under the LORD's control.
He turns them in any direction he chooses.

² A person thinks everything he does is right,
but the LORD weighs hearts.

³ Doing what is right and fair
is more acceptable to the LORD than offering a sacrifice.

21:2–3 I'm forever convinced I'm right, but you see the sin in my heart. Make me intent on doing right instead of looking good.

⁴ A conceited look and an arrogant attitude,
which are the lamps of wicked people, are sins.

21:4 You leave no room for debate—conceit and arrogance are sin.

⁵ The plans of a hard-working person lead to prosperity,

but everyone who is always in a hurry ends up in poverty.

⁶ Those who gather wealth by lying are wasting time.
They are looking for death.

⁷ The violence of wicked people will drag them away
since they refuse to do what is just.

21:6–7 Getting rich by lying courts death. Refusing to do what is just will get me dragged away.

⁸ The way of a guilty person is crooked,
but the behavior of those who are pure is moral.[\[23\]](#)

⁹ Better to live on a corner of a roof
than to share a home with a quarreling woman.

21:9 Bring peace to my household before one of us needs to move to the roof.

¹⁰ The mind of a wicked person desires evil
and has no consideration for his neighbor.

¹¹ When a mocker is punished, a gullible person becomes wise,
and when a wise person is instructed, he gains knowledge.

21:11 Help me watch and learn from the punishments others endure. Don't let me repeat their mistakes.

¹² A righteous person wisely considers the house of a wicked person.
He throws wicked people into disasters.

¹³ Whoever shuts his ear to the cry of the poor will call
and not be answered.

21:13 You always hear the cry of the poor. Don't let me refuse their pleas.

¹⁴ A gift given in secret calms anger,
and a secret bribe calms great fury.

¹⁵ When justice is done, a righteous person is delighted,

but troublemakers are terrified.

21:15 I'm glad to see justice in this world. Troublemakers are the only ones who are terrified when good triumphs.

¹⁶ A person who wanders from the way of wise behavior will rest in the assembly of the dead.

¹⁷ Whoever loves pleasure will become poor.
Whoever loves wine and expensive food will not become rich.

21:17 Loving pleasure will make me poor. Expensive tastes will keep me from building wealth.

¹⁸ Wicked people become a ransom for righteous people,
and treacherous people will take the place of decent people.

¹⁹ Better to live in a desert
than with a quarreling and angry woman.

21:19 Bring peace to my marriage before one of us runs away and pitches a tent in the desert.

²⁰ Costly treasure and wealth are in the home of a wise person,
but a fool devours them.

²¹ Whoever pursues righteousness and mercy
will find life, righteousness, and honor.

21:21 The only way I'll find life and honor is by pursuing righteousness and mercy.

²² A wise man attacks a city of warriors
and pulls down the strong defenses in which they trust.

²³ Whoever guards his mouth and his tongue keeps himself
out of trouble.

²⁴ An arrogant, conceited person is called a mocker.
His arrogance knows no limits.

21:24 Don't allow me to become a mocker, a person with unlimited arrogance.

²⁵ The desire of a lazy person will kill him
because his hands refuse to work.

²⁶ All day long he feels greedy,
but a righteous person gives and does not hold back.

21:25–26 Laziness will kill me because I won't ever get what I need. Compel me to hard work and generosity.

²⁷ The sacrifice of wicked people is disgusting,
especially if they bring it with evil intent.

²⁸ A lying witness will die,
but a person who listens to advice will continue to speak.

²⁹ A wicked person puts up a bold front,
but a decent person's way of life is his own security.

21:29 Wicked people have to pretend to be brave, but a life of doing good makes me truly secure.

³⁰ No wisdom, no understanding, and no advice
can stand up against the LORD.

21:30 No amount of human wisdom or understanding or advice can stand up to you!

³¹ The horse is made ready for the day of battle,
but the victory belongs to the LORD.

22¹ A good name is more desirable than great wealth.
Respect is better than silver or gold.

22:1 Help me live in a way that earns me a good reputation.

² The rich and the poor have this in common:

the LORD is the maker of them all.

22:2 You made both the rich and the poor. You love us all the same.

³ Sensible people foresee trouble and hide ַfrom it,ֿ
but gullible people go ahead and suffer ַthe consequenceֿ.

22:3 Help me be smart enough to see trouble coming and take shelter. Don't let me be stupid and try to stand up to a storm.

⁴ On the heels of humility (the fear of the LORD)
are riches and honor and life.

⁵ A devious person has thorns and traps ahead of him.
Whoever guards himself will stay far away from them.

⁶ Train a child in the way he should go,
and even when he is old he will not turn away from it.

22:6 Use me to train my children in the way they should go. Even in their old age they won't turn away.

⁷ A rich person rules poor people,
and a borrower is a slave to a lender.

⁸ Whoever plants injustice will harvest trouble,
and this weapon of his own fury will be destroyed.

⁹ Whoever is generous will be blessed
because he has shared his food with the poor.

22:9 I'm glad for the blessings you promise me when I'm generous. I'll share with the poor the abundance you've already given me.

¹⁰ Drive out a mocker, and conflict will leave.
Quarreling and abuse will stop.

¹¹ Whoever loves a pure heart and whoever speaks graciously

has a king as his friend.

22:11 Make me pure of heart and gracious in speech.

¹² The LORD's eyes watch over knowledge,
but he overturns the words of a treacherous person.

¹³ A lazy person says,
"There's a lion outside!
I'll be murdered in the streets!"

22:13 Lazy people make up all kinds of excuses not to get up and go to work. Fill me with passion and purpose.

¹⁴ The mouth of an adulterous woman is a deep pit.
The one who is cursed by the LORD will fall into it.

¹⁵ Foolishness is firmly attached to a child's heart.
Spanking will remove it far from him.

¹⁶ Oppressing the poor for profit
┐or┐ giving to the rich certainly leads to poverty.

Listen to My Advice

¹⁷ Open your ears, and hear the words of wise people,
and set your mind on the knowledge I give you.

¹⁸ It is pleasant if you keep them in mind
┐so that┐ they will be on the tip of your tongue,

¹⁹ so that your trust may be in the LORD.
Today I have made them known to you, especially to you.

22:17–19 I open my ears to the words of wise people. I open my mind to the knowledge you impart.
I'll memorize your words so they stay on the tip of my tongue. Then I'll trust you fully.

²⁰ Didn't I write to you previously with advice and knowledge

²¹ in order to teach you the words of truth
so that you can give an accurate report to those who send you?

Living With Your Neighbor

²² Do not rob the poor because they are poor
or trample on the rights of an oppressed person at the city gate,
²³ because the LORD will plead their case
and will take the lives of those who rob them.

22:22–23 The poor and oppressed make easy targets. But if I harm them you'll defend them.

²⁴ Do not be a friend of one who has a bad temper,
and never keep company with a hothead,
²⁵ or you will learn his ways
and set a trap for yourself.

22:24–25 I can't let myself be best friends with hotheads. It's too easy to pick up their bad habits.

²⁶ Do not be „found„ among those who make deals with a handshake,
among those who guarantee other people's loans.
²⁷ If you have no money to pay back a loan,
why should your bed be repossessed?
²⁸ Do not move an ancient boundary marker
that your ancestors set in place.
²⁹ Do you see a person who is efficient in his work?
He will serve kings.
He will not serve unknown people.

22:29 Teach me to be efficient and get real work done. That will prepare me for greater responsibility.

23¹ When you sit down to eat with a ruler,
pay close attention to what is in front of you,

23:1–3 There's no free lunch when I eat with important people. Give me good manners and wisdom in the gifts I accept.

² and put a knife to your throat if you have a big appetite.

³ Do not crave his delicacies,
because this is food that deceives you.

⁴ Do not wear yourself out getting rich.
Be smart enough to stop.

⁵ Will you catch only a fleeting glimpse of wealth before it is gone?
It makes wings for itself like an eagle flying into the sky.

23:4–5 Warn me when I wear myself out getting rich. Make me smart enough to stop. Wealth doesn't last.

⁶ Do not eat the food of one who is stingy,
and do not crave his delicacies.

⁷ As he calculates the cost to himself, this is what he does:
He tells you, "Eat and drink,"
but he doesn't really mean it.

⁸ You will vomit the little bit you have eaten
and spoil your pleasant conversation.

23:6–8 I want to be truly generous when I share. I'm happy to see others enjoy what I give them.
Alert me so I can repent of any reluctance I feel.

⁹ Do not talk directly to a fool,
because he will despise the wisdom of your words.

23:9 Fools don't listen to wisdom. Tell me when I'm wasting words.

¹⁰ Do not move an ancient boundary marker
or enter fields that belong to orphans,

23:10 I won't cheat my neighbors or steal from the needy. You're their defender.

¹¹ because the one who is responsible for them is strong.
He will plead their case against you.

Learning From Your Father

¹² Live a more disciplined life,
and listen carefully to words of knowledge.

¹³ Do not hesitate to discipline a child.
If you spank him, he will not die.

23:13 Teach me how to discipline my children. Let them experience your love and firmness through me.

¹⁴ Spank him yourself,
and you will save his soul from hell.

¹⁵ My son,
if you have a wise heart, my heart will rejoice as well.

¹⁶ My heart rejoices when you speak what is right.

23:15–16 My parents rejoice when they see my wise heart. Help me to not disappoint them.

¹⁷ Do not envy sinners in your heart.
Instead, continue to fear the LORD.

23:17 I choose to live for you with total respect rather than envy people who do wrong.

¹⁸ There is indeed a future,
and your hope will never be cut off.

¹⁹ My son,
listen, be wise,
and keep your mind going in the right direction.

²⁰ Do not associate with those who drink too much wine,
with those who eat too much meat,

²¹ because both a drunk and a glutton will become poor.
Drowsiness will dress a person in rags.

23:19–21 Your wisdom keeps my mind going in the right direction. Guard me from people who drag me to drunkenness or greed or laziness.

²² Listen to your father since you are his son,
and do not despise your mother because she is old.
²³ Buy truth (and do not sell it),
└that is,└ buy wisdom, discipline, and understanding.

23:23 I'm determined to get wisdom, discipline, and understanding. When I get hold of them I'll never let them go.

²⁴ A righteous person's father will certainly rejoice.
Someone who has a wise son will enjoy him.
²⁵ May your father and your mother be glad.
May she who gave birth to you rejoice.
²⁶ My son,
give me your heart.
Let your eyes find happiness in my ways.

23:26 I freely give you my whole heart. Your ways make me exceedingly happy.

²⁷ A prostitute is a deep pit.
A loose woman is a narrow well.
²⁸ She is like a robber, lying in ambush.
She spreads unfaithfulness throughout society.

²⁹ Who has trouble?
Who has misery?
Who has quarrels?
Who has a complaint?
Who has wounds for no reason?
Who has bloodshot eyes?

³⁰ Those who drink glass after glass of wine
and mix it with everything.

23:29–30 Drinking too much brings trouble and misery, quarrels and complaints, pointless wounds
and bloodshot eyes. Carve those facts in my mind.

³¹ Do not look at wine
because it is red,
because it sparkles in the cup,
because it goes down smoothly.

³² Later it bites like a snake
and strikes like a poisonous snake.

³³ Your eyes will see strange sights,
and your mouth will say embarrassing things.

23:31–33 Wine sparkles in the glass and goes down smooth, but then it bites like a poisonous snake.
It blurs my vision and makes my mouth say embarrassing things. Carve those facts in my mind.

³⁴ You will be like someone lying down in the middle of the sea
or like someone lying down on top of a ship's mast, saying,

³⁵ "They strike me, but I feel no pain.
They beat me, but I'm not aware of it.

Whenever I wake up, I'm going to look for another drink."

23:34–35 Too much wine makes my body heave as if I'm riding ocean waves. Someone could punch
me but I wouldn't feel pain. I'd just want another drink. Carve those facts in my mind.

24¹ Do not envy evil people
or wish you were with them,
² because their minds plot violence,
and their lips talk trouble.

24:1–2 I won't envy evildoers or wish I could hang out with them. In the end all they get is trouble.

³ With wisdom a house is built.
With understanding it is established.
⁴ With knowledge its rooms are filled
with every kind of riches, both precious and pleasant.

24:3–4 Wisdom not only builds a house but fills it with lavish riches. Build me and fill me like that.

⁵ A strong man knows how to use his strength,
but a person with knowledge is even more powerful.

24:5 Strong people often get what they want, but your knowledge makes me even stronger.

⁶ After all, with the right strategy you can wage war,
and with many advisers there is victory.

⁷ Matters of wisdom are beyond the grasp of a stubborn fool.
At the city gate he does not open his mouth.

⁸ Whoever plans to do evil will be known as a schemer.

24:8 Even worse than doing evil is scheming ahead of time how to carry it out. Clear my mind when I start planning to sin.

⁹ Foolish scheming is sinful,
and a mocker is disgusting to everyone.

¹⁰ If you faint in a crisis, you are weak.

¹¹ Rescue captives condemned to death,
and spare those staggering toward their slaughter.

¹² When you say, “We didn’t know this,”
won’t the one who weighs hearts take note of it?
Won’t the one who guards your soul know it?
Won’t he pay back people for what they do?

24:12 I can pretend I’ve done no wrong, but you take note when I sin. You guard my soul, so you know the evil I’ve been planning. And you pay me back for whatever I do.

¹³ Eat honey, my son, because it is good.
Honey that flows from the honeycomb tastes sweet.
¹⁴ The knowledge of wisdom is like that for your soul.
If you find it, then there is a future,
and your hope will never be cut off.

24:13–14 Your wisdom is like honey for my soul. I eat it because it tastes sweet. It gives me a hopeful future.

¹⁵ You wicked one,
do not lie in ambush at the home of a righteous person.
Do not rob his house.
¹⁶ A righteous person may fall seven times, but he gets up again.
However, in a disaster wicked people fall.
¹⁷ Do not be happy when your enemy falls,
and do not feel glad when he stumbles.
¹⁸ The LORD will see it, he won't like it,
and he will turn his anger away from that person.

24:16–18 I might fall seven times, but each time you pick me up. If I'm glad when my enemy stumbles then my attitude has become the problem.

¹⁹ Do not get overly upset with evildoers.
Do not envy wicked people,
²⁰ because an evil person has no future,
and the lamps of wicked people will be snuffed out.

²¹ Fear the LORD, my son.
Fear the king as well.
Do not associate with those who always insist upon change,

24:19–21 I won't lose sleep over the wicked or envy their success, because you say evildoers don't

have a future. I'll keep living in awe of you.

²² because disaster will come to them suddenly.
Who knows what misery both may bring?

Learning From Wise People

²³ These also are the sayings of wise people:
Showing partiality as a judge is not good.

²⁴ Whoever says to a guilty person, "You are innocent,"
will be cursed by people and condemned by nations.

²⁵ But people will be pleased with those who convict a guilty person,
and a great blessing will come to them.

24:23–25 You hate judges who play favorites and call the guilty innocent. Everyone knows it's good to hold the guilty accountable.

²⁶ Giving a straight answer is like a kiss on the lips.

24:26 Teach me to give answers as straightforward as a kiss on the lips.

²⁷ Prepare your work outside,
and get things ready for yourself in the field.
Afterwards, build your house.

24:27 Give me wisdom to know what I should do first, second, and third.

²⁸ Do not testify against your neighbor without a reason,
and do not deceive with your lips.

²⁹ Do not say,
"I'll treat him as he treated me.
I'll pay him back for what he has done to me."

³⁰ I passed by a lazy person's field,
the vineyard belonging to a person without sense.

³¹ I saw that it was all overgrown with thistles.

The ground was covered with weeds,
and its stone fence was torn down.

³² When I observed └this┐, I took it to heart.

I saw it and learned my lesson.

³³ “Just a little sleep,
just a little slumber,
just a little nap.”

³⁴ Then your poverty will come like a drifter,
and your need will come like a bandit.

24:30–34 There’s laziness all around me—lives overgrown with weeds and left unprotected from enemies. Let that be a lesson to me. Too much sleep, and poverty will overwhelm me.

25¹ These also are Solomon’s proverbs that were copied by the men of King Hezekiah of Judah.

Advice for Kings

² It is the glory of God to hide things
but the glory of kings to investigate them.

³ └Like┐ the high heavens and the deep earth,
so the mind of kings is unsearchable.

⁴ Take the impurities out of silver,
and a vessel is ready for the silversmith to mold.

25:4 Remove the impurities from my life. Mold me into your perfect shape.

⁵ Take a wicked person away from the presence of a king,
and justice will make his throne secure.

⁶ Do not brag about yourself in front of a king
or stand in the spot that belongs to notable people,

⁷ because it is better to be told, “Come up here,”
than to be put down in front of a prince whom your eyes have seen.

25:6–7 I won't assume I deserve a place of high honor. I'll let you invite me up to a better seat rather than set myself up to be put down.

⁸ Do not be in a hurry to go to court.
What will you do in the end if your neighbor disgraces you?

25:8 I won't hurry to court. I don't want to be unnecessarily disgraced.

⁹ Present your argument to your neighbor,
but do not reveal another person's secret.
¹⁰ Otherwise, when he hears about it, he will humiliate you,
and his evil report about you will never disappear.

25:9–10 I won't tell another person's secret. I don't want to humiliate either of us.

¹¹ ׀Like׀ golden apples in silver settings,
׀so׀ is a word spoken at the right time.
¹² ׀Like׀ a gold ring and a fine gold ornament,
׀so׀ is constructive criticism to the ear of one who listens.

25:11–12 I always want to speak the right word at the right time. I choose to welcome constructive criticism.

¹³ Like the coolness of snow on a harvest day,
׀so׀ is a trustworthy messenger to those who send him:
He refreshes his masters.
¹⁴ ׀Like׀ a dense fog or a dust storm,
׀so׀ is a person who brags about a gift that he does not give.

¹⁵ With patience you can persuade a ruler,
and a soft tongue can break bones.

25:15 Teach me to let patience do its amazing work. Remind me that a soft word is stronger than I can imagine.

¹⁶ When you find honey, eat only as much as you need.
Otherwise, you will have too much and vomit.

¹⁷ Do not set foot in your neighbor's house too often.
Otherwise, he will see too much of you and hate you.

25:16–17 Give me good sense not to eat more sweets than I can stomach—and good sense not to overstay my welcome when I'm a guest.

¹⁸ „Like„ a club and a sword and a sharp arrow,
„so„ is a person who gives false testimony against his neighbor.

¹⁹ „Like„ a broken tooth and a lame foot,
„so„ is confidence in an unfaithful person in a „time of„ crisis.

²⁰ „Like„ taking off a coat on a cold day
or pouring vinegar on baking soda,
so is singing songs to one who has an evil heart.

²¹ If your enemy is hungry, give him some food to eat,
and if he is thirsty, give him some water to drink.

²² „In this way„ you will make him feel guilty and ashamed,
and the LORD will reward you.

25:21–22 Give me graciousness and generosity toward my enemies. I'll feed their hunger, quench their thirst, and trust you to change their hearts.

²³ „As„ the north wind brings rain,
so a whispering tongue brings angry looks.

²⁴ Better to live on a corner of a roof
than to share a home with a quarreling woman.

²⁵ „Like„ cold water to a thirsty soul,
so is good news from far away.

25:25 Send me good news I don't expect. It will be a cup of cold water to my thirsty soul.

²⁶ ׀Like׀ a muddied spring and a polluted well,
׀so׀ is a righteous person who gives in to a wicked person.

25:26 When I give in to an evildoer I'm like a muddied spring. Purify me and help me stand up for what's right.

²⁷ Eating too much honey is not good,
and searching for honor is not honorable.[\[24\]](#)

²⁸ ׀Like׀ a city broken into ׀and׀ left without a wall,
׀so׀ is a person who lacks self-control.

25:28 My lack of self-control exposes me like an unprotected city. Train me to take charge of myself!

All About Fools

²⁶¹ Like snow in summertime and rain at harvest time,
so honor is not right for a fool.

26:1 No fool deserves honor. Help me rise above my foolishness.

² Like a fluttering sparrow,
like a darting swallow,
so a hastily spoken curse does not come to rest.

³ A whip is for the horse,
a bridle is for the donkey,
and a rod is for the backs of fools.

26:3 I don't want to be a fool who needs harsh discipline. I'll respond quickly to your commands!

⁴ Do not answer a fool with his own stupidity,
or you will be like him.

26:4 If I answer stupid with stupid, I've become a fool. Don't let me stoop to that.

⁵ Answer a fool with his own stupidity,
or he will think he is wise.

⁶ Whoever uses a fool to send a message
cuts off his own feet and brings violence upon himself.

⁷ „Like„ a lame person's limp legs,
so is a proverb in the mouths of fools.

⁸ Like tying a stone to a sling,
so is giving honor to a fool.

⁹ „Like„ a thorn stuck in a drunk's hand,
so is a proverb in the mouths of fools.

¹⁰ „Like„ many people who destroy everything,
so is one who hires fools or drifters.

¹¹ As a dog goes back to its vomit,
„so„ a fool repeats his stupidity.

26:11 Teach me to recognize stupidity the first time around, so I don't make the same mistake twice.

¹² Have you met a person who thinks he is wise?
There is more hope for a fool than for him.

¹³ A lazy person says,
“There's a ferocious lion out on the road!
There's a lion loose in the streets!”

¹⁴ „As„ a door turns on its hinges,
so the lazy person turns on his bed.

¹⁵ A lazy person puts his fork in his food.
He wears himself out as he brings it back to his mouth.

26:14–15 Wake me from my slumber when I make rest and recreation the most important part of my life.

¹⁶ A lazy person thinks he is wiser than seven people

who give a sensible answer.

26:16 Give me the sense to realize I'm never wiser than a group of sensible people.

- ¹⁷ ḲLikeḲ grabbing a dog by the ears,
ḲsoḲ is a bystander who gets involved in someone else's quarrel.
¹⁸ Like a madman who shoots flaming arrows, arrows, and death,
¹⁹ so is the person who tricks his neighbor and says, "I was only joking!"

26:18–19 When I say, "I was only joking!" I'm like a madman shooting flaming arrows of death. I'll say what I mean and mean what I say.

- ²⁰ Without wood a fire goes out,
and without gossip a quarrel dies down.
²¹ ḲAsḲ charcoal fuels burning coals and wood fuels fire,
so a quarrelsome person fuels a dispute.
²² The words of a gossip are swallowed greedily,
and they go down into a person's innermost being.

26:22 Confront me when I greedily swallow gossip. Slanderous words poison me and all of my relationships.

- ²³ ḲLikeḲ a clay pot covered with cheap silver,
ḲsoḲ is smooth talk that covers up an evil heart.
²⁴ Whoever is filled with hate disguises it with his speech,
but inside he holds on to deceit.
²⁵ When he talks charmingly, do not trust him
because of the seven disgusting things in his heart.
²⁶ His hatred is deceitfully hidden,
but his wickedness will be revealed to the community.

26:23–26 Smooth talkers conceal the evil in their hearts. They disguise the deceit inside them. Help me see through their charm. Then I'll know enough not to trust them.

- ²⁷ Whoever digs a pit will fall into it.

Whoever rolls a stone will have it roll back on him.

²⁸ A lying tongue hates its victims,
and a flattering mouth causes ruin.

All About Life

27¹ Do not brag about tomorrow,
because you do not know what another day may bring.

27:1 I won't brag about tomorrow because I don't know what it will bring. But I count on you to go with me no matter what I face.

² Praise should come from another person and not from your own mouth,
from a stranger and not from your own lips.

27:2 Alert me when I don't realize I'm boasting. I'll wait to hear praise from the lips of others.

³ A stone is heavy, and sand weighs a lot,
but annoyance caused by a stubborn fool is heavier than both.

⁴ Anger is cruel, and fury is overwhelming,
but who can survive jealousy?

⁵ Open criticism is better than unexpressed love.

⁶ Wounds made by a friend are intended to help,
but an enemy's kisses are too much to bear.[\[25\]](#)

27:5–6 Friends wound me to help me. But don't let me fall for enemies who blow me a kiss.

⁷ One who is full despises honey,
but to one who is hungry, even bitter food tastes sweet.

⁸ Like a bird wandering from its nest,
so is a husband wandering from his home.

⁹ Perfume and incense make the heart glad,
but the sweetness of a friend is a fragrant forest.[\[26\]](#)

¹⁰ Do not abandon your friend or your father's friend.
Do not go to a relative's home when you are in trouble.
A neighbor living nearby is better than a relative far away.

27:9–10 Perfume is sweet but a true friend is even sweeter. Teach me to value friends nearby who give me everyday help.

¹¹ Be wise, my son, and make my heart glad
so that I can answer anyone who criticizes me.
¹² Sensible people foresee trouble and hide.
Gullible people go ahead and suffer.

27:12 Let me see trouble coming and find a good place to hide.

¹³ Hold on to the garment of one who guarantees a stranger's loan,
and hold responsible the person who makes a loan in behalf of a foreigner.
¹⁴ Whoever blesses his friend early in the morning with a loud voice—
his blessing is considered a curse.

27:14 I want to be a true blessing to all of my friends. Show me when my efforts fall short, and teach me fresh ways to love.

¹⁵ Constantly dripping water on a rainy day is like a quarreling woman.
¹⁶ Whoever can control her can control the wind.
He can even pick up olive oil with his right hand.[\[27\]](#)

¹⁷ As iron sharpens iron,
so one person sharpens the wits of another.

27:17 I need people to keep me sharp. Help me find friends and mentors and role models who will partner with me in following you.

¹⁸ Whoever takes care of a fig tree can eat its fruit,
and whoever protects his master is honored.

¹⁹ As a face is reflected in water,
so a person is reflected by his heart.
²⁰ Hell and decay are never satisfied,
and a person's eyes are never satisfied.

27:20 I know my eyes can long for more and more of everything. I'll practice being content with what I have.

²¹ The crucible is for refining silver and the smelter for gold,
but a person is tested by the praise given to him.
²² If you crush a stubborn fool in a mortar with a pestle along with grain,[\[28\]](#)
even then his stupidity will not leave him.

27:22 I'll submit to you and learn from you willingly. You won't need to crush me to rid me of stupidity.

²³ Be fully aware of the condition of your flock,
and pay close attention to your herds.
²⁴ Wealth is not forever.
Nor does a crown last from one generation to the next.

²⁵ When grass is cut short, the tender growth appears,
and vegetables are gathered on the hills.
²⁶ Lambs will provide you with clothing,
and the money from the male goats will buy a field.
²⁷ There will be enough goat milk to feed you, to feed your family,
and to keep your servant girls alive.

27:25–27 Open my eyes to all the resources you've given me. They're gifts from you to keep me alive.

28¹ A wicked person flees when no one is chasing him,
but righteous people are as bold as lions.

28:1 I'm bold as a lion but only because you back me up. No matter what I face I won't flee in fear.

² When a country is in revolt, it has many rulers,
but only with a person who has understanding and knowledge
will it last a long time.

28:2 Bring our country together. Give us leaders who get us all going in the right direction.

³ A poor person who oppresses poorer people
is like a driving rain that leaves no food.

⁴ Those who abandon ַGod's teachings praise wicked people,
but those who follow ַGod's teachings oppose wicked people.

⁵ Evil people do not understand justice,
but those who seek the LORD understand everything.

28:5 Keep me from thinking only about me. Teach me about justice. Show me what I can do to
make the world more just.

⁶ Better to be a poor person who has integrity
than to be rich and double-dealing.

⁷ Whoever follows ַGod's teachings is a wise son.
Whoever associates with gluttons disgraces his father.

⁸ Whoever becomes wealthy through ַunfair loans and interest
collects them for the one who is kind to the poor.

28:8 If I gain wealth unfairly, I know you'll give it to someone else—someone who is kind to the
poor.

⁹ Surely the prayer of someone who refuses
to listen to ַGod's teachings is disgusting.

28:9 My prayers disgust you if I refuse to follow your teachings.

¹⁰ Whoever leads decent people into evil will fall into his own pit,
but innocent people will inherit good things.

¹¹ A rich person is wise in his own eyes,
but a poor person with understanding sees right through him.

28:11 Having a lot of money doesn't mean someone is wise. I'll listen to anyone who has genuine understanding.

¹² When righteous people triumph, there is great glory,
but when wicked people rise, people hide themselves.

¹³ Whoever covers over his sins does not prosper.
Whoever confesses and abandons them receives compassion.

¹⁴ Blessed is the one who is always fearful _{of sin},
but whoever is hard-hearted falls into disaster.

28:13–14 As long as I hide my sin I won't prosper. So I'll confess and abandon everything that goes against your commands. I trust in your compassion. I'm blessed to have a healthy fear of sin.

¹⁵ _{Like} a roaring lion and a charging bear,
_{so} a wicked ruler is a threat to poor people.

¹⁶ A leader without understanding taxes _{his people} heavily,
but those who hate unjust gain will live longer.

¹⁷ A person burdened with the guilt of murder
will be a fugitive down to his grave.
No one will help him.

¹⁸ Whoever lives honestly will be safe.
Whoever lives dishonestly will fall all at once.

28:18 Honesty keeps me safe. Dishonesty always puts me in a precarious place.

¹⁹ Whoever works his land will have plenty to eat.
Whoever chases unrealistic dreams will have plenty of nothing.

28:19 You provide me with plenty when I work hard. Show me when my dreams are unrealistic.

²⁰ A trustworthy person has many blessings,
but anyone in a hurry to get rich will not escape punishment.

²¹ Showing partiality is not good,
because some people will turn on you even for a piece of bread.

28:20–21 Let me enjoy the blessings of being regarded as trustworthy. Teach me to not play favorites but to show fairness to everyone.

²² A stingy person is in a hurry to get rich,
not realizing that poverty is about to overtake him.

²³ Whoever criticizes people will be more highly regarded in the future
than the one who flatters with his tongue.

28:23 Nobody will take me seriously if I make a habit of flattery. Train me to offer helpful criticism in the right time and right way.

²⁴ The one who robs his father or his mother
and says, “It isn’t wrong!” is a companion to a vandal.

²⁵ A greedy person stirs up a fight,
but whoever trusts the LORD prospers.

²⁶ Whoever trusts his own heart is a fool.
Whoever walks in wisdom will survive.

²⁷ Whoever gives to the poor lacks nothing.
Whoever ignores the poor receives many curses.

28:25–27 Greed urges me to stir up fights to get what I want. But I’ll trust you to prosper me. I’ll rely on you to guide me. I’ll look for ways to give to the poor.

²⁸ When wicked people rise, people hide.
When they die, righteous people increase.

²⁹¹ A person who will not bend after many warnings
will suddenly be broken beyond repair.

29:1 I'll flex when you warn me and bend your way. Rejecting your warnings will break me beyond repair.

² When righteous people increase, the people ⌋of God⌋ rejoice,
but when a wicked person rules, everybody groans.

29:2 Build up your people to be your righteous and wholehearted followers. We'll all rejoice to see what you do!

³ A person who loves wisdom makes his father happy,
but one who pays prostitutes wastes his wealth.

⁴ By means of justice, a king builds up a country,
but a person who confiscates religious contributions tears it down.

⁵ A person who flatters his neighbor
is spreading a net for him to step into.

⁶ To an evil person sin is bait in a trap,
but a righteous person runs away from it^[29] and is glad.

29:6 Sin pulls me in like bait in a trap. Alert me to the dangers of temptation. I'll run away and be glad!

⁷ A righteous person knows the just cause of the poor.
A wicked person does not understand this.

29:7 I understand the just complaints of the poor. I'll defend the needy every chance I get.

⁸ Mockers create an uproar in a city,
but wise people turn away anger.

⁹ When a wise person goes to court with a stubborn fool,
he may rant and rave,
but there is no peace and quiet.

¹⁰ Bloodthirsty people hate an innocent person,
but decent people seek ⌋to protect⌋ his life.

¹¹ A fool expresses all his emotions,
but a wise person controls them.

29:11 Train me to keep my emotions in check. Teach me the right time and way to express them.

¹² If a ruler pays attention to lies,
all his servants become wicked.

¹³ A poor person and an oppressor have this in common:
The LORD gives both of them sight.

¹⁴ When a king judges the poor with honesty,
his throne will always be secure.

29:14 You'll make me secure when I treat the poor with honesty. Help me see when I'm anything less than honest.

¹⁵ A spanking and a warning produce wisdom,
but an undisciplined child disgraces his mother.

¹⁶ When wicked people increase, crime increases,
but righteous people will witness their downfall.

¹⁷ Correct your son, and he will give you peace of mind.
He will bring delight to your soul.

29:17 I'll choose to discipline my children for their long-term good. In the end I'll enjoy peace of mind.

¹⁸ Without prophetic vision people run wild,
but blessed are those who follow "God's" teachings.

29:18 Speak to your people and lead us. We'll follow you wherever you want us to go.

¹⁹ A slave cannot be disciplined with words.
He will not respond, though he may understand.

²⁰ Have you met a person who is quick to answer?
There is more hope for a fool than for him.

²¹ Pamper a slave from childhood,
and later he will be ungrateful.[\[30\]](#)

²² An angry person stirs up a fight,
and a hothead does much wrong.

²³ A person's pride will humiliate him,
but a humble spirit gains honor.

29:22–23 I'll cool my temper rather than do wrong. I'll silence my pride before I humiliate myself.

²⁴ Whoever is a thief's partner hates his own life.
He will not testify under oath.

²⁵ A person's fear sets a trap └for him┐,
but one who trusts the LORD is safe.

29:25 Fear will trap and destroy me. I'll trust in you and live unafraid.

²⁶ Many seek an audience with a ruler,
but justice for humanity comes from the LORD.

29:26 Everyone looks to powerful people for justice. But I'll rely on you for real help.

²⁷ An unjust person is disgusting to righteous people.
A decent person is disgusting to wicked people.

30¹ The words of Agur, son of Jakeh. Agur's prophetic revelation.

Agur Speaks About God

[To God]

This man's declaration:

"I'm weary, O God.

I'm weary and worn out, O God.

² I'm more like a dumb animal than a human being.
I don't even have human understanding.
³ I haven't learned wisdom.
I don't have knowledge of the Holy One.[\[31\]](#)

30:1-3 I feel weary when I lack a living knowledge of you. I haven't mastered your wisdom and can't claim great human understanding. I'm more like a dumb animal than a human being.

[To the audience]

⁴ “Who has gone up to heaven and come down?
Who has gathered the wind in the palm of his hand?
Who has wrapped water in a garment?
Who has set up the earth from one end to the other?
What is his name or the name of his son?
Certainly, you must know!

30:4 You dwell in heaven and come down to earth. You created earth from end to end. You are God's Son.

⁵ “Every word of God has proven to be true.
He is a shield to those who come to him for protection.
⁶ Do not add to his words,
or he will reprimand you, and you will be found to be a liar.

30:5-6 Your every word proves true. I can't add a single thought to what you say.

A Prayer

[To God]

⁷ “I've asked you for two things.
Don't keep them from me before I die:
⁸ Keep vanity and lies far away from me.
Don't give me either poverty or riches.

Feed me only the food I need,
⁹ or I may feel satisfied and deny you
and say, ‘Who is the LORD?’
or I may become poor and steal
and give the name of my God a bad reputation.

30:7–9 Keep me in a place where I need you—make me not too rich or too poor. If I have too much I won’t rely on you. If I have too little I’ll grow desperate and sin.

Against Slander

[To the audience]

¹⁰ “Do not slander a slave to his master.
The slave will curse you,
and you will be found guilty.”

Four Kinds of People

¹¹ A certain kind of person curses his father
and does not bless his mother.

¹² A certain kind of person thinks he is pure
but is not washed from his own feces.[\[32\]](#)

¹³ A certain kind of person looks around arrogantly
and is conceited.

¹⁴ A certain kind of person,

whose teeth are like swords
and whose jaws are like knives,
devours oppressed people from the earth
and people from among humanity.

30:11–14 Make me fully devoted to my whole family. Keep changing me until I’m truly unsoiled.
Challenge me when I look down on others. And soften my sharp words.

Human Bloodsuckers

¹⁵ The bloodsucking leech has two daughters—
“Give!” and “Give!”

Four Things That Are Never Satisfied

Three things are never satisfied.
Four never say, “Enough!”:
¹⁶ the grave,
a barren womb,
a land that never gets enough water,
a fire that does not say, “Enough!”

Disrespectful Children—Their Punishment

30:15–16 Shield me from harsh demands that won’t go away. Protect me from death and barrenness, from drought and raging fire.

¹⁷ The eye that makes fun of a father and hates to obey a mother
will be plucked out by ravens in the valley and eaten by young vultures.

30:17 Teach me to respect my father and mother. Don’t let me lose my sight.

Four Things of Intrigue

¹⁸ Three things are too amazing to me,
even four that I cannot understand:

¹⁹ an eagle making its way through the sky,
a snake making its way over a rock,
a ship making its way through high seas,
a man making his way with a virgin.

30:18–19 You created a world I can't begin to understand—a place of slyness and flight, of adventure and love.

About the Woman Who Commits Adultery

²⁰ This is the way of a woman who commits adultery:
She eats, wipes her mouth,
and says, “I haven't done anything wrong!”

30:20 Compel me to admit my sin. Don't let me get away with transgressions large or small.

Four Things That Are Intolerable

²¹ Three things cause the earth to tremble,
even four it cannot bear up under:
²² a slave when he becomes king,
a godless fool when he is filled with food,
²³ a woman who is unloved when she gets married,
a maid when she replaces her mistress.

Four Things That Are Small—Yet Smart And Strong

²⁴ Four things on earth are small,
yet they are very wise:
²⁵ Ants are not a strong species,
yet they store their food in summer.
²⁶ Rock badgers are not a mighty species,
yet they make their home in the rocks.
²⁷ Locusts have no king,
yet all of them divide into swarms by instinct.

²⁸ A lizard you can hold in your hands,
yet it can even be found in royal palaces.

30:24–28 Give me the wisdom I see in your creation. Teach me to plan ahead, to create a safe home,
to work well with my companions, to be bold and daring.

Four Things That Move With Dignity

²⁹ There are three things that walk with dignity,
even four that march with dignity:
³⁰ a lion, mightiest among animals, which turns away from nothing,
³¹ a strutting rooster,[\[33\]](#)
a male goat,
a king at the head of his army.[\[34\]](#)

30:29–31 Give me the dignity I see in your creation. When I feel beaten down, help me walk with
self-respect.

Keep Calm and Quiet

³² If you are such a godless fool as to honor yourself,
or if you scheme,
you had better put your hand over your mouth.

30:32 Teach me humility when I get out of hand in honoring myself. I'll start by silencing my
boasting mouth.

³³ As churning milk produces butter
and punching a nose produces blood,
so stirring up anger[\[35\]](#) produces a fight.

31¹ The sayings of King Lemuel, a prophetic revelation,
used by his mother to discipline him.

Advice to a Prince

² “What, my son?

What, son to whom I gave birth?

What, son of my prayers?

³ Don’t give your strength to women
or your power to those who ruin kings.

⁴ “It is not for kings, Lemuel.

It is not for kings to drink wine or for rulers to crave liquor.

⁵ Otherwise, they drink and forget what they have decreed
and change the standard of justice for all oppressed people.

31:4–5 Remind me of the risks of alcohol—making me forget my own important decisions and causing me to lower my standards of how I treat others.

⁶ Give liquor to a person who is dying
and wine to one who feels resentful.

⁷ Such a person drinks
and forgets his poverty and does not remember his trouble anymore.

⁸ “Speak out for the one who cannot speak,
for the rights of those who are doomed.

⁹ Speak out,
judge fairly,
and defend the rights of oppressed and needy people.”

31:8–9 I’ll find ways to speak up for people who can’t speak up for themselves. I’ll defend the rights of the oppressed and needy.

A Poem in Hebrew Alphabetical Order

¹⁰ “Who can find a wife with a strong character?
She is worth far more than jewels.

¹¹ Her husband trusts her with לֵּאמֹר his heart,
and he does not lack anything good.

¹² She helps him and never harms him all the days of
her life.

31:10–12 Discipline me so I develop strong character. Make me worthy of the total trust of others.
Every day of my life I want to be a source of help, not harm.

¹³ “She seeks out wool and linen ⌋with care⌋
and works with willing hands.

¹⁴ She is like merchant ships.
She brings her food from far away.

¹⁵ She wakes up while it is still dark
and gives food to her family
and portions of food to her female slaves.

¹⁶ “She picks out a field and buys it.
She plants a vineyard from the profits she has earned.

¹⁷ She puts on strength like a belt
and goes to work with energy.

¹⁸ She sees that she is making a good profit.
Her lamp burns late at night.

31:13–18 I can’t provide for my family without your help. I need your strength to work hard and long. I need your wisdom to earn a living.

¹⁹ “She puts her hands on the distaff,
and her fingers hold a spindle.

²⁰ She opens her hands to oppressed people
and stretches them out to needy people.

²¹ She does not fear for her family when it snows
because her whole family has a double layer of clothing.

²² She makes quilts for herself.
Her clothes are ⌋made of⌋ linen and purple cloth.

31:20–22 With your help I’ll give generously to the oppressed and needy. I’ll shelter my own family and keep them warm. I’ll provide them with good things.

²³ “Her husband is known at the city gates
when he sits with the leaders of the land.

²⁴ “She makes linen garments and sells them
and delivers belts to the merchants.

²⁵ She dresses with strength and nobility,
and she smiles at the future.

²⁶ “She speaks with wisdom,
and on her tongue there is tender instruction.

31:25–26 I dream of strength and nobility and optimism. I want wisdom for myself and others. I need watchful eyes for my family and energy for work. Increase those qualities in me.

²⁷ She keeps a close eye on the conduct of her family,
and she does not eat the bread of idleness.

²⁸ Her children and her husband
stand up and bless her.

In addition, he sings her praises, by saying,

²⁹ ‘Many women have done noble work,
but you have surpassed them all!’

³⁰ “Charm is deceptive, and beauty evaporates,
but a woman who has the fear of the LORD should be praised.

³¹ Reward her for what she has done,
and let her achievements praise her at the city gates.”

31:27–30 Make me a blessing and not a burden. I want my work to stand out. Give me enduring character as I live in awe of you.

[1] 2:22 Or “will be swept away.”

[2] 3:6 Or “straight.”

[3] 3:9 Or “harvest.”

[4] 5:19 Or “graceful goat.”

[5] 6:33 Or “wounds.”

[6] 7:22 Hebrew meaning of this line uncertain.

- [7] 8:5 English equivalent difficult.
- [8] 8:30 Hebrew meaning of “master craftsman” uncertain.
- [9] 9:13 Hebrew meaning of this verse uncertain.
- [10] 11:25 Or “and whoever gives someone a drink will also get a drink.”
- [11] 12:6 Or “mouths.”
- [12] 12:12 Hebrew meaning of this verse uncertain.
- [13] 12:27 Hebrew meaning uncertain.
- [14] 12:27 Hebrew meaning of this line uncertain.
- [15] 13:15 Masoretic Text; Greek “is their disaster.”
- [16] 14:16 Hebrew meaning uncertain.
- [17] 14:33 Hebrew meaning of this line uncertain.
- [18] 17:8 Or “who receives it.”
- [19] 18:24 Or “A person has friends as companions.”
- [20] 19:23 Hebrew meaning of this line uncertain.
- [21] 20:4 Fall was the start of the planting season in Palestine.
- [22] 20:20 Or “snuffed out as darkness approaches.”
- [23] 21:8 Hebrew meaning of this verse uncertain.
- [24] 25:27 Hebrew meaning of this line uncertain.
- [25] 27:6 Hebrew meaning of “are too much to bear” uncertain.
- [26] 27:9 Or “is sincere advice.”
- [27] 27:16 Hebrew meaning of this line uncertain.
- [28] 27:22 Hebrew meaning uncertain.
- [29] 29:6 Hebrew meaning of “runs away from it” uncertain.
- [30] 29:21 Hebrew meaning uncertain.
- [31] 30:3 Or “holy ones.”
- [32] 30:12 Blunt Hebrew term but not considered vulgar.
- [33] 30:31 Hebrew meaning of this line uncertain.
- [34] 30:31 Hebrew meaning of “at the head of his army” uncertain.
- [35] 30:33 In Hebrew there is a play on words in verse 33 where the same verb is used to express all three actions.

About the Author

Kevin Johnson is the bestselling author or coauthor of more than fifty books and Bible products for youth and adults. With a background as a youth worker, senior editor, and teaching pastor, he now pastors Emmaus Road Church in metro Minneapolis. He holds an MDiv from Fuller Theological Seminary and a BA in English and print journalism from the University of Wisconsin–River Falls. Kevin is married to Lyn, and they have three children. Learn more at www.kevinjohnsonbooks.com.

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